

Container Corporation of India Ltd. (CONCOR)

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Call: May 2023

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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

(A Navratna CPSE of Govt of India)

No.CON/F&CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No .293/NoteNo.196

Dated: 26.05.2023

1. The Bombay Stock Exchange Ltd., Mumbai (Through BSE Listing Centre)

Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Dalal Street

Mumbai-400001

2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (Through NEAPS)

Exchange Plaza, 5th Floor, Plot No. C/1,G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E)

Mumbai-400 051

Dear Sir/Madam,

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Requirer:nents) Regulations, 2015.

Pursuant to applicable provisions of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find

enclosed transcript of Post results conference call held on 19.05.2023.

For your information and record please.

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Regd. Office: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Matbura Road, New Delhi-110076

~/Tel.011-41673093 ,011-49512150,011-49512160

{-l@/ E-mail.co.pro @concorindia.com CIN: L63011DL1988GOI030915

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"Container Corporation of India Limited

Q4 FY 22-23 Earnings Conference Call"

May 19, 2023

MANAGEMENT : MR. V. KALYANA RAMA – CHAIRMAN & MANAGING
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

MR. MANOJ KUMAR DUBEY – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) -
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

MR. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS &
SERVICES) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

MR. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR
(DOMESTIC) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM C APITAL ADVISORS
LIMITED

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CAPITAL C H O R L L'

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Container Corporation of India Limited Q4 FY23 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Dam Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from Dam Capital Advisors. Thank you and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, thanks. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Container Corporation of India's Q4 FY23 earnings call. We have the management today being represented by Mr. V. Kalyana Rama, Chairman and Managing Director, and his entire senior team. I'll now hand over the floor to Mr. Rama for his initial remarks and post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A.

Over to you, sir.

V. Kalyana Rama: Thank you, Bhoomika, and good morning to all of you. Thank you for joining for the conference call and to share our views on our business and the future. Last year, we could achieve around 7% growth in our volumes. Even though there is a strain on volumes in EXIM, we are facing some headwinds. We are working on them. So let me share with you some customers are taking some positions because of the continued uncertainty going about the divestment, but then we found the solutions for that and we are positively getting the response for that and we are working on that.

Very interesting thing which happened in the EXIM sector is the direct connection to Dadri for the DFC. So that has enabled us to run the double stack train direct from Dadri into Mundra and and Pipavav and the time

taken is less than 24 hours. So, a lot of diversion of road, cargo to rail we are expecting in that, even time sensitive cargo, light cargo.

We also started the movement of reefer containers and double stack from Dadri. That's a new thing we started. So, with all these developments, this year we will be able to withstand the headwinds in the EXIM cargo.

Domestic we are doing very well. This is the third year where we could see a good growth in domestic. On revenue side, we grow by 25%. On the volume side by almost 15%. This year also we are working out to grow in the same manner. Maybe our targets are very high, but there are certain constraints in that. The main constraint is the container availability because we stopped importing from China and we are developing in Atmanadbar, Bharat. We released 19,000 containers manufacturing in India, but the ecosystem development is still taking time. So, the container manufacturing is not going at the pace which we expect and which we want. So, there is a shortage of domestic container. ~ ~

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As of now we are able to maintain our supply lines, but to grow faster we require more containers. So we are working on different aspects like getting some containers on lease. We are working on that. And also, we are releasing further orders for container manufacturing to make the interest that was generated in more and more manufacturers. So, a lot of effort is going on in this direction.

Wheel and axle, there is an issue of availability in India. So, we are working with railways and we are with other manufacturers for developing these wheel and axles. And to get rakes rolled out from wagon manufacturers. So that also we are working on. Of course, these two constraints will be there towards the growth, but we are hopeful that we will be able to overcome these constraints.

And with that, the domestic growth we expect this year to be very good. And EXIM, the export-import scenario is one worrisome factor because the economies in the Western world and the other places are not very encouraging the commentaries what we are hearing. There is the issue of recession, as also people are talking of.

But the domestic side, India is growing. And if the EXIM scenario increases, we will get more

growth. And as of now, the existing EXIM volume, we are trying to get more share. Our share is getting affected, that we are working on to recover back that share, where we were. And this double stack operations and other schemes which we are coming out, like the existing schemes which are running off 50% discount on empty repositioning from port to hinterland. And one plus one scheme we introduced last year. We are seeing a lot of good tailwinds in that. So we will be able to get some more schemes coming out with those schemes as the things progress. So as of now, I am not very much worried about the scenario for the next financial year, even though the task is very tough on the EXIM side. But I am hopeful that my team will be able to come out with new things and will be able to withstand all these pressures and will be able to get that growth, which we always start with around 10% to 12% growth for the year. This year also we are starting our financial year. We started with the same assumptions and we are working towards that.

The rest of the things I will answer as the conference progresses. Thank you.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Amit Dixit: Good morning, everyone. Thanks for taking my question, sir. I have two questions. The first one is on capex. In the last concall, you rightly indicated that capex would be back in the next year. We have seen capex increasing in Q4. If you can just highlight the main areas of capex last year in FY23 and how much capex can be expected in FY24 and in

what areas? That is the first question.

V. Kalyana Rama: DPS, Director Projects will answer your first question.

Ajit Kumar Panda: As far as capex is concerned, we have got investment into going into terminals, rolling stock, that is wagons, procurement of containers. We have four new terminals last year and we are hoping to commission another five terminals in FY24. For rolling stock, we are expecting to add ~ ~ CONCOR

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anything between 24 to 36 trains in FY24. We are expecting a capex of about INR600 crores in FY24 vis-à-vis we have got INR560 crores last year.

In INR560 crores, the major investment has been made in rolling stock related activities.

Although we have not got the rolling stock physically, we are expecting them delivered this year, we have invested in getting new wheels, rolling stock components, manufacturing activities and axles. So, the major part, that is about INR300 crores we have spent on rolling stock alone.

V. Kalyana Rama: This year also, the major portion of the capex expenditure will be on the rolling stock and the handling machinery.

Amit Dixit: Okay, that is very clear, sir. The second question is on margins. Now, if I look at your margins from Q2, margins have gone one way down from 25% EBITDA margin I am talking about to 20.4% in this quarter. And since you have highlighted that there is a strain on the EXIM volume, while I am not asking you to crystal gaze and tell us the margins, I just wanted to get what kind of EXIM growth are we targeting and what kind of empty running costs were there in this quarter?

V. Kalyana Rama: See, as I mentioned in my comments, I look at try to achieve the 10% growth in EXIM volume also. So as I already mentioned in my inaugural remarks that the DFC running now is going to help us. So that is where we are putting our cards and we are trying to work on the positive impact which it can bring on. So, to start with, we will work with the 10%, but things are not very encouraging in EXIM.

Actual export-import scenario itself is not very good. The Indian exports are under strain, like handicrafts are not going, merchandise exports are less, except primary agro exports, other exports are less and a lot of empty-container inventories are building up in India. So, it is one way it is good that export freight rates have come down, but the export scenario is not good, that is why the empty-container inventory is increasing.

So now coming to, as I said, even though exports may not increase, but the existing EXIM volume, our share has come down. In the last year, we lost some percentage share. Now we are working on to regain that share back. So that is the main thrust area this year we are concentrating. So we will get back our share, so that will increase our EXIM volumes. And also we are working on increasing our margins by improving more and more double-stack. So there is a possibility of increasing double-stack because now we are doing it directly. And also, domestic we are trying to bring into double-stack operation.

This is a new thing. So that -- because now we got two hubs on DFC one is Swarupganj. That is near Palanpur. And then 1 in Dadri, NCR. So between these 2 hubs, there's distance of around 650 kilometers. We are working on bringing even domestic on to double stack. That will also increase some margins for domestic as well. So these are all of the things we are working on. So

this is a continuous improvement to us as we keep on doing, so with that, maybe we will be able to maintain our margins.

Amit Dixit: Okay, great. And the empty running cost in this quarter, EXIM and domestic? ~ ~

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V. Kalyana Rama: Empty running, INR94 crores. Domestic is INR87 crores and EXIM is INR7 crores.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from Deepak Krishnan from Macquarie. Please go ahead.

Deepak Krishnan: Sir, I just wanted to understand. You said you lost market share. So maybe could you share the overall market share number at the end of the year? And also, port-wise, where are you in terms of market share, at Mundra, JNPT and Pipavav?

M. Azhar Shams: Yes. I'm Director, Domestic, Mohammad Azhar Shams. Could you please, I mean, repeat your question? And do you want to know the port share of CONCOR? Or I mean -- what share you are talking about, please?

Deepak Krishnan: So overall share in rail, like you indicated you have lost share. Last quarter, you indicated you were at 58%. So I want to know in the CTO market, what is CONCOR share? And individually at JNPT port, Mundra port and Pipavav port, what are the market shares? Like last quarter, you indicated about 79% at JNPT, 38% at Mundra and 48% at Pipavav. So similar number.

M. Azhar Shams: Actually, this overall share of CONCOR combined together, if you talk about the whole of this country-wide movement taking place...

Deepak Krishnan: It is only in EXIM, sir.

V. Kalyana Rama: Port share is not readily available because Director International Marketing, Sanjay Swarup is not here. So you send the email, we will answer you.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, sir. Maybe then I just wanted to understand, there has been a substantial jump in other expenses this quarter. Has there been any sort of one-off cost or any factor that has caused, because our segmental margins are quite strong, but unallocable expenses...

Manoj Kumar Dubey: You are talking about other operating expenses?

Deepak Krishnan: Yes. So I can just give you the number as well in case that sort of helps you.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So in other operating expenses, there is not much that we have enhanced, except for the fact that in the TKD depot, there was some MCD tax issue was there. And in Mulund depot, there was some -- that was made for dispensing with some hazardous containers. These are the two culprits because of that we have taken some hit in that area. The rest, it is as usual.

Deepak Krishnan: So, sir, it's not just other operating expenses, other expenses as well, which is closer to about INR103 crores this quarter in standalone versus INR59 crores, about INR59.78 crores the previous quarter. So, Q1-Q2, there has been a doubling, whereas, you know, revenues are at a similar level?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: No, in other operating expenses, it's not from INR138 crores, we have gone down to INR134 crores. And in administration and other expenses, yes, from INR268 crores to INR312 crores, that is INR40 crores that we have gone up. Right?

Deepak Krishnan: Yes. ~ ~

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Manoj Kumar Dubey: So, this INR40 crores break-up I told you, there are around INR10 crores that we paid at Tulagabad depot for MCD taxes that were... some dispute was going on and under the court order, we had to pay that. After that, there is some repair and maintenance work we have taken heavily in our depot that is costing us INR15 crores. INR6.74 crores has gone to the Mulund depot, as I mentioned to you, for disposing some hazardous materials. And CSR payment has gone up by INR5 crores in this FY. And there is something else we are doing in this bulk cement business, where we have booked around INR2 crores. So, that quantifies for nearly INR40 crores of expenses that has gone up. But if you look at other operating expenses, there we have gone down from INR138 crores to INR134 crores.

Deepak Krishnan: Yes. Yes. Maybe just one, if I can squeeze in, could you just share your originating volumes for the quarter?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: Volume?

Deepak Krishnan: Yes. Okay.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: The originating volume... So, for EXIM, it is 1.1 lakh. It is 19,18,079 for FY. And for domestic

business, it is 4,40,878.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, sir. So, could y

ou just repeat that again? 19 lakhs?

M. Azhar Shams: 19,18,079. That is the EXIM originating volume. And the domestic is 4,40,878.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, sir. So, those were my questions. And thanks for the opportunity.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is on the line of Atul Tiwari from Citigroup. Please go ahead.

Atul Tiwari: Yes, sir. Thanks a lot. So, just wanted to get your view on the margin profile for domestic business. And the context is that, if they are, you know, obviously, the company has done very well. And now on a per TEU basis, you know, even at this level of volume, it is almost similar to Exim. So, margins have really expanded. So, if the volume ramp up from here, can we potentially look at further expansion in per TEU in terms of domestic business? And can it even go higher than EXIM?

V. Kalyana Rama: No, see, Atul, the domestic margin per TEU we are trying to improve upon, but they are always not comparable to Exim volume. See, Exim, every moment is paid for us. Because we undertake movement on behalf of the shipping line or other customers. In domestic, if there is an empty repositioning, it is at our cost. So, that is where actually we take a hit on our margins. So, our, always our endeavor is to reduce as much of empty running as possible. But as the business grows at a faster pace, there is always an inherent empty repositioning involved in this.

Till we get, you know, a better circuit built up for the new business we are getting. So, this is, the margin expansion cannot be much faster. In fact, to improve our margins in domestic, what we are working on is we are adding value-added services. So, value-added services in the form of first mile, last mile deliveries, business support solutions, and distribution logistics, which we are talking, I am talking of for last four or five years now, to start off as early as possible. ~ ~

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That is a total asset like business. So, with these things, we want to improve our margins for domestic business.

Atul Tiwari: Okay, sir. And just a second question on the EXIM, originating volume. So, the number that you gave 19,18,000 for this year, if I like look at the history, I mean, we did the similar number, say, FY15 also. So, almost like seven, eight years. And, you know, it has been kind of flattish. So, you know, what is the strategy to kind of build numbers from here?

V. Kalyana Rama: You can't take 116 and 123 say flattish, there was a growth in between. Now it has come down, actually. I already told you, we lost some market share. There is a lot of competition for us. And the uncertainty of divestment, some customers are taking some positions. Okay, so this actually, we lost some volume of EXIM in the last year.

We lost our market share. So, we come out with a new scheme in the month of November, one plus one scheme. So, after a threshold volume, if anybody offers us one loaded container, we'll move on empty container free. So, that is one scheme which has been taken up by all my customers very enthusiastically and the volumes are increasing. We are already continuing our empty repositioning scheme.

So, we are now working on coming up with some new schemes. As I said, reefer containers, we put on to double stack. We are going to come out with some scheme with reefer containers. So, these are all the things which we are coming out to withstand the competition and also to overcome the uncertainty problems which we are having for four years. So, we are working on that.

Atul Tiwari: Okay, sir. And sir, finally, very quickly, could you say the domestic originating volume number again? I missed that. Sorry. Domestic originating volume.

V. Kalyana Rama: Can we go to next question, please?

Moderator: Yes, sir. Thank you. The next question is from the line of Abhishek Ghosh from DSP. Please go ahead.

Abhishek Gh

osh: Yes. Hi, sir. Thanks for the opportunity. So, just wanted to, just on the market share loss part of it, just wanted to understand one thing. Is it because of supply addition, terminal addition by competition or is it a pricing strategy that has been taken by competition that has led to market share loss?

V. Kalyana Rama: Both are there. Both play a factor because the competition pricing strategy is CONCOR minus. So, there is no pricing strategy. If I say my price is X, they will say X minus 3000. Okay. And competition is not the other people operating on the rail alone. So, we don't see that as a very big competition. Competition is road as well. Road network is improving, lot of express way are coming up and the things are moving very fast. So, we have to match that. Okay. These are

the two factors.

Abhishek Ghosh: And, sir, since you also spoke about the market share loss in the last quarter as well, is it fair to assume that the market share loss has now at least got arrested and, you know, it will be stable ~ ~

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now? Is it fair to assume that?

V. Kalyana Rama: In fact, you can assume positively. See, think positive. That is the essence of life. So, what we are working on is a more market share. Stabilize the market share.

Abhishek Ghosh: Great. And, sir, just one last thing on the domestic part of the business is how has been the traction on the cement part of this thing, if you can just enlighten us with that?

V. Kalyana Rama: See, we did handle around 3,700 or 3,800 containers last year. So, last month in the month of March, we touched 800. So, there is a lot of interest. Now, things are stabilized. So, but there is, that is a major issue. So, we are not really pushing it very fast. We require 25,000 more containers. But India container manufacturing industry has yet to pick up. So, we are working in a balanced way.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from Ankita Shah from Elara Capital. Please go ahead.

Ankita Shah: Yes, thank you for the opportunity. So, my question is on LLF. What will be the LLF amount this year FY '24?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So, you want to know what we paid this year or what you are expecting to pay this year? What is your question?

Ankita Shah: Expecting to pay this year, '24?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So, actually, you will see that on the actual basis, if you recall our concall in Q1 and Q2, where you mentioned very clearly that for the FY '22, '23, we were paying on actual basis because by that time, we have got all the rates of the land. So, last year, we ended up paying around INR392 crores. So, we just add 7% on that. So, that comes out to be something around INR430 crores.

Ankita Shah: Okay. And no more adjustments to the number or the land dominance that is not defined.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: As we disclosed to you last year also that we have already made provisions of around INR70 crores with us. So, by and large, most of the places we have already reconciled the things with the Indian Railways. A few parcels are still there, but we have got enough questions with us.

Okay. So, what I was mentioning that we have got enough questions with us in provisioning in FY '22, '23. So, '21, '22. So, that provision is already there and we are on the mode of reconciling things. Most of the things have been done with the Indian Railways. And the few cases where if any further payment is required to be done, provision already exists. So, in this FY, whatever we are required to pay is on actual basis, that is 392 plus 7%. This is what we are planning to pay. I hope I am very clear.

Ankita Shah: Yes, sir. Absolutely. So, secondly, on the realization part, do we see more pressure on the realizations for the EXIM and what about domestic side? How much should we take that going forward?

V. Kalyana Rama: I think, Ankita, I answered this question now for two,

three guys. ~ ~

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Ankita Shah: Sir, on the realization part, you said you mentioned about the market share and the margins.

V. Kalyana Rama: I said margins also, there is a pressure. So, that is what realization is, isn't it? So, margin, there will be pressure on EXIM, because we will be trying to get our market share back. So, we will be coming out with schemes. But that pressure on market, we stand by improving our double stack operation from Dadri and try to reduce more and more empty running. And domestic, as I said, the circuit building which we do, as we add new traffic, there will be more of empty running. Then we will start to scout for more traffic in the reverse directions and we build the circuits. And also, we are adding value-added services.

Ankita Shah: Got it. Lastly, if you can share the double stacking of trains that we run in this year?

V. Kalyana Rama: Last year, 4,100 double stacks compared to 3,750 a year before. This year, we are trying to bring domestic into double stack. So, our aim and my target to my team is that we must cross 5,000 double stacks this year.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Abhishek Nigam from B&K Securities. Please go ahead.

Abhishek Nigam: Yes. Thank you for the opportunity. So, if you can just update us on the five new terminals, where are they coming up and will they commence operations in FY '24 or '25?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. We are coming up with one in Jodhpur. You know the Kalinga Nagar steel cluster, that very large steel cluster. Then the second one, we have got one on competition, one Mandelgarh. Then we are building the Burnham which has been notified but it will be connected to DFC on the other side. Then we are also planning a terminal on south of Delhi for which the land acquisition is under discussion with the Haryana government. Then another terminal we are trying to have in Punjab. So, about five terminals we are planning for FY '23-'24.

Abhishek Nigam: Okay. So, '24, '25?

Ajit Kumar Panda: These are for '23, '24.

Abhishek Nigam: So, okay. Calendar year '23, '24. Yes. Fair enough. Fair enough. And just on the DFC, if you can, whatever latest updates, if you have any thoughts on, especially for the final connectivity for JNPT?

V. Kalyana Rama: No. You have to ask DFC.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Yes. Good morning, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. My first question was, what is the contribution in terms of the volume sourced by our associates or trade partners which is coming on to our rakes for FY '23?

V. Kalyana Rama: What is that? Associate trade partner. What is that? ~ ~

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Achal Lohade: Associates or trade partners who are sourcing the volumes and using our rakes for the movement?

V. Kalyana Rama: So, we call them business associates, BAs. So, domestic volume may, it is, except corporate customers, everything will come through BAs only. So, the volume will be something like 60% is through BAs. So, 60% of domestic volume is through associates.

Achal Lohade: Sorry, sir. I could not hear in between. You said 50% of the domestic volume is through business associates, right? Have I got the number right?

V. Kalyana Rama: 60%.

Achal Lohade: 60. Okay. And how about EXIM, sir?

V. Kalyana Rama: EXIM, there is no associate. No, EXIM, it is, you know, booking at the terminal. There is no concept of associate in EXIM. Where from you got this concept?

Achal Lohade: No, I am just asking, sir. Domestic, I was aware. So, that is why I wanted to know the percentage?

V. Kalyana Rama: In EXIM, it is, directly the CHAs, the exporters, importers, some, see, in imports, it is entirely through s

hipping lines. All the imports, shipping lines are our customers. Shipping lines directly give us the volumes. On export side, now the scenario is shipping lines operate some places, CHAs operate some places, there are some places where directly customers are operating. It is a mixed bag.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Sir, sorry, I am hopping on the market share question. You know, is the market share loss at a particular port terminal or is it at a particular pocket, ICD pocket? Can you clarify a little bit on that? Or it is across the board, sir, in the EXIM segment?

V. Kalyana Rama: EXIM segment, major, basically the competition which we feel is on the, this western sector, particularly Mundra and NCR sector. So, that is where the competition is really tough and where we lost some market share, we are working on that.

Achal Lohade: Got it. Sir, just a margin guidance with respect to EXIM and domestic for the full year, sir. That is about it from mine. Thank you.

V. Kalyana Rama: Margin guidance, as I said here in my opening remarks, we will try to maintain the same margins.

Achal Lohade: Of fourth quarter. Have I got it right, sir?

V. Kalyana Rama: What we have seen this financial year.

Achal Lohade: Financial year, okay, sir.

V. Kalyana Rama: We don't work on quarter-on-quarter, no? So, that you people try to do it because, see, long term investors I got, they don't bother about quarter-on-quarter performance. They look at it for the ~ ~

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next five years performance.

Achal Lohade: Absolutely, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Priyankar Biswas from Nomura. Please go ahead.

Priyankar Biswas: Thank you, sir, for the opportunity. So, sir, my first question is, as you had indicated that the number of double stacking will increase from 4,100 to around 5,000. So, if that happens to what extent should our EXIM profitability should go up?

V. Kalyana Rama: I am not analyst. As I said in many conferences, people are listening to me for last seven years, I don't do these guess works. You see, there will be definitely increase in margins. Now, what percentage, how many percent basis points, that I really don't know.

Priyankar Biswas: Sir, you are guiding for same margins in EXIM...

V. Kalyana Rama: I said, yes? Because there will be, see, there are factors we are getting affected by the competition, some headwinds against us. So, we are working on. So, maintaining the same margin in logistics business what we got for this financial year is itself a very tough task and it's, the margins at this level, logistics business is very tough. I don't think any other logistics operator are coming out with these margins.

Priyankar Biswas: That's true.

V. Kalyana Rama: Yes. Thank you for accepting.

Priyankar Biswas: So, sir, and one more thing is, sir, you have been highlighting about the first mile and last mile to improve the services to your customers. So, at this point, how much of a network, like, in terms of terminals, do we have this full first mile and last mile coverage?

V. Kalyana Rama: We got now almost all terminals covered under first mile, last mile. Okay. So, and growth also is very good in that. So, like last year, we handled almost more than 0.5 million TEUs. So, our target is 50% of the volumes we handle. Something like we handle originating volumes of 2.2 million to 2.3 million. So, we want to handle almost 1 million to 1.25 million TEUs under our FMLM in this arc by the next financial year. That is our target. We are working on that.

And moreover, to improve the productivity on the FMLM side, what we are trying to do, we ordered 100 LNG trucks. Order is already placed. In fact, if you people followed Honorable Transport Minister, Shri Nitin Gadkari ji, he mentioned in one of his speeches that he inaugurated the first LNG truck from t

he Pune company. So, that is where we placed our orders,

100 LNG trucks. So, these LNG trucks we will be introducing and we will be putting our LNG station in our own terminal. We are already tying up with the oil companies. Their oil companies are also very much interested. So, once we start with this, when we experience this for two-three months, then we will proliferate this across all our main terminals with LNG transportation. And let me tell you, the LNG transport will be at the 50% cost of diesel transport.

Priyankar Biswas: So, the running cost would be like 50% lower for the LNG trucks, so something like that? ~ ~ CONCOR

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V. Kalyana Rama: Yes. So, that is not 50% of the cost. There are other costs. So, the fuel cost in the local transportation is something like you can work, you can account it for 40% to 45%. So, you will save 20%-25% of money in the local transportation.

Priyankar Biswas: Okay, okay, sir. Just if I may squeeze just one more in. So, your double stacking has risen very sharply, like FY '23 versus FY '22, but the increase in profitability in EXIM is sort of range bound. I mean, is there any other factor that we need to be aware of, like what is like preventing the EXIM margins from going up high? I understand it's one of the highest in the industry, but still.

V. Kalyana Rama: See, the empty running cost, Railways was giving 25% discount on empty in '21-'22. Now, last year it is withdrawn. And then there is a 5% reduction in the load run. That is reduced, but we have not increased our rates. So, we have absorbed these costs, 25% in the empty. When I say empty, it is not only empty racks, empty container movement as well. And all that 25% cost in domestic as well as in EXIM also we absorbed. And 5% increase in the loaded runs we absorbed. So, these are all the pressure on the margins. So, that is where we could maintain our margins only with a little bit of pressure on margins because of our improved double stack, improved operations and faster turnaround of rakes.

Priyankar Biswas: Yes, sir. That's very clear, sir. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mukesh Saras from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Mukesh Saras: Yes, sir. Good afternoon and thank you for the opportunity. My first question is again on the

market share, but you had commented that road transportation is also getting extremely competitive. So, with the backdrop of double stacking, DFC, timetable trains, we would actually expect the opposite where rail would have gotten a lot more competitive. So, just trying to understand what are the reasons that road is also gaining share over rail or getting more competitive?

V. Kalyana Rama: Have I said that, that road is gaining share?

Mukesh Saras: No, I mean, okay. It is competitive because of which it's probably impacting your margins or market share.

V. Kalyana Rama: Hey, competition is a word that means road is not giving up. So, as we are improving things, there are improvements in road also. There are expressways coming up. See, now Delhi-Mumbai expressway, Honorable Minister is talking of moving in 16 hours from Delhi to Mumbai. So, when I say competition, it doesn't mean that they are gaining. Now, that you should never understand like that. Competition means they are also equally improving things. So, we have to keep on improving our things to maintain our share as well as our margins.

Mukesh Saras: Right. But is it fair to assume road has not lost share still because in the last two, three years with DFC and double stacking, we had assumed there will be a movement from road to rail. Is that happening or not? ~ ~

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V. Kalyana Rama: We gained share. Now, see, I don't maintain the entire All India Statistics. So, these figures, we

have to see. Whether how much road has gained, how much rail has gained, we have to see. But definitely, we gained some traffic because of the double stack running we are doing and the domestic, the DFC connecting to Dadri now happened this year. So, this year, we are definitely expecting more volumes to come to us when we are seeing the traction. You see, when I tweeted on my handle about the double stack, the connection of Dadri directly into Mundra, it got a number of hits. There's so much of interest in that.

Mukesh Saras: Okay. So, we should assume that probably with more connectivity now, this could be an inflection point. We could gain a lot more share from road going ahead, sir?

V. Kalyana Rama: You are a bull or a bear, tell me, then I will tell what you are saying.

Mukesh Saras: No, but on the ground, you would be a better...

V. Kalyana Rama: Definitely, right. We see from Dadri to Mundra now, the container is moving within 24 hours.

Mukesh Saras: Sure.

V. Kalyana Rama: So, no road can take this to 24 hours to Mundra. So, it's all expressways. Now, JNPT connection with the dedicated freight corridor, I can't comment on that. As it comes, it happens. Then we will be definitely compete with the Mumbai-Delhi expressway. Mumbai-Delhi expressway, somebody is talking of 16 hours, that is for a car. If somebody is driving without non-stop, that is the -- so, a truck will take maybe 30 hours if you go with a double driver. So, then there is always the rail, the dedicated freight corridor will reach within 24 hours to JNPT. These are all the improvements which are coming in rail sector, they will be competing with the road. So, road is doing competition. So, rail also has to keep on improving things.

Mukesh Saras: Got it, sir. Thank you. And secondly, sir, what are the rail freight margins in this fourth quarter?

V. Kalyana Rama: 26%.

Mukesh Saras: 26%. All right. And lastly, the lead distances, if you could give for both domestic and EXIM?

V. Kalyana Rama: Lead distance are almost same for the -- lead distance, you want to know for what? For the quarter?

Mukesh Saras: Yes, for the quarter, if you could?

V. Kalyana Rama: Quarter, it is 657 in EXIM and 1,382 in domestic.

Mukesh Saras: Sure. All right, sir. Thank you so much for this. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is in the line of Vikram Suryavanshi from PhillipCapital. Please go ahead.

Vikram Suryavanshi: No, my question is answered. Thanks. ~ ~

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V. Kalyana Rama: Okay, Vikram. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Ragmindra Rathore from Dolat Capital. Please go

ahead.

Ragmindra Rathord: Yes, sir. I just wanted to know that the capex plans that we had at the start of FY '23 that we would be spending around INR8,000 crores to INR10,000 crores in the next three to four years. I think this year, we won't be on track due to the domestic ecosystem. So what is in the medium term, is the plan still on for capex?

V. Kalyana Rama: The plan is on. We will be spending that money because our plans to acquire 260-270 rakes, in that we got now 33 racks. The remaining racks, we will be acquiring in next three to four years. We are working on the ecosystem. So there is 237 rakes left over. Each rack, put INR14 crores to INR15 crores. You calculate. You take down your pen and paper, note down these numbers. We want to increase our domestic containers, our holding of containers over next five years to something like a 1 lakh to 2 lakhs, depending on the demand. Now each container put 4 lakhs, calculate yourselves.

So our plans are there. So now we have to develop the ecosystem. Then the capital expenditure will take. That's what I said. You see, quarter-on-quarter, our investors are not looking at. Our investors are looking at what in the next five years we are going to do. In

next five years, our

plans are intact. As I mentioned, INR8,000 crores, INR10,000 crores, we will be investing into the rolling stock, into the terminals, into various other things. It is still there and it will happen.

Ragmindra Rathord: And sir what would be your guidance on the additional benefits of this capex in the medium term on our top line?

V. Kalyana Rama: My guidance for this financial year, we will try to maintain our margins. We will try to grow at 10%, what we always aim at, and then we'll see how things will go along. So there is no guidance I can give you beyond one year. We don't give that guidance.

Ragmindra Rathord: And sir, the EBITDA margins in this sequentially have contracted. So is there any one-off or what are the reasons behind it?

V. Kalyana Rama: EBITDA margins, I already got one-off question our DF has answered. It's very less, very small, one-off we did. So there is not much of one-off. There are personal margins and we will be working towards maintaining the same margins as this current FY also as the previous FY.

Ragmindra Rathord: Okay, thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you.

V. Kalyana Rama: Sir, if there are no further questions, I think, Bhoomika can hand over, Bhoomika?

Moderator: Sir, we have one follow-up question. Can we take that?

V. Kalyana Rama: Okay. ~ ~

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Moderator: Yes, that is from Achal Lohade from JM Financial.

Achal Lohade: Yes, thank you for the follow-up, sir. Sorry, I just wanted to know, in terms of market share for the full year for domestic and EXIM, if you could specify, sir, I know you said the market share is not available, but just a part contraction, how much is the part contraction in the EXIM portfolio?

V. Kalyana Rama: You want figures? See, you want to know the policy and the trends? I think I can comment. If you want my exact figures, what I suggest to you people send mail, my secretarial branch will reply you.

Achal Lohade: Sure. Just another statistic with respect to the rail coefficient and the port mix?

V. Kalyana Rama: Again, you want numbers or you want the trend?

Achal Lohade: A trend, if you could specify a number, I will send the email.

V. Kalyana Rama: In rail coefficient, we lost some share. In rail share, we lost some share in the EXIM segment. In domestic, we are doing very well. In EXIM market, we almost command 90% share on the containers which are moving by rail. But in EXIM segment, we lost share, where we are working on to gain back that share.

Achal Lohade: I meant rail coefficient at ports or aggregate ports. If it is 22%, it is improved or declined or anything of that sort?

V. Kalyana Rama: I can't give you those figures. I told you, you send mail, you get figures.

Achal Lohade: All right. Sure. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that would be our last question for today. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair for closing comments. Thank you and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, I would like to thank everyone and thank you to the management for giving us the opportunity to host this call. Thank you very much, sir, and wishing you all the very best.

V. Kalyana Rama: Thank you. Thank you, Bhoomika.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of Dam Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes

this conference. Thank you all for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. ~ ~

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Q1 FY 23-24 Earnings Conference Call"

August 11, 2023

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(DOMESTIC ) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
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MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM C APITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED



Moderator: Good day, and welcome to the Container Corporation of India Limited Q1 FY 2023-2024 Earnings Call, hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode. There will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Limited. Thank you and over to you maam.

Bhoomika Nair: Thank you, Dorwin. Good morning, everyone, and welcome to the Q1 FY '24 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management today being represented by Mr. V. Kalyana Rama, Chairman and Managing Director. I'll now hand over the floor to Mr. Rama for his initial remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Over to you, sir.

V. Kalyana Rama: Thank you, Bhoomika, and good morning, everyone. So I'm having all my directors along with me here. So Sanjay, Director International Marketing, Azhar, Director Domestic, Ajit Panda, Director Projects and Director Finance, Manoj Dubey. So this last quarter we had mixed results, the turnover and margins have come down. Even though we were able to start getting traction during the month of May with April little down comparatively because after March that is normal effect, by May we were doing well, but in June we had unfortunate incidents.

The Balasore train accident which affected the running very badly in the whole month in the eastern sector, that put us off the track in balancing of rates, balance of containers and all the things in the domestic business, mainly in domestic business. And in the Exim, the Biparjoy on the west coast has affected us for 15 days. And added to these two incidents, a lot of unseasonal rains across India, that dented demand in domestic and also to some extent the running of trains and other issues.

So these all affected the June and the first quarter we have to end with a muted result. But let me assure you that things are good, that the demand is back and the tailwinds are, we are seeing good tailwinds. And we, at this moment, I don't see any need to revise the guidance which we gave after the first year, the last financial year results. So last conference call, whatever guidance I gave to you, that we will stand by it and we are confident we will be able to come back to the guidance levels by the end of this financial year.

In fact, Q2 itself made the giving good results, this traction goes on except for certain measures and the government policies sometimes do affect the trade like the ban on the rice exports is one such thing which is affecting the traffic in both domestic and Exim. But otherwise the demand is good so we will be able to see the tractions and we are sure we will come back to the normal levels. The DFC operations are very well stabilized. Dadri as we shared with you, the double stack operations on Dadri going on and the traffic times more or less stabilized at 30 hours between Dadri and Mundra, that's a good thing.

So a lot of traffic is getting diverted to Rail from Road. And the discounts what we gave on the upper stack, even though it is reported in media that CONCOR is going for rate cut, it is not rate cut. It is basically a discount we offered to the trade for the upper stack containers moving from Container Corporation of India Limited  
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the Dadri. That will be, that is helping us. A lot of new traffic has come. And in addition to that, this time reduction to 30 hours is helping in attracting the lightweight cargo back to the rail. And the new rates which we introduced with the 25 ton axle capacity and now DFC permitting the running

of 25 ton axle that is we can load 80 tons onto the wagon. We are operating now even domestic containers into the double stack. As all of you know that we got our hub, Swarupganj, and that was using these two hubs. We are able to put domestic containers back in this. So all these new things are helping and in domestic containers with the efforts what we put in last two, two and a half years.

The container manufacturing in India has picked up some pace, not as required by us but at least we are able to get some 350, 400, 500 containers per month. That's definitely adding and giving us some breathing space for picking up the increased demand in domestic. With all this and with the issue of land licensing fee, settle down, wealth, and without any further ambiguities in that, except that the 7% increase which we keep on taking on. So, the things are more or less set in. And as all of us know that even though the divestment thing has not been pulled back, but I am not seeing any further movement on that. That also has given good confidence on our customers and things are stabilizing on that front as well. So with this I just conclude my initial remarks that we will be able to maintain the guidance given to you people in our last conference call.

Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. The first question is from the line of Deepak Krishnan from Macquarie. Please go ahead

Deepak Krishnan: Just wanted to understand, given that you've given certain discounts on your domestic and Exim for both getting traffic as such, we've seen realization decline about 10% on a full year basis. Is this sort of realization expected to sort of continue? Or we expect certain pricing actions to kind of help us get realization back to last year levels?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, the realization drop that you have seen, that is because of the drop in our top line as our CMD just now explained because of the various factors of disruption in services in Western and Eastern part of the country, and certainly, the growth is the increase in the land license fees. These two sectors contributed to a decline in our bottom line. But we are very confident that we will be able to recover the bottom line. And for the end of the financial year, the guidance that initially were given, we'll be able to maintain that.

Deepak Krishnan: Sure, sir. Maybe just a clarification on the land license fee, the increase that we've seen. I think on media, you're still flashing that you'd only be paying about INR430 crores for the full year.

So just wanted to understand why the sudden bump up in 1Q?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So actually, you see, when we started a new regime, if you recall what in '19, '20 and '21, our CMD gave a guidance, that was around INR450 crores per annum, if you recall that. So against that INR450 crores that we had ballpark figures that we have assessed, every year negotiation with the railway for the various land parcels were going on. And last year, we ended up paying INR392 crores, right, for the whole year. One depot. Tughlakabad, which is right in the center

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of Delhi now. So the rate for Tughlakabad under discussions, and there was a difference of the opinion about what rates would be taken as the base industrial rate.

So finally, with the negotiations, what we have ended up post-COVID is that it is around INR100 crores more than what we have paid in last FY. So nearly 25 point plus impact will come in every quarter so far as LLF is concerned, which is the last year.

Deepak Krishnan: And this rate once fixed for TKD is not going to get changed, right? Now it will be a 7% escalation further on?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: Yes. So whatever we paid in TKD last year, every quarter, we are going to have an impact of it INR22 crores to INR23 crores. So meaning thereby nearly INR100 crores per annum.

Deepak Krishnan: Maybe just one last question.

If you could just share the Exim and domestic originating volumes.

Sanjay Swarup: For this quarter, the Exim-orienting volume was 466970 TEU and domestic originating was 104076 TEUs, total is 571046 TEUs.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Amit Dixit: I have a couple of questions. The first one is essentially an extension of the first participant. If we look at the realization, while you have said that the realizations were due to drop in -- I mean, due to disruption in services, was it also because of increased competitive intensity because we have seen volumes going up in the quarter Y-o-Y. However, the realization has come off. Was it due to the increased competitive intensity and how much it has to do with the discount that you have given to the customer? If you can bifurcate these two, that would be great.

Sanjay Swarup: If you closely see the physical feedback, you will see that originating figures have not experienced an increase. The increase in only handling figures, which is due to the fact that we are handling more containers at hubs because of double stacking. And second thing is that we are first mile, last mile logistics that we are doing for our customers and logistics. That number also we are adding in our handling figures. So handling figure is seeing a growth, but originating volumes have not seen growth. So if you see the profit per TEU originating volume, then that will be a better indicator for you to compare this year as compared to last year.

Secondly, this has been the company's policy that we don't sacrifice our margins to give discounts whatever savings we do based on our operational better operational management, part of the savings we pass on to customers. For example, that Dadri has come on double-stack, ICD Dadri. So whatever savings that we are having by running direct double-stack train to Mundra, Pipavav from Dadri. Part of that savings we share with our customers, even though the railway has not reduced any rail freight, but that saving or we shared with our customers, an 8% to 9% reduction we had for our rail freight from export from Dadri to Mundra Pipavav. That doesn't mean that we are sacrificing our margin. Our margin will, in fact, increase because we are sharing only part of our savings.

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Amit Dixit: The second one is since we have started the double-stacking now from Dadri to Mundra and Pipavav. So just wanted to understand how much the number of double stacking trains in Q1 FY '24?

Sanjay Swarup: Total double stacking train is 1,184 in Q1. Out of that, Dadri itself has handled 238 double stack trains.

Amit Dixit: And how many were for domestic operations?

Sanjay Swarup: That figure, I don't have at the moment. Maybe later on, I can tell you how much domestic and Exim figure we don't have for double stack.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Atul Tiwari from Citigroup. Please go ahead.

Atul Tiwari: Sir, just again, one clarification on LLF. So this year, we should be working with about INR520 crores of LLF factoring in this Tuglakabat impact? Is that a rough ballpark?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: No, Ballpark will be nearly 500 because this quarter, we have got some payments for the last year also. So what we are looking forward to 392, that you said last year, plus 100. So it should end up somewhere around 500 only for the whole year.

Atul Tiwari: Okay. And now, sir, all the negotiations with railway are done. And then from the next year, we just assume 7% increase on this INR500 crores number?

V. Kalyana Rama: Well, let me tell you and all the other people or the LLF, there is no negotiation. That means what do people feel in the marketing balance that will be done across that they will negotiate with railway. It's not that negotiations. This principle is very clear. It is

based on the land revenue

rate by the revenue authorities at that circle. So that there were some easy interpretations that keep happening and these interpretations happen at divisional level in Indian railways. So we work with the divisions, 26 divisions, different divisions.

So it's not surprised at the ministry at the railway board where we discussed the policy. So this is where the DF was talking about negotiation. So it's like land revenue rate as per the revenue authorities. So there was a problem with Delhi government as well. Delhi government is also doing some flip laps in the rates because of COVID they reduced after that, they increase, they increase suddenly. So all these things keep affecting. So here, the land revenue rates now are almost fixed everywhere.

So is there anywhere which is not fixed? No. So it's fixed at all the 26 location unless this land revenue is changed by the revenue authorities, suddenly, that is not in our hands. That's state government, they do that the thing will be 7% increase over the whatever we pay last year. So there's a TKD impact, which DF explained. So that is taking us to 390 plus 7%. That means around INR425, INR430 about INR150, INR160 crores impact. I hope things are clear. And if anybody else has got anything about LLF other than is please ask.

Atul Tiwari: My second question is, again, I kind of missed the originating volume if you could repeat that again, sorry for that.

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V. Kalyana Rama: No, for that you send a mail here. You can't repeat volumes over the conference call.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Can you help us with the market share port-wise market share what we share, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: In JNPT, it is 60% of the rail volume that we are handling. In Mundra, it is 37%. And Pipavav, it is 45%.

Achal Lohade: And aggregate, would you have sir for the country as a whole?

Sanjay Swarup: Country as a whole, we don't have yet.

Achal Lohade: The second question, just a clarification, sir, you said this will be the LLF unless the authority revises the land rate. Have I understood?

V. Kalyana Rama: So I told it very clearly. What is that you people are trying to understand? Seven years spending with you all guys every quarter, the question should be on the policy on the future. This is not going to impact the balance sheet if it is INR5 crores here and there. Do we think it will change the structure of this company? Will it change the balance sheet of this company? Let's go for good quality questions man.

Achal Lohade: Just one more question, if I can ask, sir. So with respect to the discount, is that specific to Dadri or it's in the Northwest pocket?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, we keep on giving discounts at various places. I cannot discuss all the discounts. I just mentioned Dadri discount, to give you an example that we are not sacrificing our margin to give discounts. That was my actually emphasis. Because of that, I gave you that example. There based on the demand from our field units and assessing the volume that we are likely to get as a result of giving discount. We keep on just giving this count. That is the ongoing exercise.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And just last, with respect to the arbitration case. This INR83 crores has already been provided or it's not provided?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: No. its not provided. It is just an information to everyone as a good governance. We have already informed to SEBI also. We had already gone to High Court, High Court is already see the matter. In the meanwhile, the complainer went to NCLT and NCLT, in our view, wrongly gave a judgment for IRP, which has been rightly withheld by state by Honorable NCLAT. So it is just an information.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Pranjal Jain from Mo

rgan Stanley. Please go ahead.

Pranjal Jain: My question number one is on the capex. Can you guide us the capex number for FY '24 and '25?

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Ajit Kumar Panda: The capex that we give you the guidance will be INR600 crores for '23-'24. This year is INR568 crores last year.

Pranjal Jain: Okay. And sir, can we have for '25 as well?

Ajit Kumar Panda: We are working out because we are hoping in the capex front, a good upswing in the current year. So we'll by the end of next quarter, we'll be able to give you the guidance for '24- '25.

Pranjal Jain: Sure. Understood, can we have the EXIM volume guidance for this year for the current scale?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually that guidance was already given at the start of the year by our Chairman and Managing Director, and that remains unchanged.

Pranjal Jain: Okay. And sir, lastly, any breakeven on procuring new containers on the new ICDs?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. We have also so far procured 1,800 containers, new containers for different terminals. And at the rate of about 400 containers per month, we are adding now. So we hope in the current financial year will be able to add about 5,000 containers, new containers.

Pranjal Jain: Understood. That's it from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vikram Suryavanshi from PhillipCapital.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Sir, some questions are already answered, but just can you share empty running cost for EXIM and domestic?

Sanjay Swarup: Which cost?

Vikram Suryavanshi: Empty running.

Sanjay Swarup: Empty running is for EXIM for first quarter is INR28.6 crores, for domestic, it is INR86 crores, total is INR114.6 crores.

Vikram Suryavanshi: And the containers we are adding are the all these are ISO containers or will there be like a specifically for the...

Ajit Kumar Panda: They are all ISO containers. Only few numbers we have added 12-fit containers. Otherwise, they are all ISO containers, all are produced domestically through our Make in India scheme.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Okay. Because what we heard that there was an issue related cotton, steel and you import coal...

Ajit Kumar Panda: All issues regarding container manufacturing have been factored out, and we are on the path of hiring containers regularly now. And the domestic ecosystem, we are encouraging to grow, and they are also responding well.

Vikram Suryavanshi: And how is the situation from the supply of rake availability?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Rake availability, yes, again, we have achieved breakthrough. There were supply chain issues, particularly for wheels and axles, That with the help of the railways we have sorted out. We are Container Corporation of India Limited

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now first with wheels and axles. In the past quarter, we have added 4 trains, 4 new trains have already added. And we hope to add about 24 trains in this financial year.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Krupa Shankar from Avendus Spark.

Krupa Shankar: Just one question on the EXIM side. While you did mention that 2Q looks promising and situation is improving. Can you further elaborate on whether the EXIM balance is improving?

Or is it more any guidance on what are the underlying sectors or anything which is picking up?

Sanjay Swarup: That one plus one scheme for every incremental import containers will we are running one empty container free of cost from Gateway Port to Interland. The scheme has really picked up very well. Plus as our Chairman mentioned at the start that the uncertainty about disinvestment is also becoming less, less and less now. And there are no visible signs for disinvestment.

So that has actually really helped the company in getting more and more business because people are -- customers are feeling very confident that the present system is going to continue. Plus, we keep on introducing a lot of various schemes a

nd they have been very well received by trade.

And on almost all the sectors like from Western ports to Northern hinterland, from Visakhapatnam to Nepal from South also everywhere, we are getting good response. And we are expecting very good growth in EXIM in the coming quarters for this financial year.

Krupa Shankar: Understood, sir. On the domestic side, we have seen some bit of slowdown coming in, I know there are multiple factors in the 1Q. But in the 2Q, you have seen some growth coming in, if you can highlight something on those that front, that will be really helpful?

Mohd. Azhar Shams: Be with respect to domestic, that we had a volume drop of almost around 2,000 containers. And these drops in the Q1 has been mainly because of the slow running and then the problem in trains running and not lifting the loads. There has been absolutely no issue with regard to demand. So now trains running improving and demand has always been there, and it is still there. So we are quite hopeful that in Q2, whatever loss we had of 2,000 containers, we will not only make good, will certainly show good growth in this Q2 and thus in the remaining quarters as well.

Krupa Shankar: And last question from my side, if I may. The rail freight margins for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: There's actually, rail freight margin for the quarter is 26.19%. It has actually, in fact, increased by as compared to the same quarter of last financial year, it was 25.6%.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Aditiya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditiya Mongia: My first question was on the EXIM segment margins that declined from 24% to about 20% on a Q-o-Q and Y-o-Y basis. One can probably reduce more than 100 basis points coming in from land license fee. Could you give us a sense of where the remaining quantum is coming from? And what could be a good guidance for FY '24 on this parameter.

V. Kalyana Rama: The guidance, I already told in my initial remarks, if we keep on repeating the same question, isn't it. I said, we will be able to maintain the guidance. And this statistical question, you can variable calculate where the other 300 basis points has come down. Rail freight margin increase, Container Corporation of India Limited

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the costs on certain fronts have gone up and the overall because the running has come down, the top line has come down as the expenses, some fixed expenses will continue to remain so.

Aditiya Mongia: Understood.

V. Kalyana Rama: Don't ask statistical question, friend.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Abhishek Verma from Fidelity International.

Abhishek Verma: On your capex figure of INR600 crores, can you please provide a breakup as well?

Ajit Kumar Panda: The breakup would be about INR200 crores for our new acquisition of Wagons and INR200 crores for containers, about INR150 crores will be on new terminals that we are setting up and INR50 crores will be on other miscellaneous item like machine handling machines, MIS, etc.

Abhishek Verma: And sir, how has your turnaround time changed post the DFC implementation? Just some color on that.

Sanjay Swarup: Turnaround time at ports, actually, as per the guidelines of NITI Aayog, consistently, we are able to achieve within 30 to 32 hours, which is quite good and appreciated by the trade, private operators have 25 to 30 days turnaround time, 12x at port.

Abhishek Verma: And comparing that to the previous number, what was that this...

Sanjay Swarup: Previously also, it was in the same level only. We have always been able to evacuate the containers in this time from the ports, but hub operations have definitely benefited us.

Abhishek Verma: And how is the lead distance changed?

Sanjay Swarup: Lead is actually now overall lead for this quarter is 804 kilometers. Last year, it was 775 kilometers.

Abhishek Verma: And just one quick one. Your depreciation breakup, if possible?

Sanjay Swarup: No

, that we will not be able to tell you right now, depreciation break up.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Anita Shah from Elara Capital.

Ankita Shah: This is Ankita from Elara Capital. Sir, out of the total EXIM originating volumes that we handle, how much percentage is double stack currently?

Sanjay Swarup: See out of the total EXIM around 25% to 30% is double stack.

Ankita Shah: And how much it can improve to in your estimate?

Sanjay Swarup: See, already, it is quite good because only Mundra and Pipavav connected to DFC, and we can then double stack. Once Nhava Sheva comes on double stack, that is around next year, then we will be able to ramp up around 40% of volume in double stack.

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Ankita Shah: Okay. And of 40%, this 25%, 30% can improve to 40% once the JNPT gets connected.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes.

Ankita Shah: And when JNPT rail coefficient ramp up, this 40% can grow up further?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, JNPT rail coefficient definitely will increase once it comes on DFC.

Ankita Shah: Correct. So then this 40% should improve further?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, it will go further.

Ankita Shah: Also, have we added, you mentioned about rakes added in this quarter. Have you added containers also for the domestic business?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes, we have added containers. So far 1,800 containers have been added and more are getting added about 400 per month getting added. So we hope to add about 5,000 containers in the current financial year.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Sumit Kishor from Axis Capital.

Sumit Kishor: I have two questions. The first question is that your market share at Mundra in FY '20 was somewhere around 48%, which has now come down to 37% like you mentioned. Could you please explain the key reasons for the market share loss and who have been the principal beneficiary?

Sanjay Swarup: The principal beneficiaries have been the private operators and who have consistently dropped their charges. That has been the basic reason for that. But we have taken a lot of steps now and we are gaining the market share back in Mundra now, Mundra and Pipava and Navasheva, all the three ports. We are gaining back the market share as a result of our various policies that I highlighted initially. So we are hopeful to get back to market share very quickly now.

Sumit Kishore: How has experience on the Exim imbalance situation from fourth quarter to first quarter of FY '24, do you see a worsening of the imbalance? And what is the outlook for the balance system...

Sanjay Swarup: See, Exim balance was there definitely it is already there. Some ports are export heavy, some ports are import heavy like Pipavav is import heavy. There's a lot of imports, but there's no export. But similarly, Mundra is more or less balanced but it has got more imports. So, but the hubbing operations have really helped us, and we are able to bring the empty running -- reduce the empty running because of hub.

Initially, we had to run rake up to port to balance. Now we have to run up only up to hub we bring the double-stack trains from ports to hubs. So that has really helped the company.

Sumit Kishore: And last question, if you could share the real coefficient at JNPT, Mundra and Pipavav?

Sanjay Swarup: That already I have told...

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Sumit Kishore: Rail coefficient. You have given the market...

Sanjay Swarup: At JNPT 17%, Mundra is 24.3% and Pipavav is 52%.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Ash Shah from Elara Capital.

Ash Shah: I had just one question. Earlier, we used to, we couldn't cater to the bulk commodities segment because of the container shortages that we were experiencing last year. But with the improvement in containers expected over this year, could you just throw some light on the bulk commodities?

Mohd. Az

har Shams: Actually, with respect to bulk -- mainly the cement loading of bulk, which started very successfully last year, and we did around 1 lakh ton of bulk cement from the four- five parties to different destinations. But there was a policy issue from railway board. Actually, the railway board gave us a FAS rate that is at all kind rate, we call it, for bulk cement loading in general purpose containers.

But that circular was valued up to 21-5-2023. So from the 21st May, that circular has not been extended. So we are basically stuck what to do or not to do. We have been chasing with railway board to extend this circular because there is a lot of demand and DPS has just mentioned, is that container supply has also increased. But this one policy issue of not extension of FAS rate for loose cement, we have been at the cross road at this point in time, but we are hopeful and chasing with the railway, let us see what outcome is there.

Ash Shah: So this policy was applicable, but what about the food grain that we were doing, if you could throw some light on that?

Mohd. Azhar Shams: Food grain actually, we are in talk with FCI. We did 1 or 2 presentations also with the Chairman, FCI. One location from where we are loading this basically Kota, but for many more locations are loading from silo to our bulk containers. So the negotiation is on. And we are quite hopeful and Chairman FCI has given us quite positive signal in this regard.

So just wait and see and Container availability has basically increased. So we are quite hopeful that whatever the happens is cement is one issue. But the bulk food grain is also in the pipeline, and we are hoping for a positive outcome with FCI.

Ash Shah: Also any other bulk commodities that we are planning to target or something in the future?

Mohd. Azhar Shams: Actually, as of now, it is food grain and the cement only, but we are also trying to experiment with the Alumina powder there in Visakhapatnam for Vedanta. So that is in the experimentation

stage.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Just as an extension on the last question. So this quarter, there was not any material bulk movement that would have happened in the domestic side. And in the month of June and probably continuing thus far. Is that the correct understanding for the domestic market?

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Ajit Kumar Panda: For cement, yes, there are disruption continues. But for food grain, whatever we are doing, we have continued to do.

Bhoomika Nair: So depending on when railway gives the revised order or whatever, then accordingly, this can come back as and when that circular is revised.

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. Just one clarification on the LLF that INR500 crores is for the full year, broadly INR490 crores, INR500 crores. So for this quarter, it would have been INR125 crores kind of provision in 1Q FY '24 that we have done?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: We have done INR129 crores this year, as I mentioned, there are some INR10 crores payment that we have brought for the last year also. So that is why you said it will be around 500 at the end of the whole FY

Ajit Kumar Panda: Actually, some adjust, basically why this doubt is coming is because some adjustments are going on. These 26 terminals, so we are paying and the rate adjustment that is happening, some arrear, some arrear in paid, some arrear we are keeping in provision. So marginal difference is coming because of these adjustments, and these adjustments will continue throughout the year. and maybe next year also, marginal adjustment will happen. So let us not bother about that, we are settling all these issues.

Bhoomika Nair: And lastly, from the lead distance perspective, you spoke about 804 million, but can I get a breakup for the Exim in the domestic side?

V. Kalyana Rama: Bhoomik

a for earlier question, I want to share one thought with you. You come with us, and we did conferences in U.S. Singapore Investor. The outlook, they look at is on a policy side. And for a balance sheet of Concor size now, a difference of INR10 crores, INR15 crores, INR20 crores, does it make difference.

The amount of time we spend for giving this conference call and you also arrange all these things where somewhere we ought not discuss this in a policy for INR10 crores, INR15 crores difference here and there, we will keep on asking resilient question, does that make any difference on the balance sheet.

See my balance sheet, it will not get affected with INR50 crores, INR100 crores difference than any of the things. And one increase in some handling at some place and company-wide we increased even INR100 crores under container the amount of money which we can add into our bottom line INR100 crores. I'm just leaving the thought to all the analysts in India.

Bhoomika Nair: Right Sir. Point noted about that. I was asking if I could just get the Exim and the domestic lead distance separately. You said INR804 was the overall number?

Sanjay Swarup: You want handling figures.

Bhoomika Nair: No, sir. Lead distance

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Sanjay Swarup: Lead for the Exim is 695 kilometers and domestic, it is 1,356 kilometers.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Shrinidhi Karlekar from HSBC.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Sir, can you update us on how has the service quality from your Dadri terminal has improved since the direct connection to the DFC in terms of time, it is saving the cost savings that you are getting and the reliability of the logistics?

Sanjay Swarup: Like I mentioned earlier, from Dadri, we are able to take the containers double-stack train in 30 hours to Mundra port and which is a game changer. Initially, when Dadri was connected to Mundra via Kathuwas that is another hub terminal. It used to take almost 60 to 65 hours to reach Mundra while the road was able to transport the containers in less than 55 hours. And now it is 30 hours directly from Dadri to Mundra. Transit time has come down drastically, and it is much, much better as compared to road.

And secondly, as I mentioned earlier, cost wise also it is cheaper. We have reduced the rate by 8% to 9% as a result of the savings that we were having it passed on a part of the savings to our customers. So cost is less, time is less. So there is no reason that traffic should not come to us. So from the road to rail, there's a huge diversion of traffic.

In fact, the other day, I was talking to Maersk, they are going to start a block train, block refer train, the refrigerated container train, I think next week, they're going, next to next week, they are going to flag off from Dadri to Mundra. Block train refer that would be running every week and maybe they will start by weekly tri-weekly, after some time.

So that kind of confidence trade is having, and they are getting all this target and all stores in U.S. all retail business that was going by road for exports, everything has come on rail now.

Ajit Kumar Panda: Per container double stacking, we have already started for the last 2 months. So I think another improvement in the service sector that we are providing to the trade.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: And sir, just a clarification, sir, Tughlakabad volume does now we are routing through Dadri or it still gets routed through Kathuwas.

Sanjay Swarup: It is going through Kathuwas.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: And is it possible to route that as well so Dadri like from...

Sanjay Swarup: It's possible, but it will be in the reverse direction, so it doesn't make any sense.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Last, just one clarification. When to answer to one of the questions, you said that 25% to 30% volume is going through double stack. Here, are we referring to only 40-foot container and the Northwe

st corridor alone, right? Is that...

Sanjay Swarup: So, I am referring to all the traffic, even lower deck upper deck combined double stack train, it is difficult to bifurcate only 40 feet containers.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: But this we're talking about the route, not at the entire network, right?

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Sanjay Swarup: So, she was asking only about the routes.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Route-specific, right?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: And sir last one, if I may because of this weight-carrying capacity constraint earlier only 40-foot containers, according to our understanding, was able to be the double stacked, are we now able to do 20-foot container double stacking as well?

Sanjay Swarup: So, that is actually not weight consideration. That is because of the restriction and the safety because of the railway, only 40 feet is allowed an upper deck, 20 feet is not allowed. We are putting...

V. Kalyana Rama: In the double stack 20 feet are going and were going from the beginning. Five year back we were doing 20 feet also in double stack, 20 feet goes in the lower deck, 40 feet goes in the upper deck.

Now the weight thing, what I explained is that is applicable only on the DFC route in the hubs between Dadri to Swarupganj. So there, we are now putting heavy weight domestic containers in lower stack and we are bringing the domestic into hubs.

So that helps in domestic margin improvement, domestic throughput improvement. So it's a little technical. I just mentioned it. You take it as that the guidance given by the management that there is a margin improvement by this. Beyond this, you want to understand technically then you have to spend some time understanding how double stack is.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Fair enough. This is helpful. Thank you so much and all the very best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Yaruqh Khan from Money Control. Please go ahead.

Yaruqh Khan: Thank you for the opportunity sir. I just have two questions. First question is, at the start of the current financial year, the Indian Railways had announced that it will stop taking orders for wagons from private companies. Has that affected our ability to procure wagons and going forward, what is the impact of that?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Kindly repeat your question could not get it.

Yaruqh Khan: At the start of the year, the Indian Railway had announced that it will stop taking new orders for wagons from private companies. Has that impacted our ability to recover values?

Ajit Kumar Panda: The orders for new wagons from whom?

Yaruqh Khan: From private companies.

Ajit Kumar Panda: No, there is some confusion. I think you have some confusion. They had -- they have released huge orders from private companies. What they have said that they are not sharing of wheelsets with others. So, for CONCOR specifically now we have started getting the wheelsets, and we have started getting the new-new rakes.

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Yaruqh Khan: My second question was that, is there any update from the government side on the divestment of CONCOR?



Ajit Kumar Panda: So the only update is silence.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Thank you for the follow up opportunity. Sir, in one of the answers, you mentioned that we are gaining back market share. In last quarter, you didn't share the market share. Can you help us with the fourth quarter market share for EXIM and domestic for us?

Sanjay Swarup: Fourth quarter figures we don't have right now. Okay.

Achal Lohade: Where I'm coming from is that when you're saying gain back market share, I presume you are talking about Q-o-Q because Y-o-Y, there is a loss of market share, particularly at Mundra.

That's my other questions.

V. Kalyana Rama: Q-o-Q a

Iso, there is a loss of market share. Sanjay has not mentioned that he is gaining now.

What he mentioned is now we are gaining back our market share, not about Q1, Q1 we lost market share.

Achal Lohade: So, Q2 onwards what we are looking at gaining market share and...

V. Kalyana Rama: That's the guidance which we are giving you...

Achal Lohade: Got it. Understood, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Koundinya M from JP Morgan. Please go ahead.

Koundinya M: Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, my first question is on the DFC. You did allude to the fact that transit times are now reduced to 30 hours. So just trying to understand, are there some efficiencies that we can look at some scope for margin improvement and efficiencies over here or is it all fully captured already in the numbers?

Sanjay Swarup: As we run more and more double stack for which there is a lot of scope as our Chairman already mentioned that we are able to run BLCS wagons, which have more capacity loading capacity.

So, more double stacking will further improve, and domestic is also coming on double stacking.

So definitely, there is a lot of scope for margin improvement. It is not saturated.

Ajit Kumar Panda: Once since the DFC gets connected to JNPT, there will be a huge opportunity and further, we'll capture further value.

Koundinya M: Sure sir. That was my second question with respect to JNPT connectivity because you and also some of your peers are also already using [inaudible 0:49:52] for example, in your case

Swarupganj to double stack containers or maybe use it as a hub to cater to JNPT as well. So, will

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connectivity to JNPT to materially change things on the DFC or I'm just thinking about on those lines, if you can help us understand the traffic flow better, maybe?

Sanjay Swarup: Definitely, the connectivity to JNPT will ramp up so much volume to rail because we will be able to run scheduled time table trains to JNPT. Imagine running a train from Delhi at 9:00 in the morning and tomorrow, it reaches JNPT at 9 o'clock 24 hours. That kind of service even road cannot provide. Nobody can provide. So definitely, a lot of volume we are expecting it will shift from road to rail.

Koundinya M: Understood, Sir, lastly, I think I missed it. Can you help us understand what those kinds of actions that you're doing to recoup the market share in 2Q?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, as I told earlier also, we have taken a lot of initiatives like 1 plus 1 scheme and running double stack more and more for Dadri plus in domestic also, we are getting building up circuits already from West to East, East to West. So, all these things will definitely help us in increasing more and more volume, and we will be able to build up the shortfall that we had in Q1.

Koundinya M: Sure sir. Thanks for the opportunity.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Janhavi Jain from Axis Asset Management. Please go ahead.

Janhavi Jain: Hi, good afternoon, sir. So, my question is regarding the last mile connectivity, which we've spoken about in the previous quarter as well. So if you could just like give on like we were about to order 100 LNG trucks. So, how are we going ahead with that and what is the volume handled in this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: The LNG 100 trucks we have ordered and out of that 25 trucks have already come to our MMLP at Mihan, Nagpur already they are they have been positioned and their registration process is going on. In another I think, 3 days to 4 days that will be completed. So we are hopeful that by next week, we are bringing them into – we will bring them into operations.

Janhavi Jain: Okay sir and also on the volumes of this quarter, if we have any for last mile?

Sanjay Swarup: And last mile, we will not be able to share the volume separately because whatever handling originatin

g figures, we have done is move last mile also for handling.

Janhavi Jain: Okay sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Pranjal Jain from Morgan Stanley. Please go ahead.

Girish: Just a question on probably a generic question, but on the strategy. Like obviously, double stacking is up and running for two ports, and we're obviously expecting JNPT to get connected and more rail movement to happen. But outside of this when you're looking at business development, you have these schemes, 1 is to 1 and double stacking, which you are offering to your existing customers. Can you probably talk about...

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Moderator: Sir, sorry to interrupt but there is a disturbance on your line and we are not able to hear you the complete question because of that disturbance. Could you please repeat the question.

Girish: Can you probably talk about your efforts that you taking to develop a business or acquire new customers across different segments if you can talk a little bit on that outside of offering schemes to your existing customers?

Sanjay Swarup: So that is actually an ongoing exercise of acquiring new more and more customers. Our all the field units, they are regularly meeting prospective customers, thus the customers who have left us, we want to bring them back into our core. That is a continuous exercise. And based on their expectations, we sometimes have a little tweak in our policy. That is a continuous exercise that we are doing because we are a commercial undertaking.

We cannot sit and rest that customers have come. We don't do anything more marketing. So that is a continuous exercise that is going on across the country at all of my terminals. And we are gaining at various places like Nagpur just to give you an example. We have done very well in Nagpur, that multimodality far Mihan, we are able to run almost 3 to 4 trains daily to Nhava Sheva, return direction also we are getting recently Maersk partner with us at 6 ICDs, they have reduced their charges. And as a result of these efforts, a lot of new customers are coming to us. So, this is an ongoing exercise.

Girish: Sure sir. And just one more question. Once we know the rail freight margin, have you done any analysis just to understand this better, that for the trains where you're double stacking, what is the differential between the margins on trains that you're double stacking? What's the rail freight margin there vis-a-vis where you can't double stack right now. How different is it? Like is it...

Sanjay Swarup: We have done the analysis and several more analysis, but we don't find it necessary to share it on this forum.

Girish: No, just to understand the contribution margin.

Sanjay Swarup: We can meet separately and discuss. I will not be able to share it here.

Girish: Fair enough. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Aditiya Mungiya from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditiya Mungiya: Thank you for the follow up opportunity. My question was more to assess the size of Dadri, as you are saying, Dadri is destined to grow fast. How much of your originating volumes are coming in from Dadri at this point of time on an analyzed basis?

Sanjay Swarup: Right now, I don't have the number, but I can tell you it is a sizable amount, and it is growing every year. And Dadri incidentally is the hub which is a junction point of Eastern and Western DFC, both the DFCs meet at Dadri, very, very critical.

Aditiya Mungiya: Understood. And could you also kind of give us a sense of, let's say, if the volumes at Dadri is x, what is the kind of road volumes that happened from that Interline? I'm just trying to get a

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sense of the growth prospects of Dadri can it double up? Can it become even better than that over the

next few years?

Sanjay Swarup: Right now, it's not possible to give those numbers also. I don't have with me readymade.

Aditiya Mungiya: Understood. Maybe just a last thing. Eastern DFC, whether it kind of getting commissioned over the next one year. Does that give us an opportunity to kind of build a particular business on that front or is it only Western corridor that helps us?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, Eastern DFC is mostly for bulk and big bulk business, not for container business. So, most of the container business is concentrated in the Western side of the country. And so Western DFC is more crucial for us.

Aditiya Mungiya: Understood. Those are my questions. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, we have no further questions. I would now like to hand the

conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair for closing comments. Over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes. I would like to thank the management for giving us an opportunity to host the call and all the participants and wishing sir all the very best in his future interval. Thank you very much, everyone.

Moderator: Thank you. Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you all for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

Conference Name:

Time:

Main Speaker(s):

Sr. No. Name Phone Company

1 HOST: Bhoomika Nair 2242022561 DAM Capital Advisors Ltd.

2 HOST: Management 1141673000 Container Corporation Of India Ltd.

3 Aakash Goel 919830519144 Tara Capital Partners

4Abhijit Mitra 2265165806 Aionios Alpha Investment Management

5Abhishek 2266578150 DSP

6Abhishek Nigam 919892660586 B&K Securities

7Abhishek Verma 919810163352 Fidelity International

8Achal Lohade 2266303081 JM Financial

9Achal Phade 918655308267 ICICI Prudential Life Insurance

10Aditiya Mungiya 2243360884 Kotak Securities

11Ajish Sharma 16617480242 PickMoney

12Akansha Modi 8292007205 Narnolia Financial

13Akhilesh Bhandari 917045688052 ICICI Prudential Asset Management

14Akshata Thakur 7208211260 AMSEC

15Ali Khan 17029131369 Alpha Capital

16Alok Deora 919820513792 Motilal Oswal

17Amish Shah 2266328656 Bank Of America

18Amit Dixit 919839043382 ICICI Securities

19Amit Khurana 2240969770 Dolat Capital

20Anand Nadapi 12032048517 Factset

21Ankit Jain 2267800305 Mirae Asset

22Ankita Shah 919820679464 Elara Capital

23Anmol Das 917666795662 BOB Capital Markets

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45Harsh Doel 9967581549 IIFL SecuritiesTHANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US

Ms. Bhoomika Nair – DAM Capital Advisors Ltd.

Management of Container Corporation Of India Ltd.

Participants ListTotal 131 Participants including the Speakers.August 11, 2023 11:30 Hrs India TimeContainer Corporation Of India Ltd. Q1 FY2023-24 Earnings Call

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Sr. No. Name Phone Company

46Harsh Shah 2242246142 Jefferies

47Himani Negi 918800845744 District D

48Jaipal Shetty 919167858570 Individual Investor

49Janhavi Jain 912231374901 Axis Asset Management

50Jayesh Gandhi 2242648148 Harshad Gandhi Securities  
51Jaynam Shah 918758759924 Equirus Securities  
52Jehangir Master 2240570323 NSFO  
53Jignesh Makwana 9930122599 AMSEC  
54Jitark Shah 919324242648 SBI Pension Funds  
55Jiten Rushi 918767323999 Axis Capital  
56Jonas Bhutta 2243568068 Birla Mutual Fund  
57Jyotiraditya Singh 919462287773 Arihant Capital  
58Kadil Khan 919833238356 Nuvama Wealth  
59Kamlesh Ratadia 2231249707 Axia Asset Management  
60Karan Mehta 919624555861 Equirus Securities  
61Kevyn Kadakia 919821514702 Sundaram Mutual Fund  
62Khushbhoo Gandhi 918879908079 YES Securities  
63Koundinya M 2261573593 JP Morgan  
64Krupa Shankar 9884128127 Avendus Spark  
65Kushagra Bhattar 2269459956 Old Bridge Capital  
66Kushant Arora 2269209663 Baroda BNP Mutual Fund  
67Lavina Quadros 919833009985 Jefferies  
68Mandar Pawar 2262185279 Kotak Mutual Fund  
69Mohit Lohia 918699633997 ICICI Securities  
70Ms Arun 919087779152 Capital Market  
71Neeraj Parkash 918097436852 WhiteOak Capital  
72Neeraj Prasad 2261291500 Motilal Oswal  
73Nilesh Purana 2267800357 Mirae Asset  
74Nirmal Gopi 13322457667 Goldman Sachs  
75Nisha Shetty 918828022907 Klay Securities  
76Nitin Prakash 9167241995 JM Fianancial  
77Paras Parekh 2266505020 CLSA  
78Paresh Dave 6569142570 Individual Investor  
79Parth Thakkar 917977050966 InCred Capital  
80Pranali Patil 2261047501 Iden Investments  
81Pranjal Jain 2261183037 Morgan Stanley  
82Pravin Yeolekar 918275744401 Bajaj Allianz Life  
83Pritish Urankar 7021526759 ICICI Securities  
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86Rachael Smith 17812306877 Aiera  
87Rahul Modi 7400132165 Nippon India Asset Management  
88Rahul Pawar 17029131114 AU Finance  
89Raiksha 917044055537 Credit Suisse  
90Raj Sharad Agrawal 918208741897 Individual Investor  
91Rajarshi Maitra 919820637133 InCred Capital  
92Rajat Parab 919421954822 Prosperity Wealth Advisors  
93Rakesh Sethia 919892151273 HDFC Mutual Fund  
94Rakesh Vyas 2266316387 HDFC Mutual Fund  
95Ravi Kiran Surana 2269113454 ITI Ltd.  
96Renita Pol 9773335514 ICICI Prudential  
97Rishabh Gupta 919900696860 Goldman Sachs  
98Rohan Gheewala 919930900453 Axis Capital  
99Rohit Choret 2261291558 Motilal Oswal  
100Rohit N 919029119456 Allcargo Logistics  
101Rohit Ohri 9870448599 Progressive Shares  
102Ronak Patak 919062516420 StockEdge  
103Ronak Sangneria 919967325463 CRISIL Ltd.  
104Roshan Nair 918369184346 B&K Securities  
105Ruchi Gupta 919422367231 Valcreat Consultancy  
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Sr. No. Name Phone Company  
106Rushabh Rawal 919820977145 Tara Capital Partners  
107Sachin Gupta 919892365152 Acer Solution  
108Sachin Pal 918095646657 MC Research  
109Sai Siddharth 9494003037 Kotak Securities  
110Sandesh Shetty 918983386423 HSBC  
111Saras Singh 2243156833 Haitong Securities  
112Satya Choulapally 4041970000 S&P Global Market Intelligence  
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114Saurabh Chugh 2266481493 Ocean Dial  
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119Sumit Kishor 919819626041 Axis Capital  
120Tanay Shah 2242022592 DAM Capital Advisors Ltd.  
121Tarang Joshi 919892855970 Entrust Capital  
122Tvisha Shah 919820722403 Karma Capital  
123Udit Dhekale 2266328520 Bank Of America  
124Urmil Shah 2268287842 Anvil Wealth Management Pvt. Ltd.  
125Urmil Shah 919819916595 Ageas Federal Life Insurance  
126Vaibhav Vasa 919004377765 CRISIL Ltd.  
127Vikram Suryavanshi 919867327414 PhillipCapital  
128Vinayak 2224255105 Axis Asset Management  
129Vinit Manek 2262327215 Karma Capital  
130Yaruqh Khan 919910367461 Money Control  
131Yatin Mata 919321410633 FIS International  
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## Call: Nov 2023

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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

(A N avrata CPSE of Govt. of India)

CONCOR Annexe, NSIC MDBP Building , 3rd Floor

Okhla Indl. Estate, New Delhi-110020

Tel: 011-41222500, 600,700

No.CON/F&CS/IRC/ STOCK EX/C.No.293/ Note No.234

Dated: 09.11.2023

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2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd.

Exchange Plaza, 5th Floor, Plot No. C/1,G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E)

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(Through NEAPS)

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For your information and record please.

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~ i:billfotll : c61.-Jcfi'f( 'ifcfff, "fft-3, ~ -US, ~ ~-110076

Regd. Office: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, New Delhi-110076

~ l Tel. 011-41673093, 49512150,60, ~ / Fax: 011-41673094

{-¾ l E-mial: co.pro@concorindia.com CIN: L63011DL1988GOI030915

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"Container Corporation of India Limited

Q2 FY 24 Earnings Conference Call"

November 03, 2023

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP -- CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING  
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS &  
SERVICES) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. M. AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR (DOMESTIC ) –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. MANOJ DUBEY – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) --  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. PRIYA RANJAN PARHI – DIRECTOR  
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING AND OPERATIONS ) --  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

Container Corporation of India Limited  
November 03, 2023

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the CONCOR Q2 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call, hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Thanks, Zico. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q2 FY '24 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management today being represented by Mr.

Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director. At this point, I'll hand over the call to Mr.

Swarup for his opening remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Thank you, Bhoomika. Good morning to everybody. I am joined by my Directors, Direct Finance, Mr. Manoj Dubey; Director Domestic, Mr. Azhar Shams; Director Projects and Services, Mr. Ajit Panda; and Director International Marketing and Operations, Mr. Priya Ranjan Parhi. All of us are present here. Just I will give you a brief snapshot and then you can start the questions.

Company has made total logistics solution to customers as one of its focus areas that includes warehousing as well as first-mile, last-mile logistics. Keeping the stress on ESG norms, we have procured -- we have given order for 100 LNG trucks for first mile, last mile and 50 trucks have already arrived. Out of that, 40 are in Baroda and 10 are in Nagpur. They are already serving the customers. And we hope to garner good margins and good business while focusing on FMLM and this would be one of the focus area. It will remain a focus area for the company.

Second point I want to mention is that the FMCG cargo, which is a low weight cargo, has not been with us till now. So taking a corrective measure, company has ordered 12-foot containers. We have given orders of 1,000 such containers. Out of that, 180 containers have already arrived, and trials have been conducted.

Now commercial operations are going to start very soon for these containers. And by deploying these containers, we are very confident that we will be able to increase our domestic share, in which we can have FMCG cargo also with us. So these 12-foot containers will be a big focus area again for the company.

We are focusing on technology-based logistics solutions to our customers. And for that, we already are doing a project at Tughlaqabad for providing artificial intelligence-based terminal management system. It is likely to be commissioned I think 15 days' time in advanced stages. And we are also working on app-based FMLM to our customers, so which is going to be taking another 1 or 2 months, it will start working.

Then we are very actively working on ice battery project for providing cold chain solution to our customers. As far as the infrastructure front is concerned, we are very conscious and active on that front also. In this financial year, we will be getting 16 high-speed BLCS new rakes. Out  
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of that in H1 7 we have received, 9 more we will be receiving in H2, which will take our total count to around 380 rakes. So -- and we are working on procuring more rakes in future. Apart from that, we are getting more than 500 containers every month for our domestic use. And our domestic fleet of containers is now around 40,000 containers, which is serving us well, and customers are very satisfied with the supply of containers. We are commissioning new terminals also.

On that front also, we are very acti

ve. And we hope that we will be able to commission very critical terminals in this financial year, which will be giving service to our customers. We have given a lot of emphasis on double stacking, which is operational efficiency. And I am happy to announce that there has been 31% growth in H1 in double-stacked trains. We handled 2,766 double-stacked trains as compared to 2,100 double-stacked trains in the corresponding period of last financial year.

Just lastly, we have firm indications from the market that domestic demand is going to pick up, as you may be observing for the last 2 financial years, we have shown more than 25% growth back-to-back in domestic. This year, again, we hope to maintain very good growth.

And as far as EXIM is concerned, imports continue to be very strong. They will be continuing same for the remaining 5 months of this financial year. And exports are weak due to various geopolitical reasons, which all of you are very well aware. So these are my opening remarks. Now we can start question-and-answers, please.

Moderator: Our first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities.

Amit Dixit: Congratulations for a good set of numbers. I have 2 questions. The first one is essentially, if I see the LLF provision for this quarter, that seems to be a tad low compared to last quarter. So just wanted to understand whether -- I mean what kind of LLF we should take for the year?

Earlier, we thought that it would be around INR500-odd crores. But from Q2, it looks like it would be lower than that. So just wanted to understand the number and the drivers behind it.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you, Amit, for your best wishes. I will request my Director Finance to take this question.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: Let's have a look on H1. Have you got the figures of H1 also with you?

Amit Dixit: Yes, yes.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So H1, what is the figure for last year? INR191.49 crores.

Amit Dixit: Yes.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: And this year, the figures are INR215.57 crores.

Amit Dixit: Yes, that's fine. But I was asking more about what is...

Manoj Kumar Dubey: Yes. So we work in approval system. So first quarter as a good business sense we made more provisions. And second quarter, we have done the balancing act. And as of now, we are 13%

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more than what we paid last year. So as you know, the rule says that we have to pay 6% of the total land value, which appreciates at a rate of 7%. So still we have a little more provisions and let's make sure that this is in the same line only. So the end of the year, we are between INR450 crores to INR470 crores at the max.

Amit Dixit: Okay. Got it, sir. The second question is essentially on your opening remarks regarding FMCG cargo. So I mean, quite interesting that we are now focusing quite a bit on domestic market. So first of all, what could the domestic market growth target for us? And FMCG cargo, what kind of margins will it yield? Will it yield lower margin or higher margin compared to what we're getting now from domestic business?

Sanjay Swarup: Our Director Domestic, Mr. Azhar Shams will take this question.

M. Azhar Shams: Actually, with regard to FMCG cargo, our CMD has just remarked that whatever market is available for FMCG, we are having a very less share with us because most of these cargo is moving via road. And the main constraint has been the loadability issues. You know that the loadability of these cargo in normal 20-feet containers has been around 2 to 3 tons, while the rail -- as per the railway rating policy, the party had to pay a minimum of 7.5 tons because that is the first lap.

So in order to address that issue and in order to increase the loadability and then reduce the per ton cost to the customers, we have come up with an innovation of 12-feet high containers. The 12-feet high means that every dimension otherwise would be same, this 20-feet length,

8-feet

width, but the height will be 12 feet, actually, which is normally 8.6.

So with that 12-feet -- now the loadability is just becoming double. We have done trial with Coca-Cola. We have done trial in Goa with the IFB. The loadability is just coming double. And the railway has given a rate of -- it means that whatever railway has been charging for a normal 20-feet containers, they shall be continue charging for the same amount for these 12-feet high containers. So we find that not only in terms of securing good volume, we are going to get some addition in the margin as well.

Amit Dixit: Okay. And what would be the domestic volume growth that you would be targeting for this year and maybe next one?

M. Azhar Shams: Our CMD has just remarked that the last 2 years, we have been growing at the rate of 25% at domestic. So we are quite hopeful, mean in the H1, the growth has not been to an extent whatever we expected. But in the remaining 2 quarters, we are quite hopeful that our volume shall be matching the numbers, whatever we gave in the last 2 years.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Lavina Quadros from Jefferies.

Lavina Quadros: Congrats on a good set of numbers. Just wanted a sense from you on how Container Corp's market share has done in the last quarter? There's been an issue with market share being on a downward trend. So how has it done in the last quarter? And what are the steps being taken over the next 12 months? And what are your expectations hereon?

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Sanjay Swarup: See, Lavina, first of all, I would like to thank you for your wishes. The market share of our company has been in the range of 65% to 70%. And we basically believe in giving service to our customers, and we don't want to pick up very low-margin business. That has been a conscious decision of the company to not pick up low-margin business, which is anyway any day we can pick up. But our focus area is basically to give service to our customers with reasonable margin. So that conscious decision stay with the company. This policy is going to continue. So market share will be remaining in the range of 65% to 70% only.

Lavina Quadros: Okay. And sir, lastly, DFC benefits in this quarter and originating volumes, if you could share?

Sanjay Swarup: Sorry, you want numbers?

Lavina Quadros: DFC -- yes, yes. Originating volume numbers and the DFC has that contribution started from this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, DFC actually started from last quarter only because from the month of May, the DFC was brought up to NCR area, that is Dadri then only we started running freight express trains, which are timetable trains directly to Mundra Port. We were able to divert a lot of business from road to rail using that facility. And definitely, it is a very big game changer for us, and we are able to take the cargo very quickly to the ports. So it has been very, very helpful for us.

Lavina Quadros: Okay. And sir, I'm not sure if this was given earlier, originating volumes, in case I missed it?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, originating volume for Q2, our EXIM is 540,990. And for domestic, it is 106,998. Total 647,988.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay. So the question is on market share. I think last couple of quarters, there was some discussion around some loss in market share and then you had introduced the 1 plus 1 scheme to gain some kind of a share there. So if you could kind of give some update on how the effect of that scheme has been? And have we started gaining some of the share that we lost?

Sanjay Swarup: See, you can already see the impact of that scheme on the business because you are seeing a growth in EXIM volumes, this scheme was basically for EXIM volumes. And domestic, definitely, you would have seen the growth because a lot of good circuits we have picked up. So

definitely, it results in the growth of the company.

But as far as market share is concerned, I already replied in the earlier question that we believe in giving service with sufficient margin. We don't want to pick up low-margin business just to increase our market share. That has not been the company's policy, and that will continue to be like that.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay. Okay, but -- okay. So what I was trying to look at, sir, is have -- do we have some more distance to cover in terms of our target market share or the scheme has already seen all its benefit? That's what I was trying to understand.

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Sanjay Swarup: See, already -- because a lot of development is taking place, we are commissioning new terminals. So definitely, there is a lot of scope to cover the business because business is widespread, and there's always a scope to cover the business. But the policy of the company for giving service with commission margins will continue.

Mukesh Saraf: All right, sir, sure. Understood. And second question is on domestic. While we've seen -- started seeing good growth, I do remember that cement was one key segment there, which had kind of a decline for us because of the policy there from Indian Railways. Any update there? Have you started again moving bulk cement on our containers, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: That was actually bulk cement. That policy is under consideration by Railway Board. Railway Ministry is examining it. And very soon, we are expecting some result on that. And as soon as it comes, we will circulate it among our customers, and we hope to start the business.

Mukesh Saraf: So that's expected soon, sir? I mean any sense that you have?

Sanjay Swarup: I cannot tell you the expected date at present, but we are expecting it in near future.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial.

Achal Lohade: Congratulations for the great set of numbers. Sir, my first question is with respect to the pricing. Is it possible to give us some sense in terms of the pricing? How do you see, given the DFC benefits kicking in especially for Dadri, is there any change in the pricing what we were charging earlier prior to DFC and now?

Sanjay Swarup: See, we believe that whenever we save, we do -- we get some savings, we share a part of that with our customers. So believing in this philosophy -- without sacrificing our margins, of course.

So on the working on the same philosophy, if you are aware, as soon as we started double-

stacked trains from Dadri, we passed on the benefit of savings to our customers and we reduced the tariff by 8% to 9% from Dadri to Mundra and Dadri to Pipavav ports. So that already is there from May onwards. And when Nhava Sheva gets connected on DFC, we will follow the same principle.

Achal Lohade: Understood. The second question I had was with respect to volumes. Now if you could help us understand on the existing locations, what kind of volume growth do we expect in the EXIM and the domestic segments. Domestic you've already answered, sir. On the EXIM part, how do you see the volume panning out? And in terms of the imbalance, what is the impact of that in terms of the margins? If you could give us some sense.

Sanjay Swarup: See, in the EXIM imports are going to be quite strong in the coming 5 months of this financial year. And -- but exports are going to be weak because of the various geopolitical reasons. So EXIM growth will be more or less similar what we see -- saw in Q2. It will maintain that pace and the guidance of the company, will remain same in the range of around 12% to 15%.

We may slightly beat the guidance. We may exceed that slightly. So that is our prediction. As far as the empty running is concerned due to imbalance, that is being countered by more and more double stacking. As I mentioned in my opening remarks, we increased double stacking by Cont

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31% in H1. So we will continue to use these measures for countering the issue of -- challenge of empty running and imbalance.

Achal Lohade: Got it. Sir, just a clarification. 12% to 15% volume growth guidance for EXIM is for current year, FY '24?

Sanjay Swarup: No, 12% to 15% is not for EXIM. For the company, I'm telling you.

Achal Lohade: Right. And for -- I mean, within that, sir, EXIM?

Sanjay Swarup: If you are attentive, you would have seen in the first conference call of this financial year.

Achal Lohade: But sir, I mean, I'm just going by what has been the growth in the first half...

Sanjay Swarup: So you can take that it will be 12% to 15% of the overall growth, EXIM plus domestic.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Abhishek Verma from Fidelity International.

Abhishek Verma: Sir, can you please help with the port-wise market share?

Sanjay Swarup: Port-wise market share is at JNPT, for the first half, we have 60% market share; at Mundra port, it is 36%; and Pipavav port, it is 45%.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Vikram Suryavanshi from PhillipCapital.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Yes. Congratulations, sir, for good numbers and the improvement in the margins. Sir, 2 questions. One is on the cold chain business, you talked about the restarting that business opportunity. And we earlier had fresh and healthy and -- experience of cold chain where we had limited success. So is there any business -- change in business model to really make cold chain business for us as a big contribution?

Sanjay Swarup: See in FHEL earlier, what fresh and healthy we were procuring the apples and storing them and selling them. That model we have changed now. We are no longer doing that procurement thing. We are giving our facility for rent to various agencies, plus we have developed one agri center also.

And the thing that I was talking was of ice battery. This is an innovation by a Japanese firm. Of course, it will take a lot of time if I start explaining everything. So I can only say it's a passive cooling technology. So maybe I can explain you in person separately. It's a passive cooling technology developed by a Japanese entrepreneur and we have entered into an exclusive agreement with that company for the marketing of this product in India. So only this much only I can tell you, but it's a very nice technology, which is, again, a green mode of technology, I should say.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Got it. And another question about this FMCG opportunity what we are talking with the 12-foot container. Will last mile be managed by us or it will be through business associates for domestic cargo and how we'll try to capture the value chain for ourselves? If you can share some views on that.

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Sanjay Swarup: See, in this 12-feet container -- 12-feet high container, as my colleague has already explained you, this will not be very, very -- having a comfortable movement on road. So we will do terminal stuffing and terminal destuffing. We will not take it on road because it will be -- dimensions 12-feet high may not be conducive for the road movement.

So customer will have to bring the cargo to originating terminal and that destination it will be

taken. So various options are available. We can also provide that service or we can tell our business associates to do that. We are open. Right now, we are not very strict on this aspect. Vikram Suryavanshi: Understood. And last, sir, if you can share empty running cost for EXIM and domestic for this quarter? That would be helpful.

Sanjay Swarup: For this quarter, you want?

Vikram Suryavanshi: Yes, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Okay? For this quarter, it is -- for EXIM, it is INR31.42 crores; domestic, it is INR86.70 crores; total is INR118.12 crores.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Atul T

iwari from Citi.

Atul Tiwari: Yes, sir. Sir, could you share the EXIM and domestic lead distances?

Sanjay Swarup: Lead distance for EXIM for this H1 is 700 kilometers. Domestic, it is 1,400 kilometers.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Ankita Shah from Elara Capital.

Ankita Shah: Congratulations, sir, on a good performance. Sir, my question was on the realization side. Could you throw some light on increase in realization in EXIM for the quarter by 6% and decline in realization in domestic by 9%. So the reasons for the same?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: The total margins of what?

Sanjay Swarup: Margins or top line?

Ankita Shah: Yes, yes, realization for the year.

Sanjay Swarup: What do you mean by realization?

Ankita Shah: Sir, revenue divided by the total handling volumes for the quarter.

Sanjay Swarup: No, no, no. Actually, Ankita, you should -- you are talking about the top line divided by -- that is per TEU you are asking?

Ankita Shah: Per TEU. Yes, realization per TEU.

Sanjay Swarup: It will be -- proper figure should be originating you should divide by originating not by handling.

Ankita Shah: Okay. Okay.

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Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes.

Ankita Shah: Have you taken any price hikes for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: We have not taken any price hikes.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So what I'm talking was that if you look at our PAT number, which is coming out of the realization, you can see that the EXIM as well as in domestic on originating volumes, we have got a better realization this quarter. The numbers that you're talking about is of total throughput, which has got handling as well as the last mile connectivity, so that may not be giving you the right picture.

Ankita Shah: Okay, sir. Got you. Also on -- there has been a good improvement in your EBIT margins for the domestic segment. So is there scope for improving this further from hereon?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Actually, there was some movement of -- because domestic loading is picking up. So everywhere, you cannot expect that you should have both sides loaded movement. So there have been some stretches where we have to move empty containers. So -- but now that circuits are getting built up. So in Q3, I think this issue will be addressed. And we are very hopeful that we will be able to improve the bottom line in domestic to a great extent.

Ankita Shah: Okay. And in this 12-foot containers that we are planning to have for FMCG what kind of a tonnage can be handled in this container?

Sanjay Swarup: That is -- that will -- see, Ankita, tonnage will not be very high. But the only thing is the FMCG volume will be very high. So maybe less than 10 tons, I should say or 7.5 tons. Yes, Director Domestic will further tell you.

M. Azhar Shams: Actually, I just -- I mean when I addressed this issue in the previous question, I explained that FMCG cargo loading like TV, fridges, ACs and all those, washing machine, etc., in normal 20-foot container has been around 2 to 3 tons. While the party we are paying 7.5 tons of the railway charges, that is the first lap of the charges -- railway charges from us.

And in this, the loading is the -- whatever experiments we have done, so from 2 to 3 tons, the loading is coming around 10 tons or so. So the per ton loadability and the per ton costing is -- certainly will be much, much cheaper as compared to whatever loads at this point of time is charging. So that is the point. That loadability will increase at least 8 to 10 tons. And then -- I mean with the reference that per ton cost will come down as comparison to the road.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditya Mongia: My first question was on the guidance for FY '24. It seems as if from the 2Q run rate, one has to go 20% higher for the remainder of the year. Could you give us a sense of whether there are any large terminals that

you're going to add? Because otherwise, given that your market share is flattening out, it's difficult to comprehend the growth?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, we are commissioning a lot of terminals. Already we have commissioned in Q3, one terminal already we have commissioned. So we should not bother about the market share

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that I already told you. And in the existing terminals itself, we have a lot of sufficient capacity to handle more volumes.

There's no issue on that and we have a number of rolling stock. We have equipments, that is containers, that I told you in the opening remark, they are already coming and handling equipments are also there. So existing terminal also have got a lot of capacity to handle more volumes. And as far as demand is concerned, that also I told you in the opening remarks, we are seeing very good demand. So there is no reason why we should not pick up more volume.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. And I'm assuming the 2Q numbers did not have any benefit of the impact of shifting of volumes from 1Q because of cyclone. Am I right in that? These are all volumes that were redestined to be in the second quarter itself?

Sanjay Swarup: See, the volumes were not shifted anywhere because of cyclone. They were with us only. Only thing is we were not able to lift those volumes because of disruption in services. So of course, part of that volume definitely has come to Q2. But Q2 itself has been very robust and this trend is going to continue now.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. And just sir 1 more thing. Dadri, can you give us a sense of how big in terms of volumes is Dadri? And because of the linkage to DFC, can that proportion or importance of Dadri go up and by how much?

Sanjay Swarup: See, Dadri is the facility on more than 250 acres. It's a massive facility, a multimodal logistic park, which is having 4 joint venture CFS And at present, it is handling volume to the tune of 400,000 TEUs. And we have -- we are aiming it to become 1 million TEU terminal, first 1 million TEU terminal in the country.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Koundinya from Jefferies.

Koundinya: Sir, my first question is on the employee expenses front. Just wanted to check if there is any one-off in that because it seems to have gone up in the -- during the quarter?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: Yes, you're right. So as you know, last year, the company has done the best ever financial numbers as well as the PAT numbers. So in view of that, the Board of the company had given onetime award a 1 month of salary to all the employees. So that a onetime impact of INR17 crores is coming in this Q2. So that's the difference.

Apart from that, we are growing at 3% to 4% normal growth in terms of the staff cost. So far as number of employees are concerned, it is, in fact, lesser than what we had last -- adding a huge number of employees in that. So that's one time only. And Q3, you will be having a tapered number.

Koundinya: Understood, sir. And sir, my second question is on the market share front. I remember it was about 55%-or-so about a quarter or 2 back, and now you improved to 65%, 70-odd percent. So just trying to understand what are the ports where you this improvement? Also, if you can give us some numbers on the rail coefficient at the ports, please?

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Sanjay Swarup: See, as I told multiple times -- not interested to pick up low-margin business just for the sake of increasing our market share. We want to give service to our customers with sufficient margins. So consciously -- this is a conscious decision of the company. Suppose today, I decide to make my market share 80%, it will not be very difficult for me. But we don't want to do that. That is not sustainable.

Now as far as rail coefficient is concerned, rail coefficient of containers if you tak

e the ports in

our country, is in the range of 18% to 20%, which is going to -- in next 5 to 6 years, when we will have DFC connectivity for Nhava Sheva as for national rail plan also, it should be touching 40%.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Shrinidhi Karlekar from HSBC.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Congratulations on good set of numbers. So very good growth on EXIM front, sir. Would it be possible to throw some light on which commodities, product categories is driving this growth?

And which are the routes where you are seeing this strong growth?

Sanjay Swarup: See, in EXIM, actually, we are getting good growth in imports, as I mentioned earlier. And the primary drivers are wastepaper import that we are getting. Apart from that, we are getting scrap also, HMS, heavy melting scrap, which is also a big driver for growth. These 2 are the main

commodities. And exports, of course, are subdued, but whatever we are able to send is reefer and rice, machine parts. These are the main commodities in exports.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Yes. Sorry, sir, I missed the first commodity that you spoke about, scrap I could understand. What was the first one you said?

Sanjay Swarup: Wastepaper.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Wastepaper. Okay.

Sanjay Swarup: Solar panels also. Solar panels, wastepaper.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Fine. And sir, recently, railways has put up this 10% busy season surcharge, has that been passed on to your customers on all the routes?

Sanjay Swarup: See, that we have taken a conscious decision that we will see -- not pass on as it is to our customers. We are in talk with our customers. And strategically, we are passing it on. Some routes, we are passing it on as it is. On some routes, we are absorbing a part of that and passing it on. Some routes, we are charging more also. So that's a strategic decision, dynamic decision that we are taking. We are not just mechanically passing it on.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: And sir, if volume growth continues to be the way it is, which is strong, do you think over a 6 months would you be in position generally to pass on this to our customers on -- at least on the absolute level of increase?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, we may take a decision. I don't think -- I will use this forum to tell you what we will decide. We will -- we are continuing carrying out analysis and we may take a decision, which will be beneficial for everybody.

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Shrinidhi Karlekar: Sure, sir. And last one, sir, if I may. Would it be possible to share the rail freight margin number for this quarter, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Rail freight margin, you want?

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Yes.

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. Rail freight margin for this quarter is 27%.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Private Limited.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Sir, just wanted to understand that now that the Dadri DFC connectivity has come in, and you mentioned that there has been a shift of volumes from road to rail. Can you just talk about what is the potential kind of volumes or market that we are seeing the shift happening? What are the kind of commodities, what kind of volumes can possibly shift? And we've also seen a very sharp improvement in the double stacked volumes. So how much more scope is there to kind of grow this further? If you can just comment on this, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: See, as you have seen, the growth it is mainly focused on imports. As I told you, imports are very strong. But still there is a scope for increasing more because the imports -- we are not able to capture entire import which is coming in that area. So efforts are continuing, and we may increase more imports.

Now second thing is the exports. At present, the exports are subdued because of various external factors. So when we get more exports, which are likely -- not likely in another 4, 5 months, then we will incr

ease double stacking in exports to a great extent. So that area is still lying you can say, partially tapped.

So if we get more exports, you can get more double stacking in exports because right now, because of less exports, we are not able to do that much double stacking. So then I can say that potential of Dadri will be used entirely. To that extent, it is not used.

Now second thing is the connectivity of DFC to Nhava Sheva. DFC is now connected only to Mundra and Pipavav. Now for Nhava Sheva, they are saying it will be end of 2024. Once Nhava Sheva also comes on DFC, then the potential of double stacking will further improve, will further improve many folds. So we are keeping our fingers crossed and watching the developments on DFC front. So as it progresses, our volumes will also grow.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure. And sir, in terms of Khatuwas terminal because earlier we were using that as a hubbing point, so now trains are going directly from Dadri to Mundra versus going via Khatuwas and now only TKD volumes would be flowing through to Khatuwas, that's the way to think about it?

Sanjay Swarup: See, Khatuwas now, actually, Khatuwas is, of course, not as busy as it used to be, you are right. But at Khatuwas, we are having good, now originating volumes also we are focusing to develop that. And TKD volumes are going through Khatuwas and Ludhiana volumes are also going

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through Khatuwas. These are the 2 main ICDs, which are -- and Ludhiana volumes have increased very much, more than doubled, Ludhiana volumes have more than doubled also.

So we are getting good traction on that front. And Khatuwas, we are coming up with some schemes which I think I will be able to announce in next conference call. I don't want to disclose it now. It is premature. So that will further improve the volumes of Khatuwas.

Bhoomika Nair: Got it. Sir, just last bookkeeping question on percentage of our EXIM volumes of the various ports of JNPT, Pipavav, etc., if I can just have that?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. It is -- JNPT is 33%, Mundra 35%, Pipavav 11%, Vaizag 7%, Chennai 4%, Vallarpadam 3.6%, Tuticorin 2%.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal.

Alok Deora: Sir, just on the capex number, if you would highlight what the capex are looking for this year and next year? Any change from what you've forecasted before?

Sanjay Swarup: Our Director Projects will explain...

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. In the capex, we are having robust growth. In the H1, we have already achieved INR284 crores and during the con-call after Q1, we were giving the guidance that we will achieve capex of INR600 crores. And we are confident of surpassing that INR600 crores because we are getting a steady supply of containers, new trains, and we are also commissioning new terminals.

Alok Deora: Sure. And sir, I missed, I think, the first question where you, I think, spoke about LLF. So LLF now this year, how much we are penciling in? Because during the first quarter, you had mentioned about INR500 crores for FY '24 and now till date, we have -- I mean, in the first half, we have done around INR210 crores-or-so. So what is the full year number now for LLF?

Ajit Kumar Panda: It will not be -- probably somewhere around INR450 crores. It will not be INR500 crores. So whatever we have H1 we will have double, maybe a little more than that.

Alok Deora: Okay. Okay. So just if you could highlight as to what changed, I mean, in the first and second quarter? Because -- so INR500 crores was also based on the assumption that it was -- it would be 7% higher than what it was last year based on 6% of the land value.

Ajit Kumar Panda: We are actually -- every time we are reviewing the thing and there are some provisions also earlier we are addressing that. And plus, we are going to [Technical Difficulty] so in -- we are planning to surrender in TKD. So --

but TKD LLF is the highest. And if we surrender a small part of it, we will have a presence in that.

Alok Deora: Okay. So this is adjusted for that surrender value?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. Again, we have already surrendered 1 terminal at Baroda. So we are selling something there. So that is why we are -- it is a dynamic thing. We are reviewing it quarter-to-quarter. So we are now anticipating that it will be around INR450 crores. It will not be INR500 crores.

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Alok Deora: And this TKD terminal surrender will happen in second half or how is it?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes, it will happen in this quarter, Q3.

Alok Deora: Okay. Okay. And so if we take INR450 crores, assuming you surrender it and earlier provisions you were done and you are adjusting for that, then next year, it could be just 7% higher of this INR450 crores or like...

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes, this INR450 crores plus 7%. Again, next year also, we'll explore the scope where we can further trim our land holding to save on LLF. So we will continue that exercise.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Alok Deshpande from Nuvama.

Alok Deshpande: Yes. Many congratulations on an excellent quarter. Sir, you mentioned about 8% to 9% cost saving coming through because of the DFC volumes starting and which you have passed on. So when more volumes come through over the next 18 to 24 months, what is your sense on what can be that overall -- what cost saving number can be reached or can be achieved, which we can pass on more?

Sanjay Swarup: See, this is not because of the more and more numbers. It's not working on the economies of scale principal. It is basically the double stacking, in double stacking on the upper deck the containers that are going that we have to pay less charges to Railways it is costing on account of that. So that will remain the same whether we get more volumes, whether we get less volumes, plus the productivity of rakes will also increase, that will also be in work out.

Alok Deshpande: Okay. So you mean, sir, more double stacking and more rakes is where that for the cost saving will come?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Because more double-stacking will be done by less number of rakes because DFC turnaround time is less. But this -- Railway has not reduced this rate. We have -- out of our savings, we have passed on to our customers.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Amit Dighe from Morgan Stanley.

Amit Dighe: Most of my questions are answered, but can you just help us understand the dispute or the court

case that has been mentioned in the notes to the account of INR87 crores? And any provisioning or any balance sheet impact of that...?

Sanjay Swarup: Our Director Projects will throw some light on that.

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. Actually, this was a -- award on company had moved to NCLT, and NCLT had given an order which was adverse to us. We have challenged it in NCLAT, and it has been stayed, that NCLT order has been stayed, the status quo continues and the concurrent court case is going on in Delhi High Court. As per the law of arbitration, we have a right to appeal, and we are exercising that right to appeal. So this litigation will continue for some time, and there is no need of provision in this.

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Amit Dighe: So here, if the litigation comes in your favor, then you will be receiving this amount from the customer?

Ajit Kumar Panda: No, no. This amount was awarded to the contractor. It was not a customer, it was a vendor for us. And this amount was awarded in an arbitration dispute to the vendor and he had claimed that amount from us. And we have taken the legal recourse and that will continue for some time till the matter is subjudice and once it is settled in the court then we will...

Amit Dighe: So if it goes away then there's a cash outflow of

this that would come in the near future if at all...

Ajit Kumar Panda: No, no, we don't anticipate that because our case is very strong. And this award has 2 parts. One was a majority decision and there was also a minority decision and the difference was huge. So we feel that we have a bright chance of success, and we have engaged the Solicitor General of India to defend our case because we are a government company and our case is very strong.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial.

Achal Lohade: Sir, my question was in terms of your business, how much of the EXIM and how much of the domestic actually is sourced by other enterprises instead of we directly sourcing that volume from the direct customers?

Sanjay Swarup: That number actually we cannot reveal in this conference call. It's not possible. We don't have ready-made numbers.

Achal Lohade: Would that be large or would that be smaller, sir? And will that...

Sanjay Swarup: Depends on terminal to terminal. On the company-wise basis, we don't compile these numbers.

Achalkumar Lohade: Understood. Understood. Sir, another question I had was with respect to the new initiatives, what you mentioned, would this come through in next 2, 3 quarters? Or it's going to take a couple of years to achieve these, whether it is in terms of the tech solutions and the first mile, last mile more aggressive...

Sanjay Swarup: See, if you are listening properly, already I have told that LNG trucks are operational. That means already benefits have started coming. So this will not take 2, 3 quarters. Already 50 LNG trucks are under operation. So they are working and 50 more are expected very soon. And seeing the commercial success, we may increase the order. So this initiative has already started working. 12-foot container, I told you it is -- already trials are about to be concluded. Then commercial operations will start for these containers also.

Achal Lohade: Got it. Okay. I actually meant for the tech based logistics solution, app-based FM, LM...

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, tech-based logistics solution also I told that for TKD another 15 days, it is likely to be commissioned. For app-based, it will take 1 or 2 months for starting.

Achal Lohade: Okay, understood. And just 1 question. In terms of the market sizing, is it possible to get some sense in terms of NCR market, the Northwest market, what would be the market size and how much of that is already moved by rail? I know at port, we have talked about rail coefficient, but

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I was just curious because some of these cargo will remain on road even if -- post DFC, right? I mean for the shorter distance.

Sanjay Swarup: So I think you are giving your insights, not asking any question. So you already answered your question.

Achal Lohade: No, no, sir, what I wanted to know is the market size, in particular, like is it 4 million, 5 million, 6 million TEUs, numbers like that for, say, Dadri market, like you mentioned 1 million TEU...

Sanjay Swarup: See, we keep that intelligence with us. We don't share it in conference calls, please.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditya Mongia: The first question that I had was the impact on volumes. As we surrender the railway land in Tughlaqabad, would it be a small or a significant impact?

Sanjay Swarup: See, I just wanted to clarify very clear -- very emphatically that wherever we are surrendering

the land, we are not losing any volume. It's a very, very -- it's a decision which is taken after a lot of deliberations. Like 16 terminals we have surrendered, we have not lost any volume. The volume is still with us in the neighboring terminals or some facility of our own we have done that, like, for example, at Baroda, we are surrendering the Baroda land -- already surrendered, and we have come up with a very b

ig logistic park at a place called Varnama which is 15 kilometers from Baroda.

So that volume has come to our facility, we are getting more volumes because I'm able to give more services to customers. So at TKD, Tughlaqabad, if we surrender the land, it's not that we will lose the volume. Volume will remain with us only.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. That clarifies. The second question that I had was a more broad question on pricing as such. And I'm assuming that rail freight margins are comparable over the years. This number of rail freight went from 26% to 30% and is now at about 27%. I wanted to get a sense that given the change in cost dynamics, would you be thinking through lower numbers of rail freight margins incrementally where things stabilize?

And I'm taking a queue from you not passing on the cost increase from haulage to customers at large. Just trying to get a sense of whether there should be -- whether these sustainable rail freight margins for you should be lower in '27?

Sanjay Swarup: See, rail freight margins actually, there is a slight drop that reason is the running of empty, not because of not passing the increase to customers because if you are aware, we are having lot of schemes like 1 plus 1 stream and movement of empty containers.

But we have taken care of these schemes in our other charge -- in the form of other charges. That is why if you see our operating margin, our operating margin is intact. In fact, for this quarter, we have shown an operating margin of 32.7%. Whereas for same period of last year, it was 32.5%. So it's just slightly increased only.

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Operating margin is a better way to look at these things in totality because rail freight is we are passing on some incentive to our customers but compensating in other forms. So operating margin covers everything. So that is the reason of rail freight margin. And second is the imbalance of import exports that -- because of that also, it's slightly less rail margin, but we are able to compensate it by doing more double stacking. So these are the reasons for drop in rail margin. Better indices will be to look at operating margin.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. But questions would still remain. Do you believe that CONCOR is at the right pricing levels from a competitive perspective? Or does it require some further tinkering at an overall level from here on to hit the right spot from a volumes perspective?

Sanjay Swarup: See actually, in logistics, you may be tracking other companies also. We are having an EBITDA margin of 26%, 27%, which is very, very high. Logistics normally company operate at a single-digit margin. So we are operating at a very high EBITDA margin. Over the years, we have been maintaining more than 25% or around 25%. So more than that is not sustainable. So I think 24%, 25%, 26% is a reasonably good EBITDA margin in Logistics business. So it will continue to be this in the coming years also.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. And just a last clarification, sir. The other income has increased quite meaningfully on the P&L and also as a cash item on 1:1 is last year. Could you give us some more clarity because we couldn't see the underlying asset base, which is cash and bank balances going up by a meaningful amount. So just trying to get a sense whether 2H can be as good as 1H.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: I hope you're only tracking the FD rates also.

Sanjay Swarup: FD interest rates.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: FD interest rates are gone quite high, number one. Number two, the dividends that we are getting from our joint ventures are also quite substantial this year. So last year, everybody has done well.

So we have got around 12 joint ventures working with various partners [CFS] and all. So from there our dividend collection is very robust as well as the interest rate to FD has gone by nearly 150 basis points to 200 basis points out of that.

Mod

erator: Our next question is from the line of Priyankar Biswas from BNP Paribas.

Priyankar Biswas: I just have some -- 2 quick questions. So 1 is usually in the third or fourth quarters, we do provide some employee provisionings on post-retirement medical benefits and others. So typically, either it's in the third quarter or the fourth quarter. So in that sense, in this year, can you give us some highlights like whichever quarter it happens. So how much it can go up by from the normal quarterly run rate?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So I think you have got some wrong motion on that. In our accrual system of accounting under Ind AS rule, every quarter you have to do the provisioning. In fact, you see my staff cost in Q2,



it is higher. And 1 question was answered that it was a little more higher for the fact that we take one of payments of awards in this particular quarter.

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Otherwise, on actuarial basis, including gratuity, leave encashment, PRP, whatever we are supposed to pay, it has to be equally taken into every quarter. The rest of that, no auditor will sign my balance sheet. So it's nothing that in Q3 and Q4 will load more and will not load than in Q1, Q2. This is not the practice in Ind AS accounting system. I hope I have clarified.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay. And sir, this time, the domestic margins have been quite high at around 10%. So do you expect that to sustain? And if so, what are the drivers -- what are the factors that is leading to this high margin this time on the domestic...?

Sanjay Swarup: Domestic business has shown very encouraging results and we have been able to develop good -- in which empty movement has come down. So that has improved our bottom line in domestic market. It will continue to be like this. We are developing more such streams where we have more and more loaded movement. Empty movement is we are -- our effort is to bring it down because that is infructuous kind of thing. But -- infructuous but very essential. But we -- so that is the reason of improving in bottom line in domestic.

Priyanka Biswas: Sir should we take this 9%, 10% margin as a sustainable level, broadly, like, let's say, on an annual basis?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes, yes, we should.

Priyanka Biswas: And sir, just squeezing just 1 last in. Of your -- all the terminals that you have, how many of them would be connected via first mile, last mile services end-to-end...

Sanjay Swarup: That is actually difficult to answer this question right now because I don't have the numbers. All I can say is we are able to give this service to 30% of our volumes on a pan-India level. But terminal wise, I think it will be very difficult for me to answer now. I don't have the numbers with me.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay. So 30% of the overall volumes are end-to-end covered, so like that, that should be interpretation?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes.

Sanjay Swarup: That's growing number.

Sanjay Swarup: And this is growing.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay. This is growing. So like previous years, it would be much lower than it is...

Sanjay Swarup: It has started from 0, very less. Now it -- previously, it was 22% to 25%.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: In fact, it is not only growing, it is giving us a good margin also every year. So as our CMD mentioned that you would look at the operating margin. So whatever stress we are having on our rail freight margin that is actually being compensated with these kind of growing margins where we are getting last mile connectivity business.

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Priyanka Biswas: So sir, if we compare, let's say, like 2 years back, so would it be right to say that your first mile last mile would be very low, like single digits or something like that?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes.

Priyanka Biswas: And probably, as you go higher than 30%, maybe, let's say, in another 2, 3 years, let's say,

50%,

so your margin should improve even more. So is this the thought process?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Of course.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Rohit Ohri from Progressive Share.

Sanjay Swarup: So 1 hour is I think, completed, we can take this last question, I think.

Moderator: Okay, sir. Our next question is from the line of Rohit Ohri from Progressive Share.

Rohit Ohri: Two questions, which are from the Chairman's speech of the AGM. So if you would like to take us to the developments of the 2 subsidiaries, SIDCUL CONCOR and Punjab Logistics?

Sanjay Swarup: Both are doing extremely well. And this SIDCUL Logistics have posted very good results this time. I don't have it in front of me. But all I can say is we are hopeful from next financial year, so they will start paying dividend also both -- even Punjab Logistics is also growing very robustly. They will also pay the dividend from next financial year. They have also come in positive. They have shown profit. SIDCUL is also profitable.

Rohit Ohri: And sir these are sustainable over the next 2, 3 years or so?

Sanjay Swarup: Sorry?

Rohit Ohri: You feel that these are sustainable over the next 2, 3 years?

Sanjay Swarup: Sustainable for forever. And from that financial year, they will start paying dividend, that is what

I told you. They are very much sustainable.

Rohit Ohri: Okay. Okay. Sir, my second question is related to the opportunities that we see for the entire sector as a whole may it be food supply chain management or coastal shipping or distribution logistics. Sir there's a lot of opportunity in terms of the diversification. Sir do you think that CONCOR would be interested in any of these diversifications or soft diversifications, if any?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, CONCOR is very conscious about these developments, and we are, of course, working on it. We don't tell everything in the investor conference. So we are working on coastal shipping also. We stopped it due to COVID. And distribution logistics, as far as distribution logistics is concerned, we are working on that front also. So we are working on all the areas where we can diversify.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question of our question-and-answer session. I would now like to hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Limited, for closing comments.

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Bhoomika Nair: Yes. I would like to thank the management for answering all the questions and giving us an opportunity to host the call and also all the participants for their active participation. Thank you very much, sir, and wish you all the very best.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you, Bhoomika.

Ajit Kumar Panda: Thank you, and a happy Diwali to all of you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

Conference Name:

Time:

Main Speaker(s):

Sr. No. Name Phone Company

1 HOST: Bhoomika Nair 42022561 Dam Capital Advisors Ltd.

2 HOST: Management 1141673000 CONCOR

3 Aish Shah 919321606200 Elara Capital

4Aakash Goel 919830519144 Tara Capital Partners

5Aakash Kumar 919920804560 Tata AIA

6Abhijit Mitra 919833686232 Aionios Alpha Investment management

7Abhimanyu 7014170558 JP Morgan

8Abhinav Bhandari 919699358293 Soham Asset Management

9Abhinav Chouhan 9461286260 Yes Securities

10Abhishek 2266578150 DSP

11Abhishek Verma 919810163352 Fidelity International

12Achal Lohade 2266303081 JM Financial

13Achal Phade 912235752441 ICICI Prudential Life Insurance

14Aditya Deorah 919339464800 Divisha Investments

15Aditya Mungya 2243360884 Kotak Securities

16Ajit Motwani 919820934229 Diamond Asia

17Akhilesh Kumar 2266505063 PLSA

18Akshata Thakker 917208211260 Asian Markets

19Alok Despande 919930075461 Numava

20Alok Devra 9820513792 Motilal Oswal

21Amit Dhinde 2261181031 Morgan Stanl

ey

22Amit Dixit 919839043382 ICICI Securities

23Amit Kumar 918898708990 Determined Investments

24Amyn Pirani 2261573583 JP Morgan

25Ankit Jain 2267800305 Mirae Asset

26Ankita Shah 919820679464 Elara Capital

27Anshul Agarwal 2266121228 Emkay Global

28Arijit Dutta 2262185636 Kotak MF

29Arun Sethuraman 919176031817 Capital Market

30Aseem Madan 2269544415 3P IM

31Ashish Agarwal 2249133276 Sundaram Mutual Fund

32Ashish Shah 6566025000 Millennium

33Ashwin Kedia 917021923440 Alchemy

34Atul Tiwari 2261759866 Citi

35Bagdish Kavalkar 2266580201 HDFC Mutual Funds

36Bharti Sawant 2267800306 Mirae Asset  
37Biswarup Mohapatra 919920237743 Reliance Nippon Life Insurance  
38Brijesh Ved 2266291215 Enam AMC  
39Chandra Prakash 2266578274 Tata Mutual Fund  
40Darshak Lodhiya 919601609500 White Oak Capital Management  
41Deepak Gupta 2242147104 SBI Pansion Funds  
42Dev Shah 918828070686 Tej InvestmentsTHANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US  
Management Of CONCOR.

Ms. Bhoomika Nair - Dam Capital Advisors Ltd-----.

Participants ListTotal 167 Participants including the Speakers.November 03, 2023 at 11:30 Hrs India TimeCONCOR Q2FY24  
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Capital Advisors Ltd-----.

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43Devansh Kothari 918169490121 Aditya Birla Asset Management  
44Dhaval Doshi 919867162127 Pinpoint AMC  
45Dhaval Mehta 919766696245 Aditya Birla Asset Management  
46Dhaval Shah 2243568083 Birla MF  
47Dhawal Somaya 2266520127 ASK Investment  
48Diksha Shetty 918828022907 Klay Securities  
49Ekta Mehta 919819633634 Karma Capital Advisors Pvt Ltd  
50Girish A 919819101512 Morgan Stanley  
51Harish Shiyad 8928849605 Individual Investor  
52Harsh Chauhan 918700332264 District D  
53Harsh Dole 919967581549 IIFL  
54Hitesh Konakalla 916281658667 UTI Retirement Solutions  
55Ishan Bhargav 918303873399 Emkay Gobal  
56Ishan Minda 2269300642 IIFL Securities  
57Jainam Shah 918758759924 Equirus Securities  
58Jaipal Shetty 919167858570 Individual Investor  
59Janakiraman Rengaraju 4466459212 Franklin MF  
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61Jatin Matta 2266084530 Fedility International  
62Jayesh Gandhi 2242648148 Harshad Gandhi Securities  
63Jeevita K. 12126171989 Bloomberg  
64Jignesh Makwana 919930122599 Asian Markets  
65Jitark Shah 919324242648 SBI Pension Funds  
66Jiten Rushi 918767323999 Axis Capital  
67John David 15103907767 Bloomberg  
68John Jajermias 4041970046 S&P Global  
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77Kyupa Shankar 919884128127 Avendus Spark  
78Lavina Quadros 2242246116 Jefferies  
79Lohit Bharange 9834310401 All Cargo Logistics  
80Lokesh Gargq 7506203325 UBS  
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82Manish Malhotra 6568122860 Polymer Capital  
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87Neelotpal Sahu 919355735975 BNP Paribas  
88Neeraj Parkash 918097436847 White Oak Capital Management  
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90Nikhil Yadav 2261291536 Motilal Oswal  
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94Nitin 9821359091 Individual Investor

95Nitin Agarwal 917045066514 Shriya Investments  
 96Nitin Agarwal 2266786515 UTI MF  
 97Paresh Dave 6569142570 Paloiasnay AMC  
 98Parth Thakker 917977050966 Incred Capital  
 99Pradeep Gokhle 2240967202 Green Lantern Capital  
 100Pranali Patil 2261047504 Iden Investments  
 101Prathamesh Ghiwar 918975895859 Tiger Assets  
 102Pravin Yeolekar 918275744401 Bajaj Allianz Life  
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 104Priteshwar Omk  
  
 ar 917021526759 ICICI Securities  
 105Priyakar Vesvas 918657737455 BNP Paribas  
 106Priyanka Nangalia 919820810432 Aditya Birla Sunlife Insurance  
 107Pulkit Patni 2266169044 Goldman Sachs  
 108Rachael Smith 17812306877 Aiera  
 109Rahul Agarwal 2243422807 Bandhan Mutual Fund  
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 151Sumeet Kishore 919819626041 Axis Capital  
 152Tanay Shah 2242022592 Dam Capital Advisors Ltd.  
 153Tvisha Shah 919820722403 Karma Capital Advisors Pvt Ltd  
 154Udit Dekhre 2266328520 BOA  
 155Urmil Shah 2268287842 Anvil Wealth Management Pvt. Ltd.  
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 157Vaibhav Vasa 919004377765 Crisil

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164Viren Dediya 919987145720 ICICI Bank  
165Vishal Adwani 919892401738 Agagon Life  
166Yarukh Khan 919910367461 Money Control  
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Regd. Office: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, New Delhi-110076 1; ~ I Tel. 011-41673093, 49512150,60, ¥Ri / Fax:

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"Container Corporation of India Limited

Q3 FY24 Earnings Conference Call"

January 25, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING  
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS &  
SERVICES ) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR  
(DOMESTIC ) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. MANOJ DUBEY -- DIRECTOR (FINANCE) AND  
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – CONTAINER  
CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM C APITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

Container Corporation of India Limited

January 25, 2024

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Container Corporation Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star, then zero on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q3 FY '24 earnings call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director, and his entire team. I now hand over the floor to Mr. Swarup for his initial remarks, post which it'll open up the floor for Q&A. Over to you sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Good morning Bhoomika. I'm joined here by my Director Finance and CFO, Mr. Manoj Dubey; and Director Domestic, Mr. Azhar Shams; and Director Projects, Mr. Ajit Panda. I will just make some opening remarks, and then we'll be open for questions.

First will be that EXIM booking has increased by 13% in Q3 over Q3 of last year and income has increased by 15% in EXIM. Overall handling of CONCOR has increased by 7% for 9-month period over last year. In EXIM, there are effects of geopolitical conflicts, these effects are temporary. We have been in touch with shipping lines and they are quite hopeful that by February first week things are going to stabilize.

In domestic, we are getting very good business, very good demand now all across the country. And we are well poised to cater to their demand with good container inventory and good fleet of rakes also. The focus area of the company continues to be customer centricity, providing total logistics solution to customers, warehousing and business solutions, including first mile, last mile incidentally, which is giving us good margins also now.

We have deployed 75 LNG trucks at Chennai, Nagpur, Baroda and Ankleshwar, which are giving us good commercial returns and the customers are also very happy. We plan to increase the fleet. We have signed MoU with M/s IGL, in November 2023 for development of LNG pumps at CONCOR terminals.

We have signed another MoU with NTPC Vidyut Vyapar Nigam in December 2023 for solar energy products development at our terminals. We have signed 1 MoU with M/s DB Schenker, which is a leading international trade forwarding company from Germany to expand our range of services in EXIM and Domestic segments.

On infrastructure front, in this quarter, we have added 5 BLC rakes, and now our total additional rakes in this financial year stand at 12, 4 more are expected in this Q4. So as forecast earlier in the financial year, we will be adding 16 rakes in this financial year as per our initial projection.

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Domestic container fleet is also increasing, and we are getting almost 400 to 500 containers every month. Now we have more than 41,000 domestic containers and we are commissioning new terminals also. In this Q3, we have commissioned Kadakola MMLP near Mysore, and it is fully ready to give the service to customers.

The company is laying a lot of emphasis on operational innovations, and one of the major is double stacking. In Q3, we have seen a growth of 55% quarter-on-quarter on double stacking and 38% in 9-month period over the last 9 months of last financial year. So, this has actually, in fact, helped us to improve our bottom line and give good, assured transit to our customers. Lastly, the company believes in technology-based green logistics. On that front, we are having app-based FMLM first mile, last mile, wh

ich has been working at 2 of our terminals Ludhiana and Jaipur, and getting very good response of customers. We are working on Ice battery solutions, which is a passive cooling technology. And we are also working on AI-based terminal management system at our flagship terminal ICD, Tughlakabad.

These are my opening remarks. Now I request that questions can start.

Moderator: We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora: I just had a couple of questions. So one is, if you can provide the originating volumes for EXIM and Domestic?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Originating volume for this quarter are EXIM it is 525,138, and domestic it is 110,131. Total 635,269.

Alok Deora: Sure. And also, sir, the LLF provisioning in this quarter has been quite low. So, we are at around -- and if you look at the 9 months, we are at around INR2.9 billion or so. So, what's the number we are looking at for this financial year?

Sanjay Swarup: I will request my Director Finance. He will take this question.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: So, for everybody just to give an overview of LLF. We started a new regime from FY 20-21. So, in 2020-21, we paid and made a provision in total for INR517 crores. For FY 21-22, we paid and made a provision of INR465 crores. FY 22-23 seems to stabilize and in most of the places, we got the rate and clarified with the railways. And things settled at INR392.36 crores. That was for last FY i.e. 22-23.

In the current FY, we were supposed to pay 7% more than this, which comes around INR419 crores. Now this FY '21 and FY '22, we had made an additional provision of INR160 crores approximately for various depots. And wherever the cases are being settled, those provisions are being reversed.

If you look at my note in the results, we have given a clear note that we have reversed INR36 crores of provisions in LLF. So, it is the impact of that. Now going forward to answer the Container Corporation of India Limited  
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question. In Q4, we are expecting LLF of around INR100 crores. That takes us to around INR388 crores to INR400 crores maximum for this FY. I hope I clarified the thing.

Alok Deora: Sure. So, sir, one is this FY '24, you have taken all these reversals. So, after that, there is no pending reversal...

Manoj Kumar Dubey: There are still around INR90 crores for various -- around [5, 6 depots], where still things are being reconciled with the Railways. If it reconciled in our favour, then those reversals will come back to us. It is in favour of the Railways then those money will be paid to Railways.

Alok Deora: Sure. So, FY '25 what number we are looking at, assuming there are no reversals?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: FY '24?

Alok Deora: '25, '25.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: '25, it is INR420 crores, approximately the actual payout for this year without any adjustments.

So, you take 7% more. So that comes out to be around INR450 crores, INR460 crores. But there is catch in that also. There are 2 things. One in the last quarter result my Director Project has mentioned to you that we are still looking at rightsizing our major depots like TKD. So those rightsizing are also in process. If we are able to surrender a few portion of the land, which are not productive for us, then there can be a decrease in our total payout, A.

And B, as you know, Gati Shakti policy is already unveiled for the new project where rate was the charges are only 1.5% fixed and there's a variable cost. Now we are also making our representation -- discussions are on that, why not that facility be given to us. If the ministry agrees to us, that can bring up more bonanza for us and that this payout may go down, but they are right now in the pipeline only.

Alok Deora: Got it. And sir, just one last follow-up on this. So, in 3Q also, we were going to surrender some part of the terminal. So, any -- we hav

e done that in 3Q or...

Ajit Kumar Panda: Let me clarify on that. On Tughlakabad terminal, where we have about 5 lakh square meters of land, 10% of it is around 39,000 square meters. We have offered surrender to railway on November 6, 2023. That will bring down the cost of LLF in TKD by about INR25 crores.

So, discussions are on for handing over. And we are very hopeful that from 1st of April, the TKD LLF will go down by 10%. Of course, this will be offset by 7% with increase. But our net outflow on TKD terminal will be less next financial year, Number one.

Number two, we have surrendered another small part of land in Baroda terminal to the Railway. After surrendering that terminal and merging the business with our Varnama Terminal, which has started operating in full scale near Baroda. So, these 2 factors we have surrendered in Q3. Similar optimization will continue.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial.

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Achal Lohade: This is Achal Lohade here. Sir, with respect to the volumes. Given how it has panned out in first 9 months, how do you look at FY '24? And if you were to hazard a guess for FY '25, how do you look at growth in the EXIM and Domestic volumes?

Sanjay Swarup: See, in the FY '24, the guidance that we gave in the beginning of the financial year, we will be able to achieve because of good volume growth in EXIM and Domestic. And EXIM, as I told you, from next month onwards, we should again have a good growth. As in Q3, you would have seen there is a growth of 13% in volumes.

Domestic till now for 9 months has shown a growth of 11%. And we are getting good demand now. We have good container fleet. So, we are very hopeful that we will end the year with



around 15% growth in Domestic and around 10% growth in EXIM.

As far as FY '25 is concerned, guidance I will give at the end of the year. But what I can say is that demand is good, and our infrastructure is ready. So, we are very, very hopeful that good growth will continue in FY '25 also, especially with the commissioning of DFC up to Nhava Sheva, which is expected in December 2024, we expect a good ramp-up from road to rail on this segment also.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Sir, if I were to just ask a bit more detailed question with respect to the DFC connection to JNPT. Is it possible to get some color as to how much of the volume in terms of thousands of millions of TEUs, which is available to us, which is yet to come on rail, whether it is currently containerized or being transported in a bulk form?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, it will be difficult to give you any number at this moment. All I can tell you is that at present that rail coefficient that JNPT is in the range of 18% to 19%. And all the volumes will not increase immediately when the DFC is commissioned for JNPT. Then in 2 years' time, you can say, the rail coefficient may rise to 25% to 30%. That is the number I can predict at this moment.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Secondly, if I were to look at the increase in freight rate, if I look at the rail freights per TEUs it's kind of increased by about INR2,000 compared to second quarter. How much of this is on account of the busy season surcharge and how much of that is already passed on, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: See, busy season surcharge, we have passed on absolute amount to our customers. But on some streams, which are of strategic importance, like where we have a competition with our road or from competitors. There, we have taken a strategic decision. And part of that, we have retained. Part of that, we have passed on. So, it is difficult to tell you the exact number how much is contributed by busy season surcharge and how much is the actual growth in volume at this moment of time. But all I can say is that we have taken a strategic decision so that we don't lose the business. At the same time,

e, we continue to grow.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Just a clarification on this, sir. When you say some streams where we have severe competition from roads or other players, would that be 40%, 50% of the volume? Or would that be like 15%, 20%, just?

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Sanjay Swarup: I'm not able to give any numbers right now. But that also constitutes a sizable volume, and that is a strategic decision our team takes. We get inputs from fuel units, and then we take a decision.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Yatin Mehta from Fidelity International.

Please go ahead.

Yatin Mehta: Congratulations on good set of numbers. So just 2 parts to previous question on peak season, sir? Sir it seems that if I look at your originating realization, the past one has been more in domestic and slightly lesser in the EXIM and, do you think this -- we have been able to manage our profitability because of the double stacking and that is why the realization is kind of looking flattish here?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, the thing is that in EXIM, whatever business surcharge was there, was passed on to the customers. But you will appreciate that the busy season surcharge was started imposed by Railways from October 1, 2023. Whereas we took 40 days, we gave a margin of 40 days to our customers to pass on that thing to them. And we started our -- we revised our rates from 11th of November. So, 40 days period, we have absorbed that. Despite that, we are giving very good numbers as far as margins are concerned despite this constraint.

Secondly, in domestic initially, there was -- we faced some setbacks when we passed on this busy season surcharge to our customers. Then our team and director himself personally Director domestic, had a one-to-one meetings with major customers, and he did some tweaking based on the strategic decisions that I mentioned earlier.

So, we have revised, and we have passed on some discounts to our customers, various strategies we have used. So based on that, now things are stabilized. So, in Q4, we should -- we are now well poised to have a good growth in terms of numbers as well as financial figures.

Yatin Mehta: Sir, that's very helpful. Just on DFC, you did mention Nhava Sheva getting connected. But we have 6 months of DFC which is connected to Mundra and Pipavav. Have you seen shift from road to rail here? Will it be possible for us to share the rail coefficient in these 2 segments?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Actually, that's a very nice thing that has happened on Mundra. Volumes have increased as compared to year-on-year existing. Rail coefficient has slightly increased. It has not increased very much, but rail coefficient has slightly increased.

Similarly, at Pipavav also, it is almost same. It has not increased. But from our experience, we are able to see that from our terminal Dadri, which is at in north -- in the national capital

region, we have a terminal like Dadri. And from there, we are running timetable freight express trains to Mundra port. In that stream, we have seen sizable shift from road to rail. So that we are seeing, and the customers are very, very happy in fact. And when their containers reaching in 35 to 40 hours and whereas road is taking more than 50 hours. So, we are seeing a sizable shift. But at this point, I can't tell you the exact number how much percentage has shifted.

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Yatin Mehta: Okay. No, that's very helpful. Sir, just one last small question. Domestic profitability for second consecutive quarter is high single-digit domestic EBIT. Do you think this is now sustainable given the scale which we have achieved? Or is there any specific in this which we need to understand?

Sanjay Swarup: As I told you that in domestic, we are getting good demand now, especially from South India, only

we were sending loaded cargo and in return direction empty was coming. So that has -- in Q3, it has adversely affected our profitability. But now that in South India also, we are getting demand for Western India as well as Northern India. So those empty containers, which were running, now they are coming in loaded condition. So definitely, in Q4, you will see very good EBITDA margins in domestic also.

Yatin Mehta: No, no. Sorry, sir, my question was slightly on a longer term that historically, domestic used to be 5% to 6%. And for the last 2 quarters, we've seen at an average of 10% -- 9% and 10%. Do you think -- given like you mentioned that the empty running is much more lower, there is sustainability of this profitability?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, definitely. It will sustain and it will become better.

Yatin Mehta: Okay. That's very helpful, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mr. Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Amit Dixit: Hi. Good morning, everyone and thanks for the opportunity. I have two questions. One is on capex. Last call, we mentioned that we are confident of reaching INR600crores of capex this year. So just wanted to understand the nine-month FY'24 capex? And is there any revised revision in guidance?

Sanjay Swarup: My Director, Projects will take this one.

Ajit Kumar Panda: We are giving a guidance of INR600 crores of capex for FY'24. And we have already achieved -- as per the balance sheet, we have achieved INR474 crores capex up to Q3. We are very confident that we will cross, exceed the guidance given by the next quarter.

Amit Dixit: Okay. Great, sir. The second question essentially is on...

Ajit Kumar Panda: This is an all-time high capex that we are achieving in this financial year.

Amit Dixit: Yes, sir. I appreciate that. The second question is essentially that last time we indicated that we have some custom-need containers for FM fast-moving durables, actually. So just wanted to understand the traction on that front, how is the response and what kind of volume growth do you see possibly next year from this particular segment?

Sanjay Swarup: For 12-feet containers, we have got 270 sub-containers manufactured at Railway Workshop. And we are actually -- at present, we are not getting much revenue from that. But our teams are working and trials have been successful. And we are very hopeful that we will be able to build circuits for this kind of containers also, which are mainly catering to low-density cargo.

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Amit Dixit: Yes. Last quarter, you indicated, sir, that we have got 180 containers. So, this time we have got 270, actually, 90 more containers have arrived in this quarter. That is the focus is clearly -- clear on this particular segment. And just wanted to understand what kind of growth we are expecting?

Sanjay Swarup: We are getting good growth because this is the segment that we are not able to capture right now. So, it has been our endeavour to get this traffic also on rail. And my Director, Domestic will further elaborate on this point now.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: With respect to 12-feet high container, as our CMD has just underlined that we have got 270 containers. I think before it started getting the traffic, there are certain things we have to do.

Number one, the railway has to give us route-to-route clarification. This permission for running these 12-feet container, that these 12-feet containers are basically A-class ODC. There is over-dimensional consignment. We have to take permission from the railway. We are in the process of taking those permissions. That is number one.

Number two, you noticed that what kind of loadability as compared to 20-foot normal containers are going to happen in these containers. So, we have done two, three trials. One we have done with Coca-Cola plant. And then second, we have done in I

FB plant in Goa. So those

trials have been successful. Once these route clearances are in place, so I think this traffic will start. And we are in talk of Reliance also for moving their cargo -- lightweight cargo from their plant in Jamnagar to various destinations. The things are in process. But that anything to start and some new thing is going to start, it certainly takes some time before it gets stabilized.

Amit Dixit: Thanks a lot for the elaborate explanation. Just last one, if I may. I just wanted to know the empty running cost with certain domestic and EXIM?

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Empty running cost in EXIM, just a minute.

Sanja Swarup: You want for the quarter or for nine months?

Amit Dixit: For the quarter, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: For quarter -- for EXIM, it is INR35.3 crores. Domestic, it is INR98.8 crores. Total is INR134.1 crores.

Amit Dixit: Wonderful, sir. That's it from my side. Thanks, and all the best.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from Dam Capital. Please go ahead.

Bhoomika Nair: Sir, you mentioned earlier in one of your comments that with the Dadri connectivity we have seen and with the timetable trains that we are offering, there has been an increase in the shift of cargo from rail to road because of the better service...

Sanjay Swarup: Road to rail.

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Bhoomika Nair: Sorry, road to rail because of the better services that we are providing. Sir, can we get some sense on how the real coefficient has changed in this circuit, what kind of volumes have kind of move which has helped?

Sanjay Swarup: See, I don't have the numbers with me right now. But because we are getting good shift, so it is visible. And even some leading shipping lines like Maersk has started retail express train and other lines are also coming for the same. So, we are seeing a shift, which is very, very visible. I'm not able to give the numbers right now. Maybe we can give you the number later on.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure, sir. Sir, the other thing is, can you talk about how your market share has moved in these three ports? And what is the rail coefficient at these three ports of JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav?

Sanjay Swarup: I can tell you the numbers. At Mundra, the rail coefficient that we are having is 36% of the total volume moved by rail. And at Pipavav, it is 45% that we are moving. And as I mentioned earlier also, consciously, the company has decided not to pick up the low-margin business because that is not sustainable. So, we believe in giving service to our customers. And at the same time, our products may be a little costlier as compared to other PCTOs. But we believe in giving service, and customers are very happy, and they are with us. And more and more customers are also joining.

And one more thing is the focus of the company is now for customer centricity. All the field staff, including myself, we are meeting personally with all the customers. We are engaging with various chamber of commerce wherever we go. I had recently visited Udaipur Chamber of Commerce. And all of them are very keen to associate with CONCOR. And they see CONCOR as a credible partner for moving their cargo. And this credibility we have earned in the last 30 years giving service to the trade. So, cost and all is not a very, very prominent thing in their mind because the cargo that is there in the containers is worth crores and lakhs of rupees. So, they don't mind paying INR1,000 more if they get good and credible service.

Bhoomika Nair: Got it. Sir, just on the FMLM services, what -- I think if I'm not wrong, it was around 30% of the volumes that were being serviced by FMLM. What is the potential increase that we can do to service all our entire volumes can shift to that? And what kind of timeframe do you think we'll be able to achieve that, or any targets that are set on this aspect?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. We have set a

target of 80% to 85% in another two years. We'll be able to do that. And we are -- at present, what we are doing is we are using auction-based system on streams. And now one more development has taken place is the app-based FMLM, which has been developed by TCS.

And we are using it at our two terminals, that is Ludhiana and Kanpur -- and Kanakpura, that is Jaipur, which have been welcomed by the trade and in which there is a real-time reverse auction by the bidders and the customers get the best price at the best -- and the service is also very good. Price is also very good. Second thing is the LNG, because we are providing green logistics solution to our customers. So, we have deployed 75 LNG trucks, which have been quite successful.

Manoj Kumar Dubey: This is DF here, Bhoomika. So, I can just give you a flavour of what percentage we are gaining financially through this transportation. So, this quarter-to-quarter, my financial numbers in road freight, that is FMLM, has gone up by 63%. And for nine months, it has grown to 40%. So as CMD mentioned that we are targeting 80% of our throughput through our own FMLM system, which earlier was not a focus for us.

So, something that our partners were doing in a very unorganized manner. So, this is really shooting up for us, and it is going to be cash low for us because margins that we thought is even better in our LNG trucks and all. So, your question is right. There is something which is going to grow for us like warehousing things that we tested in the last 3, 4 years.

Bhoomika Nair: Understood. Understood. Sir, just two data related question, if I may. The number of rakes in this particular quarter and the lead distances?

Sanjay Swarup: Number of?

Bhoomika Nair: Rakes movement. Double stack rake, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Double stack, double stack. Okay, double stack in this quarter was total 1,376 double-stack trains.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. And the lead distance, sir, for both EXIM and domestic?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. Lead distance is EXIM -- I have for -- what -- you want for the quarter?

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: One minute. I have for the quarter. It is -- for EXIM it is 724 kilometres. Domestic, it is 1,413. Total is 827. Both are growing, yes.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Pulkit Patni from Goldman Sachs. Ladies and gentlemen, we got disconnected from Mr. Pulkit. Next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Thank you for the follow-up opportunity, sir. Just wanted to check in terms of the market share. Is it possible to get some sense for EXIM? What is the market share for CONCOR at aggregate level? And how has it moved compared to 2Q as well as 3Q of last year, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: EXIM market share is around -- in the range of 55% to 60%, which is more or less the same as compared to last year. And as I told you, we -- consciously, we have decided not to pick the low margin business. So that is why we are maintaining that market share and with our pricing policies and growth and giving service to our customers.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Sorry, I'm hopping on this question, sir. If I look at the railway volume, the railway volume seems to have grown about 12% Y-o-Y for 9 months. And if I look at our originating volume, it has gone up by 7%. So, it appears that there is a loss of market share, but you're saying that there is no -- the market share is pretty much stable. So, am I looking at the right number? Is there a different way of calculating by Indian Railways?

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Sanjay Swarup: No, you are right. There has been a slight drop in market share in domestic. That is why this has happened. So, you are absolutely right. You're not -- your statistics is correct.

Achal Lohade: Okay. Sorry, sir, I was

talking only for the EXIM segment, sir. EXIM Indian railway seem to have grown 12% for 9 months.

Sanjay Swarup: No, EXIM, actually, in fact, we have also grown, but market share is in the bracket of 55% to 60%. It is same.

Achal Lohade: Okay. Understood. Sir, one more question I had in mind is with respect to DFC. How much of our total volume actually is in and around DFC pocket? And what kind of shift do you see over the next 3 to 5 years? I mean, let's say, hope once JNPT also gets connected, do you see this proportion kind of growing at 20%, 30%? Or it could be just 12% to 15% growth for this particular DFC route cargo?

Sanjay Swarup: As you may be aware that around 60%, 65% containerized cargo moves between Western India and Northern India. So that will be especially for the whole country. So Western DFC is catering to this segment only. So, when JNPT also comes on Western DFC, then we will see a very good shift of cargo from road to rail and because it will be economical and it would be faster.

So, as I mentioned earlier, the rail coefficient will increase from 18% to around 25% to 30% at JNPT. So right now, we are not able to give you the numbers that what will be the annual growth rate for CONCOR because 2, 3 years span is a very long span. So, the guidance we will be giving every year. So, numbers I'm not able to give right now.

But I see a very good potential in the coming 3 to 5 years. The JNPT coming on DFC which will be very exciting for us to -- because we are building up terminals also, new terminals we are building on DFC. Already, we have some terminals. So, all of them will be catering to a lot of traffic on DFC.

Achal Lohade: Got it. Sir, just a clarification. You mentioned 60% to 65% of India's containers are in the West and North pocket. What would be that proportion for us? Would that be similar? Or it could be lower given the significant competition is actually in this pocket only?

Sanjay Swarup: Our proportion from where, from total?

Achal Lohade: West and North -- West and North pocket.

Sanjay Swarup: West and North, our business, we are also following the same trend that 60% to 70% is in this pocket only.

Achal Lohade: 60% to 70%. Understood. And just one question I had with respect to multimodal logistics parks. How many are in -- currently in operations? And how do you see that tally improving over the next couple of years? And as we speak for 9 months, let's say, how much of the revenue is coming from these MMLPs? Would it be possible to get some sense on -- because

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there is significant investment which has gone into this and in terms of revenue and profit contribution, if you could guide us how much is that coming from these MMLPs?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, right now, we have 15 MMLPs under operation all on CONCOR land. And we are quite aggressive, quite bullish on developing more and more logistic parks to provide good service to trade. 10 more are in the pipeline at various stages. So, these are long gestation projects. So, we cannot expect that as soon as we construct, they will start giving us profits. All I can say is the Kathuwas, which was the first logistic park that we constructed, it has become free to us now. Whatever we have invested, more than that we have got. So now whatever we are getting is extra, is the bonus, you can say, not extra.

So, all the logistic parks are in a very vantage positions, where we do proper survey because it would be before constructing the logistic parks. So, we are quite hopeful that all of them will give us very good returns in the future. We are constructing them as futuristic terminals. More than 100 acres of land for each of the terminal.

And we maintain each terminal as a profit centre. But at this point of time, I will not be able to tell you the details how much we are getting from logistic parks. All I can assure y

ou is

whatever investments we have made, we will get more -- much, much more than returns what we expected.

Achal Lohade: Got it. And is there any wide space left -- given 15 already commissioned, 10 in pipeline. Are there any important clusters which are still left over -- left out? Or they are very much captured by now?

Sanjay Swarup: We have captured most of the clusters, and 10 more are in pipeline. And keeping in mind the places like, for example, I will give you just one example because other also have questions.

Like in Ahmedabad, we were not having a point for double stacking till now. We have a terminal at Khodiyar, which is a multimodal logistic park, but we cannot handle it double stack trains there. So, we were in lookout for that for some locations, where we can handle the double-stack trains.

I'm happy to inform all of you -- all the investors, that we have found a place that is at a location at Chharodi near Sanand, which is Auto hub also. It's a very, very vintage location, where we will be constructing a multi-model logistic park in 100 acres of land and it will be handling double-stack traffic from Mundra, Pipavav and JNPT in future. So that will be a very, very good location. And it will give very good return to us, the latest in the list.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Pulkit Patni from Goldman Sachs. Please go ahead.

Pulkit Patni: Sir, thank you for taking my question. Apology I was dropped off previous line. Sir, just a follow-up to Achal's questions on these MMLPs. And glad you spoke about Kathuwas now being almost free for us. When I look at the last 5, 6 years at your company, where capex has gone up, and it's gone in MMLPs and other infrastructure, what we are seeing is that it is not reflected in your ROEs or ROCes. Because as a company, if I go a decade back, we were more

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in the early 20s. And now we are in the early 10s when it comes to ROE. So can you give us a sense that over the next four, five years, as volume grows, as these logistics park gets better

utilized, what is the target ROEs that as a company we need to get to?...

Because while our cash generation has been very strong, given the good business model we have, it seems that the ROEs have been very compressed because of these investments. So, any sense on that will be very helpful, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: See as I mentioned earlier also that we are expecting a very good growth in the coming years due to various factors like DFC, good demand in domestic, good fleet of rakes, good inventory of containers and at our terminals at vantage locations. So, I'm quite hopeful that the ROE is going to increase in the coming years.

At this point of time, it is not possible for me to give you the target number that we will be aiming at in the next three or four years. It is quite long term. But I can assure you, all the investors, that your company will give you a very good ROE, which will be more than the best in the industry. I am very, very hopeful.

Pulkit Patni: Sure, sir. Sir, one follow-up question. On double stacking, you mentioned that for the first nine months, we are up from 60% compared to same time last year. Now when I look at our margins and adjust it for -- the LLF adjustment that you do, we are not seeing that reflect in better margins. Is it fair to assume that double stacking is only going to be a function of higher cargo that we get and how many times we break it, but it doesn't really benefit us in the form of margins? Because numbers are not reflecting that. So, a better understanding of that would also help.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Pulkit, you will appreciate that in the Q3 that you are talking. Q3 actually, we absorbed the increase in 10% rail haulage in EXIM segment for 40 days. Out of the total 90 days, almost half of the quarter we absorbed the increase in rail haulage.

Because railway increased the haulage on 1st of October and we passed on from 11th of November, giving a period of 40 days to our customers.

This move, although we sacrificed our margins for some time, but it acts as a very good marketing tool for the company. So, customers appreciated it very much. And they told that in such times, when you have stood with us, so we will be there always with you. This is the comment I got from many customers.

So, it was a strategic move of the company. And secondly, it's a very justified thing. Because if we pass on immediately to our -- to increase to our customers, they will have to bear the loss because the transit time from foreign shores to our ports are almost 30 days.

So consciously, we took a hit. And that was actually partly contributing to drop in margin.

Second, the contribution was in domestic segment in Q3. We were doing some empty running also because we were not getting load in the return direction. So, these things were pulling down the margin.

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At that time, double stack came as a saviour. It pulled up the margin slightly. But if you compare the margin with Q2, definitely, you will see a drop because of the two factors that I mentioned. Double stack, of course, pulled up the margin slightly, but it's still be almost INR20crores drop as compared to Q2.

But to make an apple-to-apple comparison between Q3 of this year to Q3 of last year, you will see a good increase in margin, around 12% increase in margin is there. I hope it satisfies your question.

Pulkit Patni: Sure, that's helpful, sir. One, just bookkeeping question. What are the rail freight margins for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Rail freight margin for this quarter is 24%.

Pulkit Patni: 24% compared to 27% last quarter, the -- I mean, previous quarter.

Sanjay Swarup: That is because of the reason I mentioned you earlier.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark.

Mukesh Saraf: My first question is on this busy season surcharge. In some form, we have seen this increase in haulage rates by new railways after eight years. So -- and especially now that DFC operational, we've seen this has increased. Should we kind of weigh slightly more into it that this is probably the kind of things to come. It's been eight years how it started increasing haulage rates. And if so, how are -- how is CONCOR or how is the industry looking at it given that this can kind of hamper the road to railway? So, what are your thoughts on this?

Sanjay Swarup: Your question is not clear. Can you repeat it, please? You are -- I think audio, there's a problem with the audio.

Mukesh Saraf: Sorry. So, what I was asking is this -- is it audible now, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, it is better now, please.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay. So, what I was asking is this increase in haulage rates by Indian railways is happening after eight years in some form. I mean they're now doing it in the form of busy season

surcharge. So, the question is, should we kind of read slightly more into this that this is probably the start of more hikes coming in because it's after a long gap of eight years. And if so, then how is the industry going to look at this whole road to rail shift? Because road freight rates are not going up. And so, the gap between road and rail obviously will go up as you pass through these costs.

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. Now I understood your question. We are in talks with the railways on a continuous basis. Now I don't visualize any further increase in rail haulage charges. And 10% busy seasonal charge that they have imposed from 1st of October. I think this is only going to continue for the period defined in the circular.

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Apart from that, there will not be any further increase in the near future at least. And this

busy

season surcharge, we have passed on in EXIM and Domestic also, except for a few strategic streams. So, it has been absorbed by the trade. And of course, there was some disturbance for some time. But now it is solved, in Q4, we get a good volume in physical as well as financially also it will be good.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay so the road to rail shift that you're seeing at Dadri, do you think we are kind of seeing the initial, say, low hanging fruits. And from here on, it will be difficult? Or do you expect that road to rail shift to continue even in these coming quarters despite this pass-through of costs?

Sanjay Swarup: This will continue. This road to rail shift will continue.

Mukesh Saraf: All right. Understood. And my second question is again related to this. How would the role of Kathuwas be changed for you sir now? Because earlier you're using it as a trans-shipment hub. But now with Dadri directly booking the double stack rakes, how is the role of Kathuwas? And are you seeing organic catchment areas there doing well for you?

Sanjay Swarup: See, Kathuwas, actually, is now also, it is having a trans-shipment centre for the ICDs at Ludhiana and Tughlakabad and Barhi. So, these three ICDs are still being catered by Kathuwas. So double stacking is being done there. Of course, it has reduced because of Dadri. But Kathuwas is developing their originating volumes also now. So, we are seeing growth in that originating and destination volumes also. That is also growing at Kathuwas. So, there is a -  
- at Kathuwas.

Mukesh Saraf: Any numbers you can share on the originating volumes for that Kathuwas any broad sets...

Sanjay Swarup: Numbers actually, unfortunately, I don't have those numbers for a particular terminal. But we can tell you later on.

Mukesh Saraf: Sure. Sir, just lastly, on the Cement business -- domestic cement business. I think your last time, you had mentioned that you're in talks with the Ministry for -- or restarting the bulk cement movement via containers. Any update on that?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. We are continuing our talks with Ministry, and they are also doing some analysis, some calculations, data we have supplied to them. I think we should be getting some news in next financial year.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Yaruqh Khan from MoneyControl.

Yaruqh Khan: Sir, I just had two small questions. One was -- so going forward, you've seen a lot of container traffics not moved to the Suez Canal and the Red Sea because of the disruptions that have been going there. Going forward, do you expect your EXIM volumes to be impacted by that? I've seen that in Q3, your EXIM volumes were not impacted and you've seen a good growth, 6% growth in EXIM volumes. What would be the impact going forward in Q4 and then in next FY?

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Sanjay Swarup: In Q3, we have got a growth of 13% in EXIM originating volumes. And the problem at that Red Sea issue. And we are feeling the strain in the current month in January. And we have -- we are in touch with some major shipping lines, and they have informed us that because of this, the containers have to pass through the Cape of Good Hope. So, the transit time has also increased and cost also increased.

So, we have been informed by them that this is going to stabilize by this month end. And from February first week, we should get good imports and good exports also because importers and exporters are in negotiations with the various shipping lines. Because ultimately, whatever orders they have, they have to execute those orders. So maybe it will be costlier and it will be taking more time.

But exporters have to execute their orders, and importers have to get their raw material. So, all these things will stabilize from first week of February. So, we are very hopeful that volumes will again start growing. And that is the indications we have got from almost

all our

stakeholders. And in FY'25, again, from the month of June, July, we should be getting good exports.

Yaruqh Khan: Okay. One -- the other question. So, like just a follow up on the last question that was asked. You said that you negotiate, you're now talking to the Indian railways to start transporting cement through open containers again. What are the sort of processes that you will have to get permission for before this process can be started again?

Sanjay Swarup: I would like to correct you, it's not open containers. It is a normal 20 feet container in which we had started moving bulk cement. For that, the Indian railways has given us rates that is create all kind rates for moving of bulk cement in normal containers. So that -- the validity of that rate circular was one year. That validity has expired.

After that, that circular in which the special rates were given, that has not been extended. So, we are trying with Indian railways to extend that circular that rates because if that rate circular is extended, then our movement becomes viable. And it can compete with road, and we are able to divert cargo from road to rail.

So Indian Railways is carrying out analysis before extending that circular because they have commercial branch, they have finance branch and they do all the analysis, whether it is beneficial for railways or not. And after that only, they will extend the circular. So, I'm hopeful that they will take some time to do that. And by next financial year, I'm very optimistic that they will extend the circular and we may resume the bulk loading in normal container, it is not open containers.

Yaruqh Khan: Sorry about that. Just last question. Any update on the strategic divestment plan for CONCOR?

Sanjay Swarup: That is the policy of Government of India. So whatever policy is given by them, we will follow that policy. We cannot comment on that. And secondly, whatever news we are getting is from new channels and from government directives. We are following the government directives.

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But having said that, we are doing normal business. We are expanding our terminals. We are expanding our customer base. And we are giving more and more -- introducing more and more services for our customers. And so that the existing customers stay with us, new customers join us. So, all these things are going on. The business is not stopping. As and when it comes, we'll obey the orders of government.

Yaruqh Khan: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Sir, thank you for the opportunity. Can you help us understand for this LLF specifically, how many terminals are there and how many terminals have already got renewed under the new policy? Or if you're planning to renew under the new policy? And if you could also help in terms of given their earlier lease duration, how many of them are about to expire over the next two, three years?

Sanjay Swarup: We have total 64 terminals. Out of that, on railway land we have 26 terminals. So, it is not possible at this time to give you the exact which terminal lease expiring on which date. It will not be possible for us right now. And as my director initially explained to you, that we are actually following a policy that wherever we close a terminal, we carry out analysis.

And we make a policy that we don't lose our customers by surrendering the terminals to Indian Railways either we shift the customers to nearby terminals or we develop a terminal on our own land near that terminal outside the city limits because we need a big area. So that has been our policy not to lose customers. But strategically, we shift -- we surrender the terminal when it becomes unviable to us. That has been our policy. Lease dates we cannot give right now. We don't have that detail wit

h us.

Achal Lohade: Understood. But just a clarification. Given the confusion around this LLFs, just a small clarification. Is it accurate to say that if you -- you have an option to renew the existing terminal for 35 years at one go or that is not the case?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. That option is there. It is there in the policy. That can be the renewed for the similar period of time.

Achal Lohade: But in that case, you'll have to surrender that terminal and go for the competitive bidding. Is that understanding right?



Ajit Kumar Panda: No, no. That is not mandatory. We can continue to pay at the 6% rate and retain that terminal for another 35 years.

Achal Lohade: Go it. And in that case, whenever the rates change for the land, the valuation, it will automatically increase. Is that understanding right?

Ajit Kumar Panda: So now the rate is increasing every year at the rate of 7%. Once the base rates has been found, in 2021 is the base rate. And above that, it is increasing by 7%.

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Achal Lohade: Okay. Okay. So further change in the valuation of that land rate in those pockets is of no consequence. Is that understanding right?

Ajit Kumar Panda: No consequence.

Achal Lohade: No consequence of that. Okay, okay. So, in other way, 440, 450, whatever number you have mentioned, that is probably the Cap. It can only be lower than that as you relook at the excess lands. Is that understanding?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. That is the Cap as far as next year is concerned. But it is increasing that 7%. And simultaneously, we are optimizing by reducing some railway land. So, we'll -- we hope to maintain that level.

Achal Lohade: Understood. This is very, very helpful, sir. Thank you so much and I wish you all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair for closing comments.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes. So, thank you very much for giving us an opportunity to host the call and answering all the queries very patiently. Much appreciate to yours and your teams efforts on this. Many thanks and wishing you all the very best. Sir, any closing remarks from your end?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no, that's all. I don't have any closing remarks. Thank you very much for your best wishes and for the investors to having faith in CONCOR.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference.

Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you.

Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No.Name Phone Company

1 Host: Bhoomika Nair 2242022561 DAM Capital

2 Host: Management 1141673000 Container Corporation

3 Abhay Modi 67319602 Helios capital

4 Abhijit Mitra 919372519256 Aionios Alpha Investment management

5 Abhinav Bhandari 919699358293 Sohum Asset Managers Pvt Ltd

6 Abhinav Chari 61389316 BOB Capital

7 Abhishek Rathie 85266920085 North rock

8 Abhishek Verma 9810163352 Fedelity International

9 Achal 918655308260 ICICI Prudential AMC

10 Achal Lohade 66303081 J M Financial

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12 Ajit Motwani 9820934229 Dymond asia

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14 Aksh Goel 9830519144 Tara Capital

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41 Deep Mehta 2261249059 Bank of India Mutual Fund  
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43 Deepika Mundra 9820788999 MNG  
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45 Dhaval Mehta 9766696245 Aditya Birla AMC  
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January 25, 2024 at 11:30 Hrs India Time  
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53 Harish Shiyad 8928849605 Retail Investments  
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165 Vaibhav Vasa 9004377765 Crisil  
166 Venkat 2266578154 DSP Investment Managers  
167 Vicky Waghwan 9960695544 JM Financial  
168 Vikram Suryavanshi 9867327414 Phillipcapital  
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170 Vinayak 2243252525 Axis AMC  
171 Vinit Mane 62327215 Karma capital  
172 Vishal Ghajoo 69153531 ITI Mutual Fund  
173 Vivek Kumar 9986431240 Informist  
174 Yarukh Khan 9910367461 Money Control  
175 Yash Tanna 9920046969 PMS  
176 Yatin Matta 66084530 Fidelity International  
177 Yogesh Patil 2266016073 LIC MF  
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## Call: May 2024

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CONCOR~~~~~

Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

No.CON/F& CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No.293/NoteNo.26 2/ ~: 22.05.2024 (A Navratna CPSE of Govt. of India)

1. The Bombay Stock Exchange Ltd., Mumbai (Through BSE Listing Centre)

Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Dalal Street

Mumbai-400001

2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (Through NEAPS)

Exchange Plaza, 5th Floor, Plot No. C/1,G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E)

Mumbai-400 051

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~: Disclosure under SEBI (Listing Obligatio n & Disclosure Requirements)

Regulations, 2015.

Pursuant to applicable prov1s1ons of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find

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"Container Corporation of India Limited Q4 Earnings  
Conference Call"

May 17, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN & MANAGING  
DIRECTOR, CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

MR. MANOJ KUMAR DUBEY - DIRECTOR (FINANCE)  
AND CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER -- CONTAINER  
CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

MR. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR  
(DOMESTIC ), CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

MR. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR, (PROJECTS &  
SERVICES), CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

Container Corporation of India Limited

May 17, 2024

Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Container Corporation of India Limited Q4 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call, hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing "\*" and then "0" on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair : Yes. Good morning, everyone. A warm welcome to the Q4 FY '24 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India.

We have the Management today being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director and his entire team. I'll now hand over the floor to Mr. Swarup for his initial remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. Good morning, everybody. I am Sanjay Swarup – CMD, Container Corporation. I am joined by Mr. Manoj Kumar Dubey – Director (Finance) and CFO; Mr. Mohammad Azhar Shams – Director, Domestic; Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda – Director (Projects & Services).

I will make some opening remarks. After that, we will be ready for questions from you. I am happy to announce that we have achieved highest ever throughput in our history. That is 4.72 million TEUs in FY '24. And we have posted highest ever containerized cargo movement that is 51.67 million tons in the FY, highest ever turnover, that is Rs. 9,010.76 crores. we have crossed Rs. 9,000 crores for the first time, highest ever PAT that is Rs. 1230.79 crores.

Then we have run record number of double-stacked trains in the FY. That is 5,440, which is a growth of 33%. In the FY '23, we could run only 4,097 double-stack trains. As far as the infrastructure additions are concerned, we have added 3 new terminals, MMLPs at Jajpur, Kadakola and Paradip. We have commissioned 14 new high-speed heavy capacity rakes, taking our total fleet size to 377. We have procured 7,653 new containers taking our total count to more than 44,000 containers. Capex in FY '24 was Rs. 745 crores that we have spent. We have procured and deployed 90 LNG trucks.

And I am happy to inform you that yesterday, BoD has authorized for 200 more LNG trucks to be procured in the near future, seeing the robust demand that we are getting. Then we have successfully stabilized the double-stacked trade express trains, which is timetable train in collaboration with Indian Railways from MMLP Dadri to Mundra Port which has helped us to a great extent to divert cargo from road to rail.

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We have signed MOUs with M/s DB Schenker, Central Warehousing Corporation, Singapore Port. for collaborative multi-model logistics solutions, leveraging their infrastructure and core competencies to bring supply chain efficiencies for our customers. The AI-based terminal management system at ICD Tughlakabad has been commissioned. It is functional now.

CONCOR, I am happy to inform has been ranked 248th among top 500 companies in India in the Fortune 500 companies list. It's a matter of pride for all of us. Focus area of company remains, total logistics solution to customers, business solution, including warehousing and FMLM and green and sustainable logistics towards fulfillment of ESG norms.

I would like to give guidance for FY '25 EXIM, we are hoping 15% growth. Domestic, we are hoping 25% growth. That makes overall 18% to 20% growth in FY '25. The company is quite bullish on growth. We have strong commitments and support from our customers. The drivers for growth in this financial year will be bulk cement in tank containers, which is a new product that w

e are going to launch, then we will get -- we will be running double-stack trains to Varnama near Nhava Sheva very soon.

And we are expecting sizable additional business at our new terminals. These will be the 3 main engines of growth in this financial year. As far as Capex budget is concerned, now we have finalized the Capex budget of Rs. 610 crores, primarily centered at wagons, containers and rolling stock, etc., development of terminals, land procurement for terminals and IT.

Of course, we will be conducting a midyear review of the Capex. And if requirement is more, we will be allocating more budget for Capex. So, these are the initial remarks. Now we are open for questions from you.

Moderator : Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. First question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade : Thank you for the opportunity. Can you help us with the -- sorry, I missed the initial part with the originating volume for the fourth quarter and for the full year, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. Originating volume for the fourth quarter was, for EXIM, it was 530,553, for domestic 142,337 and total 672,890. For full financial year, the originating for EXIM was 2,063,651, for

domestic 463,542 and total 2,527,193.

Achal Lohade : Understood. Sir, if you look at 530,000 TEUs, we see the growth is about 9%, but on a low base. So, if you could help us understand in terms of the market share for the fourth quarter and for the full year in the EXIM and the total as well, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : See, I don't have numbers for the quarter, but for full year, I can give you the market share. EXIM, it has been around 55% to 56% and domestic, it has been around 67% to 68% for the full year.

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Achal Lohade : And if you could help us with FY '23 as well? In the same fashion.

Sanjay Swarup : FY '23, market share in EXIM was 58%. Domestic, it was 73%.

Achal Lohade : Understood. And just one more question with respect to EXIM 15% growth, how do we look at this? This is the handling volume you was talking, hence, the originating volume growth will be 89%. Is that a fair assumption? Or do you think originating will also grow in the same fashion?

Sanjay Swarup : Originating will also grow in the same fashion. We are expecting good volumes because the movement is almost stabilized and geopolitical situations. And secondly, as I mentioned, we will be running double-stack train very close to Nhava Sheva because Nhava Sheva is still not connected on double stack. So, we are expecting good volumes in EXIM. And plus the new terminals that we have commissioned are also going to give us business.

Achal Lohade : The new terminals, which you mean the FY '24 commission terminals you're saying?

Sanjay Swarup : See, FY '24 by commission terminals, they may not be ready for custom clearance. So, they will be primarily giving business for domestic. But the new terminals means FY '23 because custom clearance facility, it takes some time to start that facility because custom notification, etc., It's a procedure, which takes some time. So, FY '24 terminals may not be ready for giving for EXIM cargo, plus we will be starting DPD movement, direct port delivery movement in a big way. Already we have started from GTI to Varnama terminal. So, we are hopeful that this DPD movement will also give us good volumes.

Achal Lohade : Understood. And any comment on the margin?

Sanjay Swarup : See, like I have been maintaining every time, we believe, our company believes in giving service to our customers, and our customers are very happy. So, we don't compromise on our margins. And our margins, EBITDA, which is in the range of 25%, we are very confident that we will be able to maintain the 25% EBITDA in this financial year also.

Achal Lohade: And just one clarification, if I may, sir. First mile, last mile, wha

t is the mix for the EXIM for

the quarter and for the full year, sir? How much of our volume you're doing?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. I will tell you. First mile, last mile, 25% of our entire volume, we are now providing first mile, last mile service to our customers. which has been very well appreciated by them. And our target this year is 50%. And by next year, that is FY '26, we are confident of reaching this number to 80% to 85% of our total volume, we will be providing first mile, last mile. That is the road map ahead.

Achal Lohade : And this would come at lower margins relatively, right, sir?

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Sanjay Swarup : I am happy to share with you that this is also giving us handsome margins. Yesterday only we have calculated around 25% margin we are getting on this movement also.

Achal Lohade : This is very helpful. I will fall back in the queue for further questions. Thank you so much.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital. Please proceed.

Bhoomika Nair : Thank you for the opportunity. Just wanted to understand in terms of the guidance that we've given for EXIM at about 15% for FY '25. Is that on the handling volumes or the originating volume, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : It will be more or less same for handling as well as originating.

Bhoomika Nair : Okay. The reason I am asking is if I look at the originating volume trajectory over the last 5, 7 years, you have not seen upwards of a 10%, 12% kind of a growth. So, what is giving us this confidence of this higher growth. Is there some shift of road to rail that you're counting on increased market share because the industry will unlikely grow beyond 7%, 8% from a port volume perspective. So, if you can just give your thought on why we are looking at a better growth.

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. See, if you see the figures of FY '24, in EXIM, we have grown by 7.08%. And in originating, we have grown by 7.59%. So, these numbers are almost same, so very close to each other. So, similar pattern will be followed in this FY also. And the drivers of growth that I initially mentioned will be the double-stack movement from NCR region to Varnama, which is very close, which is actually Baroda, very close to Nhava Sheva.

So, we are expecting sizable shift of traffic from road to rail. Second main driver of movement will be DPD movement. DPD is direct port delivery, which is as present moving by road. So, we are shifting it to rail, and we have been successful in doing it in the initial month of this financial year. So, we are very confident that this trend will continue and multiply.

Bhoomika Nair : As an industry, I mean, what kind of volume share or volume shift are you looking at from road to rail during the year or from a 2, 3-year perspective, how should one think about it?

Sanjay Swarup : As per national rail plan, when DFC is fully commissioned to Nhava Sheva, then national rail plan is projected that the rail commission, which is at the present 18% to 20% will grow between 40% to 45%. So, that has been slightly delayed, DFC commissioning. So, we are very confident that maybe if you see a perspective of some 4 to 5 years, we should have a very good rail coefficient at ports, which may hover around 35% to 40%.

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Bhoomika Nair : Sir, my second question was on the last mile connectivity that you talked about that we're increasing the target to 15%, 18%, would that be for both domestic and EXIM or largely domestic volumes?

Sanjay Swarup : First mile, last mile is both for EXIM as well as domestic.

Bhoomika Nair : And just lastly, if I can get the empty running charges for the quarter and for the full year, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : I can give you for the full year right now. For EXIM, it was Rs. 129.6 crores. For domestic, it has been Rs. 378 crores, total is Rs. 508 crores. For Q4 also, you

can note down. It is EXIM Rs.

34.28 crores, domestic Rs. 107 crores, total Rs. 141.3 crores.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Priyank from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Priyankar Biswas : Thank you, sir, for the opportunity. So, my first question is regarding the land license fee. So, in your press release, it is written that the Tughlakabad demand by Indian Railways at around Rs.

Rs. 680-odd crores. So, I am trying to understand what is the difference like between the viewpoints of Indian Railway and the management as far as LLF is concerned?

Sanjay Swarup : I will request my Director Finance, to take this question.

Manoj Kumar Dubey : So, actually, this is nothing new. This is the demand which we received in the first FY when this LLF started on land license fee basis, that was 2021. So, the new auditor that we have got nominated from CAG side this year after a 3 years gap, so he wanted to reemphasize again that this issue is still lingering, pending. This is one.

Meanwhile, what has happened, railways for TKD has calculated taking the base year of 2014, while the circular was issued in 2020, so we have a very clear view that the base year would be 2020 for the valuation of the industry rate of the land. So, precisely the difference is creating the huge gap between what we are paying at Rs. 230 crore every year, and they are looking around somewhere about Rs. 540 crores, it is that only.

Meanwhile, there is one more new development. You know that Gati Shakti scheme was launched by Indian Railways and Government of India last year. And we are also eligible to participate in that. We have already applied for Tughlakabad. If it is materializing in this financial year, as you know, the rate in Gati Shakti scheme is only 1.5% of the industrial land value at the base prices. And the other part is a variable price, which is linked with the number of trains that we are running. If we get into Gati Shakti this financial year, the LLF for TKD will come down drastically maybe around 60% to 65% to what we are paying right now.

Additionally, this financial year, we have also surrendered 60,000 square meters of the land at TKD, which will bring down the cost as per the old regime also by Rs. 30 crores odd for 1 year.

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So, this is the status about TKD and what keynote that auditor has given is only a repetition of what we have got in the financial year 2021. I hope that clarifies.

Priyankar Biswas : Very clear. So, just adding on to that. So, I assume that you get eligibility in Gati Shakti for TKD. So, under such circumstances, what will be, let's say, your LLF overall for, let's say, FY '25?

Manoj Kumar Dubey : So, giving the figures, if you look at my booking figures, you will see it is Rs. 370 crores for this year.

Priyankar Biswas : Exactly.

Manoj Kumar Dubey : This is adjusted figures. If you recall, our Q3 comments, since we have already reconciled the figures for many reports. So, the provision that we have made earlier, we had written back also.

So, actually, my payout for FY 2023, '24 has been Rs. 424 crores, right?

Priyankar Biswas : Yes, sir.

Manoj Kumar Dubey : If you assume Rs. 424 crores and the Rs. 30 crore odd that we think that we have already surrendered, on the current system that we're paying, my payout will not be more than Rs. 420



crores for the current FY. This is number one. Now coming to your question that if I enter into Gati Shakti for TKD, which is, consuming 60% of my total payout. Out of Rs. 420 crores, I paid Rs. 260 crores alone for TKD. This Rs. 260 crores will come down by 40%, which is nearly around Rs. 150-160 crores. So, additional Rs. 100 crores saving will be there, only by TKD. And once we are able to do the TKD, the whole plan is to proliferate the same method for the remaining 25 depot also.

Priyankar Biswas : So, essentially, what you're saying is that this number, i

f things pan out as you are thinking can

even fall to like a Rs. 300 crore odd level for the overall company?

Manoj Kumar Dubey : More than that. The Board has told us to give the biggest case that is TKD for which my CMD has already written a few months back. That is under consideration. Once it is through, every depot is under the purview because we have got the first right of refusal provision in the Gati Shakti scheme for brownfield depots also, right? So, our assessment is that if everything materializes, then my payout will come down by minimum Rs. 100 crores to Rs. 120 crores.

Priyankar Biswas : That's quite a big number.

Manoj Kumar Dubey : Because you see the 6% will come down to 1.5%.

Priyankar Biswas : Yes, yes.

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Manoj Kumar Dubey : And the other portion is directly linked with my number of trains that we are running. So, if I run more trains, I pay. If I don't run many number of trains, there is no fixed payout for me. So, that is a good scheme that government has launched, and we are very hopeful and willing to participate to that for the long term.

Priyankar Biswas : Yes. Sir, if I can just squeeze one more question in. So, this is regarding pricing. So, of course, you told that service levels matter, more than what the competitors are pricing. So, how difficult, let's say, if I ask you for competition to match up to your service levels? Can you give some examples of the gap between you and competition? Like what you are doing versus what they can't technically do?

Sanjay Swarup : See, actually, we are running timetable trains in collaboration with Indian Railways from our MMLP Dadri to Mundra Port, which is taking the train to Mundra port in 38 hours. So, it's a predictability in service when the shippers know that their containers will be able to catch the vessels. That is a very, very crucial product that I am offering, which is very well received by freight.

Secondly, the MMLPs that I have established, I have set up 16 MMLPs in the country, which are a big cargo aggregation center. And all value-added services, warehousing, containers tracking, everything is under one roof. So, customer doesn't have to go from here to there. And this has been very well received by the customers.

Third and very crucial fact is the IT-based solutions, IT-based services that I provide to my customers, which is very well patronized by them. And I have started a logistics app through which customers can book their cargo for first mile, last mile, through reverse option, very, very competitive rate and efficiently. And I have also started AI-based system at Tughlakabad for terminal management which is a pilot project. It is working very well. I plan to slowly replicate it to other terminals also.

So, all these things and the customer connect that my people have, that also plays a very, very important role. We have been a trusted logistics partner for our customers for the last more than 30 years, and customers are very happy with our services. In fact, wherever I myself and my directors, whenever we go on a field visit, we always make it an important point that we meet our customers. So, all these things over the years, they have developed a feeling of trust and faith which keeps them from not moving anywhere else.

Priyankar Biswas : Sir, that's great to hear. That's all from my side. I will get back in the queue for further questions.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Rohit Maheshwari from Tata AIG. Please go ahead. Mr.

Maheshwari, your line is unmuted, please proceed.

Rohit Maheshwari : Thank you. My question has been answered.

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Moderator : Next question is from the line of Atul Tiwari from Citigroup. Please go ahead.

Atul Tiwari : Thanks a lot, sir. Sir, just again, one question on the very strong guidance that you have given for th

e EXIM growth next year. So, could you give some more color that how the lead distances will change? I mean, is it mostly the short distance cargo that you are planning to bring from roads to rails, which will drive the growth? And will the revenue also grow in the same ratio,

15% year-on-year or the revenue growth will be lower than 15%?

Sanjay Swarup : See, the lead will be more or less the same. Like if you see last year, our lead in EXIM, it has grown from 670 kilometers to 712 kilometers, which is 42 kilometers growth, which is a quite good number. So, lead will continue to be around 712 or 720, 725. So, that will be maintained in this financial year also. And as far as the revenue growth is concerned, we hope to have a good revenue growth also. At the moment, we can say that it will be almost same. Because if you see revenue growth, revenue growth this year in physical as well as revenue, they are almost matching.

Atul Tiwari : And sir, my final question is on the pass-through of haulage charges. So, how is the pricing environment? And if there is any hike, etc., do you expect to like completely pass it through? Or you're still kind of absorbing some of the impact?

Sanjay Swarup : See, Railway has actually that busy season surcharge that they introduced from October. In the EXIM segment, we have passed through the entire amount. In domestic segment, we have passed strategically. We have not passed everywhere, depending on the stream, depending on the capability of the customers to absorb that part, that hike. We have strategically passed. So, it is not that everywhere we have passed just like that.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Pulkit Patni from Goldman Sachs. Please go ahead.

Pulkit Patni : Sir, thank you for taking my questions. Sir, I am unable to understand that if originating and handling volume growth is going to be same, are we saying we are not going to be increasing double stacking because our understanding was, and correct me if it was wrong, is that as the impact of DFC becomes more prominent, double stacking will be a larger part, volumes would be broken at multiple areas, in which case, the growth in handling should ideally be higher than growth in originating. So, how come your guidance is actually talking about similar growth in both of the segments? That's question number one.

Sanjay Swarup : So, Pulkit, if you see the growth in this FY in ISO, handling has grown by 7.08%, whereas originating has grown by 7.59%. So, they are not exactly the same number, but more than 7%, they are very, very close. So, I told that percentage-wise because handling has got a bigger base, originating is almost 70% to 75% of handling.

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So, numbers will be more or less hovering around the same quantity. So, it may not be exactly same, but as you see in this financial year also, we have done record double stacking, still originating and handling are almost very close to each other. So, these things will be almost around the very close numbers, both of them.

Pulkit Patni : Sir, my second question is on the overall guidance. I mean, I think a few of my other participants also asked this. But when we look at the last 4, 5 years, our growth has not really been as strong. Now obviously, the guidance you have given is super strong. Just a sense of whether global trade is looking so good, there's no impact of Red Sea whatsoever. I mean, just like the underlying what you see in terms of what drives such strong demand in terms of the guidance that you have given?

Sanjay Swarup : See, Pulkit, actually, as I explained earlier, we are very, very confident of diversion of a lot of traffic from road to rail due to our sustained efforts in doing so. We are in touch with our customers and they have assured us that they will be giving more and more volume on rail. As I told you a couple of steps that we are taking,

like double stacking of Nhava Sheva cargo also,

secondly, DPD movement in a big way, and the traffic and new terminals, all these things will be the engines of growth in this financial year. So, you will see the results very soon.

Pulkit Patni : Very good to hear that. Thank you.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Abhishek from DSP. Please proceed.

Abhishek Ghosh : Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, if you can help us understand as far as the EXIM segment is concerned, how is the pricing scenario? Because at some point in time, we had seen peers kind of resorting to aggressive pricing. Does that still continue? Or has that normalized? Any thoughts on that, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : See, normally, in these conference calls, I don't talk about what the CTOs are charging in pricing. So, we are actually watching our strategy that is giving excellent service to customers while maintaining the reasonable amount of margins. What others are doing, normally, we keep a watch, but I don't talk on these forums.

Abhishek Ghosh : Sir, but just if you look at it for the last 4, 5 years, this kind of a volume growth you have not seen. If suppose that 15% kind of volume growth comes in because there's an element of operating leverage, there is an element of better or reduced empty running. So, can that help you in margin? And will you use that lever to lower down the pricing? Any thoughts, sir? Because we haven't seen this kind of growth for a long time. So, any thoughts on that, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : See, we are very confident of getting this growth. But as far as margins are concerned, I will still maintain that we will be around EBITDA of 25%, we will maintain. We will not reduce our

margins.  
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Abhishek Ghosh : And sir, just on the Dadri front, now that has got connected to the DFC. So, how are you seeing traction around that? Are channel check suggests that you are gaining traction. Any thoughts on if you can help us understand with that.

Sanjay Swarup : See, the connection of Dadri to DFC has been a game changer as far as the logistics scenario of our country is concerned. We are able to run timetable freight express rail from Dadri to Mundra, which is taking containers in 38 hours. Now very soon, we'll be launching a product of double stack, this is from Dadri to Baroda because the JNPT, it will take some time to be commissioned on DFC. So, we will bring double-stack train from Dadri to Baroda, that is Varnama terminal. And that we'll try to have timetable service. And all these things will be definitely very, very main drivers for bringing more logistics efficiency and supply chain cost will come down in our country.

Abhishek Ghosh : Thank you so much and wish you all the best.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from SUD Life Insurance. Please go ahead.

Anupam Goswami : Sir, I joined the call little late. Can you just briefly explain what led to a realization decline in this? And going forward, what's your LLF expectation on that provisioning?

Sanjay Swarup : What do you mean by realization decline?

Anupam Goswami : Sir, I see a little EXIM realization decline. So, do we take it as a one-off sort of, where do we see that?

Sanjay Swarup : There was slightly decline in realization because we absorbed the rail haulage increase for 40 days. So, briefly, that was a temporary decline. That will not be there in this financial year.

Anupam Goswami : And going forward, do you see our EXIM volume outpacing domestic growth?

Sanjay Swarup : See, they are two different segments. So, EXIM will see growth of 15%. Domestic will see growth of 25% in this financial year. Combined, it will be a growth of 18% to 20%.

Anupam Goswami : And sir, last, on the LLF provisioning. What's your guidance on that? Like, how do we see that in the FY '25?

Sanjay Swarup : I will request my Director Finance to give you this guid

ance.

Manoj Kumar Dubey : So, for the current FY, if you missed the discussion, we had a long discussion on LLF going forward. So, the one answer to your question is this year, our provisions will be hovering around Rs. 400 crores to Rs. 420 crores. We have already surrendered 60,000 square meters of land in TKD, which is the costliest part of our railway parcels.

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Apart from that, we have also mentioned in this con call in the earlier Q&A, that we have applied for inclusion in Gati Shakti scheme, if we get that inclusion, which we are entitled for, then the payment will further come down for TKD, which is nearly 60% of my total payout by nearly Rs. 80 crores to Rs. 100 crores.

Anupam Goswami : And even that you are sensing a margin expansion if that comes?

Sanjay Swarup : Margin?

Anupam Goswami : Would it increase the margin? I mean how much would it improve the margins if that comes?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. You will come to know all these things in the coming days.

Manoj Kumar Dubey : As CMD have clearly mentioned that the 25% is a very healthy margin that we're maintaining in our logistics business. So, that is not compromised. But detailed result strategies that cannot be discussed here right now.

Anupam Goswami : Understood, sir. Got that. I'll get back in the queue.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Krupashankar from Avendus park. Please go ahead.

Krupashankar NJ : Good afternoon, and thank you for the opportunity. My first question is on the domestic piece of it. So, you have given a strong guidance of almost 25%. Can you highlight specifically, while I do understand the bulk cement was one of the key drivers for domestic, what are the other triggers that you're seeing for the sector, domestic?

Sanjay Swarup : I will request my Director Domestic to take this question.

Mohd. Azhar Shams : Actually, you see that with respect to bulk cement, earlier we planned that we shall be moving the bulk cement in general purpose containers. We started also and then subsequently after a year or so, on 21st of May 2023, that circular was withdrawn by the railways that the charging in general purpose container was at FAK.

And we continued the chasing with railways but that circular was not revised. So, now actually, that initiative by Container Corporation that was stopped. But since bulk cement has a very huge market, a lot of bulk cement is moving, you see there's roughly, if we take around 300 million tons of production of the bulk cement in the country. So, 25% is moving by road mainly in

bulk, so 25% means 75 million tons.

So, what we have now decided is that we shall be introducing tank containers, cement tanks containers for tapping this market. So, we have done groundwork, we floated an EOI also in which who's who of the cement industry they participated and everybody has shown quite great interest to collaborate with Container Corporation of India Limited  
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the process of procurement of cement tank containers. My estimate is that within 2 to 3 months we will start getting these tank containers, not in the initial first 2 quarters, but subsequently third and fourth quarter, we are expecting that we shall start getting the benefit of this cement movement in the tank container. And that is going to add quite substantial amount to our growth. In addition, last year there has been lot of restriction by government. Rice was basically stopped movement in for export and bulk cement container availability of DCL wagon in railways became quite high. And we lost quite substantially on these 2 commodities. But now we are expecting that those things are going to be removed and whatever 30,000 to 40,000 containers we lost on these 2, 3 commodities that is again going to come to us. So, in addition to bulk cement in

tank container and the commodities which we lost last year, that was going to be added to the growth of the country in the domestic segment basically. So, combined 2, 3 things, we are quite hopeful that the guidance given by our CMD with regard to 25% domestic growth is going to be realized basically.

Krupashankar NJ : And a couple of bookkeeping questions, sir. On port-wise market share, what would be your share or volumes originating from JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav? If you can share that. Sorry. My second question was more on port-wise volume contribution to our overall pie as well as our market share in respective ports, if you can share that, please.

Sanjay Swarup : Yes, contribution of port is like this, JNPT 32.5%. Mundra Port 35.3%, Pipavav 11.3%, Vizag 7.3%, Chennai 4.3%, Vallarpadam 3.3%, Tuticorin 2%. So, that takes care of around 97% of volumes. And market share at JNPT 60%, Mundra Port 37%, Pipavav Port 47%.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Amit Dighe from Morgan Stanley. Please go ahead.

Girish Achhipalia : Girish from Morgan Stanley. I just had a couple of questions on rail coefficients, if you can help for the full year ending at different ports?

Sanjay Swarup : Just now I told the rail coefficient that JNPT is 17%, Mundra Port 26%, Pipavav Port 63%.

Girish Achhipalia : So, whenever you're giving this data around volume at different ports or coefficient, you are talking about the YTD number, right, and not for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. That's right.

Girish Achhipalia : Just a second question. I know this question has been asked in different forms. But you obviously could have some benefit basis how the policy on LLF plays out. You could also have DFC, which will become bigger as Western DFC gets commissioned. My question was a simple one that if you had to choose between volume and margins, is it fair to say that you would be focused more on volumes and maintain margins? Or am I getting it wrong?

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Sanjay Swarup : I like to keep a balance between the 2. And we want to maintain our margins, EBITDA at 25% that we are very, very committed to do that. And while maintaining the margins, if we are getting more volumes than they are welcome.

Girish Achhipalia : And this step-up in domestic, sir, explain what's happening because of partly cement, but is there any other commodity, which is changing our outlook on growth?

Sanjay Swarup : Director Domestic was explaining it, but call got disconnected. I will request him to again briefly tell.

Mohd. Azhar Shams : Actually, you see in the domestic segment, whatever bulk cement movement in tank containers, a new initiative, what we have taken, and that is going to materialize, I think, within 2 to 3 months, so not in the first 2 quarters, but we are confident in the last 2 quarters, we will get the full benefit of our this new initiative. So, that is number one.

Number two, you know that from October 1, the railway increased that busy seasons surcharge. So, there were panic in the market. But now the things have been streamlined, and we have started again getting benefit after passing some portion of our busy season surcharge to customer and absorbing some. So, I think that thing is again settled.

Number 3 point, what I wanted to mention is that last year, the 3 to 4 commodities combined together around 40,000 to 50,000 TEUs we lost because of one policy or other, like rice was stopped by the government for export. Now that is going to be revised, whatever we have heard.

Number two, the cement in bulk conditions. The bulk cement, we were doing quite good numbers, but that was again stopped because of the good availability of the railway wagon. So,

now that demand is again with us, and we are going to get good numbers whatever we used to get the bulk cement in general.

Number 3, you know that because the busy seasons surcharge, we lost lot of star

ch business,

whatever we were having from Ahmedabad around 10,000 TEU, we lost and the parties started moving by road.

So, these things actually because of busy season surcharge, because of government policies here and there, I think those volume around 40,000 to 50,000, we are quite hopeful that we are going to get. In addition, as I told you that bulk cement movement in tank container that is going to give us good volume. So, combined together, whatever our CMD has given a guidance of 25% growth in domestic that we are quite hopeful that we shall be getting those.

Moderator : Mr. Amit, does this answer your question?

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Girish Achhipalia : Sorry, last question on Capex. The number was, I think, running at Rs. 700 crores to Rs. 800 crores per year, and we've put the number at Rs. 600 crores. Just wanted to understand, will this number probably be sustaining at these levels going forward? And is there a way to understand the capacity utilization or efficiency in the way the wagons are being utilized currently? If you can qualitatively comment on that as well.

Sanjay Swarup : See, actually, last year also, in FY '24, we have achieved Rs. 745 crores Capex. This year, at the start of the year, we have kept at Rs. 610 crores, and this will be subject to midyear review, which we'll be conducting after Q2. So, based on our demand, we can increase the Capex also. There's no issue on that. As far as utilization of the capital that we are using for purchasing new wagons, new containers, I want to assure all our investors that we are making a good utilization of all the instruments that we have. And nothing is idling at the moment.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Lavina Q from Jefferies. Please go ahead.

Lavina Quadros : I just wanted to check that rail haulage hike which Indian Railway has done in 3Q, sorry, if I missed it, if you have commented on this earlier. So, I remember you had mentioned most of the pass-through had been done in the December quarter itself. Just wanted to double check that, I mean, has it been completely done? Is the margin impact completely in place, so that going forward with volume growth, you'll see better operating leverage?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes, absolutely, you are absolutely right. Whatever pass-through strategically in domestic and 100% in EXIM has already been done. It is all stabilized. So, hence forth, there will not be any plus minus. You are absolutely right.

Lavina Quadros : And sir, just lastly on this. I mean this road to rail shift on this call, you're sounding extremely confident. Do you think that maybe because of the rail haulage hike, something that could have happened last quarter has just been delayed by 3 to 6 months? So, essentially, that is driving your confidence that now customers are saying we're definitely going to move given that haulage has stabilized. Is that fair to say?

Sanjay Swarup : That may be one of the reasons. And secondly is the service level that assurance that they have that we will be able to transport their containers in a very, very efficient manner. So, they are very confident. Plus, after the elections are over, there may be some revision in diesel prices also that may impact the road rates. That is also one of the possibilities.

Lavina Quadros : And lastly, again, sorry, in case you addressed this earlier, we'll check with the Dedicated Freight Corridor as well. But on the ground, JNPT led by 26%, is that the broad feedback just to understand?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes, as per the Dedicated Freight Corridor officers, JNPT will be commissioned on DFC by March 2025. That is a projection they have given.

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Moderator : Next question is from the line of Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital. Please go ahead.

Bhoomika Nair : Yes, sir, just one follow-up question that I have was on t

his conversion of the TKD facility into

a Gati Shakti terminal. You sir, as per the Gati Shakti, will there be a requirement to share any percentage of revenues per se with the government as it typically is the norm? Or we will not have to share any revenue share or anything of that sort?

Manoj Kumar Dubey: No. So, you understand this in a very clear manner. The old method is flat 6% of the industrial value of the land. This is what we are doing right now as a brownfield depot is old system. Now the new system that has been offered, it has got 2 components, a fixed component and a variable component. Now fixed component is 1.5%. The 6% has 1.5%, this is fixed. Whether you run a single train, you don't run any train or you run any number of trains, this is a fixed component.

Now coming to this variable thing that you are mentioning, that is revenue share. They're not revenue sharing. It is traffic access charges. The railway charges an amount on every rake that is handled in their land. This is right now also in their good sheds the same thing is being followed.

So, that also right now is Rs. 1.6 lakhs per rake. So, for me, for any 90 containers that I am handling in the rake, I'll have to pay that Rs. 1.6 lakhs, which is nearly Rs. 1,500 to Rs. 1,600 per container. Now taking this together, these 2 things together and what I am paying is 6% is nearly 60% of what I am being paying to them. That is what I tried to reason out. I hope I have clarified.

Bhoomika Nair : Yes, sir. That is quite clear. Now it's understood. Fair point. Sir, just last thing, if I can get the lead distances for the quarter and for the year, sir?

Sanjay Swarup : So, we have it for the year. It is for EXIM it is 712 kilometers; domestic 1,406 kilometers, total 823 kilometers.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Aryn Pirani from JPMorgan. Please go ahead.

Aryn Pirani : Thanks for the opportunity. Most of my questions have been answered. I just want to raise 2 things. A, your guidance for growth in FY '25, does it capture some kind of market share increase because in the last 2, 3 years, I think there has been some small market share losses. So, are you expecting to regain some market share? Or do you think that the market itself is going to be more strong in domestic and EXIM?

Sanjay Swarup : I think we will be able to gain some market share.

Aryn Pirani : And sir, lastly, I don't know if you have already shared this, the rail freight margin for the quarter?

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Sanjay Swarup : Rail freight margin?

Aryn Pirani : Yes.

Sanjay Swarup : One minute, rail freight margin is 25.1% for the year.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Atul Tiwari from Citigroup. Please go ahead.

Atul Tiwari : Sir, again, the question was on the DFC. So, you said that it will be connected to JNPT by March 25 as per the current estimates, right?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes. As per information given by DFC Officer.

Atul Tiwari : Okay. But sir, then how is it supposed to benefit us in FY '25 in running the double stack train to Nhava Sheva?

Sanjay Swarup : Now the thing is that the DFC will not be commissioned upto Nhava Sheva. But I have a terminal at Baroda, which is approximately 400 kilometers from Nhava Sheva. So, that terminal is unique.

It is connected to DFC as well as to Indian Railways. So, what I will do is from NCR region, I will run double stack up to that Baroda terminal.

There, I will break it up into 2 single stacks and take it to Nhava Sheva. So, major distance, like almost 3/4 of the distance from NCR to Nhava Sheva, I will be running on double stack, I am sorry. And for the 1/4 portion, I will be running on single stack. So, that will drive maximum cost benefit to our customers and efficiency will also go up.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Kushal Chopra from RV Invest. Please go ahead.

Participant : My effort is to gauge the over-

all economic outlook of the country as we are seeing that the various PLI schemes of the government is motivating the corporates to get into the manufacturing side of the economy and boost it. So, from which areas of the countries or which states or which regions, are we seeing a good amount of growth in container handling. So, if you can just give an insight in this economic indicator?

Sanjay Swarup : See, as far as, about the overall economic scenario in the country, I am not the best person to answer the question. But as far as container business is concerned, I can probably give you some insights. As far as EXIM business is concerned, almost 65% to 70% of the business is concentrated in Western part of our country and North.

And other than that, domestic, we have a lot of business throughout the country. There's a lot of potential. Cement business, as we are talking, which will be the main engine of growth in this financial year, that is around cement clusters mostly in South India or some in Western side also.

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And plus tiles businesses there in Gujarat, plus we have a lot of business in Gujarat area, where other commodities like cement, white cement, they are also there.

Participant : Sir, the second question is in the line of market share. We have been losing the market share since the last data has come down to 57% from 63%. So, the other private competitors, are they aggressively ramping up their capacities? So, due to that reason, are we seeing a market share

loss?

Sanjay Swarup : See, it has been a conscious decision of the company not to sacrifice our margins for gaining market share. We are retaining our customers, getting new customers while maintaining our margins. So, that is the primary reason. If I want to gain market share, it's very easy for me, sacrifice margin and take market share of 80%, but that is not my objective. I maintain my margin, maintain my service level. At the same time, I have a reasonable market share also.

Participant : Sir, we have been getting 30,000 to 40,000 containers in the commodities and rails and rice sector. So, post elections, are we indicating towards the exports of rice that will be getting resumed?

Sanjay Swarup : See, I am not in a position to answer this question because this is related to the policy of the Government of India, which I am not competent to comment in this conference call.

Moderator : Next question is from the line of Shrinidhi Karlekar from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Shrinidhi Karlekar : Thank you for the opportunity. Sir, I wanted to know how much of our originating volume on a full year basis originate from the Northwest corridor, which is likely to benefit from full commissioning of DSP. And second related question is, sir, out of that volume, which is originating from Northwest, what percentage of 40-foot container are already getting double stacked?

Sanjay Swarup : See, that data we don't have at the moment, that how much volume is originating from which region. We have the pan-India numbers, which already I have given to you. And as far as double stacking is concerned, I can tell you that if you see our overall volume, almost 15% to 20% is being double stacked right now.

Shrinidhi Karlekar : Of overall volume, yes?

Sanjay Swarup : Yes, that's right.

Shrinidhi Karlekar : And sir, in the denominator, we are talking only about the 40-foot container here? Or we are talking about denominator being 20-foot plus 40-foot?

Sanjay Swarup : We are talking 20 plus 40, both.

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Shrinidhi Karlekar : Okay. And typically, would you say, sir, how much is 40-foot container in overall mix?

Sanjay Swarup : See, in our company, I am not in a position to reply it to you. But as per the broad industry estimates, 40-foot container will be around 55% to 60%.

Shrinidhi Karlekar : Fair enough. An

d sir, if I may ask, how has this financial year started? Are you seeing a sharp uptick in volume growth from the run rate we saw in the last quarter?

Sanjay Swarup : We are very optimistic. Other than that, I think in next conference call only we can reply to this question. We are talking about only up to 31st March.

Shrinidhi Karlekar : Fair enough, sir. Thank you for answering my questions and all the very best.

Moderator : The next question is from the line of Vikram Suryavanshi from PhillipCapital. Please go ahead.

Vikram Suryavanshi : I have two questions. One, when you talk about terminals and Gati Shakti, can they be used as an exclusive terminal for us or it have to be common user facility?

Sanjay Swarup : So, they are the terminals on our land. So, they are exclusive for us.

Vikram Suryavanshi : And just domestic cargo side, obviously, there were restrictions coming and going for certain type of cargo. But bulk cement also, I think we were looking for opportunity of flexi bags for bulk cement movement. And now what I am hearing is about, I think, a tanker. So, is there any change in the policy or is that a different opportunity?

Sanjay Swarup : See, bulk cement in normal containers was not a very sustainable business, like my Director Domestic has replied earlier. The railway also did not give extension for the FAK rates. So, now we are launching a new product in the market that is transportation of bulk cement in tank containers, which is a sustainable business for us. And we are very hopeful of getting a lot of volumes by introduction of this new product.

Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, we will take this as the last question for the day. I would now like to hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair for the closing comments.

Bhoomika Nair : Yes, I would like to thank everybody and for being on the call and participating and also the management for patiently answering all the queries. Thank you very much, sir, and wish you all the very best.

Sanjay Swarup : Thank you, Bhoomika.

Moderator : Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you all for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No.Name Phone Company

1 HOST: Bhoomika Nair 42022561 DAM Capital

2 HOST: Management 1206743444 Container Corp

3 Abhay Modi 67319602 Heliou Cap

4 Abhinav Attal 8779258257 Investor  
5 Abhino Bhandari 9699358293 Sohum Assest Managers  
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46 Deepak 9867588935 Individual Investor  
47 Deepak Neralla 9398457942 9 Rays Equity  
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A Multi-modal logistics Company  
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Pursuant to applicable provisions of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find  
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For your information and record please.

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Regd. Office: CO\COR Bha~an, C-3, Mathura Road. ',e~ Delhi-110076  
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CAPITAL  
MANAGEMENT: MR. SANJAY SW ARUP -CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING  
DIRECTOR, CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED  
MR. MANOJ KUMAR DUBEY -DIRECTOR (FINANCE),  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED  
MR. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS -DIRECTOR,  
(DOMESTIC), CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED  
MR. AJIT KUMAR PANDA- DIRECTOR, (PROJECTS &  
SERVICES), CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED  
MR. BARISH CHANDRA- EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR  
(FINANCE) AND COMP ANY SECRETARY, CONTAINER  
CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED  
MODERATOR: MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR-DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

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CONCOR  
A Navratna Company  
Moderator:  
Bhoomika Nair:  
Sanjay Swarup: Container Corporation of India Limited

August 09, 2024

Ladies and gentlemen , good day and welcome to QI FY '25 Earnings Conference Call of Container Corporation of India Limited Hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors . Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Yes. Good afternoon , everyone and a warm welcome to the QI FY '25 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management today being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, CMD, and his entire team. I'll now hand over the floor to Mr. Swarup for his opening remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Thank you and over to you, sir. Good afternoon , everybody . I am being joined by my Director (Finance) , Mr. Manoj Dubey; Director (Domestic) , Mr. Azhar Shams; Director (Projects) , Mr. Ajit Panda; and Mr. Harish Chandra, ED (Finance) and Company Secretary. I will just give you a brief about the quarter and then we will be taking your questions.

I am happy to post 6% growth in our throughput in this quarter, which is in line with the growth of India's international trade. In this quarter, India's international trade has grown by 5.8% - sorry, India's exports have grown by 5.8%, and we have achieved almost \$110 US billion exports. And in this quarter, we have achieved an import of \$172 billion, which is a growth of 7.6% year-on-year.

And increase in EXIM market share for CONCOR has been 50 basis points in this quarter.

Besides that, domestic stream has posted a healthy 15% growth year-on-year in this quarter. Our operating income growth has been 9.3%. PAT growth has been 4.6%. And another significant thing is the growth in double-stack rakes, which is 14% this year in this quarter year-on-year basis.

We have added significant infrastructure to our network. We have commissioned 1 new high speed rake, taking a total to 378 rakes. Besides that, we have procured 2,500 new containers and our container fleet today stands at around 47,000 container s, which I should say it's a very healthy fleet.

We have a capex budget of this financial year at INR610 crores. In the first quarter, we have already achieved around INR157 crores of capex. We will be conducting a midyear review. If required, we will revise our capex budget. We have procured and deployed 100 LNG trucks for our first-mile , last-mile stream, and we are going for 200 more LNG trucks, which has been proved to be a big hit with our customers.

And one more initiative, which has been welcomed by trade, is the online booking of containers that we have started at all CONCOR terminals. So it's a very big facilitation measure for the trade. We are not charging anything extra. So it's proving to be a big marketing tool for the company. The focus area for the company remain total logistics solution to customers. Business

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solutions, including warehousing and first-mile , last-mile and giving green and sustainable logistics to our customers.

Guidance of the company , I would like to keep it unchanged. We are very optimistic that we will be able to achieve the guidance that I gave at the start of the financial year. New initiatives and growth levers for the company in this financial year will be as under:

First will be the bulk cement and tank containers .

Second is we are having a tie-up, long-term tie-up with shipping lines, which we'll be signing in the month of September. Then we are bringing Nhava Sheva also on double-stack through Vamama , our terminal near Baroda. We are quite strongly looking at DPD movements from ports to hinterland . Then we are going for additional business and new terminals , which is another growth driver for us.

And lastly, we are tying up with big business houses, giving them total logistics solutions . Like just to name a few, like Vedanta, Jindal, Tata, we are in talks with them at advanced stages so that we give them total logistic package for their pan-India movement utilizing our Pan-India services.

So this is all for my opening remarks. Now you can ask questions , please.

Thank you very much. The first question is from the line of Amit from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

I have a couple of questions . The first one is on the volume guidance, sir. While you have kept it unchanged , but the EXIM growth rate that we saw on Y-o-Y basis in this quarter was only 3.3%. So just wanted to understand, I mean, what do you see going ahead, so as you have kept the volume guidance unchanged? That is the first question I have.

Yes. See, actually, now the --there was this China to America circuit, which was --in which containerized cargo was moving to a great extent. It was overloaded till 31st of July because due to some duty issue, Chinese goods were being pushed to American markets. So now after 1st August that overloading has eased.

So there's a lot of movement of containers and vessels in India, Western countries stream. This has resulted in the softening of ocean freight and more availability of containers and vessels for India. So this will be a major reason for growth in export-imports from India. And softening of ocean freight means the low-value imports like wastepaper , scrap, this will be coming in a big way for India.

And exports also, we will --we are going to get very good exports

. In fact, for the last 1 month

already, there is a growth in --healthy growth in exports. So --and 1 more thing is that due to our services --service levels, we have increased our market share in EXIM at Mundra port and Pipavav port, both the ports, we have increased significantly. And on a pan-India basis, we have increased the EXIM market share by 50 basis points. And in the coming months, due to all these

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factors, I am very sure that the import export will increase and we will increase our market share also.

So combination of these things, plus one more thing that I mentioned in my opening remarks that we will be giving double-stack benefits for our Nhava Sheva customers from NCR area. So this way, we will be able to give them the benefit of transit time as well as benefit of rates. So we are hoping for a lot of transfer of cargo from road to rail and into our fold. So these 3, 4 factors will result in a healthy growth in EXIM. And I am quite positive that I will be able to achieve the guidance that we have given at the start of the financial year.

Yes. The second question is essentially on domestic business. So if I see the domestic realization and profitability, both are a tad lower when I compare it with the past 3, 4 quarters. I'm not talking about Q1 FY '23, but Q2, Q3, Q4. If I compare it to the domestic realization and profitability , both have gone down. So what could be the reason behind that? Is it that we are giving discounts or is it the empty running cost? Just wanted to get your thoughts on that.

See, domestic, actually, despite posting a 15% growth, we could maintain good margins. And now we have identified the circuits where we are getting the return cargo also. Like a lot of containers are moving from north to south and even from Western India to South India. Return direction now, we are getting good business of cement and we are tapping other commodities also. So we are very hopeful that we will bring down the empty running. Already, you will see in the running quarter that we are having now Q2, so we are expecting good profit margins in domestic as well as top line and bottom line improvement you will see in the coming months. But sir, what --since we are talking about this quarter, we saw that there was a drop in realization and profitability. So I just wanted to get your thoughts around that. So what you have mentioned is fine, we will maybe get back to our level of profits that we have shown in Q2, Q3, Q4. But in this particular quarter, what was the reason for the decline?

See, Q1, actually, normally, Q1 is --because after Q4 of the financial year, if we see Q1, Q1 is normally like that. Trend is similar in every year, if you see. It is --there's not much difference in Q1. And busy season surcharge that was imposed from 1st of October 2023 by Indian Railways , that also has some role to play in the profit margins. But now the trade has very well accepted that surcharge . And we have also taken corrective steps. So definitely , there will be a good improvement in both EXIM well as domestic as far as top line and bottom line is concerned.

The next question is from the line of Disha from Ashika Institutional Desk.

While you have already given the clarification as to why you expect a good growth in volumes for FY '25 and are keeping the margin unchanged , it is quite difficult to understand. I mean the EXIM volumes will have to grow at an average of 20% year-on-year if you plan to keep the

volume growth unchanged at 15% for FY '25. So will this be achievable ?

See, Disha, I'm very optimistic person. So definitely , I'm very optimistic about it, we will be able to achieve it. Why we should not achieve?

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So do you think the initiative that you mentioned that is the DPD movement , bulk cement and the new initiative that is with large corporates will help you in achieving that within FY '25 or will it get pushed to the next year as well?

See, bulk cement in tank containers, as I mentioned , it will start giving us business only in Q3. Q2 we will not be able to get any business because the containers orders we have given, they are being manufactured . Of course, we have had a dialogue, detailed dialogue with the cement manufacturers. They are ready with the business, but the constraint is the supply of containers, which we are expecting they will be arriving in Q3. As soon as they arrive, the demand is ready. So Q3 only, we will be able to get the benefit of transportation of bulk cement in tank containers . Other than that, all the other things or initiatives are being taken by the company and the results, you will see in the next --in this Q2 only -after end of Q2 only.

Okay. Can you --I mean, my second question is, can you expand on what the initiatives that you are taking with companies like Vedanta and Jindal?

No, see, I can't tell you all the commercials , but all I can say is that we are having a long-term agreement. Already with Vedanta, we have an agreement for 3 years, which is going to expire next month, and we are in talks with them to further extend it for 3 years. That is an exclusive agreement. All of their business they give to CONCOR. In turn, we give them some assurance in terms of supply of containers , supply of rakes, and we give them some special tariff for that. That is an agreement we entered for long term, so we get exclusivity. They don't give it to any other operator. That much only I can tell you here.

The next question is from the line of Amyr Pirani from JPMorgan.

Sir, can you share the originating volumes, which you give out every quarter?

Yes. Originating volume for EXIM is 4,81,912 TEUs. Domestic , it is 1,24,844 TEUs. Total is 6,06,756 TEUs.

Okay. Okay. And sir, when you're talking about getting into these long-term arrangements with some business groups and you also mentioned Vedanta, so are you mainly referring to a renewal of these engagements that are already there or are you talking about getting into newer engagements , which can add to a new business going forward?

Yes. Actually, you can say a combination of both. Because when we entered into an agreement with the Vedanta, 3 years back, they were not present at so many locations . And now in the present agreement, we will be covering all the locations. So other than that, with the Jindal and Tata, Jindal, we had a partial agreement that is only for EXIM. Now we are looking for both EXIM and domestic . Similarly , Tata, we don't have any agreement. So we will be looking at a new agreement. So it's a combination of both.

Okay. That's good to know, sir. And sir, lastly, can you also help us with the empty running cost for the quarter across EXIM and domestic ?

Okay. EXIM, it is INR33.28 crores. Domestic , it is INR86.91 crores. Total INR130.18 crores.

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The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equities.

Sir, just wanted to check, when you said market share for EXIM, you've gained by 50 basis points, is that Y-o-Y or Q-o-Q, and would you be able to quantify what is the market share? Actually, it is Y-o-Y. So in last year, first quarter, it was 54.54%, now it has become 55.08%. Understood.

The second question I had, you mentioned about the work what you're doing with Vedanta. Vedanta earlier was only EXIM, now both. Did you say that it will --it is an exclusive arrangement, so they won't give any business to any other CTO? Have I understood right? No. Vedanta actually was both EXIM and domestic. And Jindal was only EXIM. So this means, exclusive means, they will give only to CONCOR.

Directly, right, not through any associate partners, etc. Is that true?

Why do we want that detail? When we are getting everything, that means everything.

Okay. Understood. Sir, in terms of the LLF, you had mentioned the cost will be 440 around, would you stick to the same number or is there any change?

I will request my Director (Finance) to answer this question.

So bang on that line. So you can see what we have spent on QI around INR106 crores, so that will remain. And if --as you recall the last con-call that we talked about, the new regime where we are trying to save. If that materializes, then even lesser than what we are projecting.

Right. I wanted to check on that only, sir, in terms of any update on the decision to surrender TKD under new policy?

440 is the outer limit on the normal rates of the old regime, if you are able to get that for the new regime then it is going to be quite lesser than what we are projecting.

Right. Sir, any update on the switch ...

That will surely add to the margins in a big way in domestic and EXIM, both.

Correct, correct. Just a clarification, sir. With respect to the TKD terminal, the switch by when do you think you will have the visibility or clarity, sir?

So TKD, one thing has been done. As you can see that we have booked lesser than the last year because of the fact that 60,000 square meters we have already surrendered from 1st of April. So that itself has a very big impact, nearly INR30 crores a year. And the other thing that you mentioned is already in pipeline. We are in the very serious discussion with Ministry of Railways and we are hopeful that something could come out very soon. And the moment something comes out, it will be shared with everybody.

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Raj Shekhar:

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Got it. And just 1 last question, if I may, sir. With respect to first mile, last mile, what is the extent of revenue contribution from this particular line of business? And last time, you had mentioned that it will have the similar margin at company level. Just thought of checking what is the mix?

First mile, last mile has been a very big hit in which I can now share the volume numbers with you. In the first quarter, in first mile, last mile, we had an income of INR82 crores, which is a growth of 35% year-on-year.

The next question is from the line of Keshav Kumar from Desvelado Advisors.

I have a question related to the export of non-basmati rice. We know that the ban has resulted in the loss of volume for the company, but there is a recent development in the situation, as 3 days



ago, NITI Aayog members indicated the possibility of lifting the ban due to improved paddy sowing and comfortable stock. My question is with indications that the ban may be lifted due to improved condition, what strategy does company have to capitalize on potential export resumption and increased rice production?

It's a very good question. We are anxiously waiting for that, and we are fully geared up. We have sufficient inventory of empty containers. There is no shortage of that. So as you may be aware, it's mostly done from Nagpur terminal and even Raipur and Dadri also, even Ludhiana. So all these terminals are fully geared up and we are anxiously waiting for the government decision. As soon as it comes, we will immediately resume the export movement office.

And sir, one general question

that I have is, as I can see, the company has also started our logistics app for providing first mile, last mile services. I wanted to know what strategies are being used to drive user acquisition for the app?

See, in that, actually, we are educating our customers also because a few days back I was in Bangalore. I had a trade meet in which we demonstrated the logistics app and first mile, last mile through logistics app. It has been very well received by our customers. And wherever we interact with our customers, which we do so very regularly, we keep it an item that logistics app, we have to demonstrate to them. So it's a very good facility and customers are quite enthusiastic. We are using social media also to tell our customers about logistics app, and it's very well received by the trade.

The next question is from the line of Raj Shekhar from Vishal Portfolio and Advisors. Please go ahead.

My question is recently, CBIT announced GST exemption on services provided by the Railways to SPVs. So my understanding is like this year, GST exemption on track access charges is there, is that benefit to us?

That is regarding Angul Sukinda and they will get it. We are not into that business. We are directly paying freight in terms of haulage charges. So there is no revenue sharing between Railways and us so far as apportionment of freight equipment. So we are not into that. This is Page 7 of 17

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Raj Shekhar:

Ajit Kumar Panda:

Raj Shekhar:

Sanjay Swarup:

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meant for DFCCIL, in fact. DFCCIL, as a company, will be getting benefited. Apart from that, many SPVs who are there in Gujarat area and Odisha area, they will be benefiting.

Okay. And our railway freight charges in this quarter went up ...

Angul Sukinda Railway is an SPV of CONCOR and that has gone operational, so this will also benefit to Angul Sukinda Railway and to that extent, we have a small stake in that.

Okay. And when this DFC JNPT, the post correction we'll get?

See, DFC to Nhava Sheva only 100 kilometers is remaining. And till now officially, we have come to know that by March 2025 they will be able to do it, which is a very, very optimistic target. But for the benefit of our customers, as I mentioned in my opening remarks, we will be giving the double-stack benefit up to a place called Varnarna, which is around 400 kilometers short of Nhava Sheva. So very soon, we will be starting that movement.

The next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors.

Sir, I just wanted to understand while you did mention about export import being disrupted a little bit. But if we look at the port volumes, particularly the key ports of JNPT, Mundra, etc, there was actually a very strong volume pickup that we saw in the month of June, July. So if you can just talk about what is the rail coefficient? How are things moving? Is the rail share not very strong because of the imbalance, which is where there is a disconnect between the rail --the EXIM volumes and the port volumes?

See, I can't talk about July right now, but I have numbers till June. Till June, in fact, as a matter of fact, rail coefficient has come down. At Nhava Sheva, last year in first quarter, it was 16.6% and now in Q1 of this financial year, it was 15.6%, so 1% down. In Mundra, it was 24.3%, now it is 22.5%. And Pipavav, it was 61.6% and now it is 52.6%. So at all the ports, it has come down. But at Mundra and Pipavav, as I told in the opening remarks, our share has increased, whereas Nhava Sheva our share has come down marginally --slightly, it has come down.

So the probable reason is that they are serving the nearby hinterland and that is viable by road only. And second factor, as I told you that when we will be connecting Nhava Sheva to NCR by double stack, then I am expecting some shift fr

om road to rail. So maybe we will see some rise in rail coefficient at Nhava Sheva.

Right. Sir, I mean, where this is coming from is that we've seen an improvement with DFC, etc. We've seen an improvement with our services itself kind of going up. So one had expected that the rail coefficient should kind of start inching up. But on the other hand, it has across all the ports, seen a bit of a decline if you take a 2-, 3-year trajectory. Do you think there is a scope for improvement in terms of the rail coefficient improving?

Yes, actually. I feel definitely, there will be scope of improvement. In fact, if I see the numbers, the port volumes have --and Mundra port also have in Q1, there have been a very good growth of port volumes. And if you see the absolute numbers carried by CONCOR and by private

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operators, there is a very good growth in absolute numbers. But as far as share is concerned, definitely, the rail share has gone down.

There may be several reasons for that, apart from DFC. Of course DFC connectivity has helped us to carry more volumes and with predictability in service and being economical from NCR area. Definitely, volumes have picked up, if you see from this area. But maybe there are a lot of industries coming around the port, and they are being served by road only. And maybe there are some transshipment volumes also there at the ports.

Understood. Sir, can I get the lead distances for both EXIM and domestic?

Yes. CONCOR lead distances for this year in EXIM was 716 kilometers; domestic, it is 1,338; and it is 821 kilometers.

Okay. And just one last clarification on the LLF, which is INR 06 crores. This takes into account the reduction of the TKD of INR 30-odd crores that we are expecting. That is already visible in this current quarter, right?

Yes, please.

The next question is from the line of Lokesh Garg from UBS Group. As there is no response from the participant, we'll move to the next. The next question is from the line of Mihir Parekh from Ashika Stock Broking.

Sir, my question is on the initiatives in the domestic front. If you could quantify the growth coming in from the incremental TEU or throughput coming in from the bulk cement initiative, which we are taking and also the V amama terminal double stacking? So if you could quantify how much incremental volumes are we expecting from these 2 initiatives?

I will request my Director (Domestic) to take this question.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: This side, Mohammad Azhar Shams, Director (Domestic). Actually, with respect to domestic volume, whatever our CMD just underlined that we are in talk to major corporate houses like Vedanta, Jindal, Tata and then even Reliance to enter into long-term agreements. This is certainly going to add a lot of volume. We can't quantify because things are --discussions are at the very initial stages, but let us see how things roll up.

But with respect to Vedanta, we were already into an agreement with them for the last 3 years and now we are going to renew that. But earlier with the plants, which were included were only 2, like Jharsuguda Vedanta plant and then TPSK in Korba area. But now we are going to add many more plants, whatever they are having like Balli in Goa, and then some area in Rajasthan. And then SCIC, they are in Panthnagar.

So I think both the volume with the addition of these new plants are going to increase in this new agreement. And whatever new discussions are going on, those we will certainly add. We will subsequently explain to you or give the data when things are finalized. That is on the agreement front.

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Now with respect to bulk cement. You know that bulk cement i

s having a very huge potential

and we have placed 500 containers bulk cement --loose cement container order to Braithwaite Limited as a PSU of Indian Railways. So the prototype is in the manufacturing stage, and we are very hopeful that by the beginning of the first quarter, we shall be getting first rake of those 500 containers .

So the volume will certainly pick up keeping in view the availability of the containers. Demand is absolutely there. We are in talks with many cement companies, and we are having orders in that respect. The thing is likely when we start getting the containers, so they have promised us that the Braithwaite , they shall be offering 50 containers per month to us starting from third quarter.

So I think in first month only in September, we can be getting first rake and subsequently after every month, every 2 months, we shall be adding 1 rake there. So I think these are the pipeline and then demand, and we are working on those fronts. And certainly volumes are going to increase with these new initiatives .

Sir, the question was the 25% domestic growth, which we are expecting, if you could quantify how much--of which would come from the Varnama as well and this cement as well?

Mohammad Azhar Shams: In the first quarter, the overall originating and volume has been around 20%. So this volume is certainly going to be to us. And we are quite hopeful these new initiative and new discussion whatever we are having and the cement initiative from the third quarter, these 2 adding together will certainly add up to 25% because 25% originating we have hired in the first quarter only.

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Manoj Kumar Dubey:

Achal Lohade: The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equity.

Sir, can you help us with the port mix?

Sorry?

With the port mix, like how much of the total volume came from JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav and so on for the quarter?

Yes. JNPT 32.3%, Mundra 38.8%, Pipavav 9.7%, Vizag 6.2%, Chennai 3.7%, Vallarpadam 2.8%.

And this is percentage of the originating volume, I presume, right, sir?

Yes, that's right.

Understood. The second question I had was with respect to the --is there any one-off in terms of expenses or employee costs in this quarter, sir?

Yes, there was a one-off that has affected. Otherwise, we will be maintaining that 5% rise in the staff cost in the coming quarters.

Sorry, sir. Can you please quantify, I couldn't hear you clearly?

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Moderator:

Krupashankar: Container Corporation of India Limited

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What I said was, yes, there was one-off in this first quarter for the staff payment. Regarding some additional payments that we did for PRP where we had provision for very good, but we were rated outstanding by DPE. So that additional payment has been done. This is one-off only. From the next quarter onwards, you will find this 5% increase that is normally we do in Y-to-Y basis.

Okay. So 5% going forward in terms of Y-o-Y increase in terms of employee costs?

For the simple fact that number will probably are decreasing only. So whatever increase that we have 3% in basic and some DA and all, that doesn't grow more than 5% in totality.

Understood. The other question I had, if you could talk a little bit about particularly Ludhiana

market, how things are shaping up? You did mention in a passing remark with respect to the low-value, high-volume cargo, which was kind of impacted given the Red Sea issues. So in terms of the overall growth, how do you see Ludhiana market moving from here on and what is our market share in that particular market, sir?

Normally, we don't talk about the particular market in this conference call. But since you have asked the question, so I will

I will give you a brief. Ludhiana market, we are having a market share of around 40%.

And we are carrying this import of waste paper to a big extent. We are, I think, biggest carrier of waste paper imports, which is a major import in Ludhiana market. Plus, rice is about to resume. We are ready for that. And domestic also, we are getting a good business in the Ludhiana market. And we have a terminal at Dhandari Kalan. We have come up with a multi-model logistics park at Kita Raipur, which is getting a good business in domestic stream.

Understood. And just I clarification, if you could, with respect to Dadri, what kind of contribution are you seeing from Dadri at the moment? And how do you see it evolving? Can you take share from our TKD ICD in order to reduce the cost?

See, Dadri has been MMLP now, and it's well connected to DFC. And TKD, we are having a garlanding of TKD. Around TKD, we have created terminals like Dadri and Kathuwas, at Barbi that is Sonipat we have created. Then south of the Delhi, we are going --just been looking for land, almost finalized. We will be making a terminal South of Delhi also. So the aim is to decongest TKD. So Dadri has subsided to a great extent.

The business of Greater Noida area is now being catered to by our Dadri terminal and Dadri to Mundra-Pipavav, we are already running double-stack trains and table service to Mundra. And once we start double-stack to Nhava Sheva from Dadri, we will run from Nhava Sheva also. So Dadri, in fact, we are aiming to have a 1 million TEU throughput at Dadri in this financial year. This will be first million TEU terminal in the country.

The next question is from the line of Krupashankar from Avendus Spark.

My first question is more of a bookkeeping question. What would be the rail freight margins for the quarter?

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CONCOR

Sanjay Swarup:

Krupashankar:

Sanjay Swarup:

Krupashankar:

Sanjay Swarup:

Ajit Kumar Panda:

Krupashankar: Rail freight margin is 24.36%. Container Corporation of India Limited

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Okay. Second question, more on double stacking from Kathuwas. We have seen that we have scaled the double stacking quite extensively. And given that we have started new direct services from Dadri to Mundra-Pipavav and to Nhava Sheva as well. Are you seeing probably that the double stacking related rake efficiency has already peaked out or do you see further levers for increasing double stacking in our entire operation, sir?

See, double stacking, if you see in this quarter also, there is a growth of 14%, which is above 30% that we had last financial year. So double stacking, definitely, there is a lot of scope. Now we are running even reefer double-stack container, in which there are reefer container on top as well as lower deck. Plus, the infusion of technology that our company believes. So we are having a 25-ton axle load wagons in which the scope of double stacking has increased because we can carry more weight per wagon, payload has increased. So it's an ongoing process.

Then as I mentioned, you Nhava Sheva also we are bringing one double stack, so that will further add more double stacking. So there is a lot of scope for double stacking. And near Jodhpur also we are coming up with a terminal at Salawas, that will also be a double-stacking terminal. So that way, we will be able to capture a lot of business from Jodhpur area if we've been double stacked, but until now Jodhpur is not having a double-stack facility. So there is a lot of future for double stacking in our country.

Understood. And also, with respect to newer terminals coming up, is there any guidance you can give us, as to what are the number of terminals that you are targeting for the current financial year, sir?

I will request my Director (Projects) to take this question.

Yes. We are now setting up 2 terminals, already work is going on in urban stage in one terminal at Mandalgarh in Rajasthan. Then another terminal, we

are just going to commence the work

soon. We have already got the land from Northern Railway. It is at Haridwar, Pathri station near

Haridwar. So these 2 places we are starting the work and another near Amritsar. That Manawala land acquisition is completed by 75%. Once we acquire the balance 25% we will start the work in this current year also. In addition to this, then we have got 2 more terminals work in progress. One has already CMD has intimated, Salawas near Jodhpur. We are acquiring land. Then another will be earlier Ahmedabad, where we have identified a land where we'll do the double stack operation. Now we are not able to do double stack operation in Khodiyar, where we are having the terminal. So we are acquiring another land near Ahmedabad, so that is also in process. Hopefully, these 2 Salawas, Manawala, and Sarodi, they will also start the work in the current year. But Mandalgarh and Pathri, we have already started. So these are the next 5 in line. Understood, sir. In the past, we had expanded quite extensively in the southern region, we had set up a lot of MMLPs over the last 5, 6 years. Are you seeing traction related to volume pickup in those facilities, sir? And what are the exact set of clientele you're looking at? Is it domestic focused or is it EXIM-focused, can you show some light on that?

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CONCOR

Sanjay Swarup:

Krupashankar:

Sanjay Swarup:

Moderator:

Aditya:

Sanjay Swarup:

Aditya:

Sanjay Swarup:

Aditya: Container Corporation of India Limited

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At the outset, I would like to clarify. We don't develop terminals region-wise. We go wherever there is a cargo. So even, in fact, in Eastern area like Odisha also, we have developed Jajpur. We have developed Paradip, which is in last 2, 3 years only. So this was the clarification from management side. Second thing is that wherever we are developing a terminal, we go for multimodal logistics parks. As you are aware, they cater to both domestic as well as EXIM traffic. At the start of the --when the terminal is commissioned, we immediately start domestic business.

But for getting clearance, for clearance and notifications from customs, it takes some time, maybe 1, 1.5 years. So there is a gap, but that doesn't mean that this terminal will only cater to domestic traffic. So after, say, gap of 1, 1.5 years, we start EXIM business also from there. So all our terminals are fit for domestic as well as EXIM traffic, and we don't develop region-wise. No. So what I meant was the --same thing on the Paradip terminal as well as other terminals, which you had started, just wanted to take an update on how is the volume traction in those regions and have you started EXIM operations in these locations?

See, at Paradip and Jajpur, custom notification is awaited. And it will not be possible to give us a terminal-wise volumes in this conference call.

The next question is from the line of Aditya from Kotak Securities.

My first question was more linked to the reduction in model rail share across the ports. And since it is across co-ports, could we think to a reason why this is happening and whether it can potentially reverse? Is it linked to imbalance in any sort or how to think through these numbers on an incremental basis?

See, probable reasons will be the shift in the industry. Like many industries are developing near the ports, which are best catered by road. And we're not able to pinpoint the exact reason now and maybe some transshipment volumes have increased at the port. Because of that also, the volume at ports, we are seeing more volumes at port being handled. And one of the reasons could be the some effect of busy season surcharge also, which has made the --for lighter commodities the rail movement may have become unviable. These may be some probable reasons.

Okay, sure. Could you also share with us the market share across ports, JNPT, Mundra and Pipavav that you would be having?

Ye

s. Yes. I will tell you. The JNPT market share was 56% for CONCOR and --out of the rail share; and Mundra, it was 38%; and Pipavav was 49%.

The next question that I had was, you talked about the lower land license fee that can happen for you as you change the regime. I wanted to clarify that if and when such a change in land licensing fee regime happens to 1.5%, would it not lead to a risk to your volumes because those terminals can then be classified as common use terminals or if there is a different way of thinking through?

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CONCOR

Sanjay Swarup:

Aditya:

Sanjay Swarup:

Aditya:

Sanjay Swarup:

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Sanjay Swarup:

Moderator:

Pulkit Patni:

Sanjay Swarup: Container Corporation of India Limited

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This policy of migrating to 1.5%, that is Gati Shakti, is still being examined by Indian Railways for brownfield terminals that already we have. We have given our request to them. They are examining. Our request is on the extent policy that they have. So they have not come up with a final decision.

As far as the common user thing is concerned, you are absolutely right. It will be a common user facility, and we will devise some strategy like terminal access charges and whatever we have to charge from the operators that come to our terminal, but our philosophy is very, very simple and straight that customers should pay the same amount of charges, whether the container arrives by CONCOR train or it arrives by private-operated train, the charges paid by customers should be the same. He should not be penalized either way. That is our philosophy, and we will stick to that.

Understood, sir. Sir, this INR80 crores, first mile, last mile component, which has grown 35% Y-o-Y, is this concentrated in 1 of the 2 segments? And also wanted to kind of check whether the margins could be very different than the segmented margins being booked otherwise?

It is in both EXIM and domestic and it is spread throughout the country. And last financial year, we had a FMLM of our total volume, 25% FMLM we could provide. This year, we have kept a target of 50%, and we are quite confident that with the launch of the app on pan-India basis and other measures that we are taking like educating the customers of the benefits. So we will be able to achieve 50% FMLM.

And so it's not having a detrimental impact on your margins at a segmented level, so far?

No, no, not at all.

Sure, sir. Sir, just a final question from my side. Market share in JNPT 56%, this quarter was 60% in the previous year. I think through the year, it was 60% only, so in a quarter's time, what has changed and can we kind of claw back this market share loss?

Yes, JNPT, you are right, in the last year in the first quarter, it was 59.6%. So there is definitely a drop of more than 3%. But Mundra at last year, it was 36%, this year, it is 38%. So there is a gain of 2%. Pipavav, it was 44%, this year it is 49% so there's an increase of 5% market share. JNPT, definitely, there is a drop, and we are examining the various reasons, and we will be taking the corrective steps very soon.

The next question is from the line of Pulkit Patni from Goldman Sachs.

I just have one question and that to a very high-level question. Sir, if I look at the last sort of 5 odd years, our quarterly PAT has ranged between INR250 crores and INR300 crores. In this period, we've done multiple investments, not a lot of new MMLPs, lot of new initiatives, more containers, etc. I'm just trying to understand when does this trajectory of profitability move higher for us, particularly in light of DFC and all these investments that we have made?

See, Pulkit, you will appreciate that in logistics business, even maintaining EBITDA of 24%, 25% is, I think, it's a very good EBITDA number because other logistics companies are able to

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CONCOR

A Navratna Company

Pulkit Patni:

Sanjay Swarup:

Manoj Kumar Dubey:

Moderator:

Mohit:

Sanjay Swarup:

Moderator:

Rohit Ohri: Container Corporation of India Limited

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maintain only single-digit EBITDA. So don't you think it is good that we are able to maintain that level?

No. No, no. Sir, I appreciate your cash profitability or EBITDA. I'm just trying to focus on profit growth in general, given the kind of investments that we have done. So --and I'm sure, given all

these initiatives on cement, etc, that you talk about, they will add to that profitability . So just wanted to understand how is your view of that profit growth from these levels?

Definitely, in the next quarter, you will see more than INR250 crores. My Director (Finance) also wants to add something .

First to keep your record straight, last year Q2, we put INR357 crores. And last year Q3, we also put INR334 crores. So your basic assumption that we are hovering between INR250 crores to INR300 crores was broken last FY only. Q1 is subdued, as my CMD has right now --I mean in the beginning only he has spoken about.

So let's think about that whether we break this INR350 crores kind of thing to INR400 crores or not, that would be the right question. And answer to that, I believe, as CMD has put in the right perspective that the way things are moving ahead and the kind of leverage that DFC will bring to the company , we are very hopeful that very soon our profit will be hovering in between INR350 crores to INR400 crores per quarter. I hope I'm making a sense.

The next question is from the line of Mohit from Macquarie.

Apologies, if my questions have been answered early, I joined a bit. So sir, just 2 questions . The capex outlay for this year? And secondly, if you could touch on what proportion of our volumes are exposed to trade with Bangladesh ? Just 2 questions.

One is the capex this year, we have made an estimate of capex. capex budget, in fact, is INR610 crores. Out of that, INR156.6 crores we have spent in Q1. And as far as Bangladesh is concerned , then Bangladesh, this year, we have --in the first quarter, we have ran 2 trains to Bangladesh.

Last year, it was only one.

So year-on-year, it's doubled, you can say. But we are getting not much demand from Bangladesh because maybe some liquidity crunch is there. And with the recent political development things are quite uncertain. But we are ready to serve Bangladesh. As and when there is a demand, we will be more than willing to cater to that.

The next question is from the line of Rohit Ohri from Progressive Share.

Two questions from my end. The first one being while we talk about increasing the size and scale of operations and giving value-added service to the customers , and at the same time, the Government of India is also talking about certain tweaking in the shipping policies. And Container Corporation has come up with an MOU with SCI. So would you like to take us through the developments , which are happening in this domain?

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CONCOR

Sanjay Swarup:

Rohit Ohri:

Sanjay Swarup:

Rohit Ohri:

Sanjay Swarup:

Ajit Kumar Panda:

Rohit Ohri:

Ajit Kumar Panda:

Moderator:

Bhoomika Nair: Container Corporation of India Limited

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Yes, actually, the coastal shipping is a very eco-friendly mode of transport. And we were doing that before COVID-19 and we had developed some streams like from Gujarat to South. So now we have entered into a collaboration with the Shipping Corporation and very soon, we will be starting coastal movement from Gujarat to South India and even from South to Eastern side of the country. So you will hear very soon that we are going to start the coastal movement.

Sir, you also spoke about certain industries developing on the coastal region as well as on the port side. So would you like to put some numbers in terms of the top line that we can fetch from this MOU that might come through maybe in Q3, Q4 as and when time comes?

Actually, it will be premature to tell you the numbers right now because

we are also doing it,

number crunching, at our end. So I don't think it will be possible to give any numbers right now.

Okay, sir. Not an issue. Sir, my second question is related to the container procurement and the tank containers that we were in process of procuring. Would you like to share the total number of containers that we would actually want to have? And how much have we procured so far?

I will request my Director (Projects) to take this question.

Yes. In the Q1, we have procured 2,497 containers. And our total container procurement so far has been 11,700 and considering the previous availability right now, we have about 48,000 containers in our disposal. So another, we have also pending order for around 5,000 more containers to be procured. So we are steadily getting supply of about 700, 800 containers per month from the manufacturer and soon, we'll be crossing the 50,000 mark of container holding by maybe end of this quarter.

So that is quite encouraging to hear that we'll reach this milestone number for the container. Sir, do you think that the capex number, which Sanjay-ji just mentioned, that has to be scaled up then to ...

Yes, we, in fact, had incurred a capex of INR 712 crores last year. And this year, we have kept INR 610 crores target, but we will review this after the second quarter. If required, we'll further increase the capex provision. So the INR 610 crores budget we have initially fixed, but we are - we hope that we will exceed it, so we'll revise it in due course.

The next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors.

Sir, I just want to, again, just talk about the rail coefficient aspect of it. If one looks at it, the trade volumes or export import is broadly growing per se at about 5% to 8% kind of a range. And on the other hand, we are seeing a drop in the rail coefficient because of industries coming up closer to the ports per se.

So what is giving us confidence that in the balance 9 months, we will be able to grow despite all of this at about 18%, 20% to meet our annual guidance of 15%. If you can just give some more details, are you seeing some very sharp uptick in terms of bookings, very strong market share gains, etc, which will be required to kind of meet this number?

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CONCOR

Sanjay Swarup:

Bhoomika Nair:

Sanjay Swarup:

Moderator:

Bhoomika Nair:

Sanjay Swarup:

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We are hoping the rail coefficient will grow in the coming months. There are some reasons for that. First is the rice exports, which is going to start now. It will be a major impact on rail coefficient as far as exports are concerned. Then there will be growth we are expecting at Nhava Sheva as a result of double stacking benefit that we will be passing on by running double stack from NCR to Varnama.

And thirdly, a lot of imports of such commodities, which only move by rail is now coming because of the softening of ocean freights that I was --I mentioned in my opening remarks.

These are low-value commodities, but heavy commodities like scrap and waste paper, which are having a low value. So when the ocean rates are softened, they become economical to import. So all these things will definitely have a bearing on rail coefficient.

Okay. So you do expect that this should kind of improve per se? And from a JNPT perspective because of our Varnama double stacking, where do you think we can possibly claw back our market share or rail coefficient can possibly improve? And lastly, sir, what is the status to the final connectivity of DFC to JNPT?

See, it will be extremely difficult to give a number. But I think you will see definitely an upward movement as far as rail coefficient is concerned. Number, I will not be able to give right now. And second question is about the connectivity of DFC to Nhava Sheva. For that, DFC is still maintaining the target of March 2025 and --but I find it ve

ry challenging. Maybe let us wait for

the update from them. They are the best people to tell the exact date of commissioning.

So as that was the last question, I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair for closing comments. Over to you, ma'am.

Thank you very much, sir, for giving us an opportunity to host the call. Really appreciate it. And thanks to all the participants for being on the call. Thank you very much, sir, and wish you all the best. Sir, any closing comments from your side?

I want to thank all the investors for having faith in my company. I just want to say that our employees are very motivated to work hard, and we have a robust infrastructure and very good demand from industry.

So there is no reason why we should not grow in the coming months. And we --the company management and all the employees of my company, we are very, very positive and optimistic that we'll be able to post very good numbers in the coming months, which I will be sharing with all of you. Thank you very much.

On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

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Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No. Name

1 HOST : Bhoomika Nair



2 HOST : Management  
3 Aayush Avjit  
4 Abdul Shaikh  
5 Abhiit Mitra  
6 Abhishek  
7 Abhishek Rath  
8 Abhishek Verma  
9 Abin  
10 Achal Lohade  
11 Aditya  
12 Aijit Motwani  
13 Akhilesh Bhandari  
14 Akshata Thakur  
15 Alok Devra  
16 Aman Agrawal  
17 Amin Tirani  
18 Amit Bhide  
19 Amit Dixit  
20 Amit Khurana  
21 Amit Kumar  
22 Amit Kumar Raiout  
23 Amresh Mishra  
24 Anirudha Sarkar  
25 Ankit  
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44 Deepak Marolia  
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1141673000 Container Corporation of India Limited  
8097436847 Whiteoak Capital  
16465173334 Bloomberg  
919833686232 Aionios Aloha Investment Manaoement  
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142 Smritika  
143 Sumit  
144 Sumit Kishor  
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146 Tamir Despande  
147 Tanay Shah  
148 Tanush Makwana  
149 Udit Dekde  
150 Urmil Shah  
151 Urmil

152 Uttam Shah  
153 Vaibhav  
154 Vaibhav Shah  
155 Venkat  
156 Vidhi  
157 Vigesh Iver  
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A Multi-modal logistics Company  
(A Navratna CPSE of Govt. of India)  
No.CON/F&CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No. 91029/NoteNo.11/  
~: 06.11.2024  
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enclosed transcript of Post results conference call held on 30.10.2024.  
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"Container Corporation of India Limited Q2 FY25  
Earnings Conference Call"

October 30, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP - CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING  
DIRECTOR, CONCOR  
MR. PRIYA RANJAN PARHI - DIRECTOR  
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING AND OPERATIONS ),  
CONCOR  
MR. ANURAG KAPIL - DIRECTOR (FINANCE),  
CONCOR  
MR. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS - DIRECTOR  
(DOMESTIC DIVISION), CONCOR  
MR. AJIT KUMAR PANDA- DIRECTOR (PROJECTS &  
SERVICES), CONCOR  
MR. HARISH CHANDRA- EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR  
(FINANCE) & COMPANY SECRETARY AND CFO,  
CONCOR  
MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR - DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED



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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Container Corporation of India Limited Q2 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing "\*" then "0" on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, thanks. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q2 FY '25 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India.

We have the management today being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director of CONCOR. I will now hand over the floor to him for his opening remarks, post which we will open up the floor for Q&A. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, good morning, everybody. On behalf of CONCOR family, I would like to extend the Diwali greetings to all of you.

In the conference call, I am joined by Mr. Mohammad Azhar Shams – Director (Domestic), Mr. Priya Ranjan Parhi – Director (International Marketing and Operations), Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda – Director (Projects and Services), Mr. Anurag Kapil – Director (Finance) and Mr. Harish Chandra – ED (Finance) and Company Secretary of CONCOR.

I would like to give you some highlights and after that we can start the question-answer session.

I am happy to announce the growth in throughput of 6% for the first half of this financial year. It includes EXIM growth of 3.5% and domestic growth of 14.5%. EXIM growth is quite in line with India's international trade. In exports for the first half, the international trade of India was total 213.22 billion USD, which is a growth of 1% over the corresponding period of last financial year. Import of our country was 350.66 billion USD, which is a growth of 6% over the last financial year.

One more point that I would like to present is that we had increase in EXIM market share for this first half. In pan-India basis our EXIM market share grew by 91 basis points. At Mundra Port, our EXIM market share grew by 248 basis points and Pipavav Port, our market share grew by 285 basis points.

The good thing is that there is growth in market share as well as there is a growth in margins also. So, without sacrificing margins, we have grown our market share. Rail freight margin grew by 80 basis points year-on-year. Operating margin excluding exceptional items grew by 95 basis points. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

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points year-on-year. The primary reasons for this performance is the customer centricity and operational excellence of Team CONCOR.

Operating income growth was 6.58%. Growth in profit after tax was 4.08% for the company and the double-stack rakes also saw a good growth of 11.5%. In this first half, we had 3,083 double-stack trains as compared to 2,766 last year.

We have added infrastructure also to give service to our customers. In this first half, we have commissioned 2 high-speed rakes, and we hope that in the second half we will be commissioning 10 more rakes. So, for this financial year, around 12 high-speed rakes will be commissioned by us. So, now our total count of rakes stands at 380.

We have procured 5,130 new containers in this first half. So, the total count stands at now 49,516 containers, which are owned by CONCOR. We are continuously adding more and more containers of tank containers, then may be for 40-foot types also we are going now for first time for our domestic customers. We had earmarked the CAPEX budget of Rs. 610 crores for this financial year. In the first half, we

have already achieved Rs. 276.16 crores, and we may be looking at the CAPEX budget very soon, whether we want to upgrade it, seeing the infrastructure requirements of the company.

International, as you all know, because of the challenging geopolitical scenario, international supply chains are adversely affected. This has resulted in erratic vessel schedules. There is congestion at transshipment ports, and there is less availability of slots in vessels for exports. These are the challenging situations being faced by the economy of our country.

Domestic loading was also affected in the 2nd Quarter, primarily because we had very good rainfall in North India and Gujarat, which affected our domestic loading. But I am happy to announce that from this month, it has picked up very nicely, and we are getting very good growth in domestic in Q3.

Despite all these challenges, the exports increased for some commodities, there was a handsome

increase. Like for readymade garments, there was 41% growth, paper products 31% growth, food items 28% growth. Similarly imports also, in solar modules it was 126% growth, wood pulp it was 20% growth.

And I am happy to inform all of you that CONCOR commenced rail services between Kandla Port and hinterland ICDs of North India. This is a new port where we have started the rail services.

And we have posted ever highest PAT of Rs. 371 crore in Q2. This is the highest for any quarter in the history of CONCOR, and this is despite the exceptional items of Rs. 25 crores net of tax, Container Corporation of India Limited

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that one of the Vivad Se Vishwas scheme claim that we settled, as per the directives of Government of India.

If we add this 25 crore, then the PAT will further increase. So, as such, 371 crore is a record for our company, a record PAT in any quarter. We had the highest operating turnover, highest total turnover in any first half year, and highest PAT also in any first half, apart from the highest PAT in a quarter also.

And the Board of Directors has declared a dividend of Rs. 3.25 per share, which is 65% of par value. So, till now we have declared a dividend of 105% for the first half of this financial year, which is around the total outgo of Rs. 322 crores for our shareholders. The focus area of the company remains total logistic solution to customers, business solution, including warehousing and FMLM, and providing green and sustainable logistics to our customers.

At this point I would like to maintain the guidance that I gave at the start of the financial year, that is for EXIM 15%, Domestic 25%, and a total of 18%. Of course, in EXIM, it will be a bit challenging, but I am quite confident that we will be able to achieve this.

The new initiative, growth drivers, for achieving this guidance will be 3-4 growth drivers we have identified. First will be the bringing JNPT, Nhava Sheva on double-stack, that is through Varnama. By November end, I am confident that we will be able to start this service, wherein we will give benefit of double-stacking to North India customers for Nhava Sheva traffic. And I expect that there will be a diversion of business from road to rail, so this will be a big gain for the company.

Second will be the bulk cement and tank containers. I had a meeting recently with CMD of M/s Braithwaite Corporation, which is a sister PSU of CONCOR under Ministry of Railways, and he has assured me that by December he will start giving us tank containers, which will be utilized for bulk cement movement. We are in touch with leading cement manufacturers. They are quite excited about it, and we hope to garner very good business in domestic in the coming months. Then we have very good demand for rice exports now, and especially at our ICDs at Nagpur, Raipur, Sonipat, etc. And we hope that in the coming months, already actually rice exports have started. After Diwali the traction is

going to pick up. So, we will have very good rice exports in

the coming months. All these things will add to our top line as well as bottom line.

We are also, we have signed, and we are still signing agreements of volume-based discounts with shipping lines, long-term agreements, 3 to 5 years. This will further cement our relationship with them and increase our business. So, besides that, we will get business at new terminals that we have commissioned, and we will have more focus on DPD (Direct Port Delivery) movements.

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So, all these five, six-growth drivers will further enhance our business, and we are quite confident that we will end up achieving the guidance that I gave at the start of the financial year.

This is all the opening statement from my side. Now you can start with questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI. Please go ahead.

Amit Dixit: Congratulations for a great performance in spite of all odds. I have a couple of questions, sir.

The first one is on the LLF. So, while we saw some kind of reversal of around 40 crores in this quarter, I just wanted to understand the broad contours of it that how do we see this LLF panning out for rest of the year and what kind of LLF provisions we should take in our own models. And secondly, why is this 40 crores provision write back? What exactly is happening over there?

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you, Amit. As far as LLF is concerned, this 40 crores provision we had made at the ICD Whitefield, but now that the land rates are settled with railways, we have set off in this quarter.

So, LLF is settled with the Indian railways. Now there is no further issue, and we are constantly, as I mentioned in my earlier conference call also, we are constantly evaluating our terminals that wherever we come up with new logistic parks, we surrender the railway terminals so as to have

a saving on LLF without sacrificing our business. So, the same policy will continue. As far as the payment of LLF is concerned, it is more or less settled with Railways. So, we need not worry on that front.

Amit Dixit: Any guidance you would like to provide for FY '25, sir, on LLF?

Sanjay Swarup: That will be in the range of 350-400 crores, not more than that.

Amit Dixit: The second question is on domestic business. So, EXIM, while it has performed pretty well, domestic also what I see that it has bounced off compared to last quarter. But if I compare on Y-o-Y basis, while our revenue has gone up, EBIT has fallen. So, I just wanted to understand whether it is due to the rail to the road competition from road guys or whether it is due to more empty running or just wanted to get a little bit more clarity on this.

Sanjay Swarup: Domestic business has performed quite well. Of course, not as expected. But if you see year-on-year for first half, there is a growth of 14.5% in handling in domestic and 22% growth in originating TUEs in number of containers. Of course, it could have been better, but because of, as I mentioned in my opening address, a very good rainfall that we had this year in North India as well as Gujarat. Because Gujarat and North India are the major originating points for domestic loading. So, there was disruption because of rains, and we could not get that much loading. But from this month, October, we are getting very good loading in domestic, and we are quite satisfied with it. So, you will see in subsequent weeks, the domestic will be doing extremely well.

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Amit Dixit: Sir, the more specific question was essentially that revenue has remained flat Y-o-Y, while EBIT has fallen. So, I just wanted to understand whether there was some one-off cost item or something that was in this quarter that

would not recur.

Sanjay Swarup: I request my Director (Domestic) to throw more light on this.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Azhar Shams this side. I agree in this respect whatever you have been underlining, my take is that for the last 3 to 4 months or you may start, say, that from the start of this financial, we have been losing a bit of market share in the domestic because the competitors and the CTOs have been really very aggressive, and I have been giving very, very aggressive rate, and we were losing the business. In order to arrest that trend, we took a conscious call, let us first regain the volume, even at the cost of some reduction in revenue and profitability and subsequently we will see what to do.

So, now, I think that result we have started getting from this month only, and we have tweaked our rates positively also in some streams. So, I think whatever negative trend, you see that our volume has increased, our revenue has been flat, but from this month and whatever corrective action we took, now the customers are with us, and they are ready to accept a bit of rate increase because of our services. So, I think the positive result in revenue, you will see from 3rd Quarter onward, and October is certainly showing very good green shoots on that.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors. Please go ahead.

Bhoomika Nair: First, can you please share the originating volume for this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, I will tell you. Originating volume of this quarter is, EXIM, it is 5,57,576, Domestic, 1,33,255 TEUs, total is 6,90,831 TEUs.

Bhoomika Nair: So, sir, how are you seeing the trajectory now in October, there was this whole Red Sea and shipping disruption, etc., which had led to heavy volumes kind of moving away from rail? How is that now kind of panning out in the month of October or of late?

Sanjay Swarup: See, October month, as I told you, we have got very good traction in domestic. Domestic, we are seeing very good loading across the country. As far as EXIM is concerned, imports are a bit muted. Growth is there but not that much. But from the last one week to 10 days, we are seeing good demand of rice exports. And we have got firm indications, we are in touch with trade, that after Diwali, rice exports is coming in a big way. And imports are also going to increase.

Because of the Red Sea disruption, there was, as I told you initially, erratic vessel schedules, vessel schedules are erratic. They cannot be very, very predictable. So, because of that, it was a

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temporary, you can say, dip in the month of October for the first 15-20 days. But now it is going to pick up.

Bhoomika Nair: Sir, can we also get the empty running charges for EXIM domestic and also the lead distances for this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: I have for half year. For EXIM, it is 63.47 crores. Domestic, it is 140.89 crores. Total is 204.36 crores.

Bhoomika Nair: And the lead distances, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Lead distances for EXIM, for domestic, it is 1,318 kilometers. EXIM, it is 705 kilometers. Total is 803 kilometers.

Bhoomika Nair: Sir, I am sorry, just to circle back on this volume aspect, I know you have guided for 15% in EXIM, but if you look at the first half, it is about sub 4% kind of a growth. So, it will mean that in the second half, we will have to see that trajectory moving to 20%-25%. That is the kind of momentum that we are seeing as of now?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, as of now, frankly speaking, that momentum we are visualizing because there is a very good projection given by trade. And we are, of course, I find it challenging as I told my TV interviews also in the morning. Of course, we find it challenging, but we are quite confident based on the various sectors like rice exports and double-stacking to JNPT. So, these things are very, very crucial for tr

ade and they are well publicized. Trade is very much aware, and so we are quite confident that we will be able to get this target.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora: Sir, just wanted to understand this LLF, there is this 40 crore reversal and you mentioned about 350 crore sort of a guidance for this year. So, we are expecting some further reversals also in coming quarters because the quarterly run rate I believe was around 100 crore per quarter.

Sanjay Swarup: I told 350 crore to 400 crore. It will be nearly 400 crore only.

Alok Deora: Near 400 crore, got it. And then for next year it will be around 7% higher kind of number.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, you are well aware. The formula is that every year it should increase by 7%, but at the same time, as I mentioned initially, we are constantly evaluating that wherever we set up new logistic parks and that logistic park is able to serve the hinterland for a particular terminal, then we move our business to logistic park and close the terminal, surrender it to railways. So, that exercise will continue. Maybe next year we are able to commission some logistic park and surrender some land. So, then it will have a saving of LLF.

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Alok Deora: And sir, on this guidance point again, I mean, you have maintained the guidance, but it's pretty challenging environment as the industry's indicators are pointing out to be. So, in that scenario, such a kind of growth in the second half as you yourself mentioned is challenging. So, what is the bare minimum growth you could actually achieve if things did not pan out the way we are expecting, bare minimum growth in the EXIM side?

Sanjay Swarup: See, normally from 1st October we say that busy season has started in railways language. Busy season has already started. Busy season means more business. So, I am quite optimistic that we will be able to achieve the guidance that I gave in the start of the financial year, and there are various pointers, and there are various pointers that I am getting by interaction with trade. So, that is why I am feeling very confident to achieve this guidance. So, I would like to adhere to it, and I am quite confident that we will be able to achieve this guidance. I would not like to speculate on any other number.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Disha Giria from Ashika. Please go ahead.

Disha Giria: So, while you are maintaining the guidance level, could you help us quantify what are the initiatives that you think would be contributing to this growth? I mean, the growth number is exorbitant, like the other participants has also mentioned, but could you help us quantify some numbers for it?

Sanjay Swarup: See, I already told the growth drivers, 5-6 growth drivers in my opening remarks. Now which growth driver will give me how much number? That I am not able to tell you right now. Maybe separately one-to-one basis we can discuss, and I can tell you.

Disha Giria: Sir, my second question is regarding this Vivad Se Vishwas, the contractual expense that we had this quarter. So, could you just explain what was this for?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, this was a dispute between contractor and CONCOR in which the Vivad Se Vishwas scheme is given by Government of India that if arbitration award goes against the company, then this is a medium through which some 65% of that award we can offer to the opposite party and if they agree, if they accept it, then we settle it and all the future court cases are avoided. There is no court case after that by the party.

So, it was some such dispute in some contract in which the arbitration award went against the company. And we, this contractor went for Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme, and we also worked out how much money is payable. And then 65% of that we offered as per the scheme to the

contractor, and he accepted it. So, we had to settle it, and we made the payment, and net of tax it was rupees 25 crores, which hit we had to take in this quarter.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP. Please go ahead.  
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Priyanka Biswas: So, this is Priyanka Biswas from BNP. So, my first question is, so what I understand now is that the Western DFC connection to JNPT is not happening before December 2025. So, earlier it was March 2025. So, in such a case, how would we be able to secure a, let's say, after double-digit growth in EXIM volumes in FY '25, again, let's say, a double-digit growth in FY '26? Because what we are witnessing is a very steady erosion in real model share in JNPT. So, if you can address this point.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, it's a good question. You rightly mentioned that the Western DFC connection to JNPT will be in December 2025 as per the indications given by DFC officials. But we are going to give benefit of double stacking to our customers for JNPT. We have set up a terminal at a place called Varnama near Baroda, which is 400 kilometers from JNPT. So, for North India customers, we will be running double-stack train up to Varnama because it's a unique terminal which is connected to Indian Railways and as well as DFC. DFC connectivity is under progress. Last week I have visited Varnama. I have inspected the site, and work is going on in full swing. Of course, it was affected because of the rains. But now work is going on at full speed, and we are confident that before the end of November, the work will be commissioned, and this terminal will be connected to DFC. So, it will be having a connection to DFC as well as Railways. So, we will run double-stack train from Dadri and Kathuwas up to Varnama double-stack train on DFC. And from Varnama, we will break it into two single-stack trains. And they will go on Indian Railways route up to JNPT for the last 400 kilometers. And the reverse will happen for imports.

So, in this manner, we will be able to have some predictability for our customers, predictable time at JNPT. And secondly, we will pass on some cost benefits for the container which are moving on upper deck. So, we are confident that we will be able to shift a lot of cargo from road to rail as a result of this exercise. So, that is one of the growth drivers that I mentioned in my opening remarks. And we are quite confident to achieve this.

Priyanka Biswas: Sir, just harping again on this. Any particular reason why in JNPT the rail coefficient is falling? And why and what is the coefficient right now? Because we have been seeing this trend for some time now. What may be the reason for it?

Sanjay Swarup: See, JNPT rail coefficient at present is around 16% in which CONCOR'S share is 58% for the first half of this financial year. The main reason is that lot of cargo has, for North India, lot of cargo has shifted to Mundra Port, which is giving a benefit of double-stacks. And secondly distance to North India is also less from Mundra port to North India. And JNPT is now serving the hinterland around JNPT for which the road becomes faster and economical. And JNPT is also serving the area of Nagpur, Hyderabad, and even we have started for Bangalore also. One moment we are doing for Visakhapatnam also from JNPT. So, all these places JNPT is serving by rails, but primarily it is serving short distance traffic, which is more viable by a road. So, that

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is the most probable reason of decline in rail coefficient. But with the commissioning of DFC, we hope that rail coefficient at JNPT will rise.

Priyanka Biswas: That's very clear, and just one question I am just squeezing in. So, I think in 2Q, the railway does not levy a busy season surcharge, but from 3Q onwards they

again start doing it. I think it's 10%.

So, would that be impacting our margins on a sequential basis at least on EXIM, if you can take that?

Sanjay Swarup: The railway is levying busy season surcharge throughout the year now. So, they have not done any relaxation for Q2. But there is no cause of worry because whatever tariff increase that we had from November of last year that we are continuing. We have not revised our rates. So, there will not be any effect on margins.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Mukesh Saraf: The question is around EXIM growth. So, if I look at your origination values, they have grown around 3% this quarter. When I look at, say, the port volume growth at some of the major ports, obviously JNPT has grown at 15%, Mumbai at 12% in the 2nd Quarter. So, just trying to understand this gap is widening between our origination growth and the port volume growth. JNPT obviously you had mentioned that rail coefficients have been falling. But in Mundra, what we understand is rail coefficients have been going up as well. So, could you kind of throw some light on the gap between the growth numbers for us and at the port level, especially in Mundra kind of ports?

Sanjay Swarup: As a matter of fact, at Mundra port, the rail coefficient has come down, but our market share has increased. I will give you the numbers. For the first half of financial year, in Mundra port, last year rail coefficient was 25.79%. It has become now 23.82%. So, there is a downward trend as

far as rail coefficient is concerned. But our market share was 36.35%, which has now become 38.83%. Like I told in the opening remarks that our market share has grown by 248 basis points at Mundra port.

As far as Pipavav Port is concerned, there is a drastic fall in rail coefficient. Last year it was 64.55%. And this year the rail coefficient is 57.42%, whereas our market share has increased from 45.04% to 47.89%, which is a growth of 285 basis points. And all this we have achieved without sacrificing our margins. That is the beauty of it. So, our margins are intact. Margins have, in fact, increased. And we have increased our market share as well as increased our margins. So, that is a testimony of the relationship, excellent relationship that we have with our customers and the operational excellence shown by our team CONCOR.

Mukesh Saraf: If you could also give the same numbers for some of the other major ports like Chennai?  
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Sanjay Swarup: I don't have numbers for other ports, but I have for JNPT, Mundra and Pipavav, which I have already shared.

Mukesh Saraf: And the second question is, I think you had mentioned in the opening remarks and in the last quarter as well, that you are getting into these long-term contracts with shipping lines, maybe three-to-five-year kind of contracts. While we don't want the details in terms of the commercials, could you throw some light on pricing, etc? How these would work? Because these are volume-based contracts and would you have to kind of bid at attractive prices to get those higher volumes? How does this work usually?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, it's a very good question. Actually, what we are doing is, we are having long-term relationship with shipping lines and big shipping lines, we are, big as well as small, it is for all. Actually, as you may be knowing since last one or two years, the focus of the company is on providing total logistics solution to our customers. This is one of the focus area of the company. So, we have 4 million square feet of warehousing spaces at our 66 terminals across the country. We are building more warehouses.

Apart from that, we have become quite strong in FMLM also, first mile last mile. We are having 130 LNG trucks for FMLM and 200 more we are procuring.  
One more news I wanted to share

with all of you. The first LNG pump in North India of our country is going to be commissioned this month only, sorry, next month in November, mid November at our MMLP Kathuwas. So, because in North India we are constrained, we cannot deploy LNG trucks because there is no LNG pump, fuel pump. So, that is being commissioned by IOC in our terminal at Kathuwas.

So, we have had a series of meetings with shipping lines at Mumbai as well as through VC, and we offered our warehouses. We offered our first mile last mile, and we offer volume-based incentives. So, all these things we gave them as a package that you use our services and in turn it will be a win-win situation for shipping lines as well as for CONCOR. So, all these things, they are part of this agreement that we are having with shipping lines.

I visited the headquarter of Maersk, which is the second biggest shipping line in Copenhagen, Denmark, and they were quite excited when I told them about the green logistics, ESG norms being followed by our company and total business solutions. So, they have had internal discussions and all of them are coming forward to sign these agreements with us which are a comprehensive agreement. So, ultimately, we are going for giving total service to our customers, and in the process, we will increase our margins also.

Mukesh Saraf: So, we should expect these value-added services to go up vis-a-vis previous contracts to these new contracts that you are getting.

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Sanjay Swarup: Yes, that's right. We should expect more value-added services, correct.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia: I will go ahead with my questions. First is actually more of a clarification. This 40 crore provision that you have kind of reversed and that links to Whitefield, does it have any impact in the manner that your incremental land license fees will be calculated? Completely different and not to be linked up to future land license fee numbers?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no, it will not be linked up to the future. This is a provision we made expecting that this will be the LLF rate once we settle it with Indian Railways. Then whatever provision, if it is extra, then that has to be written back. That is what we have done. So, future, I don't think it will have any impact.

Aditya Mongia: Now if I then assume this to be a one-off, it seems that your margins are much lesser than 25% at an EBITDA level. I just wanted to understand when you kind of gave this guidance on the

interview, was this including other income that you were saying 25% or if it was not, if it was an EBITDA margin level before other income, then how do you bridge the gap from here on? Because today the margins are more like 23ish or so, if I take away this benefit.

Sanjay Swarup: As far as our, if you see the operating margin, operating margin is also quite high. It is a healthy operating margin. We have a 33.65% operating margin in this first half of financial year. Rail freight margin was around 28%. And one more thing is the exceptional item, Vivad Se Vishwas. That is 25 crore net of tax. So, if we take all these things into consideration, I am quite confident that 25% EBITDA levels can be maintained by the company.

Aditya Mongia: Yes, but this is including other income, just clarifying when you gave this number out, or excluding other income?

Sanjay Swarup: Of course, it includes other income also.

Aditya Mongia: So, that clarifies. As in just moving on to the other questions, I wanted to get a sense from you that this modal share coefficient issue is impacting assets that already have a DFC there. So, it is actually impacting somewhat JNPT, but a lot more Mundra and Pipavav. Should this be something that one should be worrying about? Will it reverse around? What are the drivers of it?

Because DFC should be supportive, right, over here. We are just trying to get a sense of why would this be happening and how to think for the future.

Sanjay Swarup: I am not able to understand your question. Can you please reframe it?

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Aditya Mongia: Typically, in Mundra and Pipavav, the modal coefficient should have gone up over time because the DFC has been connected for some time while it is going down. Could you give us a sense of what is happening leading to this situation?

Sanjay Swarup: So, now the Pipavav Port is mostly serving the hinterland, near Pipavav, so road becomes very competitive. Rail is not competitive for that short distance movement. For Mundra also, there is a lot of short distance movement, and apart from that, there is movement for this CFSs around Mundra. There are around 35 to 40 CFSs near Mundra port, where many shipping lines prefer that they de-stuff their containers and take the cargo by road, if they have urgency of containers near the ports. So, all these factors also affect the rail coefficient.

But of course, our endeavor is that maximum container should come to the hinterland for which we are creating so much assets. We continue talking to the trade and convincing them and many times it happens also that they shift their pattern from CFS to the hinterland ICDs. But lot of decision making is done by shipping lines.

Aditya Mongia: Just a couple of questions more from my side. First of all, your other income or your interest income, if I see the cash flows statement, has meaningfully gone up from 1Q to 2Q. Could you give us a sense of what is driving this and will this number again fall or be sustained at 2Q levels?

Sanjay Swarup: I will request my ED (Finance), Mr. Harish Chandra. He will take this question please.

Harish Chandra: You have rightly said, the other income, we have the income from interest, the dividend which we get from our subsidiaries, so these kind of income and the rental income, so this varies because the dividend received from the subsidiaries and joint ventures, it depends the receipt of the dividend. And then secondly, we have also received one refund from Income Tax Department. There was also some interest element in that. So, that is the reason that the increase in the other income is reflected. In last year, it was 102 crores, and this is 130 crores in this quarter. So, that is the reason. Mainly receipt of dividend as well as interest on the refund, income tax refund.

Aditya Mongia: Maybe a last question from my side. I think we now better understand JNPT because you are saying that you will do double stacking and give more predictability and pass on some savings to the customer. Could you give us a sense of how much the customer would be better off now when he makes a decision of choosing road and rail and what kind of savings would you be passing on to the customer once you have the Varnama terminal ready?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually I cannot disclose that at the moment, but I can give you some idea about it. First thing is that when the container goes on upper deck, railway charges 50% of rail haulage. So, that will be one of the savings that we will be having for 40 feet containers carrying lightweight cargo.

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So, just to give you an idea, when from Dadri to Mundra port we were running double-stack, when we started double-stack trains, we tweaked our tariff by 8% to 10% for this lightweight cargo and we had extra 12% to 15% traffic. So, maybe Nhava Sheva may be around that number only, but right now the exact numbers, it is not possible to give it to you.

Aditya Mongia: And is there any other terminal alongside Varnama which may also come up from a competitor perspective? Let's say, Viramgam for that matter, is that a similar offering of double-s

tacking

that is happening till Viramgam and then one goes to JNPT? Or are you the only one benefiting or going to benefit from this?

Sanjay Swarup: Viramgam is actually not on that route. Viramgam is a different, it will be taking off towards, it will be from Ahmedabad towards Mundra port. So, if you bring the train from North India to Nhava Sheva, Viramgam will not come in between. Viramgam will be a different route. From Ahmedabad to Mundra, in between you will get Viramgam. So, as of now, near Varnama, there is no such terminal which has connectivity to DFC as well as Indian Railways.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Srinidhi Karlikar from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Srinidhi Karlikar: Sir, just one clarification. Sir, did you say there was a busy season surcharge even during quarter 2?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, please.

Srinidhi Karlikar: So, in that context, sir, what has driven the sequential improvement in the rail freight margin? Because if I look at the rail freight cost as a percentage of revenue, there has been a sharp sequential improvement. May I ask what has really driven this?

Sanjay Swarup: This is due to the operational excellence of team CONCOR. As I told you, there is a growth in double-stacking. There is 11.5% growth in double-stack in the first half of this financial year.

This first half, we have handled 3083 double-stack trains as compared to 2766 double-stack trains last year. So, this has contributed in a big way for reducing the empty running which has positively affected the rail freight margin.

And secondly, the domestic also, we are getting a lot of loaded movement. Now empty movement has come down. In domestic, if you see, there is a 1.5% reduction in empty running which is a remarkable performance as compared to 143 crores last financial year. We have incurred empty running cost of 140.8 crores. So, there is a reduction of 1.5%. So, all these factors have positively impacted the rail freight margin, and it has improved by 80 basis points year-on-year. From 27.06%, it has gone to 27.85%.

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Srinidhi Karlikar: Sir, a lot of the factors that drove this improvement seem to be company specific. So, do you think this very healthy rail freight margin adjusted for the mixed changes you would be able to retain in the second half as well?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, of course, we will be able to retain it, and I think we will be able to improve upon it because we are bringing JNPT also on double-stack now, plus domestic we are seeing very good traction.

So, all these things will positively contribute, and the rail freight margin will further improve.

Srinidhi Karlikar: And sir, last one. I think the Director (Domestic) did highlight some changes like increases in domestic business prices. Have you taken any price hikes in the EXIM segment as well in recent months in some nodes?

Sanjay Swarup: No, EXIM we have not undertaken any price hikes because railways also not revised the prices, and domestic also we keep on changing. As such we have not done any, not across the board increase and we keep on revisiting because domestic is a dynamic pricing kind of thing. Road, it is a direct competition with roads. So, we keep on revisiting wherever we have to bring it down, wherever we have to increase. So, that is a continuous exercise by domestic division.

Srinidhi Karlikar: And sir, last one. How has been the first mile-last mile penetration now and where do you think it going up by next year?

Sanjay Swarup: In this financial year FY '25, we are targeting 50% of our business that we are giving should be on first mile, last mile. So, at present on pan-India basis around 27% to 30% we are able to achieve in the first half of this financial year, and we are continuously working to improve it and achieve the target of 50%, and next financial year we will set up a target of 80% of

our volume

should be first mile, last mile we will be able to give. And we are getting a very good margin also on this stream. For the first half of the financial year, we have got 35% increase in first mile, last mile as far as revenue terms is concerned.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Amit Bhide from Morgan Stanley. Please go ahead.

Amit Bhide: I wanted to understand that there was an announcement made in September that there would be some discounts provided on the storage charges, etc., to boost the EXIM trade. So, what would be the cost impact for us on the EXIM margins or increase in cost in other words?

Sanjay Swarup: Now I want to clarify, there is no concession on storage charges. It was in the media also. The thing is that we are already giving 90 days free storage for empty containers. For empty containers, we are giving 90, in EXIM I am talking, in empty containers we are giving 90 days free storage at all our terminals. And for loaded containers, we are giving free storage of 15 days. So, that is there for last one year. We have not changed it. There is no reduction or there is no



upward movement is there.  
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The thing that we revised was the empty handling charges at our terminal at Dronagiri. At Dronagiri, empty handling charges were in the range of 6,000 for 20 feet and 9,000 for 40 feet. So, that we have brought down. The reason was that at present, we have very miniscule empty inventory at our terminal at Dronagiri. So, we are intending that with this reduction in empty handling charges at Dronagiri, at only Dronagiri, we have brought it down. So, we will get lot of business. A lot of empty containers will come.

So, at present, suppose we are having an earnings of 0. So, at least we will get some earning. So, keeping that perspective in mind, we have revised the empty-handling charges, and there have been enquiries from shipping lines, and very soon they will be storing their empty containers at our terminal. So, that will be like extra earning for the company. It will not be a loss at all. And as per as empty storage time, I again want to clarify, it is still 90 days free time at all CONCOR terminals. This is there for last one year. There is no reduction in that.

Amit Bhinde: And how about the 50% reduction in the charge beyond 90 days? Was there already there? Or now that would come? Or beyond 90 days?

Sanjay Swarup: No, beyond 90 days, there is a uniform tariff. Then there is no reduction in charge.

Amit Bhinde: So, I think the news suggested that there would be 50% reduction.

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, yes, that is in media what was being shown was not in the correct perspective. So, it is good that you have asked this question. So, I hope it clarifies. If anybody has any doubt, they can ask more questions. I am ready to clarify.

Amit Bhinde: Sir, the second question that I have is your guidance as you were mentioning earlier. You mentioned that now the trends would be such that handling and originating would be growing in line itself. And there wouldn't be disparity. So, the guidance holds on both. But here we see that your domestic has grown at around 15% in handling and at around 22% in originating. So, now your guidance for full year, are you giving it on the originating basis or handling basis?

Sanjay Swarup: Handling.

Amit Bhinde: Handling basis, okay.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Koundinya from Jefferies. Please go ahead.

Koundinya: Sir, my first question is a bit on the macro side. Can you help me understand what is the thought process in extending this busy season surcharge? Because we clearly see that rail coefficient has been falling off across the ports. That's the first one. And the second one, can you help us understand what is driving this market share improvement for CONCOR? What are the key reasons, if you c

an elaborate, please?

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Sanjay Swarup: See, for the first question, I am not the best person to answer this question, because this was done by the Ministry of Railways. But to be fair to them, for the last 8 years, they have not increased the rail haulage charges. So, 10% increase, I don't think it was very much unjustified, I should say. But of course, the quantum was very high, that immediately it stopped the trade. That is my reply on the first question.

As far as the second question is concerned, this increase in market share is due to the customer centricity policy that we have been following for the last one, one-and-a-half years. Plus the operational innovations, operational excellence that has been done by my team, operational team at CONCOR. These are the two reasons, primary reasons for increase in market share with corresponding increase in margin. There is no drop in margin also.

Koundinya: Sir, lastly, if you can also briefly touch base on some of the initiatives, because you spoke in one of the Con Calls that you are offering specific, you are giving specific offers to certain corporate groups. Can you provide some update on that and what is the current status?

Sanjay Swarup: See, we are PSU. So, we cannot have a one-to-one offer that is valid for one customer, it will not be valid for another customer. What we do is we design our schemes and based on the volume slabs, so whichever customer crosses that slabs, they are eligible to avail of that scheme. We are not designing a scheme for a particular customer. We can't do that because we are a public sector company.

So, we have been doing it for so many years, like volume discount schemes, if you give more volume you get more discount. If your incremental volume is more, you get more discounts. So, there are so many schemes like that, that we are doing it for exports, imports, throughout our ICDs as well as domestic.

Domestic we have business-associates policy. So, if they give more business, they become Platinum category. Then there is the gold category. Below that, Silver category, Bronze

category. So, it is all the thing about whatever volume you are giving and what is the incremental volume as compared to last year. These are the two basic criteria that give incentive to our customers.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Sumit Kishore from Axis Capital. Please go ahead.

Sumit Kishore: In your opening remarks, you mentioned that EXIM volume growth of 3.5% was pretty much in line with India's international trade growth, export growth of 1%, import growth of 6%. So, for the second half, when we are expecting a strong double-digit growth, what sort of macro export-import growth numbers you are thinking about for the country to grow at, which if they don't materialize, your guidance would be at risk?

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Sanjay Swarup: See, I can talk about only CONCOR's. Country, I think Honorable Commerce Minister will be the, you can ask this question to him. But as far as my business is concerned, I have already highlighted the growth drivers, and I am focusing on that. Of course, it is all driven by the policies of Government of India. So, we are hopeful to achieve our target whatever we gave to us at the start of the financial year.

Sumit Kishore: So, I think the objective was to basically check if all India export-import growth were in a similar range, your growth drivers won't get impacted as much, you would still manage your double-digit growth because of Varnama and other initiatives that you have outlined.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, I think that is what I meant also.

Sumit Kishore: That's very clear. The second question is on the double-stacking numbers that you have given of 11.5% growth and 3,083 rakes being double-stacked. What percentage of your ove

rall rake

movement on the DFC now is double-stacked? The idea is to understand how much of the potential of double-stacking has already been tapped when it comes to, say, Mundra, Pipavav. I know JNPT would still be pending, but this question is more to understand what potential of double-stacking has already been tapped by CONCOR.

Sanjay Swarup: See, if you see on DFC, we are giving double-stack benefit at Mundra and Pipavav. So, I can say that the total volume that we are running on DFC, around 70% to 75% is double-stacked.

Sumit Kishore: So, pretty much this is a fairly high level of double-stacking which has already been achieved.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, that's right.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Akshay Ajmera from Nirzar Securities. Please go ahead.

Sanjay Swarup: I think this conference call is for one hour or more?

Moderator: Sir, we will take this as the last question, sir.

Akshay Ajmera: Sir, this question is regarding the news announcement made by our Commerce Minister Mr. Piyush Goyal in September, and I think this question was already taken up by you, but a part of it I want to understand more from you. So, on that press conference, which was basically to facilitate increase or ease of doing for the exporters of our country. So, the intent was to reduce the tariffs and provide logistic solutions to them. How do you see this going forward?

Because the intent of the government is to give and pass on benefits to the exporter so that they can export more, at the same time to reduce the logistic costs. This has been reiterated by the government and ministers of the government various times, that their intention is to reduce the overall logistics costs in this country. So, how do you see this pressure coming to you in terms

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of reducing costs, passing on the cost benefit, like you are talking about double-stacking, DFCC and all these things? But how this will improve the margins? Because I think it can give us some volume, but at the same time, whatever cost is there, you have to pass on to the customer.

And in the same meeting, they have also slashed your empty container charges, handling charges. This is what we have read from the news article. So, if you can clarify about how much impact you had, and what is your thinking on their intentions going forward.

Sanjay Swarup: See, now, actually, as far as the empty storage charges, as I clarified earlier, they are 90 days free at all our terminals for the last one year. They were not done after this meeting. And secondly, the handling charges we had reduced only at one terminal. That is Dronagiri. At all other terminals, the handling charges remain the same. We have not reduced it.

Akshay Ajmera: So, what could be the potential impact of that? Because 33% of the volume has come from Dronagiri, if I am not wrong.

Sanjay Swarup: How much percent?

Akshay Ajmera: 33% of our volumes.

Sanjay Swarup: No, Dronagiri hardly contributes less than 1% of our volume.

Akshay Ajmera: Volumes, okay.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, it is nothing actually. So, at present, the impact is zero. There is no impact at all. And

because we are yet to receive empty containers from shipping lines at our Dronagiri terminal, which is near JNPT, so we have not started getting the container, so impact is zero. So, we are expecting in the next 10-15 days, they will be using this facility. Then we will get some revenue, because imagine we were not getting any revenue. Now at least we will get some revenue. So, it will be gain for the company. It will not be a loss for the company. Media article was giving some other impression. So, I wanted to clarify now to all of you that it will be gain for the company, that from zero revenue we are going to get some revenue.

Apart from that, for the last one year, we have started a scheme of 25% concession on empty

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container movement from gateway ports to hinterland ICDs. This was done to promote exports. But we were offsetting this concession in terms of some charges that we had at terminals. And we are continuing with those charges. So, there is no loss of margin on that account. And because of the more empty container movement at our terminals, because of these concessions, we were getting exports, additional exports. So, it was additional income for the company. That is quite evident in our numbers also.

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As I told you, we have increased our market share, but we have not sacrificed our margins. Margins have also increased, and market share has also increased. This is because of the policy that the company has been following. We don't believe in sacrificing our margin to gain market share. We believe in giving good service to our customers so that the customer stays with us despite there are some... we may be expensive, but our service that we give to customer is of international standards.

So, remember we evacuate the containers from the ports immediately. The dwell time is less than 30 hours, whereas our competitor's dwell time is 30 days. So, there is a huge gap between service levels. So, customer is willing to pay more to get good service. So, that has been the philosophy of our company, and that will remain for the future also.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Due to time constraints, that was the last question. I would now like to hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair for closing comments. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Thank you, everyone, and particularly the management for giving us an opportunity to host the call. And wishing you all the very best and a very Happy Diwali, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you very much, Bhoomika. Same to you and your team.

Moderator: On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No. Name Phone Company

- 1 Host: Bhoomika Nair 2242022561 Dam Capital Advisors
- 2 Host: Management 1141673000 Container Corporation Of India Limited
- 3 Aakash 9892138178 Canara Hsbc Life
- 4 Abhinav Bhandari 9699358293 Sohum Asset Managers Private Limited
- 5 Abhishek Sanghavi 9969987152 Pragya Equity
- 6 Abin 66242413 M K Global
- 7 Achal Lohade 9136727590 Nuvama
- 8 Aditi 9821447626 Abakus Asset Manager private Limited
- 9 Aditya Mongia 2243360884 Kotak Securities
- 10 Ajit Motwani 9820934229 Dymond Asia
- 11 Akhilesh Bhandari 442086096838 Millinunum Capital
- 12 Aksah Kumar 7208838564 LIC
- 13 Akshay 9625580449 Informist
- 14 Akshay Ajmera 9870624556 Nirzar Securities Llp
- 15 Akshya 7208211260 Asian Market
- 16 Ali Khan 12064299176 Nexa
- 17 Alov Devra 9820513792 Motilal Oswal
- 18 Aman Agarwal 8697218375 Carnelian Capital
- 19 Ameen Tirami 61573583 J P Morgan
- 20 Amish 66328656 Bank Of America
- 21 Amit Bhinde 2261181031 Morgan Stanley
- 22 Amit Dixit 9839043382 ICICI
- 23 Amit Goyal 9820517779 Amit Ventures
- 24 Amit Khurana 2240969754 Dolat Capital
- 25 Amit Kumar 8898708990 Determined Investments
- 26 Amruta 9969053166 Wealth Managers

27 Anifa 9821931519 Dam Capital Advisors  
28 Anil Bagadia 9757494130 Equicorp  
29 Anish 9820563345 UTI Mutual Fund  
30 Anishwer 7506161740 Pioneer Investcorp  
31 Ankit Jain 67800305 Mirae Asset  
32 Ankita Shah 9820679464 Elara Capital  
33 Anshuh Agrawal 66121228 Emkay Global  
34 Anurag 9650806954 Individual Investor  
35 Areen 7977572598 Rb Investments  
36 Arman 8319790530 Blue Sky Capital  
37 Arun 9087779152 Capital Market  
38 Ashish 9324233832 Individual Investor  
39 Ashish Shah 6597265952 Millilium Capital  
40 Ayush Sabarjeet 8097436847 Whiteoak  
41 Bharati C Sawant 9004192576 Dam Capital Advisors  
42 Bharti Sawant 67800306 Mirae Asset  
43 Bijoy Shah 9867207988 Tara Capital  
44 Darshan 9930609141 Informist  
45 Deepak Gupta 2242147104 SBI Pension Funds  
46 Deepak Kumar 7838341823 Fedility

47 Deven 9820280686 Sage Investment  
48 Devendar Sariipelli 4041970088 S&P Global  
THANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US  
Participants List  
Total 159 Participants including the Speakers.  
October 30, 2024 at 11:30 Hrs India Time  
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| Sr. No. | Name                | Phone       | Company                                |
|---------|---------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------|
| 49      | Dishi Giria         | 9324791509  | Ashika                                 |
| 50      | Gauran Kedia        | 9830108977  | Individual Investor                    |
| 51      | Gaurav Narayan      | 9820073819  | Saltoro Investments                    |
| 52      | Gautam              | 9819701801  | Mirzar Enterprises                     |
| 53      | Harini Kumar        | 9434225692  | Individual Investor                    |
| 54      | Harsh Dole          | 9967581549  | Optiva                                 |
| 55      | Harshal Mehta       | 9967568857  | ITI Mutual Fund                        |
| 56      | Harshit             | 9007036570  | Nuvama Institutional                   |
| 57      | Hemanshu Srivastava | 7506748289  | Taurus Mutual Fund                     |
| 58      | Hemant Shah         | 69153547    | ITI Mutual Fund                        |
| 59      | Hiten Udeshi        | 9820036204  | Individual Investor                    |
| 60      | Hitesh Jhaveri      | 2262074401  | Axis Mutual Fund                       |
| 61      | Jainam Shah         | 6353378861  | Equirus Securities                     |
| 62      | Jainam Shah         | 8758759924  | Equirus Securities                     |
| 63      | Jayshree            | 16578375417 | London Stock Exchange Group            |
| 64      | Jignesh Mackwana    | 9930122599  | Asian Market Securities                |
| 65      | Jinesh Kothari      | 9727001077  | Elara Capital                          |
| 66      | Jonas Bhutta        | 9819222287  | Birla Mutual Fund                      |
| 67      | Kartik              | 9990134412  | Container Corporation Of India Limited |
| 68      | Kenil Kadakiya      | 9821514702  | Sundaram Mutual Fund                   |
| 69      | Koundinya           | 2242246159  | Jefferies                              |
| 70      | Krupashankar        | 9884128127  | Avendus Spark                          |
| 71      | Kunal Mehta         | 9769004293  | Janthor Partner                        |
| 72      | Lavina Quardz       | 2242246116  | Jafferries                             |
| 73      | Lavish              | 9004973083  | Sushil Finance                         |
| 74      | Laxminarayanan      | 9789951580  | KSEMA – Wealth Management              |
| 75      | Lokesh Garg         | 61556038    | UBS Securities India Private Limited   |
| 76      | Mandar Pawar        | 2262185279  | Kotak Mahindra Asset Management        |
| 77      | Manish Gupta        | 6585134023  | Individual Investor                    |
| 78      | Manoj Bagadia       | 9821083147  | Equicorp                               |
| 79      | Mayur Magar         | 7028585756  | Bandhan Life                           |
| 80      | Mehul Chawla        | 7977909377  | R W Equity                             |
| 81      | Mohit Jain          | 7400195462  | Tara Capital                           |
| 82      | Mukesh Saraf        | 9840016171  | Avendus Spark                          |
| 83      | Nandish Shah        | 8097603295  | Neo Wealth                             |
| 84      | Nikhil Jain         | 8866684989  | Crisil                                 |
| 85      | Nilotpal Sahu       | 9355735975  | BNP Paribas                            |
| 86      | Nirmal Gopi         | 13322457667 | Goldman Sachs                          |
| 87      | Nirmal Murarka      | 8240095715  | V2 Capital                             |

88 Nitin Gandhi 9821359091 Individual Investor  
89 Paresh Dave 6598380755 Balyasny Ams  
90 Parth 7977050966 J M Financial  
91 Pranali Patil 61047506 Individual Investor  
92 Pratik 9833755318 Alpha  
93 Pritesh 7021526759 ICICI  
94 Priyankar Vishwas 8657737455 BNP Paribas  
95 Pulkit Patni 9820107735 Goldman Sachs  
96 Rachel Smith 17812306877 Aiera  
97 Raghu 6596279496 Bam Capital  
98 Rajarsai Maitra 9820637133 Incred  
99 Rajvi Shah 8767224443 Bright Securities  
100 Rakshak 8197162711 Kivah Advisors  
101 Ratish Varier Ratish Varier 7823976240 Sundaram Mutual Fund  
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103 Renita 9773335514 ICICI  
104 Rishabh Gupta 9900696860 Goldman Sachs  
105 Ritik Dhiman 66323075 Bank of America  
106 Ritika 9910097857 JP Morgan  
107 Rohan 9870041211 Axis Capital  
108 Rohit 9870448599 Progressive Shares  
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Sr. No. Name Phone Company  
109 Rohit Jain 6289550527 Tara Capital  
110 Roshan Pawar 9892721423 City Group  
111 Rupam Jaiswal 6289899866 Investwell  
112 Rushabh Sheth 9833133428 Karma Capital Advisors  
113 Sachin Upadhyay 69106000 Klay  
114 Sagar Shirke 61291553 Motilal Oswal  
115 Sahil Kadam 17029131499 Global Solutions  
116 Sameer Deshpande 9960621718 Fairdeal Investments  
117 Sandeep Mamnn 4424679216 Frankling Templaton  
118 Sandesh Shetty 9082589149 HSBC Bank India  
119 Santosh Kumar 15103907767 Bloomberg  
120 Saras Singh 9930440712 Haitong Securities  
121 Saurabh Chugh 9820117499 Salto Investments  
122 Shah 4041970000 S&P Global  
123 Shalya Shah 7977349982 Kotak Life  
124 Shantanu Pawar 37514752 Individual Investor  
125 Sheena 85291631120 TRP Co  
126 Shey Gandhi 9589915521 CRS  
127 Shiva Hari Raman 9620767145 Pinpoint Amc  
128 Shobhit Tiwari 2266585681 Canara Robeco Mutual Fund  
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133 Sonu Upadhyay 7208798028 Motilal Oswal  
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bir Samadder 8777431404 HDFC Pension  
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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

## A Multi-modal Logistics Company

(A Navratna CPSE of Govt. of India)

No.CON/F& CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No.91029/NoteNo.28/~: 07.02.2025

1. The Bombay Stock Exchange Ltd., Mumbai (Through BSE Listing Centre)

Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Dalal Street

Mumbai-400001

2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (Through NEAPS)

Exchange Plaza, 5th Floor, Plot No. C/1,G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex, Sandra (E)

Mumbai-400 051

Dear Sir/Madam,

~ : Disclosure under SEBI (Listing Obligatio n & Disclosure Requirements )

Regulations , 2015.

Pursuant to applicable provisions of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find

enclosed transcript of Post results conference call held on 31.01.2025.

For your information and record please.

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Page 1 of 16

“Container Corporation of India Limited

Q3 FY25 Earnings Conference Call”

January 31, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING  
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS & SERVICES) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR  
(DOMESTIC ) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. PRIYA RANJAN PARHI – DIRECTOR  
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING & OPERATIONS ) –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. ANURAG KAPIL – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. HARISH CHANDRA – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR  
(FINANCE) & COMPANY SECRETARY AND CFO -  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

**MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS LIMITED**

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Q3 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call of Container Corporation of India Limited hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Thanks, Rutuja. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q3 '25 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director and his entire team. I'll now hand over the floor to Mr. Swarup for his initial remarks, post which, we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Good morning to all. I am joined by my Directors, Director Projects, Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda, Director, Domestic; Mr. Azhar Shams, Director, International Marketing and Operations, Mr. Priya Ranjan Parhi; and Director, Finance, Mr. Anurag Kapil. So I just would like to make some opening remarks, and then we can open for questions.

I'm happy to inform that there has been a throughput growth of 7.8% in the 9-month period ending on December 31, 2024, in which EXIM registered a growth of 5% and domestic stream registered a growth of 7.8%. This is in confirmative with India's international trade, in which exports have registered a growth of 1.6% to \$327.7 billion and imports registered a growth of 5.1% i.e. \$532.48 billion year-on-year. In Q3, our company registered a growth of 11.6% over the corresponding period of last financial year, which included EXIM growth of 8% and domestic growth of 24.7%. This has been in spite of supply chain disruptions at international level due to the various geopolitical reasons, of which you are very much familiar.

I am further happy to inform that we gained an EXIM market share also in Pan-India basis by 73 basis points. And at Mundra Port, we gained market share by 180 basis points. And at the Pipavav Port, we gained market share by 278 basis points. This is despite our increasing the rail freight margin. Also, we did not sacrifice on any margins while gaining the market share. Our rail freight margin increased by 15 basis points year-on-year from 25.61% to 25.76%. Operating margin was flat, same year-on-year, more than 30%. And the reasons for the increase in market share is customer centricity that is being observed by all the officials of the company. Customers have reposed faith in our company. And secondly, due to the operational excellence of Team CONCOR. Further, we had operating income growth of 4.23% and PAT growth of 3.6% despite challenges on geopolitical front.

We also registered a growth of 11.25% in double stack rakes. Last year, we did 4,142 double stack rakes in the 9 months. And this year, we have done 4,608 double stack rakes. For catering to our demand, which is increasing day by day, we have added infrastructure. In the 9 months, Container Corporation of India Limited  
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we have commissioned 4 rakes. Now our total fleet stands at 382. As on December 31, we procured 6,868 containers, and now our total fleet of containers in domestic stream owned by us is 51,236 containers.

Then yesterday, Board of Directors deliberated the various demand, which we are catering and future demand, which is very, very robust. And seeing into the demand, Board of Directors have decided that we will increase our capex by 40%. It was a -- capex budget for this financial year was INR610 c

rores. Out of which, already INR444 crores we have achieved. Now we have revised it upward 40% to INR855 crores that we will be spending by this year-end.

And company is going for a massive infrastructure creation. I'm happy to inform that by 2028, that is 3 years from now, we will be having 80 terminals. We will be having 500-plus rakes ownership by CONCOR, and we will be having around 70,000 container fleets. So this will be a massive infrastructure upgradation, which we are doing, keeping in the demand in the market and a lot of demand is there. We have to meet the demand and the outlook is quite bullish by the company.

And I'm also happy to inform that we have declared an interim dividend of INR4.25 on share of par value INR5. So till now, we have declared a total interim dividend of INR9.50, which is 190% of the par value.



As you are very well aware that the business in logistics is deeply impacted by challenging geopolitical scenario. International supply chains are getting adversely affected. Kinetic vessel schedule there are congestion at transshipment ports. All these factors had led to a small dip in the month of December. And now if fully recovered in the current quarter, we are experiencing a double-digit growth. And even then, in the 9 months, we have registered handsome growth in exports and imports, exports in RMG, ready-made garments, increased by 92%, export of auto parts increased by 21%, export of our food items, 22%; paper products, 20%, fabrics, 37%. In imports, auto parts increased by 34%, raw cotton increased by 77%. Rail Services, we have started export reefer containers from Sadi Patli to JNPT and in which we have already done 442 TEUs of movement.

And one more thing is that we have brought Nhava Sheva on double stack for North India by running the double-stack space up to MMLP Varnama, which is near Baroda. That's 400 kilometers short of JNPT. So even DFC has not been commissioned up to JNPT, it will be likely to be commissioned by December 2025. And we have already given the benefit of our North India customer. And I think a very good response. From December, we have started these services, and we are ramping up very good volume in this stream.

One more thing is that we have started new rail services at Gangavaram port and which is in Andhra Pradesh. And already, we have done 700 TEUs we have on Gangavaram port. Focus area for the company. In the end, customer centricity, total logistics solution to customers, business solutions and green and sustainable logistics, which is a key focus area for the company towards fulfilling of our ESG norms. New initiatives will be growth drivers in the coming

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months will be the very big growth driver. It will be the bulk cement in tank containers. We are procuring 1,000 tank containers.

Okay. Now let's just -- I will take one more minute. The new initiatives, which will be the growth drivers for the company in the coming months will be bulk cement in tank containers. We are procuring 1,000 tank containers. And from yesterday, we have started receiving the supply of tank containers from our sister PSU Braithwaite, and they have started supplying tank containers to us. In the coming months, this will be a very big growth driver in the domestic stream. Even our customers are eagerly waiting for this.

Then second will be double stacked to JNPT that I already told on DFC. Then we are -- we have signed various long-term agreements with our corporate customers and shipping lines, which will further push up our volumes. Then we have rice exports, which is quite robust now. So we are getting very good demand, very good volumes in EXIM and domestic both. And we are on the correct track to achieve the historic 5 million TEUs handling targets that we will be having in this financial year. I'm quite confident that we will be able to achieve 5

million TEUs, which

will be the landmark for the company. First time we will be achieving that target.

So these are -- this is all opening remark from me. Now you can put up questions.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities.

Amit Dixit: I have a couple of questions. The first one is on the capex. So while you highlighted that we will have 80 terminals, 500 rakes, 70,000 containers, is it possible to let us know a cumulative capex number till FY '28 FY '26, '27, '28 if I add all the. And this INR855 crores revised budget, now we have already spent INR440 crores, and just two months are remaining in the year, so are you confident that we will spend this entire amount or something will flow through in FY '26? That is the first question.

Sanjay Swarup: No, actually, we -- I am giving you estimate about this financial year. That will be INR855 crores. All I can say is, for the next 3 years also in the same range we will be spending. If you remember some 4, 5 years back, we used to spend INR1,000 crores every year. So figure will be remaining around this number. Exact number is not possible to give at this stage.

Secondly, as I told you, INR444 crores, we have spent only to December 31st. And January is already now getting over. So that number I have already not told you. So for this quarter, we will be spending the remaining amount. We are quite confident. That is why we have revised the budget. We are quite confident of spending that much amount.

Amit Dixit: Okay, sir. The second question is essentially on the growth. So what -- given that January is already behind us and you mentioned that in January, you have seen certain growth uptick. So what kind of volume growth can we expect in Q4 in both domestic and EXIM side?

Sanjay Swarup: At this stage, I would not like to give any numbers, but all I can say is the -- both EXIM and domestic, domestic, of course, has done very well. They are experiencing double-digit growth. But EXIM is also having double-digit growth in the month of January, which I'm quite confident is likely to continue up to March. I will not like to give any number at this stage.

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Moderator: The next question is from the line of Lavina Quadros from Jefferies.

Lavina Quadros: Sir, just wanted to understand two or three things. Your depreciation is lower by INR80 crores approximate run rate. INR25 crores, I understand, is because of the depreciation policy change.

What about the balance INR50 crores? Is it a sustainable reduction because of a quarterly basis?

Secondly, our realization in EXIM was down about 10%, right? I know you addressed it a little bit, but just a little more color there, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Realization because of the -- volumes were down that I told you because of supply chain disruptions were there in the international movement because of geopolitical reasons. That is why we could not do very well in EXIM in this Q3. But now everything is back to normal. And in fact, we are getting very good volumes in EXIM. So for depreciation, I will request my ED Finance he will explain this in details.

Harish Chandra: Good morning. You said that depreciation has come down by INR25 crores. That is correct. This is for the quarter, this reduction is there. But if we see for the period, the impact of the change in the age of our useful life of our wagon, the impact is INR79 crores. So effectively, our wagon depreciation for the current quarter is INR12.5 crores. And for the period, it is INR36.7 crores. So this is the clarification.

Lavina Quadros: So you're effectively saying I should look at the 9-month depreciation trend not focus so much on the quarter, right, for the trend ahead?

Harish Chandra: Yes, yes.

Lavina Quadros: That's the way to look at it. Okay. Just...

Harish Chandra: It's clearly stated in the note also. So if you see the

note to the results, that has been clarified, the impact in the quarter as well as in the period.

Lavina Quadros: Understood. And sir, just one more thing. This -- on this realization, would it be fair to say that because volumes were weak, maybe some benefits, some pricing changes were made, which should, therefore, be corrected as volumes gradually pick up ahead? Would that be fair to say?

Sanjay Swarup: No. We have not done any pricing change. Normally, whatever prices we declare, we keep it stable. We frequently don't go for pricing change. So pricing changes were not done. It was purely as a result of volumes.

Lavina Quadros: Okay. And sir, lastly, if you exit DFC, right, I mean, if I look at a 3, 5-year period, what do you think is the volume growth that you could see without DFC organically? And would that be different once JNPT connects, if I look out 3 to 5 years?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, whenever we make our assessment for the forecast, what will be for 3 to 5 years, we have to take DFC into picture. Without DFC, making a forecast will not be realistic because DFC is coming in 1 year. So realistic forecast can only be made if we take DFC into picture. So with DFC, so very good volume growth numbers I cannot share right now.

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But all I can say is that future is very good, and we have been talking to trade. Even running double stack up to Varnama is giving us a very good response, and trains are reaching quite quickly and double-stacking and the evacuation from port is also very fast. So these benefits are going -- we are seeing the benefits. If Nhava Sheva also connects -- gets connected on DFC and with the CSS second terminal also coming up, it will have a capacity of 10 million TEUs. Nhava Sheva can handle 10 million TEUs now. So there is very good growth expected in the coming months.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Kaustav Bubna from BMSPL Capital.

Kaustav Bubna: Sir, my question was regarding the DFC only. So could you explain to me a little bit about how much of a detail you can, providing data points of your knowledge. About the market opportunity that's opening up for your company as the DFC becomes operational over the next couple of years?

Sanjay Swarup: DFC is going to be a game changer. I will just give you some data. Like Mundra port, when it is now connected to DFC and feeder loop and our Dadri terminal is also connected to DFC. Now Dadri -- from Dadri to Mundra port, there's a distance of 1,200 kilometers. Road is taking 55 hours to send one container from Dadri to Mundra Port. Whereas DFC, as a result of DFC, we are running timetable trains which are called Freight Express. We are able to take -- we are able to send the container in 38 hours from Mundra Port to -- from Dadri to Mundra Port.

So containers are catching their schedule, and it is very fast. And we have doing our rates also. We are doing some commercial benefits to customers. So as a result of operational as well as commercial benefits, there is a sizable shift, almost 11% to 15% shift from road to rail between

Dadri and Mundra Port.

Now when Nhava Sheva also gets connected on DFC, which is approximately 1,500 kilometers from Delhi, that will be a game changer in logistics period. And for the national rail plan also, which is -- which was done by Indian Railways, they are expecting a rail coefficient of almost 40% to 45%, which is, at present, 18% to 19% at Nhava Sheva. So it is going to be a game changer in the field of logistics.

Our company is also going to derive a lot of benefit from that because we have already commissioned 5 MMLPs -- 4 MMLPs on DFC, fifth one is under commissioning. So all these 5 MMLPs will cater to the growing demand in hinterland. And we will be running timetable trains in the collaboration with DFC and Indian railways, connecting our MMLPs to Nhava Sheva. So this time,

because of its predictability and transit assurance, this is a very big thing in logistic.

Once it is given to customers, then we are expecting a very good shift from road to rail.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors.

Bhoomika Nair: Sir, if you could just share first the originating volumes for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Okay. Originating volume in EXIM was 975243 TEUs; domestic, 309551 TEUs; total 1284794 TEUs. Sorry, this is handling, and originating EXIM 525812, domestic, 117644; and total 643456 TEUs.

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Bhoomika Nair: Right. Now so this -- just to understand this drop in realizations. While obviously, volumes have been a bit of a challenge, particularly in EXIM, but the realization drop has got to do with some mix change, the distance is falling or exactly what has driven this decline in the realization because you said there has not been any drop or any changes in our pricing strategy, per se.

Sanjay Swarup: So the only reason is the drop in volumes. And there's no other reason that comes to my mind because lead is also our lead in EXIM, they just slightly dip, slight -- they've been 9 months, it has come down from 708 kilometers to 704, only 4-kilometer dip is there. Not much dip is there in the lead. So only the reason is drop in volumes.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. Sir, in terms of the overall -- as we move ahead in terms of the volume pickup, you said that January has seen an uptick in terms of volume. Now for the full year, we were already looking at a much sharper growth. Will this now be kind of toned down? And what is your outlook, especially from FY '26 perspective that we could look at?

Sanjay Swarup: See, FY '25, I would not like to give any further guidance because now only one quarter is remaining. And whatever we were expecting because of the geopolitical disturbances, we could not reach that number in EXIM. In domestic, of course, we'll be reaching that number. But FY '26, let us wait for 2, 3 months more. I will give a guidance in my next call.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure. So sir, I mean, are we seeing an improvement in the overall EXIM cycle? And do you think growth can come back out here? And particularly, the road rail share had gone adverse a little bit. Have we started to now start seeing volumes come back to rail in general?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes. We are seeing a very good growth in EXIM also and domestic also. And there is a lot of demand which is there in the market, and very robust growth we are expecting. That is why keeping all these things in mind, the Board of Directors had decided that we will increase our capex spend now. And I think we will be able to sustain around this number only for the next 2, 3 years. There is a lot of demand in the market.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure, sir. And lastly, may I have the empty running for both EXIM and domestic, please, for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. For the quarter, you want for this 9-month period?

Bhoomika Nair: Anything will do, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, 9-month period, EXIM was INR89.70 crores and domestic was INR220.92 crores, total INR310.61 crores.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama Wealth.

Achal Lohade: Sir, can you help us with the market share port wise, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Market share at JNPT, our market share is 58%; at Mundra Port, it is 38%; at Pipavav, it is 48%.

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Achal Lohade: And is it possible to get the market share for the -- this is 9 months, I presume, right, sir? Or this is for the third quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: This is for 9 months period.

Achal Lohade: 9 months, okay. And in terms of the port mix, if you could help us with?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. The volumes that we are getting on port?

Achal Lohade: Yes, yes.

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. JNPT, we are

getting 33%; Mundra port, 38%, Pipavav, 10%; Visakhapatnam, 5.5%; Chennai, 3.8%; Vallarpadam 4.5%. I think that should be enough. Almost 95% I've told.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Sir, if I put the originating volume along with the revenue number, the segment revenue, I see that the realization for domestic has gone up from 56,000 to 69,000 quarter-on-quarter. Can you help us understand what has driven this? Is there a significant change in terms of the mix or anything, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Basically, it is because of the reduction in empty running in domestic. We are getting very good circuits and traffic on both the sides. And our domestic team has worked very hard. And one very good initiative that we took was, the containers which were coming -- running empty in empty direction, we have given very competitive rates so that at least we get some money. So all these steps have really given excellent results and you can see the realization gaining in domestic.

Achal Lohade: Right. Sir, just one question, if I may. Overall market share, would you have -- what was it in 2Q? And what is it in 3Q, sir? Overall market share on the CTO basis, overall rail volume?

Sanjay Swarup: I got it. I have for 9-months period, I can give. Quarterly, I don't have.

Achal Lohade: Yes.

Sanjay Swarup: For 9-months period, I can give. Our EXIM market share is 55.28%, and domestic, it is 58%, total 56%.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And just last question, if I may, sir. You mentioned about Varnama. You've started the train from JNPT. Is it possible to get some sense in terms of what is the benefit in terms of A, the operational side? And B, on the financial side, what kind of price reduction or cost reduction one can look at?

Sanjay Swarup: See, it has both the benefits, operational as well as commercial, I will tell you in brief. Mundra Port -- sorry, Dadri from where we are running the service and Kathuwas, these are the two MMLPs in North India from where we are running double-stack service to Varnama.

From there, if we run on double-stack speed, which is because up to DFC, up to Varnama, it is going on DFC, which is giving a very good speed to us. And almost -- in Indian railways, we Container Corporation of India Limited

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are getting a speed of around 20-kilometer per hour, whereas from Dadri to Varnama, if we run on DFC, then we get an average speed of 65 to 70-kilometer per hour, which is almost 3x speed. So it is taking 1/3 of the time in reaching Varnama.

At Varnama, we split into 2. And this double stack has done -- is made a single stack train up to Nhava Sheva for the last 400 km of the journey. So it is giving us the benefit in terms of transit time, number one.

Number two, commercially also, we have not revised our tariff till now. So we are just -- we just started in the month of December. So we have not revised our tariff. But because on the upper deck, we have to pay 50% of rail haulage to Indian railways, so it is making a positive contribution towards my bottom line at present.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And sorry, one more question, sir. Is it possible to get a sense as to how much of the JNPT volume is destined for North India? And how much of that is going on rail?

Sanjay Swarup: See, at this moment, it will not be possible for me to elaborate on this question, but I can answer you separately afterwards.

Achal Lohade: Thank you. I'll fall back in the queue for follow up.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Mukesh Saraf: Thank you for the opportunity. Sir, you mentioned about the rail coefficients in this quarter. And what I see is it has largely stayed the same, say over the last few quarters. And when I look at the port volumes, the container volume growth at say, Mundra or JNPT, it is up double digit in this quarter as well. It's up 10% or so. But our originati

ng volumes are flat this quarter.

So just trying to understand, our originating volumes are flat, but the port volumes are up and the rail coefficients are flat. This either points out to a market share loss, but you're clearly saying that you've gained market share or have kept it flat. So could you help understand the relationship between these three data points, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Actually, you are not comparing the corresponding data. The rail coefficient numbers that I told you, that are not for the quarter, that are for the 9 months period. And market share, also I'm telling you for the 9-months period. And there has been a drop in volumes in the third quarter only. If you see 9-months period, our volumes in fact, have increased. And so that is the reason.

Mukesh Saraf: So if I look at -- I mean, obviously you have not given this quarter numbers, but this quarter probably there have been a drop in market share, so then?  
Sanjay Swarup: Not exactly because actually, volumes were -- in this quarter, the volumes were not very good. So everybody has experienced a drop, not only CONCOR. So market share drop is not there in this quarter.  
Mukesh Saraf: Okay. So there's a rail coefficient drop in this quarter basically?  
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Sanjay Swarup: No, no. Inward entry port has also come down  
Mukesh Saraf: Okay. All right. Sir, I'll probably try and ask this question later on.  
Sanjay Swarup: We'll take this separately; we can discuss this in detail.  
Mukesh Saraf: Thanks a lot, sir. That's it from my side.  
Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sumit Kishore from Axis Capital. Please go ahead.  
Sumit Kishore: Sir, over the past 3 quarters, we have been listening to your commentary around drivers of volume growth around the Varnama double-stacked trains NCR to Varnama. We have been hearing about the transportation of cement in tank containers and the pickup in rice exports. So exactly how much volume in these three buckets are you likely to clock or expect to clock? Could you give some sense in terms of TEUs in these three categories would be very useful, say, over the next 1 year.  
Sanjay Swarup: At this moment, I don't have the numbers with me. I can share with you separately.  
Sumit Kishore: Thank you so much.  
Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama Wealth. Please go ahead.  
Achal Lohade: Sir, can you help us with the rail coefficient for each of the port?  
Sanjay Swarup: Already, I have told you in the earlier question. But..  
Achal Lohade: Port mix, I think you had said, sir.  
Sanjay Swarup: I can tell you, at JNPT, rail coefficient, you want, okay?  
Achal Lohade: Yes, sir.  
Sanjay Swarup: Rail coefficient at JNPT in 9 months period was 15.7%; Mundra Port, it was 24%; and Pipavav port, it was 58%.  
Achal Lohade: Understood. And how about the land license fee because I remember last quarter, we had some reversal that's why the number was lower. This quarter, the number is a little higher Q-o-Q, but it is still lower than what it was last year. So if you could help us, what is the number as an expense we can look at as a line license fee expense in the P&L for full year FY '25, sir?  
Sanjay Swarup: See line license fees, as I told you, for the terminals that we are operating on railways, it is increasing 7% every year. So -- but we are taking steps. And whatever terminals are not useful to us, we are surrendering. So that is stabilized with the railways. There is no issue on that. So it will be around the same in the same direction. It will move like 7% increase. And maybe it may  
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not increase every year also. Like in this, you have seen from INR287 crore, I think it has gone to INR262 crores. It has reduced in this financial year. My director projects will further...

Ajit Kumar Panda: In the quarter if you see Q-on-Q December quarter '23, it was INR71.95 crores. And in the current quarter, we have booked INR89.42 crores. So -- and the adjustment whatever we did earlier in the current financial year, this quarter, there has not been any adjustment.  
Achal Lohade: So is it to say that this is the run rate one could expect and see a 7% calculation?  
Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. This is a trajectory in which we are going. We hope to close by INR350 crores in the current financial year.  
Achal Lohade: Right. But in the next financial year, there will be 7% escalation to that, right?  
Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. We are looking at some kind of some surrenders -- some adjustments. So let us say, right now, yes, 7% growth will be there in the next financial year. But still, we want to contain that. So we are looking at some other options. So far, they have not materialized. But if they materialize, we may have a little less growth next year. But the INR350 crores for this year, you can say.  
Achal Lohade: Understood. Any update on the TKD? We were looking at switching under the Gati Shakti policy?  
Ajit Kumar Panda: That, so far, that we all discuss on stage only. That discussion has not concluded with the Ministry of Railways. So right now, we are paying the LLF. But we have surrendered 10% land. So that we are -- the surrendered part, we are not paying. So we have contained that expenditure

by surrendering partially from 1.4.24. And we'll -- as we go forward, we'll look at alternatives. It's a dynamic thing. Every year, there will be some small developments in some places. So that way -- and we are trying to contain that expenditure as much as possible.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And just last one, in terms of the volumes, of our total EXIM volume, let's say, if I were to ask on originating volume basis, how much would currently be in the regions where the DFC is going to be operating in like the Northwest pocket?

Sanjay Swarup: You mean to Mundra, Pipavav and partially Nhava Sheva, how much volume we are doing?

Achal Lohade: No, no. So of the Northwest volumes, which is NCR, Punjab, part of Rajasthan, etc., which would potentially be catered by DFC once it is fully operational, how much volume -- what kind of volume we are doing right now out of our total volume? Is it 50%? Is it 60%? 40%? etc.?

Sanjay Swarup: It is around 60%.

Achal Lohade: 60% of our volumes are from these areas. Have I understood right, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: 55% to 60%, yes.

Achal Lohade: And if you could comment, sir, in terms of specifically Ludhiana, Punjab market or NCR market, how the demand is shaping up? You clear for some numbers with respect to imports and exports

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commodity-wise. But broadly, are you seeing a pickup in terms of the inquiries, etc., from these particular pockets or it's still -- things are still weak?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no. This is actually -- demand is already there. A lot of demand is there in imports. A lot of demand is there in exports. There is a continuous exercise like -- yes. And it is actually international trade dynamics. When I suppose, for example, iron scrap rates supposed internationally, they increase, then iron scrap imports will come down. After some time, it is a cyclical thing.

After some time, international rates become less, it becomes competitive, iron scrap imports will increase. So these are the market dynamics, all of you guys are well aware. So at present, that I was telling you in the opening remarks, we are getting very good demand at all the places around the country, we are having the demand in domestic and in both. So that is a general statement I was making. And across the country, in all the sectors, there is a very robust demand now.

Achal Lohade: Got it. And just a clarification. The 4Q double-digit growth, are you also meaning on the originating basis or just

the handling basis, sir? And was it an aggregate or just the EXIM impact?

Sanjay Swarup: Both.

Achal Lohade: 4Q volume growth, you said double digit in your opening remarks. 4Q FY '25. It is both.

Sanjay Swarup: Originating and handling.

Achal Lohade: Originating as well as handling. On an aggregate basis, right, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Correct.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Akash Mehta from Canada HSBC Life.

Akash Mehta: So basically, I just wanted to check in terms of the geopolitical issues kind of get resolved. To some extent, what kind of growth we could see in terms of EXIM? And are you seeing anything, I mean in the near term that is happening on that front? So yes.

Sanjay Swarup: Geopolitical, if it is stabilized, then it will be very good because the vessel schedules which are quite erratic now. And sometimes vessels will stop coming. Then after some months, suddenly, a lot of vessels will be coming. So all these things, uncertainties will be over, and we will be -- vessels will be running as per schedule. Secondly, for catering to the same volume of traffic, less equipment will be required because now transit time is more. So equipment are also -- more equipment have to be deployed by shipping lines.

Then thirdly, there will be a correction in the ocean freight also because now they have to take a longer route.

And when the geopolitical issues are resolved, then they don't have to take that long route. So they will charge less. So there will be very good growth in the market. How much growth, it is

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very difficult to predict. And when it will resolve that also I cannot predict right now. It is dependent on so many factors.

Akash Mehta: Sure. That's it from my side. Thank you.

Moderator: Mr. Mehta, does that answer your question?

Akash Mehta: Yes. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Priyankar Biswas from BNB Paribas. Please

go ahead.

Priyankar Biswas: Most of the questions are answered. Just one follow-up question here. So since we were discussing Gati Shakti there. So if some of the key terminals were to shift to Gati Shakti, so can you just quantify for us like how much can be the LLF linked savings, especially particularly TKD was there? That's all I have to ask?

Sanjay Swarup: At present, our management has taken a decision that we will not be going for that option because there is a lot of uncertainty involved in. If Brownfield terminals are migrating to Gati Shakti, then there is a big element of uncertainty. So we have decided that we will not be using that facility provided by Indian Railways, but for Greenfield projects we are going for Gati Shakti only.

Priyankar Biswas: Sir, what's the competitive intensity in these Gati Shakti bids? I mean what sort of TAC shares people are typically bidding, if you can shed some light?

Sanjay Swarup: What is the question?

Priyankar Biswas: What is the TAC share that people are bidding in this Gati Shakti project if you can share some light like if the bids aggressive or not?

Sanjay Swarup: It depends on the terminal where they are getting traffic. I cannot speculate how much they will be bidding. That is not within my ambit of discussions.

Priyankar Biswas: Okay sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Prateek Maheshwari from Tree Line Advisors. Please go ahead.

Prateek Maheshwari: Actually, just I had two questions, but I have another one, just to clarify. You said we are not going with the Gati Shakti bidding process for Tughlakabad and the other terminals which we have on the railway line. Is that right?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, Brownfield projects.

Prateek Maheshwari: For the Brownfield projects. I see. Okay. And also like on the EBITDA level if I just look at the EBITDA level for this quarter if I understand correctly, if I look at EBIT

DA per ton excluding

the other income it looks like it's dropped by almost 18% to 19% year-over-year. So I'm just

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trying to understand what has happened because I understand lead distance have not come down, pricing has not come down. So any light on that?

Sanjay Swarup: What number are you talking, EBITDA per ton?

Prateek Maheshwari: Yes. Just looking at our EBITDA per ton overall?

Sanjay Swarup: EBITDA per TEU or EBITDA per ton?

Prateek Maheshwari: Sorry EBITDA per TEU.

Sanjay Swarup: EBITDA per TEU you have calculated.

Prateek Maheshwari: Yes.

Sanjay Swarup: You have taken originating TEU or handling TEU?

Prateek Maheshwari: Handling volumes.

Sanjay Swarup: No, you should take the originating volume actually that is the clear indicator because handling if we do double stack, then the same containers can manage two times. So I would request you to take the originating numbers, then it will not be so much drop.

Prateek Maheshwari: I see. And just one final question if may. So on the depreciation front, right, I think this was already asked earlier. But just to clarify, I think if I understand correctly depreciation this quarter was about INR86 crores. And I think last quarter it was about INR166. And I understand that INR25 crores drop can be explained by that wagon life extension thing, but I didn't really understand the explanation that you gave earlier. So if you could please clarify again, that would be really helpful?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes. If you see what we are requesting is that in this financial year, this calculation of life of wagon has been -- there was some anomaly and the anomaly has been removed. And it has been brought in line with the actual life of the wagon that are being used in the railway system. So now you should see the EBIT as a depreciation figure for the 9-month period, not the quarter period because once the adjustment has been done for the full year, it was -- the booking may look a little more in first two quarters and less in third quarter.

But if you add all the 3, then the correct picture emerges. There will be drop in our depreciation figures for the 9-month period. So you kindly see the 9-month period.

Prateek Maheshwari: I see. Understood. Perfect. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Vaibhav Shah from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Vaibhav Shah: Yes. Sir, just to continue on the depreciation part. So if you look at 9 months there is INR408 crores. So going forward, quarterly numbers should be INR130 crores, INR140 crores per quarter?

Ajit Kumar Panda: Yes like that. Yes.

Vaibhav Shah: And sir secondly if you look at the volume growth in domestic, in terms of handling volume it is 25% up, while in terms of originating volume it is 7% growth. So there is a sharp ingress in the handling sector for the -- on the domestic side. So what could be the reason for that following the sharp variation in the growth numbers?

Sanjay Swarup: My director, I will request my Director domestic to explain.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Actually, in handling you know that some of the containers volumes we have taken from our PFTs, whatever PFT rakes we are handling. We have taken those volumes also. So that is the reason that the handling figure has gone up very sharply. And the originating is only TEU volumes whatever we are doing. So that is the main reason.

You know that at Paradeep we are handling around 50 to 60 rakes for railway wagon and at other PFTs also we are handling one or two rakes. So at that rakes we charge higher -- asset charges and then handling charges also. So we have been adding those volumes. So that is the reason, basically.

Vaibhav Shah: So for Q4, the growth, if you look at the originating -- the handling growth in Q3 is 25%

. So if

we assume that a similar growth count in Q4, so the difference of persistent Q4 as for on the originating side or it will minimize?

Mohammad Azhar Shams: No. Actually originating, we are going to increase from 7% what has been there to keeping in the volume and all those things because originating volume will increase. Now the handling volume will depend that how many rakes we handle in our PFT location. That is there. In this quarter, the number has been quite good.

So that's why our handling number has gone up to up to 24. It may come down also, and it may increase also keeping on keeping into the numbers of the railway rakes we handle at Paradeep and then Khatwas and all those PFT locations.

Vaibhav Shah: Okay. So lastly if you want to look at the Q4 numbers in terms of volumes, so if we're guiding for a 10% growth in terms of -- a double-digit growth in terms of EXIM, so it should be both in EXIM [inaudible 48:16] handling as well. Assuming a similar handling factor would be there.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Exactly.

Vaibhav Shah: And similar could be the case for domestic as well at least for the originating part?

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Yes, actually domestic in originating and handling both will be double digit only. We are quite confident on that.

Vaibhav Shah: Okay. Thank you sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

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Amit Dixit: Just one follow-up question, if I may. Now since this particular quarter's numbers and segments have been adjusted with the depreciation, is it possible to give the unadjusted EBIT number segment wise for this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, but why do you want those numbers? These are the actual numbers, which have been approved by CA auditor. Why do you want...

Amit Dixit: Just for comparison because these numbers are not comparable with the earlier numbers?

Sanjay Swarup: But we give only one set of numbers. We don't give two sets of numbers. In the 9-month period is there. We will give only one set of numbers and which have been approved by our auditors. We don't give two, three sets of numbers for your analysis. Sorry.

Amit Dixit: Okay. No problem. Okay.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sandesh Shetty from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Sandesh Shetty: Thank you, sir. All my questions have been answered.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital. Please go ahead.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Sir, just one data point that I just wanted was the lead distance for the domestic side, if I could get that, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. For domestic for 9 months period lead distance was 1317 kilometers.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay, Great sir. So I think there's no more questions in the queue. So we can end the call. Thank you so much to all the participants and the management for giving us an opportunity to host the call. Wishing you all the very best, sir. Thank you.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you very much, Bhoomika.



Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Conference Name: Container Corporation Of India Limited Earnings

Conference Call

Time: January 31, 2025 at 11:30 Hrs India Time

Sr. No. Name Company

1 HOST: Management Container Corporation Of India Limited

2 HOST: Ms. Bhoomika Nair Dam Capital Advisors

3 Abhishek Rath Northrock Capital

4 Achal Lohade Nuvama Wealth5 Aditya Mungiya Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Co. Ltd.6 Akash Goyal Tara Capital7

Akash Kumar LIC Mutual Fund 8 Akash Mehta Canara HSBC Life Insurance9 Akash Rawat Bouyant Capital

10 Akhilesh Bhandari Millennium Management11 Akshata Thakar Asian Market Securities12 Akshay Johnson Individual

Investor13 Akshay Karwa Aviva Life Insurance14 Alok Deora Mot

ilal Oswal Financial Services15 Aman Agrawal Carnelian Capital16 Ameen Pirani J.P. Morgan 17 Amit Bhiande Morgan Stanley18 Amit Dixit ICICI Securities19 Amit Khurana Dolat Capital20 Amit Kumar Determind Investment21 Anand Vyas Bajaj Holdings22 Anish Rankawat UTI Mutual Fund23 Ankit Jain Mirae Asset24 Ankita Shah Elara Capital25 Anshul Narayan Arete Securities26 Anupam Goswami B&K Securities27 Anurag Khadelwal Individual Investor28 Arun Capital Market29 Arun Kumar Bloomberg30 Ashish Individual Investor31 Ashish Shah Millennium Management32 Atul Kothari Progwell Securities33 Ayush Abhijeet WhiteOak Capital Management34 Basanth Patil N P TCG Asset Management35 Bharati Sawant Dam Capital Advisors36 Bharti Sawant Mirae Asset37 David Brown Aiera38 David Yehuda S&P Global Market Intellegence39 Deepak Kumar District D40 Devan Sangoi Tej Investment41 Devendar Sariipelli S&P Global Market Intellegence42 Dharmendra Grover Helios Capital43 Dhirendra Patro Parth Private Wealth44 Dipen Kapadia RR Investments45 Disha Giria Ashika Institutional46 Ekta Mehta Karma Capital Advisors Pvt. Ltd.47 Gaurav Khanna Capgrow Capital48 Gaurav Narayan Salto Investments49 Gurpreet Singh Arihant Capital50 Harish Gawaskar Individual Investor51 Harshil Shah PhillipCapital52 Harshit Sarawagi Nuvama Wealth53 Hemal Murarka VT CapitalTHANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US

Total 153 Participants including the Speakers.

Participants List

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55 Hetali Maniar Share India Securities56 Isabel S&P Global Market Intellegence57 Jayvant Shah Equirus Securities58

Jignesh Mukwana Asian Market Securities59 Jinesh Kothari Elara Capital60 Karan Shah Onyx Capital Group61 Kartik Jiwani

Edelweiss62 Kaushtab Bubna BMSPL Capital63 Keshav Misra Vostok Capital64 Kevyn Kadakia Sundaram Mutual Fund65

Koundinya N Jefferies66 Krupa Shankar Avendus Spark67 Kunal Mehta Individual Investor68 Laskhmi Narayanan Ksema

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69 Lavina Quadros Jefferies70 Mandar Pawar Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Co. Ltd.71 Manish Gupta Millennium

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Capital93 Pratik Maheshwari Treeline Advisors94 Pritish ICICI Securities95 Priyanka Aditya Birla Sun Life Mutual Fund96

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Arihant Capital111 Rohit DSP Investment Managers112 Rohit Ohri Progressive Shares113 Ronak Bhta Aditya Birla Sun Life

Mutual Fund114 Rupali Zade Researchbytes115 Rupan Jain Investwell Agents Pvt. Ltd.

116 Rushabh Sheth Karma Capital Advisors Pvt. Ltd.

117 Sagar Shirke Motilal Oswal Financial Services

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otilal Oswal Financial Services126 Shagun Kabra Individual Investor127 Shithika J.P. Morgan 128 Shiva Hariraman Pinpoint

Group129 Shivaji Mehta Individual Investor130 Shivam Agarwal InCred Finance131 Shobhit Tiwari Canara Robeco Mutual

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Morgan 136 Sumit Kishore Axis Capital137 Suraj Gupta M Solutions138 Tanishq Makwana Elara Capital139 Tisha Shah

Karma Capital Advisors Pvt. Ltd.140 Trusha Boring Asset Management 141 Udit Dhekeli Bank of America142 Uma

Ramachandran Florintree Advisors143 Vaibav Jain RV Investments144 Vaibhav Shah JM Financial145 Vandana Puranik

Bloomberg146 Venkat DSP Investment Managers147 Vikram Suryavanshi PhillipCapital148 Vinay Jain Karma Capital

Advisors Pvt. Ltd.149 Vineet Mane Karma Capital Advisors Pvt. Ltd.150 Vishal Khadelwal Bajaj Holdings151 Yash Hegde



## Call: May 2025

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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

(A Navratna CPSE of Govt. of India)

No.CON/F&CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No.91029/NoteNo.44/ ~: 28.05.2025

1. The Bombay Stock Exchange Ltd., Mumbai (Through BSE Listing Centre)

Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Dalal Street

Mumbai-400001

2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (Through NEAPS)

Exchange Plaza, 5th Floor, Plot No. C/1,G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex, Sandra (E)

Mumbai-400 051

Dear Sir/Madam,

~: Disclosure under SEBI {Listing Obligation & Disclosure Requirements)

Regulations, 2015.

Pursuant to applicable provisions of SEBI (LODR) Regulations , 2015, please find

enclosed transcript of Post results conference call held on 23.05.2025.

For your information and record please.

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"Container Corporation of India Limited

Q4 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call"

May 23, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING  
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS AND  
SERVICES) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR  
(DOMESTIC ) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. VIJAY KUMAR SINGH – DIRECTOR  
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING AND OPERATIONS ) –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. ANURAG KAPIL – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. HARISH CHANDRA – PRINCIPAL EXECUTIVE  
DIRECTOR (FINANCE) AND COMPANY SECRETARY AND  
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – CONTAINER  
CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Container Corporation of India Limited Earnings Call Q4 FY '25, hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Thanks. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q4 FY '25 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management today being represented by Mr.

Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director.

At this point, I'll hand over the floor to Mr. Swarup for his initial remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Good morning, everybody. I am represented -- I am having with me Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda, Director, Projects and Services; Mr. Mohammad Azhar Shams, Director, Domestic Division; Mr. Vijay Kumar Singh, Director, International Marketing and Operations; Mr. Anurag Kapil, Director, Finance; and Mr. Harish Chandra, PED, Finance, Company Secretary and CFO of the company.

I would like to give some opening remarks, and then we can proceed with questions. At the outset, I am glad to announce that Board of Directors has approved the bonus share 1:4, 1 share for every 4 shares in the meeting concluded yesterday. And we have announced a dividend of INR2 per share, that is 40% dividend for this quarter, and it takes the total dividend to INR11.50 at a share value of INR5, that is 230%.

Bonus share are subject to requisite approvals, which will be coming in due course. Then as far as the performance of the company is concerned, CONCOR achieved ever highest throughput of 5.09 million TEUs, crossing the 5 million TEUs mark for the first time in its history.

Throughput growth has been around 8% in the financial year.

It includes EXIM growth of 7% and domestic growth of 12%. It's in line with the India international trade. Export has grown by 0.08% to US\$437.42 billion and import of India grew by 6.2% to US\$720.24 billion.

In Q4, we had a growth of 8.25% as compared to the corresponding period of last financial year.

It includes EXIM growth of 12% and which we are able to sustain in the present quarter also.

And domestic, we had a negative growth of 2.6%, primarily because of 3 reasons.

First is the -- we deliberately did not pick up the low-margin traffic that was available. And second reason was the impact of congestion in railway network in Eastern India, which impacted our business in domestic.

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And third reason is the delay in supply of tank containers by M/s Braithwaite, our sister PSU due to the various teething technical problems that they were having. Because of these 3 primary reasons, domestic throughput, in fact, declined as compared to the corresponding period of last financial year.

But now I will tell you subsequently, we have taken corrective steps. And in the current financial year, we see a very robust growth in domestic. I also want to highlight that in EXIM, we have increased the market share on Pan-India basis by 40 basis points, JNPT only 9 basis points, Mundra port 127 basis points, Pipavav port 232 basis points.

And one important thing is we have gained market share and despite not sacrificing our margins.

In fact, our rail freight margin has increased by 55 basis points. So market share has also increased and rail freight margin has also increased from 25.10% to 25.65%.

Operating

margin has remained same year-on-year. Last year, it was 30.7% and this year, it was 30%, almost same. EBITDA margin also same, year-on-year, 25.5% to 25%. So all these performances, we were able to achieve. Because of our strong focus on customer centricity, customers have reposed faith in our services and operational excellence of team CONCOR. Despite geopolitical challenges that we were facing, we could achieve operating income growth of 2.7% and PAT growth of 3.35%. And PAT is ever highest in company's history and turnover in this financial year is also ever highest in the company's history. And as far as operations front is concerned, we have seen a 16% growth in double-stack handling of rakes.

This year, we crossed 6,000 rakes. We achieved 6,302 double-stack rakes this year. Last year, it

was 5,440. So there was a growth of 16%. We also added infrastructure to meet this demand. We commissioned 11 rakes in this financial year, taking our total rake count to 388. We procured around 9,000 containers, taking our container fleet to more than 53,000 containers.

And all this was possible, and we achieved capex of INR810 crores in FY '25. For FY '26, Board of Directors have approved capex budget of INR860 crores, which will be primarily used for procuring containers, procuring wagons, development of terminals for -- and for management of management information system, that is IT equipments.

Company has embarked on massive infrastructure creation after seeing the robust demand. By 2028, we have set a target of 100 terminals, 500-plus rakes and 70,000 containers of our own. For ESG, we have established CONCOR-TERI Center of Excellence for green and sustainable logistics for giving us various consultancy and guiding us how to go for green and sustainable logistics.

As far as outlook for FY '26 is concerned, we see stability in EXIM business and with commissioning of WDFC up to JNPT by December 2025. We see a spurt in volumes in Q4 of this financial year. On domestic front, there is a robust demand. We expect good volumes of bulk cement and tank containers, ceramic tiles, food grain, etc.

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In the last financial year, exports basically increased. Ready-made garments saw 84% growth, auto parts saw 22% growth and plastic goods saw 82% growth. Similarly, imports also increased. Raw cotton increased by 122% and glass by 57%.

We have resumed rail services for third country import from Haldia port to Birganj. We loaded more than 1,000 TEUs in the last financial year. And for DPD also, we increased by 31% in last financial year. We have loaded 3,847 TEUs this -- in last financial year, which was a growth of 31% over corresponding period of previous financial year.

So at this moment, I would like to give guidance for FY '26. In EXIM, I am giving guidance of 10% growth, in domestic 20% growth. So overall, there will be 13% growth in this financial year in overall business combined EXIM and domestic.

How we will achieve this? There are various factors that we will be working on. First is customer centricity, which remains the focus area of management. Then second is total logistics solution to customers. We have set upon a target of 100% first mile, last mile that we will be doing in this financial year.

Then we will be working on green and sustainable logistics and bulk cement and tank containers will be a very big driver of growth and long-term agreements we are going to have with corporate customers and shipping lines, which will help us to give more volumes into our fold. And last but not the least, we will have business at our new terminals also that we are going to commission.

In this financial year, we have set up a target of commissioning 4 new terminals, and we are actively working with railways and DFC for getting land for setting up more terminals so that we are able to achieve the target of

100 terminals by 2028. So these are my opening remarks.

Now you can start the questions, please.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question is from the line of Achal Gohade from Nuvama.

Achal Gohade: Can you help us with the originating volume for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Originating volume for Q4 for EXIM, it is 557,670 TEUs and for domestic 121,789 TEUs. Total is 679,459 TEUs.

Achal Gohade: Understood. Sir, if you could help us understand with respect to the market share. You did mention about the market share, but if you could give the number specifically, what is our market share, JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav and Aggregate India level for EXIM?

Sanjay Swarup: JNPT, we have a market share of 58.44%. Mundra port, it is 37.7%. Pipavav port, it is 48.4%. And on Pan-India, if we see, we achieved the market share of 55.2% in EXIM and 57.6% is domestic. Total is 56%.

Achal Gohade: And if you could help us with FY '24 number as well, sir, in the same fashion, please?

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Sanjay Swarup: FY '24 JNPT was 58.3%, Mundra port was 36.4%, Pipavav port was 46%. Pan-India, EXIM 54.8%, domestic 66.8% and total is 57.7%.

Achal Gohade: Understood. Sir, if you could help us explain the drop in terms of the domestic business, specifically for the quarter. Like it is appearing to be fairly large, somewhere around 15% Y-o-

Y in terms of originating volume. What has driven this particular drop, any particular geography or it's just a cement -- bulk cement container basically what you are seeing?

Sanjay Swarup: See, I already mentioned in my opening remarks, there are basically 3 reasons. First is there is a lot of traffic available, which is working on very low margin. So purposely, that is a deliberate decision of the management not to pick up that traffic. We have not -- we have decided not to go for 0% margin or 1% to 2% margin.

So that was a decision of the management for not picking up that traffic. And second reason, as I told you, there was a congestion in railway network in Eastern India and due to various factors and that has impacted our volume in a big way in domestic because domestic, if you analyze it deeply, a lot of traffic is moving from Western India to Eastern India.

So if there is a congestion, then rakes don't get unloaded, then they don't get loaded. So because of that, the domestic business was severely impacted. Third was the tank containers that we were banking that it will start in Q4.

But somehow because it is a new product, first time it was being developed in our country. So there was a lot of teething problems, and they could not be delivered, and we could not get any loading of bulk cement in tank containers. So these were the basic 3 big problems that impacted our drop in domestic.

Achal Gohade: Understood. And just one more question in terms of the LLF. You've mentioned in the notes, it's INR370 crores net of INR65 crores impact. So I'm just curious, what is the number for fourth quarter? Is it INR110 crores? Or is it INR175 crores? How do we look at it?

Sanjay Swarup: My PED Finance can answer this question. INR108 crores -- it is INR108 crores in fourth quarter, I think.

Achal Gohade: Okay. INR370 crores is the net number. INR370 crores for the full year. And how do you see it for FY '26? That's my last question, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: See, as I mentioned earlier in my -- one of the interviews today morning, FY '26 also, it will be in the same range, even though it will increase by 7%, but we are constantly working on surrendering the terminals that we don't need or the land within terminals that we don't need. So net impact will be around this number only.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Disha from Ashika Institutional.

Disha: Sir, my first question is if you would have any idea by when we would receive the specialize

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containers from Braithwaite because it has almost delayed for 1 quarter, if you have any idea on it?

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Sanjay Swarup: Actually, we have already received 90 containers from Braithwaite that are sufficient to form a rake. Now these containers are under trial loading at one of the cement plants. So we are quite hopeful of a breakthrough. So because for the first time they are being loaded, so you will appreciate that there is a teething issue.

So people are working on it. Our officers are also working. Braithwaite officers are also working.

And I'm expecting that by first week of June, it should streamline and stabilize. And apart from that, we have published a tender for 500 more containers for open tender we have published. So that is a parallel exercise we are doing.

And one more thing on bulk cement front, we have signed agreement with 2 leading cement manufacturers, UltraTech Cement and My Home cement, where we have given 2 acre land each to them in our terminal at Dronagiri in Mumbai, and they will be setting up silos. And they are procuring bulk tank containers on their own.

Even My Home cement, they have procured 200 containers already. So they are constructing a silo. And then that loading will be parallelly they will be doing.

Disha: All right. Sir, my second question is in terms of if you would have an idea on what is the total containers handled at all India ports? And what is CONCOR share in it?

Sanjay Swarup: See, all India ports, of course, we keep a data, but that may not be very authentic. I will just give you an idea of that. One minute. All India ports, the total handling was around 23 million TEUs.

Disha: All right. If I may ask one last question. We did see a drop in realization in terms of domestic and EXIM business both. So going forward, do you expect realization increasing in both these segments? I do understand by domestic, we are not specifically going into low-margin business that would slightly impact our volumes, but in the EXIM business?

Sanjay Swarup: See, as I told you, we are able to maintain EBITDA level of 24% to 25% every year and despite growing also and -- which is quite good in logistics business. Normally, it is in single digit. So we will be able to maintain this business going forward. The things that will help us will be the commissioning of DFC, which will increase the double-stacking.

It will bring down the empty running. Similarly, domestic also, we will be able to move both the loaded traffic and a lot of circuits, we are working on it. So I think we will be able to improve

our EBITDA and maintain at 24%, 25% level.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital.

Bhoomika Nair: Sir, just wanted to understand the EXIM segment a little better. This year has been fairly muted in terms of growth, and we're talking about a 10% growth next year. How is the volumes really shaping up in the last 2 months? Has there been a pickup? And what is the outlook that you're seeing in terms of shipping lines?

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Is there a balance of trade between EXIM -- between export and import? If you can just talk a little bit about qualitatively in terms of the volume trajectory that we are seeing? Because last year, there was a lot of shipping disruption, which had impacted our volumes.

Sanjay Swarup: See, in this current financial year, we are able to see a stable volume in EXIM, as I informed earlier. And there is a good business we are getting. And I have had talks with various shipping lines, and they have informed that this year is going to be good because whatever uncertainties remain, but they have sort of overcome that and it has become stabilized.

So export-import is never balanced in our country. So some places, there's more imports, some places there is more exports

. So at present, exports are very good as compared to imports. It keeps on happening. So -- but that is not an issue. We are able to overcome that challenge by increasing our double-stacking. So EXIM guidance of 10%, I find it quite achievable.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure, sir. Sir, the other question was on margins. If we look at EXIM margins for the current quarter, 4Q, while obviously, for the last 2 quarters, it has been quite healthy, but this particular quarter saw a drop to about 20% versus what we've been doing about 25%. So any particular reason why in this quarter there was a drop in the EXIM EBIT margins?

Sanjay Swarup: See, this was the final quarter. So there are a lot of adjustments also which we carry forward and whatever expenses are there. So all these factors are there. Otherwise, there is no particular reason. As far as operationally, we have been able to reduce the empty running. This number, I don't have with me right at the moment, but it was quite good. Double-stacking was quite good. So this is likely to continue in this financial year also. So margin front, I don't think we have to worry.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay, sir. Sir, can I just get the empty running and the lead distances, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Empty running in this financial year was EXIM, it is INR121.3 crores. Domestic, it is INR286.7 crores and total was INR408 crores. And in both EXIM and domestic, it is less than last financial year. EXIM, it is reduced by 6.4%. Domestic, it is reduced by 5% and there's a total reduction of 5.3% in empty running.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure, sir. And the lead distances, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Lead distances for EXIM, it was 701 kilometers. Domestic, it is 1,321 kilometers. Total is 801 kilometers.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Krishnendu Saha from Quantum Asset Management.

Krishnendu Saha: Just quickly a couple of things on the domestic front. You spoke about the Eastern India volume was impacted the domestic volume. Could you quantify as to what percentage? Like is it a large volume or is it like low single-digit volume for us?

Sanjay Swarup: In the last quarter, Q4, there was a drop of 2.6% in domestic volume as compared to the same corresponding period of previous financial year.

Krishnendu Saha: 2.6%. Just on the realization part...

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Sanjay Swarup: Overall for the financial year, there was a growth of 12% in domestic volume.

Krishnendu Saha: Yes, sir. Right. I mean, no -- because you said 3 reasons why this happened. So I'm just asking -- just trying to get a number too. On the realization part on the domestic for the last -- from '24 to '25, there's a degrowth of the realization.

Do you see any pickup in realization per TEU on the domestic front in FY '26 or '27 because '24 there was a degrowth of 5.2%. '25, there was a degrowth of 9.2%. With new business coming in tankers for cement and others and tiles, do we see the realization is being flat? Or do you think that the realization will have further degrowth from here also?

Sanjay Swarup: The realization will be good. As I told you, we are working on various circuits. Like suppose my container is coming empty in some -- from point A to point B, I give a very good rate, maybe on very less margin so that at least I get some money. Instead of getting negative returns, I get some returns. So all these strategies we are working.

So it's a detailed subject. It will not be possible to tell in detail at this moment. So we are

constantly working and we are very sure that we will be able to improve domestic margins in this current financial year.

Krishnendu Saha: So that will be largely also high realization but is being flattish as compared to '25, right? Is -- that can be taken into consideration, realization for domestic?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, you can say it will be slightly more than FY '25. And overall EBITDA will be 24%, 25% or even more

than that.

Krishnendu Saha: Sure. And just from my understanding on the EXIM front, just a hypothetical example, where the shipping liners rate per TEU goes down from suppose \$4,000 to \$3,000, do you face a pressure on realization front on the EXIM side also, likewise? And what is the quantity and how fast...

Sanjay Swarup: We don't feel any such pressure because we maintain excellent relations with our customers. So whenever we go for any rate increase, first thing is we give them sufficient time. Second thing is we inform them that we are going to do that, and they have these reasons, A, B, C. So we have excellent communication with them.

So we don't face any such pressure that the shipping lines are reducing ocean freight.

Correspondingly, we will also increase or decrease our inland charges. These pressures, we don't face.

Krishnendu Saha: You don't -- because large of the number of contracts will be all long term with them. That is the understanding, right?

Sanjay Swarup: We are a public sector undertaking. So we are not a private company. So we cannot change our rate on a daily basis. And we cannot be selective that we will charge this thing from person A, and another rate from person B. We can't do that. Whatever rates we are notifying it's public rate, public domain available on our website.

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So -- but only thing what we can do is we can give volume-based incentives. So if some person gives me more volume, he will get more incentive. If some person gives me less volume, he will get less incentive. And that is also very transparent.

Krishnendu Saha: But that adjustment happens in Q4, I guess.

Sanjay Swarup: Sorry?

Krishnendu Saha: That adjustment happens in Q4. That's why the margins take a dip in Q4 on the EXIM side. Is that...

Sanjay Swarup: Exactly. Yes, yes, you have hit the point. That ultimately, in Q4, every -- all these things are -- because we close our accounts for the year so all these issues are reflected in Q4.

Krishnendu Saha: And just one small question. This cement tankers and tiles, will they have such a large -- will they have such a better margin than the current domestic TEU profile? Or will be the margin same? Could you just throw some light on that?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, per se, you cannot say that only one side loaded will fetch good margins. Margin, we should see an overall perspective because in domestic, even for empty container movement, we have to pay to railways, but we don't get anything. While in EXIM, if we move empty container, shipping lines pay us. So that is the difference between -- basic difference between EXIM and domestic.

So domestic, it becomes very challenging because suppose I move tiles from point A to point B., then in return direction, suppose I bring the empty container, I don't get anything, but I have to pay to railways. So my endeavor is that in return direction, I should fill some cargo in that.

So basically, you cannot say that for tiles, you will get more returns. The key question should be how much empty running you will reduce.

Krishnendu Saha: Yes. No sir, I was also asking about tankers, the cement tankers which you use, will they have -- were they getting -- what you call, that the return cargo would be difficult. So would they have the same margin profile?

Sanjay Swarup: That's a good question. In empty tankers, we will be bringing them in empty state only. But for that, railway has given one incentive scheme valid for first 5 years of the tanker. That -- for first 5 years, we will avail of that incentive scheme in which for empty movement, they give some incentives. But we have notified our rates in such a manner that we take that cost into consideration, that empty cost also and parties have agreed for that.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from SUD Life.

Anupam Goswami: Sir, my first question on th

e -- what's our target on the double-stack portion? And on the DFC

on the Eastern front also, are we looking any double-stack introduction over there? And also on

the EXIM margin, I missed on that front, how do we see the EXIM margin from here onwards?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. See, first question, there is no target on double-stack. We want to increase it as much as



16%. Before that also, we got double-digit growth. So as such, there is no target that we have fixed for double-stack, but we want to maximize it. So -- but there is a lot of improvements going on in wagon technology also.

Wagons are now coming, which can carry more payload. Now -- previously, there were wagons which could carry 68 to 70 tons payload. Now we have wagons available, which can carry 80 tons of payload. So obviously, these things will increase the double-stacking. So this is helping us a lot. Second question is Eastern.

Eastern DFC is not fit for double-stack. It is -- and it is only catering to bulk and break bulk cargo. Mostly containers are not running and because overhead equipment, height is not that much, that it can -- double-stack train can run on Eastern DFC. So it is not possible to run double-stack.

Third question is about EXIM margin. Yes, EXIM margin, you will see a lot of improvement in the coming weeks, and we will be able to maintain EBITDA of 24% to 25%.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Vikram Suryavanshi from PhillipCapital.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Just wanted a clarity on depreciation. So last quarter, we have increased the life for assets, and there was a reduction in our depreciation for last quarter. But again, if you look at this quarter has gone up. So can you clarify for that?

Sanjay Swarup: My PED Finance will answer this question.

Harish Chandra: Yes. Depreciation, like in the last quarter, as you know, we have increased the life of our wagons from 15 years to 30 years. So that had an impact of INR79 crores in the December period. And if you see in the March period, the total impact is INR92 crores. So the impact in the March quarter is around INR13 crores because of that. So that's the main reason.

And that has also been reflected or has also impacted our tax provision. If you see there is a deferred tax provision, which has increased. And there is a decline in the current tax provision because we have got the tax benefit for the capex what we have done during the year. So current tax liability has come down.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Okay. So quarter-on-quarter increase is mainly because of the asset addition what we have done?

Harish Chandra: Yes, yes.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Okay. Understood. And in terms of container fleet, we also used to take a fleet on lease. So what you are mentioning around like 53,000 container, does it include only our own container or we have lease fleet also?

Sanjay Swarup: It is all own container. Now there's no lease container.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Okay. Understood. And last question is that our revenue share, which you give every quarter, how much is our revenue share from JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav, Chennai, if you can share that number for full year?

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Sanjay Swarup: Yes, I will give you. JNPT, our volume share is 33.4%. I'm giving for the full year. Mundra Port is at 37.3%, Pipavav 9.5%, Vizag 5.5%, Chennai 4%, Vallarpadam 4.7%, Tuticorin 1.3%, Ennore 1.75%, Kattupalli 1.72%. Total is 99.41%.

Vikram Suryavanshi: Okay. And just to add, since you are talking about end-to-end logistics, are we also looking to come back for coastal any possibility or will be more like a surface, road-to-road?

Sanjay Swarup: No, we are open for coastal also. We have signed an MOU with Shipping Corporation of India for coastal mov

ement also. But till now, we are not able to achieve any breakthrough because of the various rates that we worked out and we shared with the trade. It was not favorable to them.

But we are constantly on the job. As soon as we get, we will inform you.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark.

Mukesh Saraf: My first question is regarding your comment that once DFC will be connecting to Nhava Sheva and NCR for the volumes, could you help us understand currently what portion of our originating volumes is linked to JNPT -- to and fro JNPT?

Sanjay Swarup: 33.4%.

Mukesh Saraf: That's of the originating volume, sir? Or that it will include your handling around the port at, say, your other MMLPs around JNPT itself?

Sanjay Swarup: So this includes imports plus exports both.

Mukesh Saraf: Right. But this will include handling revenues as well, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: No, this is not revenue. This is physical volume I'm telling.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay. Physical volumes -- originating volumes is about 30%-odd, 33%, right? Right. And so just trying to understand, once the DFC connects to Nhava Sheva, the expectation is that we'll see for the volume. So there should be some shift from road to rail basically. So what proportion right now of volumes moving between, say, Dadri or NCR region to JNPT are moving by road currently?

Sanjay Swarup: See, it will not be some shift. It will be a substantial shift from road to rail because -- I will tell you, because in logistics, the people look for 2 things. First is transit time. Second is cost. Dadri will be connected on DFC with Nhava Sheva then both these things will be taken care of. Transit time because we will be running time table trains from Dadri to Nhava Sheva. So there will be predictability in our services, which will be welcomed by the trade, as it has been in Dadri to Mundra circuit.

Second thing is cost. When we run on -- train on DFC, all will be double-stack trains. For upper deck, there will be substantial cost saving. So without sacrificing my margins, I will share a part of these savings with my customers. And the light cargo, which is at present not coming to rail, it is moving by road. All this light cargo will come to rail.

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So I'm expecting substantial shift because of these 2 reasons, predictability and cost, the traffic will be coming to rail. And just to give you an estimate, at present, the rail coefficient at Nhava Sheva is in the range of 17% to 18%. And as soon as DFC is commissioned, immediately overnight, it will not happen, but at least by 1, 1.5 years after that. I'm very optimistic that this rail coefficient will double.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay. Understood. So the reason...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Mr. Saraf, may we request that you return to the question queue for follow-up questions.

Mukesh Saraf: Just my second question, actually.

Moderator: Okay. Go ahead.

Mukesh Saraf: No. I'll just finish this last one. So the reason I was asking this, sir, we haven't seen the rail coefficient go up at Mundra. So what was, say, around 25% in FY '23, even now is around this 25% despite this road to rail shift happening. So that's the reason, if you could just clarify this last point, then I'll get back in the queue.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, that's a very good question. See, now this 25%, how it is calculated? It includes transshipment volume also. So if you see originating actual numbers, actual numbers, there is a very good growth at Mundra, import-export. But because we are calculating it on percentage of the overall handling at the port.

And there is a sizable chunk, is there of transshipment volumes. Second reason is the DPD. DPD also plays a very important role as the direct port delivery, DPD, and direct port entry is for exports. So DPD, DPD is primarily moving by road at present also, not coming to rail. So because

of that, also, it is impacting the rail coefficient. These 2 factors are actually primarily responsible for rail coefficient remaining stagnant.

Moderator: We take the next question from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas.

Priyanka Biswas: Just harping back to the previous participant's question. Sir, if you can give me some more color regarding JNPT, like what extent of the volumes that happen at JNPT are relatively, let's say, low lead because that would ideally not shift to a rail.

And also, if you can give some idea because the understanding is that most of the DFC -- most of the JNPT volumes that occur today at present is more aligned towards Maharashtra and Northern Karnataka. So if you can give an idea is what actually of the DFC volumes that are happening today moves along the -- let's say, the north-south axis?

Sanjay Swarup: It's a good question. Now the thing is that you are right. At present, the JNPT, a lot of volume - I don't have the numbers with me, but a lot of volume is moving to Maharashtra, Karnataka as well as to Andhra also because Hyderabad is also being catered primarily by JNPT. But there is a lot of cargo, which is moving from JNPT -- to and fro JNPT and NCR area also. And a lot of this cargo is moving by road.

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So I'm basically targeting this traffic. DFC, of course, will not impact the movement of Karnataka and Maharashtra and Andhra cargo. It will remain like that. But the cargo, which is available in North India, which we are not able to handle by rail for Nhava Sheva, these things will come to our fold.

Priyankar Biswas: So sir, does it imply...

Sanjay Swarup: Percentage figures, I don't have with me right now.

Priyankar Biswas: So can it be fair to say that at least on the northern leg, the number should be at least be higher than 30%, 35%. Otherwise, the rail coefficient really cannot move up. So would that be a right assessment, for broad ballpark?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, you are right. It should be -- no, but this is the number that I'm telling you, which is moving by rail. Actually, road figures are much higher, like 33% that I told CONCOR volumes coming from JNPT. It is only by rail. Road is not included in that because we are not having road service between JNPT and North India and other places.

Priyankar Biswas: No, no, sir. What I meant is you said that rail coefficient in JNPT is around 17% today. And 2 years down the line, it can double. So I'm saying that around 30%, 35% where it can go up to, that's what you said. So is it fair to say that the north-south volumes that occur, that is along the WDFC route, would be somewhere in this range? That is what I was asking.

Sanjay Swarup: Definitely, it will be in this range.

Priyankar Biswas: Sir, just one last question, if you can share these data points. What are the rail coefficient in the key ports like JNPT, Mundra and Pipavav? And what it was, let's say, last year? That's my final question.

Sanjay Swarup: JNPT last year, it was 16.6%. This year, it is 15.7%. Mundra last year, it was 25.5%. This year, it is 24%. Pipavav last year, it was 62.4%. This year, it is 57.8%.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Shreeji Kalekar from HSPC.

Shreeji Kalekar: Sir, my first question is in just previous answer, you said there's been almost -- at each of the major ports, there has been a loss of rail coefficient. Could you please elaborate what is really driving this loss of rail coefficient at JNPT, Mundra and Pipavav port?

Sanjay Swarup: See, primary reason is DPD. Are you familiar? What is DPD?

Shreeji Kalekar: Yes, direct port delivery, right?

Sanjay Swarup: Direct port delivery. So DPD is primarily moving by road. It is not moving by rail. This is first. And second reason is the port volumes include transshipment volumes also. When they give throughput of port, they add transshipment volume also. So beca

use transshipment is increasing,  
so this percentage figure is coming down.  
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Shreeji Kalekar: But that is more of a phenomenon in Mundra, right, sir, not much in JNPT and Pipavav. But we see there also there is a sharp...

Sanjay Swarup: So JNPT -- in Pipavav, it is not there. But JNPT, up to some extent, it is there. Yes.

Shreeji Kalekar: And sir, second, sir, you guided for a 10% EXIM volume growth. Can you please help us connecting it how should one think about what does it imply in terms of originating volume? Because our double-stacking is generally growing double digits. And your first mile, last mile, you're also aspiring to make 100%. So given these that helps in handling volume, can you help us what our originating volume growth guidance are you really implying?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, I have given guidance for the handling throughput for EXIM and domestic. So you can work out or we will help you subsequently. So how to give the -- how to work out the guidance for originating volume and financial. This, we can work out subsequently. I don't think we'll have a lot of time now to discuss these things. This is guidance for handling throughput.

Shreeji Kalekar: Understood. And sir, you also said that this year, we are targeting 100% first mile, last mile. May I ask how much was it last financial year, F '25?

Sanjay Swarup: 35%.

Shreeji Kalekar: 35%? Okay. And sir, last one bookkeeping, if I may. Sir, you -- in one of the answers, you alluded that India level, we handled about 23 million TEUs. May I ask a similar number for last year?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, I can tell you. Last year, it was 21 million TEUs.

Moderator: We take the next question from the line of Sumit from Axis Capital.

Sumit: My first question is, in your opening remarks, you mentioned the possibility of acceleration in EXIM volume growth in fourth quarter, if DFC were to materialize up to JNPT. Given our long-held experience of delays here, another 6-month delay can very well happen. So in that event, how would your 10% guidance for EXIM on handling change for the fiscal?

Similarly, for domestic tank containers and as freight has been delaying, let us say, delays happen this year also, what would your guidance of domestic volume growth of 20% change to? So I'm just trying to evaluate the risk to your guidance.

Sanjay Swarup: See, Sumit, I'm a very optimistic person. So I don't know what force you to ask this question. So in one of the TV interviews today morning, one of the anchor asked me that there is a news that DFC will be commissioned to Nhava Sheva by October, and you are telling December. So you are telling 6 months, why not 3 months before December. You should ask me what should be

your guidance then.

Sumit: So sir, we had discussed in February and you were of the opinion that it may get delayed to June also. So June '26?

Sanjay Swarup: It will not get delayed. It will be on time.

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Sumit: On time? Okay, sir. Sure. My second question is then if we think about the reported EBITDA margin -- I'm just trying to understand where the gap is coming. The reported EBITDA margin at stand-alone level is 21.4% and this figure in FY '24 was 22.4%.

So I mean, I'm not including other income in EBITDA margin calculation. So I was just trying to understand when you say stable margins of 24%, 25%, I mean, what are we -- where are we differing in terms of the calculations on EBITDA margins?

Sanjay Swarup: See, as per my calculation for FY '24 -- of course, we can check it separately. FY '24 EBITDA margin was 25.5%. That is INR2,300.69 crores. For FY '25, it is 24.9%. I take it 25%, which is INR2,330.4 crores.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Achal Gohade from Nuvama.

Achal Gohade: Sir, you did mention about the JNPT connection will drive the increase

in volumes. So in that

connection, I wanted to check, a, in terms of what kind of cost reduction or price reduction one can look at? As you said, we'll try and maintain margin and pass on this? And b, what is the breakeven lead distance here on the Western DFC, if you could talk about these 2 aspects, please?

Sanjay Swarup: See, at this moment, we have not worked out our tariff for JNPT. So I cannot tell you how much reduction we will make. But what was your second question? Breakeven distance, I did not understand. What do you mean by breakeven distance?

Achal Gohade: Basically, earlier, we used to say that around -- up to 500 kilometers road is more viable or economical than rail is. In the similar fashion, if -- for the Western DFC specifically, what would that number be? Because in that case, could the South Gujarat cargo can also move from road to rail on the DFC. I'm more curious to know because -- or alternatively, if you could give us some sense about how much road cargo, which is coming from NCR to JNPT?

Sanjay Swarup: I don't have those numbers with me right now. But we used to say that for 500 kilometers, rail faces a stiff competition from road and only heavy cargo moves by rail. So this was the complete statement we used to make. But in DFC, that constraint will not be there because in DFC, even light cargo will move by rail.

Because as I explained earlier, light cargo will move on upper deck, and we will reduce the rate substantially. So it is moving -- that light cargo is moving by road at the moment. It will also come on rail. So that constraint will be removed in DFC.

Achal Gohade: Okay. And one more question, just a bookkeeping question. With respect to other expense, if I look at, it has increased from INR258 crores to INR304 crores for full year FY '25. Is there any one-off out here, sir? Because I see for the other expense fourth quarter, the number looks very large compared to 3Q FY '25?

Sanjay Swarup: I will request my PED Finance. Maybe last quarter may be having -- we may have made some adjustments and all.

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Achal Gohade: Right. But for the full year also, sir, 17% looks very large, given our cost optimizations in the past.

Harish Chandra: No, other expense include a lot of expenses which are clubbed here. It has mainly expenses related to the maintenance of our depots and the equipment. So there is some increase in the maintenance part of it of our equipment and this thing. And there is some increase in our legal expenses as well. So the overall --there is increase in expenses.

Achal Gohade: So it's more of a recurring -- there is no one-off. That's what I guess. Is that sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes.

Achal Gohade: Okay. Understood. Sir, if you could help us with the port mix for FY '24 as well. You have given for FY '25. FY '24, if you could help us with that?

Sanjay Swarup: Sorry, I don't have with me right now for FY '24. It will be more or less same.

Achal Gohade: Okay. Understood. And empty cost for the fourth quarter, if you may, sir, for EXIM and domestic, only for fourth quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Which cost?

Achal Gohade: Empty.

Sanjay Swarup: Empty running cost?

Achal Gohade: Yes, sir. Empty running cost.

Sanjay Swarup: Empty running cost is -- EXIM is INR31.6 crores, domestic INR65.8 crores. Total is INR97.4 crores.

Moderator: We take the next question from the line of Koundinya from Jefferies.

Koundinya: Three questions from my end. Starting with, sir, on the EXIM side, you did allude to the fact that you spoke -- you are having some conversations with the shipping lines. So how is the -- I mean, how did those shape up post the recent tariffs by the US administration and then waiver on the China side?

So how are the things with respect to, a, on the trade movement or the container availability side? And in that context, how should we look at the growth, I mean, fir

st half, as I say, second

half kind of scenario, keeping aside whatever happens on the DFC? That's one.

And second question, sir, related to again on the EXIM side. How should we look at the margins from here? Because if I were to look at it on an originating volume basis, we saw a sharp decline this quarter. So how should we look at it on a sustainable basis?

Sanjay Swarup: See, as far as the tariffs and all are concerned, now you must be knowing there is a 90 days fall.

So tariff -- it is not having much impact on our business in EXIM. So more or less, it is stable

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now, import-exports. And for your -- for second quarter, but our originating volume have increased. You are saying it has come down?

Koundinya: No, sir. I'm looking at the margin -- EBIT margin on per TEU on a originating basis. So there's a sharp decline in this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. As I told you earlier to other person who was asking a question, this was the fourth quarter, this was the final quarter of the financial year. So whatever discounts and all rebates we have to give, everything we settled in fourth quarter.

So you can see the perspective -- whole perspective for the financial year because in fourth quarter, all these things will be there in our expenses. So it appears as if the margins are less in fourth quarter. But in EXIM, margins are maintained in every quarter. So there is no issue, no worries. No concern should be there on your part.

Koundinya: Okay. Sir, again, just a bookkeeping question on the operating expenses side, excluding the LLF. Throughout the year, we saw a sharp increase ahead of your volumes or revenue number. So just trying to understand what has changed here? I'm looking at excluding the LLF?

Sanjay Swarup: I don't have numbers with me. Such detailed analysis only you, young bright people can do. We will have to work on it and get back to you.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Disha from Ashika Institutional.

Disha: Sir, you had earlier mentioned that we are planning on commissioning of 4 new terminals. So if you could just give some insights on it?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. These terminals are very critical terminals for us. One is Salawas, near Jodhpur, which will be catering to the Jodhpur area. It's very, very crucial. We will be able to run double-stack trains from Mundra Port to this terminal because right now, we are not running any double-stack train to Jodhpur.

And when we run double-stack trains, we will divert a lot of business from road to rail. So as I told you, the business at new terminals, this is one of the potential area where we'll get more business. Second terminal is at Pathri, near Haridwar. We don't have any presence in that area, and we have had talks with various stakeholders there.

So we are going to get a lot of domestic traffic there. Patanjali has a very big presence there. So this terminal will also give us very good growth. Then we have targeted at Mandalgarh.

Mandalgarh is also a very good place where we can tap the traffic of Bhilwara and other -- near Kota nearby areas. DOC traffic is also there.

Stones are also there and fabric, this Bhilwara is there. So we have a lot of business potential at Mandalgarh also. And fourth is at Chunar. Chunar is near Banaras, Varanasi. There also, there's a lot of carpet industry. So all these 4 terminals are very crucial for us for future.

Disha: So we are already in talks of commissioning it. So I'm assuming we would have some deadline in mind, if you could just mention it?

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Sanjay Swarup: Yes, of course, we have deadlines and our people are working. Right now, I don't have those deadlines with me, but they will be commissioned quite quickly.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital.

Sanjay Swarup: I think

this may be the last question. I think one hour is over.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Sir, just before we close out, just 1 or 2 small questions. One is on Varnama. December onwards, Varnama had started off. And if you can just talk about the benefits. Obviously, the double-stacking continues to go up, but has it helped us in terms of the margin profile, etc., if you can talk a little bit about that?

Sanjay Swarup: See, Varnama, per se, we have not calculated separately. But definitely, it has helped us because we have done double-stacking for JNPT, but we have not revised our tariff. So whatever savings, whatever margins are there, we are keeping it with us. We have not shared it with our customers till now. Operationally, of course, benefit is being experienced by our customers, but commercial benefit is only with us. So numbers I don't have, but definitely, it is helping us to have good margins.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure. Sir, the other question is in terms of the long-term agreements and volume discounts that shipping lines we are giving or customers -- corporate customers. So what percentage of our volumes is these kind of long-term contracts that we would have done in FY '25 or in fourth quarter, any kind of understanding?

Sanjay Swarup: See, as far as EXIM is concerned, almost 20 shipping lines have signed the agreement. So this is a very big volume they cover, almost the entire volume. So as far as domestic is concerned, we are in talks with big corporate customers like Vedanta. Already, we have signed agreement.

Jindal also, we are going to sign very soon.

And we are in talk with JK Group also. Recently, I had a meeting with their MD. So efforts we are continuing. And Tata also, we are going to approach. SAIL also, Steel Authority we met. So they are also very keen to work with us. So we are going to sign agreements with all of these people very soon, and we'll get good volumes.

Bhoomika Nair: But right now, as we speak today, sir, is it a very meaningful large amount of our volumes or largely all this will kick in, in the next year?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no, it will kick in this year only because -- but in domestic, a lot of volume is fragmented. All is not there with corporate customers, like the ceramic tiles business at Gujarat. I will give you an example. Ceramic tiles business at Gujarat is a fragmented business. There's no single person who controls the business.

But cement plants, cement manufacturers with whom we are tying up, they are very big people, UltraTech, My Home cement, they are well-known big corporate customers we have. So it's a mix of both.

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Bhoomika Nair: Okay. So difficult to give a percentage of total volumes, which would be more long-term oriented per se?

Sanjay Swarup: Correct. It is difficult to give.

Bhoomika Nair: And would the realization drop also be because of the discounts that we are giving to these customers, so which is why we are on a reported basis, seeing these discounts and a drop in realizations?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, definitely in a competitive environment, we have to have some tools by marketing tools by which we attract our customers. So some discounts we have to give.

Bhoomika Nair: Understood, sir. Understood. Great, sir. This is helpful. I really appreciate you taking time out for all the investors and all the participants on the call and giving us an opportunity to host the call. I wish you all the very best. And any closing comments from your side, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no, nothing. I just want to say that company is having very strong fundamentals, and we are giving a very strong infrastructure push. And our Board of Directors was appreciative about the performance of our employees. And we -- Board of Directors also wanted to reward the shareholders, which they have done by bonus shares and good dividend. So I hope we will be doing better in FY '26. Thank

you very much.

Moderator: On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Registrant Email Registrant PIN Registrant Date Name

krishnendu@quantumamc.com 88394 05/23/2025 09:28 IST Krishnendu Saha

mayurb@hdfclife.com 50960 05/22/2025 16:00 IST Mayur Bhurke

nsingh@choruscall.com 97989 05/02/2025 19:04 IST ZZZ

Deepak.kumarfil@fil.com 40408 05/22/2025 15:40 IST Deepak

gautam.trivedi@nepeancapital.com 70123 05/22/2025 16:11 IST Gautam Trivedi

manoj@carneliancapital.co.in 13664 05/22/2025 20:28 IST Manoj Bahety

shobhit.tiwari@canararobeco.com 81352 05/22/2025 15:33 IST SHOBHIT TIWARI  
praful.kumar@dymonasia.com 81109 05/22/2025 15:34 IST praful kumar  
priyanka.nangalia@adityabirlacapital.com 55000 05/22/2025 15:42 IST Priyanka Nangalia  
urmil.shah@ageasfederal.com 32543 05/22/2025 15:42 IST Urmil Shah  
noel.vaz@unionmf.com 972461 05/22/2025 16:59 IST noel vaz  
urmil@anvilwealth.in 06415 05/22/2025 22:37 IST Urmil Shah  
shalya.shah@kotak.com 08083 05/23/2025 10:44 IST shalya shah  
abhishek.ghosh@dspim.com 44562 05/23/2025 10:52 IST Abhishek Ghosh  
yash.h@damcapital.in 857435 05/05/2025 11:35 IST Yash Hegde  
nfgh1@gmail.com 751201 05/22/2025 15:02 IST ZZZ: Main Line  
nfgh2@gmail.com 761378 05/22/2025 15:03 IST ZZZ: Back Up  
ramesh.mantri@whiteoakinvestors.com 928387 05/22/2025 15:52 IST Ramesh Mantri  
dharmendra\_grover@helioscapital.in 199757 05/22/2025 16:04 IST Dharmendra Grover  
Arul.Selvan@bajajallianz.co.in 126932 05/22/2025 17:41 IST Arul Selvan  
anish.rankawat@uti.co.in 154377 05/23/2025 09:43 IST Anish Rankawat  
rakesh@questinvest.com 313917 05/23/2025 10:12 IST Rakesh Vyas  
manish.sonthalia@emkayim.com 005946 05/23/2025 10:39 IST Manish Sonthalia  
sumit.rathi@adityabirlacapital.com 909439 05/23/2025 10:40 IST Sumit Rathi  
Company Location Phone Number  
Quantum AMC Mumbai-Vashi 9892702832  
Hdfc Life Insurance Mumbai 9869439032  
CC Gurugram NA  
Fidelity Mumbai 0  
Nepean Capital LLP Mumbai 09920075111  
Carnelian Mumbai 9930146463  
CANARA ROBECO MUTUAL FUND MUMBAI 9552584542  
dymonasia singapore +656589388126  
Aditya Birla Sunlife Insurance Mumbai +919820810432  
Ageas Federal Life Insurance Mumbai 9819916595  
Union Asset Management mumbai +919820458707  
Anvil Research Mumbai 9819760697  
Kotak Mumbai 9820358864  
DSP Mumbai 9819431867  
Dam Capital Mumbai 9930522124  
MAIN Mumbai 123  
BACK UP Mumbai 123  
WhiteOak Mumbai +919892305917  
Helios Capital Mumbai 67319613  
Bajaj Allianz Life Pune 02066286347  
UTI MF Mumbai 9820563345  
Quest Investments Mumbai +919967030730  
Emkay Investment Managers limited Mumbai +919930450950  
ABSLAMC Mumbai 9718830988

## Call: Aug 2025

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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

(A '1,vratna CPSE of Govt. of India) No.CON/F&CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No.91029 /NoteNo.61/ ~: 11.08.2025

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2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (Through NEAPS)

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Mumbai-400 051

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~ : Disclosure under SEBI (Listing Obligation & Disclosure Requirements)

Regulations, 2015.

Pursuant to applicable provisions of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find

enclosed transcript of Post results conference call held on 06.08.2025.

For your information and record please.

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co.pro@conconnd1a.cmn Visit us at:hllp: w,n, co11con11clia.co.m

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"Container Corporation of India Limited

Q1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call"

August 06, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS AND
SERVICES) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

M R. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR
(DOMESTIC) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

M R. VIJOY KUMAR SINGH -- DIRECTOR
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING AND OPERATIONS) –
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. ANURAG KAPIL – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) –
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. HARISH CHANDRA -- PED (FINANCE) AND
COMPANY SECRETARY AND CHIEF FINANCIAL
OFFICER – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM C APITAL ADVISORS
LIMITED

Container Corporation of India Limited

August 06, 2025

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Container Corporation of India Limited Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Good morning, everyone and a warm welcome to the Q1 FY '26 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management today being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director. At this point, I'll hand over the floor to him for his initial remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you, Bhoomika. Good morning to you all. I am joined by my Directors, Director Projects, Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda; Director, Domestic, Mr. Mohammad Azhar Shams; Director, International Marketing and Operations, Mr. Vijoy Kumar Singh, Director Finance, Mr. Anurag Kapil; and PED, Finance and Company Secretary and CFO, Mr. Harish Chandra.

So I'm glad to announce that Board of Directors has approved a dividend of INR1.60, i.e. 32% on share of INR5 par value that is because of the good performance given by the company. Throughput in Q1 of FY '26 has been 1.29 million TEUs, which is all-time high for any Q1 in the company's history. Throughput growth has been excellent, 11.3% in which EXIM's contribution is 12%, and domestic's contribution is 9%. And India's international trade, merchandise trade also has seen a growth of 2% in EXIM -- in exports, which is USD112.17 billion, and 4% in imports, which is USD179.44 billion in Q1.

Domestic, we saw a subdued performance. There are primarily two reasons for this. First is the delay in supply of tank containers via M/s Braithwaite, and we were banking on it, and there has been some delay because for the first time, they have been manufacturing such containers. And second is the low-margin traffic that we have not picked up consciously because basically, our philosophy is to give good performance to -- good service to our customers while keeping the margins intact. We saw a good increase in market share, 200 basis points at JNPT, and market share was unchanged at Pipavav port.

Rail coefficient, we saw an increase at Mundra as well as Pipavav, which is a good news for us. Rail freight margin, I'm glad to announce that, despite increase of our market share, we have not sacrificed the rail freight margin and operating margin. Rail freight margin increased from 24.36% to 26.96%. Operating margin increased from 28.58% to 29.81%. And there is a growth in operating income, 2.5%, growth in PAT, 1%. It is slightly less as compared to physical volumes. There are basically three, four reasons for this.

First is the volume discount data. It was reconciled in Q1, and there were some reconciliation figures for that. Second is the increase in staff cost. It was due to the onetime award that we declared for good performance of our staff, which was reflected in this quarter's expenses. Third is the lead -- decrease in lead in EXIM by around 4%.

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The basic reason for this is less demand in North India. North India ICDs, there was less demand of imports, exports like Ludhiana, Tughlakabad and SIDCUL ICDs. So we saw below performance in these ICDs in Q1. Of course, now it has normalized in Q2. Then last reason is subdued demand in domestic, which I already explained earlier.

We saw a very handsome increase in double stack rakes, 11.2%. We have done 1,505 rakes this quarter, as

compared to 1,353 rakes in last year same quarter. We are continuously increasing our infrastructure. In this quarter, we have commissioned 5 high-speed rakes, and we have procured 1,500 containers for our domestic use. Capex achieved in Q1 is INR202.5 crores, and our Capex budget for this financial year remains intact at INR860 crores.

We will do a midyear review after Q2. Target for 2028 remains same, 100 terminals, 500-plus rakes, and more than 70,000 containers. I'm glad to announce there is an excellent growth in EXIM stream. It is likely to continue and will further increase. We'll see a quantum jump with commissioning of WDFC up to JNPT by December 2025.

In domestic, after a muted Q1, now there is a very robust growth we are observing in Q2 with excellent demand from Eastern India, mainly Gunny Bales Traffic, then our new terminal at Morbi, Rafaleswar in Gujarat also will give boost in business. Than bulk cement in tank containers, which is a new product.

And we are great -- happy to announce that we have loaded first rake on 30th June 2025, and industry has given a very positive response. We are going to get another rake by Braithwaite in this month only, and this will further contribute to our domestic traffic. Exports growth has been

good in auto parts, 22% growth.

Rice saw 12% growth, and ready-made garments, 14% growth. Imports, there was a good growth in aluminum scrap, 8%; stainless steel, 17% growth. We have commenced EXIM rail service from Hindustan Zinc's siding at Chanderiya to Mundra Port, which is a new service we have started. And there has been a good increase in direct port delivery movement also, almost 18% growth we have seen. Then there is a very good growth in imports at various ports that we have observed.

Overall, there has been a 12% growth in imports in this quarter. Mundra saw a growth of 8.4%; JNPT 19.3%; and Chennai, 19.4%; Vizag port, 29%. So there is a very good growth in imports that we have observed in this quarter. And one -- another good thing is there has been substantial decline in empty running of flats as well as empty containers, both in domestic and EXIM. Total empty running cost decrease was 13.7%, and which has contributed in a positive manner to our bottom line.

And I would like to inform another landmark achievement that were achieved by the company.

We signed an MOU with the RHS Group of Dubai for end-to-end logistics solution. And the containers of CONCOR are now moving across the shores of India. Till now, we were giving service only up to our ports, but now they have crossed the ports and they are reaching Dubai, and we are able to give end-to-end service to our customers. Several containers have moved to Dubai, Sharjah and other parts of UAE.

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And very soon, we will be starting such service to other countries like Singapore also. I would like to mention again that we are in touch with big corporate houses, Tata, Jindal, Vedanta, JK Cement, LT Foods and they have shown a positive attitude for giving more and more business to CONCOR. So mostly, it will be in domestic. So the outlook of the company is very, very strong and positive. And we hope that we will be showing very good results in the coming quarters of this financial year.

At this point, I would like to keep the guidance unchanged at 13%, in which EXIM will be 10%, and domestic will be 20%. So that's all opening remarks from my side. Now you can start the questions.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Disha Giria from Ashika Institutional Desk.

Disha Giria: Sir, my first question is regarding the domestic volume and the domestic realization. So what we have seen in the past is whenever there has been a volume thrust, volume increase, the realization has gone down and that impacts your revenue. So could you give us a competitive intensity of what the market dynamics is right

now in the domestic market and how we are going

to take it forward? Because our top line decline is something that concerns me.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. As I informed you that domestic, the growth was muted in the first quarter. And now we are seeing very good growth in domestic. And we are getting return traffic also. So empty running is coming down.

And in Q1 also in domestic, empty running, in fact, has come down by almost 12%. So with the good management of demand, we are quite hopeful that in the coming quarters, we'll show a good performance in domestic.

Disha Giria: Okay. Sir, my second question is regarding the bulk cement containers. We already have one rake from Braithwaite, and you said that we are in process of receiving another rake. So if you could just give us some quantitative numbers on how the demand has been, and how is it processing out in the market? And what do you expect it to contribute to the total volume for the full year?

Sanjay Swarup: See, demand is enormous. Like we do around 14 to 15 million tonnes in domestic every year. So demand is -- only bulk cement in tank containers can add same volume every year. So hardly 9% to 10% is moving by rail. Everything is moving by road.

So this is a new product that we have launched. So because now the containers are getting manufactured. So as soon as we start getting containers from -- we have -- apart from Braithwaite, we floated an open tender and one private company is also manufacturing some containers for us. So from both the sources, we will be getting. But now because in this -- there is a monsoon time now.

So cement, as you know, construction activities are not carried out in this time. So cement loading drops during the Q2 period also when monsoon will end in September. Then from Q3 onwards, we can see a very good growth in bulk cement loading, and we will get containers from private vendor also from which we have ordered. So Q2, of course, bulk cement loading will not

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be much because of the monsoon. And from Q3, we can expect very good loading in bulk cement.

Disha Giria: Okay, sir. Sir, if I can ask one last question. The employee cost, you mentioned it's a one-off for this period. So going forward for the other quarters, can we expect the normative range of employee cost, how it had been in the past year?

Sanjay Swarup: See, this was actually aberration that we announced an award. But normally, as I told you -- as you are aware, of course, that our employee cost is usually around 5% of our turnover. So we will be ending the year on that number only.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes. Sir, first, if you can just share the originating volumes for both EXIM and domestic?

Sanjay Swarup: I will tell you. Originating volume for EXIM 5,31,099, Domestic 1,21,624. Total 6,52,723.

Bhoomika Nair: Sure, sir. Sir, in terms of the -- you spoke about onetime employee, how much would that award be and which would have led to a higher employee cost this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: We gave 1-month salary to them. You want number?

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. The onetime cost number.

Sanjay Swarup: Around INR18 crores.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. Okay. And you also spoke about volume discount that happened in the first quarter this time. Sir, what was that amount? And how should we look at it going ahead?

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, that was -- as I told you, that was a onetime -- that was, you can say, a reconciliation kind of thing that was done. So normally...

Sanjay Swarup: So it will have around 1% impact, you can say.

Bhoomika Nair: 1% of revenues?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes.

Bhoomika Nair: Total revenue, sir, all put together?

Sanjay Swarup: Right, right.

Bhoomika Nair: Around -- I mean, roughly only for the quarter, so about INR21 crores?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, INR21 crores.

Bhoomika

Nair: Okay. Okay. Understood. Understood. Sir, the other thing was you spoke about lead distances coming down because of the demand being a little weak.

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A, can you give the lead distance? And B, how is the demand now panning out in -- particularly in the month of July, August, how are you seeing the outlook in terms of the movement of volumes?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Now the lead distance is for this quarter for the EXIM, it was 688 kilometers and domestic, it was 1,356 kilometers. Total 792 kilometers. So now the demand is very good, as I told you in Q2. So this North India is showing good demand. And both imports, exports, as well as domestic has picked up. In Q1, it was somehow subdued. So it has picked up now, and we are getting good volumes.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. Okay. And in terms of the export, import, any improvement that you're seeing out there, particularly given this whole trade-related issues, tariffs, are you seeing any slowdown per se that you are witnessing now in August, September?

Sanjay Swarup: See, all I can tell you is that in Q1, we have posted a handsome growth of 12% in export, import handling. And till now, we are able to maintain that. So we are not seeing any impact.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from JM Financial.

Priyanka Biswas: My question is -- see, sir, in last year 1Q, the EXIM volume base was quite low because it was, if I recall, something like 481,000 TEUs on an originating basis. And then in September, we had a large increase as well, and this rate was maintained in September and December. So given that even on a weak base, we were not able to deliver a very strong growth. So what gives us the confidence that in the next 2 quarters, we will have growth on a relatively high base? So that's my first question.

Sanjay Swarup: See, as I told you in this quarter, you are right, it was around 4,81,000 last year in EXIM in originating, but we are able to give 10.2% growth in that. And for Q2, I can tell you same growth is being maintained. So what is your question exactly? I'm not able to understand. We are able to maintain that growth and we are -- there is a demand in import, export both.

So what exactly are you asking? I'm not able to understand.

Priyanka Biswas: See, I'm asking that in September 2024 quarter, your EXIM volumes increased very sharply. So from 4,80,000 TEUs on handling basis -- on originating basis to something like 5,50,000 TEUs broadly. So that was a steep jump, almost like 15% quarter-on-quarter jump that you had last year. So can a similar level of growth happen Q-o-Q this time as well?

Sanjay Swarup: See, I'm not an astrologer, so I cannot predict what will happen in the remaining part of the year. All I can tell you is there are good indications that there will be a very good growth in this financial year also. What will happen, I don't know. I can only see the market forces that are operating and what volumes we are getting because of our various policies. So this is giving us results.

Even in this Q2, I'm telling you we are maintaining the growth of Q1.

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Priyanka Biswas: Okay, sir. And sir, if I may add another question. Can you just comment on the pricing landscape? So what I'm essentially trying to see is like what is the -- how does our pricing stand, let's say, versus other CTOs on same routes? And what is the comparable pricing for roads, given that the diesel prices have been sort of stable, if you can elaborate on that?

Sanjay Swarup: See, pricing normally, what we do is when we do pricing, we take, of course, road rates into comparison. We don't see what our CTOs are offering because our service levels are completely different from them. Normally, I don't -- I will not like to comment on how they are pricing their products.

But

the very proof that we are able to maintain 55% to 60% market share, and it proves that whatever pricing, whatever service levels we are able to maintain, customers are using our services. What model they are following, I cannot comment on that.

Priyanka Biswas: So sir, if we benchmark against roads, so like diesel prices, we were saying was sort of being stable. So can you comment like how has the -- at least wherever you have direct roads competition, like what is the sort of differential we have vis-a-vis roads on a general basis? And since you are also offering, let's say, first mile and last mile at several places as well. So on a total delivered basis, I mean, from door-to-door to customers, so how does our offerings compare versus, let's say, a pure roads?

Sanjay Swarup: As I already told you, since we are able to attract traffic, so that means we are competitive. More than that, I cannot disclose in the conference call. These are commercial decisions of the company, which cannot be put in public domain.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama.

Achal Lohade: Sir, I just wanted to check in terms of the first mile, last mile, what is the mix in 1Q? And how do you see it changing? And what kind of impact does it have in terms of the profitability or profit contribution?

Sanjay Swarup: First mile last mile, we are able to do a total volume, around 35%, we are able to do first mile last mile. In Q1 also, we are able to do 35%. Now we are going to scale up. And we are not looking per se at a very high profit margin on this segment. But we are using it as a, you can say, marketing tool to attract more and more business to our fold.

Even with very less margin, we are aiming to attract more customers so that we get more business, and in turn more traffic on rail, warehousing and handling. So that will be our major sources of revenue, not first mile, last mile. But of course, it is a profitable business. We are not incurring any loss in that.

Achal Lohade: And is it fair to say that this first mile, last mile revenue would be about 5%, 7% of the handling revenue, total revenue? Would that be a fair assumption for the EXIM revenue? Or it would be even lesser than that?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes. It is around 5% of total revenue. Yes, you're right.

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Achal Lohade: Of total EXIM revenue, you mean, right, sir? This is more for the EXIM you're talking about? Or are you talking about the...

Sanjay Swarup: No, I'm talking about the total revenue. It was around INR98 crores for Q1. So it is almost -- for the total revenue, I'm talking about this first mile, last mile is for EXIM domestic both.

Achal Lohade: Right. Understood. The second question I had, sir, if I look at the segmental revenue what you have given and the volume what you have given for the EXIM, I get a realization of roughly around 26,000. So that's declined about 4% Y-o-Y. Any particular reason?

You did mention the lead distance, the north cargo. Is that the only reason? Or you think there is an element of the discounting part will also play out in this realization aspect as well, right, sir? The volume discount what you mentioned?

Sanjay Swarup: So actually, you have mentioned correctly, lead is the only reason because of the 4% decline in lead and less demand in North India, that was the only reason for less realization.

Achal Lohade: And how about the volume discount reconciliation you mentioned, that would have had an

impact on the revenue and hence realization, right, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Volume discount reconciliation, of course, will have some impact, but major reason was the decrease in lead.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Understood. Sir, if you could help us with the market share for port-wise and also the port mix, which you could, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. At JNPT, our market share is 58.39% in Q1. Last year, it

was 56.02%. Mundra port, it is

36%. Last year, it was 38%. Pipavav, it was 49%, same as last year.

Achal Lohade: And aggregate, sir, would you have, overall India level?

Sanjay Swarup: India level, yes. India level, our market share, EXIM-domestic combined was 53.6%.

Achal Lohade: Sorry, only EXIM, sir, if you could help with that?

Sanjay Swarup: Only EXIM is 53.1%.

Achal Lohade: And the last year, same quarter, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Last year, it was 55%.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Understood. And the port mix, if you could, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Port mix, CONCOR volumes from ports?

Achal Lohade: Yes, yes.

Sanjay Swarup: JNPT contributed 35%, Mundra 35.3%, Pipavav 8%, Vizag 6%, Chennai 4.8%, Vallarpadam 5%. Rest all was small, like Ennore 2%; Tuticorin 1%.

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Achal Lohade: Got it. And empty's cost, if you could help us the absolute number for domestic EXIM, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. It was EXIM it was INR27.69 crores, domestic INR65.64 crores, total INR93.32 crores.

Achal Lohade: And these are sustainable given the way things are evolving. Have I understood right, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, these are sustainable.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from B&K Securities.

Anupam Goswami: Sir, you mentioned about some volume discount in the Q1. How do we take the realization for the rest of the quarter? And given some demand being muted in the first quarter, are we seeing that pent-up demand coming in the 9 months?

Sanjay Swarup: The reconciliation was done only in this Q1, as I told you initially. And now we are seeing good demand. There won't be a reconciliation now. So we can expect good numbers from Q2 onwards.

Anupam Goswami: And sir, so clarifying, sir, we don't expect any much broader discounts in the next Q2 onwards, right, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: And then employee cost will also be extra cost that were awarded -- that was given and it was only in this quarter. That also will not be there in the coming quarters. So all these were onetime things.

Anupam Goswami: Okay. Sir, and double stacking now been increasing, should we expect -- how much of the total volume -- if we can get some unit economics in that, how much of a margin improvement should follow in the next -- let's say, in the coming years?

Sanjay Swarup: What exactly -- I'm not able to understand your question?

Anupam Goswami: Sir, double stacking now that we are increasing, where do we see that going? And how much of a margin improvement can follow?

Sanjay Swarup: See, double stack actually already every year, we are growing almost 20% to 25%. This year also, we are going -- 11.2% growth we have seen. So now double stacking we'll see around this growth only. And from -- when the JNPT comes on double stack by December, then from Q4 of this financial year, we can see some real growth in double stacking.

Anupam Goswami: Okay. So JNPT, we don't see any further delay as of now?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no. I think it is going to be commissioned by December '25.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Koundinya from Jefferies.

Koundinya: Thanks for the opportunity, that's just Koundinya here. So sir, my first question is if you can help us maybe understand this volume discounting part a bit better. I mean, what happened?

Why was it given? And how should we read it for the coming quarter? I mean, can you throw some color?

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And what extent of it has been reflected in the EXIM or the domestic segment? That's one. And two, a couple of bookkeeping questions. If you can help us with the lead distance and rail freight margins for the last quarter, 1Q '25, please?

Sanjay Swarup: As I told you, we are seeing very good growth in EXIM. It will continue. Plus domestic also from this quarter onwards, we are seeing a good demand and good growth we are able to

o

maintain. So this will increase our volumes and which will be -- we will be able to achieve the guidance that I gave you at the start of financial year. So this will translate into good financial numbers also in the coming quarters.

And lead distance is, I told you, it was 792 kilometers for this quarter for the company. What other bookkeeping question do you want?

Koundinya: Sir, I was asking for the last -- 1Q FY '25, last quarter, the lead distance and rail freight margin.

Sanjay Swarup: Rail freight margin?

Koundinya: For the last quarter, not 1Q '26, but 1Q '25?

Sanjay Swarup: It was rail freight margin was 24.66%. This year, it is 26.96%.

Koundinya: Sure. Sir, I mean, just to understand that volume reconciliation part, I mean, what was the reason why it was given? I mean, is it like a rising competitive intensity and therefore, you have to provide discounts? Or what exactly happened? If you can help us understand that better, please?

Sorry, it was a little unclear for me.

Sanjay Swarup: This volume discount reconciliation is normally that we pay to our shipping lines and our customers to -- there's an incentive kind of scheme. If they give more volume, they get more discount. So these numbers are calculated and at the end of the financial year. Sometimes it spilled over to the next quarter for making payments to them, reconciliation takes some time.

And that is the only reason.

Koundinya: So are you saying that these are actually discounts given in the last financial year, but are reflected now? Is that the way to look at?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, these are the discounts which were for the volumes offered in the last financial year. I would like to put it in that way.

Koundinya: Okay. And I mean the reason I'm asking that on this realization part and the discount part is because one of your smaller peers also reflected a decline in realization. So just trying to understand if at an industry level, you are seeing a pricing aggression kind of thing?

Sanjay Swarup: No, no, it is not that. It happens every time. Reconciliation takes some time. You are very well-versed in finance. So you know these things. Actually, there is no change in our discount policy. Whatever discount has been given, the figures were being reconciled with the customers.

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After reconciliation, their bills are settled. So that takes a little time. So that happened. There has been no change in volume discount policy. The policy remains the same. So we don't expect any adverse effect this year.

Koundinya: Okay. Sir, can you speak a little bit about the outlook on the containers. You did speak that EXIM growth is good? But do you see any challenge amidst whatever is happening on the tariff side globally and all that? So what is your reading on that side, if you have -- can throw some color, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Till now, we have not experienced any effect on our volumes as a result of tariffs. But we should be very optimistic. I can only say that if one door is closed, there are several other doors which can be opened. I think you will understand.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Krupashankar from Avendus Spark.

Krupashankar: My first question would be on the land license fee. Just wanted to get a sense around any decisions taken with respect to surrendering of some of the unused land and reducing this LLF cost, which we were contemplating last year. So any thoughts around that?

Sanjay Swarup: See, that is -- as I told in my earlier conference calls also, that is a continuous exercise being done by our company that wherever we find that land is surplus, or if we come up with a terminal near the existing facility, or which is catering to the same hinterland, then we immediately surrender the land. So that process is continuous. Like in Jodhpur, we have a terminal at Bhagat Ki Kothi.

Now we are coming up with

a new terminal at Kathuwas. So we will surrender railway lines at Bhagat Ki Kothi and we'll have our own terminal at Kathuwas. So this is a continuous exercise that we are undertaking. So that is why you can see that despite the formula of 7% growth in LLF every year, we are able to maintain the same number that we are paying to rail. This is the only reason.

Krupashankar: Understood, sir. Understood. My second question on the domestic side of things. While I do understand that there are certain challenges with respect to volume growth coming in the first quarter, and we are quite optimistic about the second half, the 20% guidance what you have given puts a lot of pressure on achieving NIM in the second half.

So just want to get some more sense that are there any other efforts you are trying to incorporate, for example, catering beyond cement into -- so on to deliver 20% growth for the year in domestic?

Sanjay Swarup: I will request my Director, Domestic, he will take the question.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Actually, our CMD underlined that the growth in the domestic has been subdued. So there have been reasons to it. One was that we have been banking on the supply of tank container for cement. Cement -- movement of cement in loose is having a very great demand, around 70 million to 80 million of loose cement in moving in the bulk. The 1,000 container order we have given 500 to Braithwaite and then 500 in the open market.
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So first rake we have got that got delayed basically. And the second rake we are going to get in this month only. So these are the 2 rakes and the 500 tank container orders we have given to Basant Fabricator, a company in Ahmedabad. They have assured us that within 2 to 3 months, they shall be starting supply of their container, the first we shall be getting within 3 months. So I think combined, this is one aspect where we are going to get the traffic and there is no dearth of the demand with respect to movement of bulk cement in tank containers.

The second is the movement of liquid cargo like caustic soda, benzene and all those. We have been in talk to customers. And we are likely to get additional traffic with the movement of liquid -- liquid in the tank containers. And then we have been basically trying to tie up with the big corporate houses for offering traffic directly to container corporation. Our CMD has met the top office in JK Cement and sir had a meeting with Mr.

N. Chandrasekaran also of the Tata Group a few days back. And sir had a meeting with CMD, SAIL also. So I think to boost the domestic traffic and then get -- ensure growth, whatever guidance sir has given, so I think we are on the line. And to cater this traffic, we have given order of 1,000, 40 feet open top containers for carrying various steel products.

So I think these 2, 3 initiatives like bulk cement and liquid cargo and the association with the top growth, and 40 feet open top containers for steel movement. I think these combined together, we are going to get a good traffic in the domestic. I think starting from the mid of the second quarter and then subsequently third and fourth quarter.

Krupashankar: Understood. One last question, if I may. On the EXIM side of things, sir, you did mention that the rail coefficient has increased in Mundra and Pipavav. Just wanted to get a sense what has led to this improvement in this quarter, and the extent of sustenance of this improvement going ahead? While you did mention that JNPT will further improve the rail coefficient levels, but just wanted to get a sense on what is driving this improvement in Mundra and Pipavav?

Sanjay Swarup: Mundra and Pipavav actually is getting more traffic for ICDs. So that's a healthy trend, I should say. At Mundra, around 2%; and Pipavav, it is around 3%. We have seen a growth in Q1, which is a good trend, and that means more and more business

is coming on rail, which is good for the country. And it's a green mode of transport.

So we have to encourage more and more momentum there.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditya Mongia: Just a clarification to start with. From what I could recall, you gained 200 basis points of EXIM market share in JNPT and you lost 200 basis points of EXIM market share in Mundra. And both these are kind of equally relevant in your port mix. How come have you lost 200 basis points overall in margins? Is it just a growth differential between Mundra and everything else? Or am I missing something over here?

Sanjay Swarup: In margins?

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Aditya Mongia: No, no. I'm just saying in market share. So apologies for the confusion. It's market share, not margins, yes. So just that you won as much in JNPT incrementally as you lost in Mundra, and both these are equal heavy weights in your port revenue mix. And how come you've lost 200 basis points on overall margins? I could not get it very well.

Sanjay Swarup: So now the thing is that I -- as I told you in my opening address, there was a subdued demand in North India in our ICDs like Tughlakabad, Dadri, Ludhiana and Pantnagar. And primarily, the Mundra traffic is being catered by North India ICDs. So this subdued demand in North India directly reflected in Mundra volumes. So that is the reason of 200 basis points drop at Mundra. And JNPT is primarily catering to areas like this Hyderabad, Nagpur, Indore, Bhopal.

So these ICDs have done extremely well and both in imports and export terms. So that is why we are seeing a good growth in JNPT, Ankleshwar also, Baroda also. All these ICDs of Central India, I should say, and South, some ICDs, they have shown a very good growth trend. So that is why JNPT saw a good growth of 200 basis points and Mundra, we lost 200 basis points because of less demand, which is now...

Aditya Mongia: This is market share, right? So you lost market share in Mundra because someone else gained market share, right, not because of...

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes. Someone has gained market share because in their ICDs, they have got more containers, and we somehow could not get in our ICD.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. Just a related question. As in Mundra, your market share, obviously -- so in JNPT, you have been able to reverse the market share trend. But in Mundra, that has not happened over the last 2, 3 years. Any specific kind of thought process on how -- any learnings from JNPT can we reverse the trend in Mundra incrementally and how to go about it?

Sanjay Swarup: See, all the markets are not same. On some segments, there is very low margin movements also, which consciously we are not picking up low-margin business. It's not the policy of the company to pick up any margin business. So that is the only reason. As far as learnings are concerned, definitely, we keep on -- keep track of our various customers, various ICDs.

We do thread bare detailed discussions. And wherever course corrections are required, we are taking that course correction.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. The second question is more on the rail freight margin. I mean obviously, it's handsomely improved. What are the reasons driving the same? And from here on, to go up from 27% as what else can happen?

Sanjay Swarup: See, the two, three reasons are there. First is the reduction in empty running cost, which I have already explained and due to the excellent planning of our operations team, then double stacking has also increased, which has also contributed to the bottom line in rail freight margins. Then we are able to do -- related thing is that we are able to do both side movement in domestic, which is also increasing. And in EXIM also, we are getting imports, exports both. So this is -- these are the various factors that contribute to improvement in rail

freight margin.

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And 27% rail freight margin is very good, I should say. And let us hope that we will be able to maintain this.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. Just a related question. As we've seen rail freight margins go up. Obviously, the domestic component. I'm assuming there's an EXIM component as well.

But then we have lost market share on the EXIM side. Does the company think through or see merit in using the pricing angle in some form to retain or regain that market share on an overall basis in EXIM?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Actually, we keep on working. We keep working on that. And we are doing strategically where to trigger with -- where to play with our rail freight and tariffs and all. So -- and where we can give discounts to get more volumes.

That is a continuous exercise that we are doing. And -- but we don't drastically reduce our margins to gain volumes. We try to have entered into a contract with big players, like I told you for big corporate houses. And then based on the -- some signing of some contract or some agreement with them, we give them some special rates or special discounts. These are the policies that we adopt to gain our volumes.

Randomly, we will not bring down our tariff so that we can get more volumes. We don't work on that philosophy.

Aditya Mongia: Maybe just a last question from my side and then I'll fall back into the queue. On the domestic side of things, has the market shares shown any change over the last 1 year? And if so, what are the reasons if there is any meaningful change that has happened on a Y-o-Y basis in the domestic side of things?

Sanjay Swarup: Domestic, actually, we saw a drop in our market share, which was a very big drop. And the reason, as I told in my opening remarks, that low-margin traffic consciously, we have not picked up in domestic. And we are facing intense competition from PCTO. And because of the policy that we will not pick up the low-margin business, somehow market share has dropped.

Aditya Mongia: I'm sorry, I missed the number, if you could just repeat the fall? And is it the same competitor in EXIM that is hurting you on domestic? Those would be my final things.

Sanjay Swarup: Number is -- last year, it was 57.7%. This year is 55%. And I would not like to take the name of competitors. That will not be fair.

Moderator: Our next follow-up question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama.

Achal Lohade: Sir, just a small clarification. So you said the market share in Mundra actually dropped and as much we have gained in JNPT. And the mix is similar. So how come we dropped as much as the overall EXIM market share, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. EXIM market share overall, it comprises of pan-India volume apart from JNPT and Mundra, because JNPT and Mundra contribute combined 70% of our total EXIM. So rest 30% is also there. So that also contributes to market share.

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Achal Lohade: Okay. No, what I was saying is that if I look at the market share, it's stable at Pipavav. Mundra, Pipavav, JNPT together would be the largest proportion. So is the drop in the non-West Coast port that substantial, which is driving this market share drop at the aggregate level?

Sanjay Swarup: So that analysis, we have not carried out. It's a good suggestion. We'll carry out the analysis and get back to you.

Achal Lohade: Sure, sir. Sir, one more question, if you could help us with just a ballpark number. Of the JNPT total, whatever, 9 million TEU, how much would be destined for north, which is in and around DFC? Could that be 2 million, 3 million or 1 million TEU thereabout?

Sanjay Swarup: This question also, I cannot reply now. I don't have the data with me right now, but we can reply to you separately.

Achal Lohade: Sure, sir. And any quantification you could do with respect to the benefit of t

he double stacking,

like what kind of saving we would have had theoretically out of this double stacking volume,

let's say, for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Actually, we had taken out this figure several years back. At that time, it was around INR5 lakh for every one double stack train that was handled. But we will have to recalculate in the present context.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And just last question, sir, LLF, what is that number we should work with? Like is this INR110 crores is a sustainable number? So should we work with INR440 crores? Or should we work with INR370 crores, like you said, we are looking at the same cost of last year?

Sanjay Swarup: I think between INR370 crores and INR400 crores should be a good number.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Ankita Shah from Elara Capital.

Ankita Shah: Sir, the new terminal additions that you are doing, is this on the EXIM side or domestic side?

Sanjay Swarup: Normally, now the new terminals that we are creating are all multimodal logistic parts. So they will have both EXIM and domestic facility. To start with, it will have only domestic because EXIM customs notification takes some time. So -- but eventually, it will have both EXIM plus domestic.

Ankita Shah: So our current terminals, it is around, I think, around 60 terminals. Are they fully utilized?

Sanjay Swarup: We have total 66 terminals. So yes, they are all utilized.

Ankita Shah: 100%?

Sanjay Swarup: So that is a different figure for different terminals. That detail I cannot give you in this conference call. We can give you separately.

Ankita Shah: Got it. And sir, what is the thought process behind going overseas market?

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Sanjay Swarup: Thought process is that we want to give end-to-end service to our customers from their doorstep up to the doorstep of their final consignee. So we were able to give service only up to Indian ports. Now we are giving the service right up to the final destination. So that is the basic philosophy of our...

Ankita Shah: Sir, what kind of services this will include?

Sanjay Swarup: This will include ocean transportation on ships from Indian ports to foreign ports and from there to the final destination.

Ankita Shah: So you tie up with shipping lines for the ocean movement or you deploy your own ships? And what about...

Sanjay Swarup: As I mentioned in my opening remarks, we have tied up with RHS Group of Dubai, who is an NVOCC and a big operator in Dubai. So he is taking care of movement from Indian ports up to Dubai and last mile transportation up to the final destination. He's not a shipping line.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Pulkit Patni from Goldman Sachs.

Pulkit Patni: Sir, just one question. While a lot has been said for the last few years about JNPT connecting to DFC and giving huge volumes. One, what is our preparedness? All these large container orders that we've placed, is that with the idea that the volumes will come to us? Plus, is there any rough calculation on what level of volume growth would come to just not you, but rail operators in general after DFC connects?

Because I'm sure when you are placing these orders, you are doing some calculation on what kind of growth you are likely to get. So just some qualitative guidance would be good enough. I'm not asking for actual numbers.

Sanjay Swarup: See, now the thing is that we are fully prepared and DFC connection is done at JNPT. Right now, we have 4 terminals already on DFC. That is Dadri, Khatuwas, Swaroopganj and Varnama. And fifth terminal is coming up at Chharodi. So we are fully geared up to handle at our terminals.

Secondly, we have sufficient number of rolling stock. We are already having 394 rakes at the end of this quarter. And in another 3 years, we will be 500-plus rakes. So as far as rolling stock is concerned, as far as terminals are concerned, we are

fully geared up. And then we will be running timetable trains now from Dadri to JNPT once it is connected in collaboration with Indian Railways.

So it will result in a lot of cargo shifting from road to rail as we have seen in Mundra. And they will be all double stack trains. So all I can give you a number is as per the National Rail Plan, the rail coefficient at present is 18% to 20%. So this will move to 35% to 40% when DFC gets connected to JNPT. So these are the figures in National Rail Plan.

And of course, it will not happen overnight. It will take some time to materialize. Suppose by December 2025, the DFC gets connected to JNPT, then it will take some 7, 8 months or maybe 1 year to stabilize this volume. I hope I have clarified your question.

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Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Anupam Goswami from B&K Securities.

Anupam Goswami: Sir, when we saw Mundra and Pipavav connecting to rail, how much there the rail coefficient increase? And how confident are we in the JNPT, DFC connecting and then rail coefficient increasing to that level? Because I think Mundra, we did not see much of a rail coefficient increase. What would lead to here, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: See, there are various reasons. Mundra also this quarter, we have seen increase. Pipavav also, we have seen increase. So maybe there is a different dynamics which plays like some consignees want that -- they want to destock the container engineer by CFSS and use other modes of transport, shipping lines are also there. So these things are there.

But I can say with confidence that because DFC is going right up to JNPT, whereas in Mundra, Pipavav, it is feeder routes. So there is a lot of difference in that. And if main DFC is going, then it has the capacity to carry 25-tonne axle load wagons also, which leverage we are not getting at Mundra, Pipavav because Indian railway track is not fit for that. So double stacking will be much more in JNPT. So you cannot compare the 2 DFCs.

Anupam Goswami: Okay. Sir, just one last question. We saw tariffs now being -- there's an uncertainty in U.S. tariff, will that somehow slow the growth in EXIM in India if some adverse decision is taken there?

And at the same time, we have lost some market share in domestic.

How confident are we to maintain the guidance in volume terms what we given earlier?

Sanjay Swarup: See, till now, we have not seen any impact of the tariffs on our volumes in Q2 also. And as I told you earlier, if one door is closed, there are several other doors which can be opened. India is a very big economy, and it's a very big market. It has got excellent growth prospects. So it cannot be ignored in the world trade.

I can only mention this much. And as far as the domestic volumes are concerned, my Director Domestic has already explained in detail that we are very confident of achieving the guidance, both in EXIM and domestic. This should be our last question, I think.

Moderator: Okay sir. Thank you, ladies and gentlemen. This was the last question for today. And I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital. Over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Thank you very much for giving us an opportunity to host the call and all the participants as well for being on the call. Thank you very much, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect.

Call: Nov 2025

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"Container Corporation of India Limited
Q2 FY26 Earnings Conference Call"
November 12, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED
M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS &
SERVICES) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED
M R. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR
(DOMESTIC) – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA
LIMITED
M R. VIJOY KUMAR SINGH – DIRECTOR
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING AND OPERATIONS) –
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
M R. ANURAG KAPIL – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) –
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
M R. HARISH CHANDRA -- PED (FINANCE) AND CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF
INDIA LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. BHOOMIKA NAIR – DAM C APITAL ADVISORS
LIMITED

Container Corporation of India Limited
November 12, 2025

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Container Corporation of India Limited Earnings Call Q2 FY '26 hosted by DAM Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Bhoomika Nair. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes. Thanks. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to the Q2 FY '26 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director. At this point, I'll hand over the floor to him for his initial remarks, post which we'll open up the floor for Q&A.

Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Good morning, Bhoomika. I'm joined by my Directors, Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda, Director (Projects and Services); Mr. Mohammad Azhar Shams, Director (Domestic Division); Mr. Vijay Kumar Singh, Director (International Marketing and Operations); and Mr. Anurag Kapil, Director (Finance); Mr. Harish Chandra, Principal Executive Director (Finance) and CFO of the company. I would like to make initial remarks, and then we can proceed with question and answers.

At the outset, I am glad to announce the dividend approved by Board of Directors, INR2.60 on a share of par value of INR5. That makes a total dividend this year of INR4.20, which is 84% of the par value of share. And the performance of the company in Q2 has been the ever highest throughput of 1.44 million TEUs, ever highest operating income and ever highest PAT in the history of the company in any quarter.

We have achieved throughput of 2.73 million TEUs in first half of FY '26, throughput growth has been 11% year-on-year basis, in which EXIM is 10.2%, domestic is 13%. and in the India's international trade also, merchandise trade has increased by 3% in first half of this financial year. And total export was USD 220.1 billion, which is 3% increase. Imports was USD 375.1 billion, which is 4.5% increase in the first half of this financial year.

Domestic demand, domestic throughput has been slightly less as per our expectations. The main reasons were the less demand in cement due to monsoon season, which is now picking up. Then Gunny Bales also, there was less demand and tiles traffic also, there was less demand. Now demand has picked up, and we are having good loading in domestic.

Apart from that, tank container supply, we had given orders for 1,000 containers. We have already got 200 containers and supply is now being smooth, and we will be getting good supply of tank containers, which will help us in ramp up our loading in domestic streams. Market share, there has been increase at JNPT, 178 basis points and decrease at Mundra, 261 basis points; increase at Pipavav, 178 basis points.

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The good thing is that we have increased the market share at ports. And at the same time, we have increased our margin also. So rail freight margin has increased from 26.17% to 27.80%. Operating margin has increased from 30.47% to 31.44%. So margin has also increased and market share has also increased.

Growth in operating income for the first half is 2.7%, growth in PAT is 1.3%. And this growth would have been more, but because of 2 reasons, it is slightly not in conformity with the physical volume growth. First reason is the subdued demand in domestic business streams for the first half of financial year. And second reason is the decrease in EXIM leads by 2.5% due to less demand in North India ICDs. Then there has been a good growth

in double-stack handling,
almost 7.4% growth.

Last year, we have handled 3,083 double-stack trains. This year, it is 3,312 in the same year-on-year basis. Then my operations team has performed excellently, and they have planned the rakes in a rakes movement and loading in a very nice manner, which has resulted in reduction in empty running of rakes, rakes and containers. EXIM empty running is down by 18%, domestic, it is down by 6.7%. So overall, it is 10.2% on a year-on-year basis.

We are quite optimistic of the demand in the future, which is now driving the infrastructure additions also. In the first half, we have commissioned 21 rakes, new rakes, high-speed rakes and which takes us total count to around 410 rakes. We have procured 3,000 containers, which takes our total count to around 56,000 container fleet for CONCOR. Capex, we have already spent INR420.35 crores as against a budget of INR860 crores. Board of Directors have

deliberated and most probably, we will be increasing the budget because we have to increase more infrastructure spending.

Target for infrastructure for 2028 remains the same, 100 terminals, 500-plus rakes and 70,000 containers for CONCOR. In EXIM, we are experiencing excellent growth, which is likely to continue. WDFC, connectivity to JNPT is likely by March 2026. Initially, it was December 2025, but it has been pushed by some accounts.

The export growth for the first half is very good in rice, almost 41% growth, auto parts, 18% growth, meat, that is buffalo meat, reefer, which goes in reefer containers, we have seen 18% growth and aluminium ingots, 13% growth. Imports growth is quite good in solar panel. There's a glass item, which is a component in solar panel. It is -- we have seen a 5x growth in imports in this particular commodity. Raw cotton, we have seen 100% growth and auto parts, we have seen 46% growth in first part of financial year.

We have commenced new EXIM reefer, road cum rail service from our ICD at Baddi to Mundra Port via Dadri. DPD movements will get a further boost, which will increase our volumes, and we have come up with a new liberalized policy of DPD, which will further bring us more business and more revenue. DPE movement from our terminal at Khemli has also grown manifold. In last year, it was nil. This year till now, we have moved 275 TEUs from Khemli to Mundra Port.

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Growth in imports has also been quite good at all the ports. JNPT, 17.5% growth. Mundra, 2% and Chennai Port, 15%, Visakhapatnam Port around 6% growth is there. In domestic, we have achieved a big breakthrough by signing MOUs with 2 giants in cement sector. First is UltraTech Cement and second is Adani Cement for movement of bulk cement in tank containers.

So this will be a very big driver of domestic streams in the coming months. Gunny Bales and cement demand are showing very good growth signs from Q3 onwards. CONCOR has been an integral part of new initiatives of end-to-end logistics launched by Indian Railways. Three initiatives have been launched by Honorable Minister of Railways for which CONCOR is an integral part. First is the assured transit time train from Delhi to Kolkata, which is being well patronized by trade.

And it is moving to -- it is almost 80% occupancy is there. And by this month end, we will have 100% occupancy of this assured transit train. This is a big hit with the trade. Second is management of Sonik Goods Shed in Lucknow division. We are developing this goods shed into an integrated logistics hub, which will be a new line of business for the company.

This is -- has been given on pilot basis by Indian Railways to CONCOR for 4 years, and we will be demonstrating the positive impact of this move and Indian Railways is quite inclined to give us more goods shed to CONCOR for developing integrated logistics hub, where we will be giving warehousing and logi

stics solutions to customers. And this is a very big step for end-to-end logistics by Indian Railways.

And third, the parcel service from Mumbai to Kolkata in which we are giving first mile, last mile solutions also. This is, again, a very big hit with the trade. And mind you, these businesses are very high margin businesses, which will be very keenly watched by all the investors in the coming months.

Then guidance, I would like to keep them unchanged at 13%, EXIM 10%, domestic, 20%. We are quite optimistic and positive that we will achieve this guidance. Lastly, I will like to tell the -- all the investors that we are securing the future of the company in a very nice way for long-term business growth.

First is we have signed MOU with Vadhvan Port, where they have appointed us common rail operator on a nomination basis. We'll be designing the rail yard, managing the rail yard, everything rail operations at new Vadhvan Port which is coming on north of JNPT and it will be on DFC.

It's a port of the future. It will be commissioned by 2030. CONCOR has become an integral part of Vadhvan Port by signing this MOU. Second, we have signed MOU with Bhavnagar Port Private Limited. We will be operating the container terminals at Bhavnagar Port, which is again a port of the future.

It is the nearest port for NCR area and very well connected by rail. Third is, we have made serious forays into shipping sector now. Our containers are crossed the shores of India. They are moving into Middle East. We have signed an MOU with a Dubai-based company.

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Already 200 containers have gone to Middle East and most of them have come back loaded. So we are getting both way loaded direction, loaded traffic, which is a very big boost to our business. We are in talks with some companies in Far East and we will very soon starting our Far East services also. This is also a very high-margin business. We are getting more than 30% margin on every container.

So this is also -- this will be also a growth area as far as our top line and bottom line are concerned. And in future, we hope that we will expand it exponentially.

So this is the opening remarks from my side. Now you can ask your questions, please.

Moderator: The first question comes from the line of Disha from Ashika Institutional.

Disha: You did mention a lot of initiatives and a lot of MOUs that would help fuel the growth of CONCOR for the future. But my question is regarding FY '26, that a 10% volume growth in EXIM and a 20% volume growth in domestic, how will you be able to fulfil it?

If you could just help us understand it in quantitative terms because for these growth rates to be fulfilled, we would need a minimum of low single-digit growth going forward for the quarter-on-quarter. So that's what I wanted to understand.

Sanjay Swarup: If you are observing it closely in the first half of financial year, already, we have achieved 10.2% growth in EXIM. So as I mentioned to you, this growth is likely to continue, and maybe it will further increase now that busy season has picked up, and we are getting good volumes in imports as well as exports. So EXIM, I'm quite optimistic that it may exceed my guidance also. I gave the guidance of 10%, already 10.2% we are achieving. I am hopeful we will exceed this guidance.

As far as domestic is concerned, I gave the guidance of 20%. And in the first half, we have achieved 13%. So there is a lag. And in almost -- and for the second half, we will have to go for 26% to 27% of growth in domestic to maintain the -- to end the year with 20% growth. So we are working on it.

As I told you, we have good demand in bulk cement. We have signed MOUs with UltraTech Cement as well as Adani Cement. And then we are getting good demand in Gunny Bales. We have good demand in tiles traffic. So all these will be drivers for growth in domestic. So I'm quit

e optimistic that we will be able to end the year with 20% growth in domestic also.

Disha: For domestic, could you help us kindly understand it in quantitative terms, if any numbers you can throw in, like how much volume boost you are expecting from MOUs with the Adani and UltraTech and how much from Gunny Bales?

Sanjay Swarup: At this moment, it will be difficult to tell the numbers to you, but we have made our internal calculations, and we are quite optimistic to achieve the target.

Disha: All right. Sir, my second question is regarding the average revenue per TEU. While volumes have been increasing, our realizations have been going down since the past 4, 5 quarters on a Container Corporation of India Limited

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minimum basis, which kind of impacts our revenue. Should we assume that for the domestic business, 14,000 approximately -- sorry, for the EXIM business, INR14,000 and for the domestic business around INR22,000 per TEU to be the average realization that we are looking forward for?

Sanjay Swarup: If you see in EXIM, it is not INR14,000. It is in the range of INR27,000 per TEU, if you see the originating volume. As I already explained, EXIM, there is a drop of lead by 2.5%. So this is the basic reason for drop in realization. It is not INR14,000, kindly correct your numbers.

Disha: Sure sir. And for domestic, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: Domestic, it is in the range of INR57,000 to INR58,000. So there is a slightly -- in domestic -- sorry, in domestic, it has increased from INR56,000 to INR57,000. So there is a growth in realization per TEU. What is -- what exactly is your question? There's no drop in domestic realisation per TEU.

Disha: Sir, I am looking at in terms of total volumes handled. So that is what I'm trying to understand.

Sanjay Swarup: Kindly divide by originating volume, not by handling.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital.

Bhoomika Nair: Sir, could you first share the originating volume numbers for this quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, so -- for this quarter, originating volume in EXIM is 5,86,011 TEU. Domestic 1,35,440. Total, it is 7,21,451 TEUs.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. Sir, when you give your guidance for the 10% growth in EXIM and 20% in domestic, is that on handling or on originating basis?

Sanjay Swarup: It is on handling.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. So how should we look at -- because the profitability, everything is pretty much on the originating basis, how should we look at the originating volume growth for both these segments

for the year?

Sanjay Swarup: Normally, all of you are very seasoned people. So you already know that from handling, very easily, you can derive originating. It is almost 65% of handling. Roughly, the ballpark is 65% of handling originating. You can see...

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Sir, in terms of EXIM, you did mention there's been some improvement in ports, etc. If you can talk about how are you seeing the outlook in terms of the shipping lines and uptick in the volumes from both export/import perspective?

And then within that, how is the rail coefficient also kind of playing out at all the 3 ports, particularly once the DFC is operational, how do you see that further improving? If you can just give some qualitative comment on that.

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Sanjay Swarup: See, rail coefficient is seeing an increase in all the 3 main container ports. JNPT also, it has increased from 15.68% to 15.83%. Mundra, it has increased from 23.82% to 24.9%. Pipavav, it has increased from 57.42% to 58.14%. So all the ports are showing a growth in rail coefficient. So -- and when DFC comes, then definitely, there will be further boost in rail coefficient at JNPT and -- which is at present, it is in the range of 16%. I am hoping that overnight, of course, that miracle will not happen. It will take at least 1 year time. It will

I double up in 1 year. I'm quite sure of that.

Bhoomika Nair: Right. And will that drive more double stacking and more balance of trade in your opinion, which will help further in terms of the margin improvement? Or do you think there will be enough competition from road and other operators, which will restrict the margin profile and we may need to pass it on to the customers the benefits of the efficiency improvements.

Sanjay Swarup: You are right, double stacking will further get a big boost when DFC is connected to JNPT. And secondly, we will be able to run assured transit train also from NCR area to JNPT, maybe in 24, 25 hours, train will be reaching Nhava Sheva, which is at present constraint because of the line capacity in various sections. And this will give a very big boost. And in double stacking in the upper deck normally, it is light cargo is carried and light cargo at present is economical to move by road. So when double stack comes, then upper deck, we have to pay less haulage charges. So we will share the benefits. As I had mentioned earlier also, we don't sacrifice our margins. Whatever savings we are doing, part of that saving, we will share with our customers so that it becomes very economical to them to move by train. And it becomes a transit assurance kind of thing will also be there. So basically transit assurance and cost, these are the 2 things in logistics, which are extremely important for a trader.

Bhoomika Nair: That helps. Sir, can you just share the lead distances and also the empty running charges?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. lead distances were 687 kilometers in EXIM and 1,326 kilometers in domestic. Total it is 785 kilometers for this first half. I'm telling the figures for first half of this financial year.

Similarly, empty running is for EXIM, first half, it is INR52 crores and domestic, it is INR132.53 crores. Total, it is INR184.53 crores. Last year, it was EXIM 63.47 crores; domestic INR142 crores, total INR205.47 crores.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Park.

Mukesh Saraf: This is Mukesh Saraf here. Sir, the first question is on market share. You had alluded that there's some improvement in market share. Could you kind of give the number for EXIM market share currently for you?

Sanjay Swarup: I had mentioned that we have increased our market share at ports. But overall market share, we have seen a slight dip. In EXIM, it has dropped for first half of the financial year. It has dropped from 55.9% to 54.1%. In domestic, it has dropped from 58% to 55.7%. And total, it has dropped from 56.5% to 54.5%, almost 200 basis points, it has dropped in total.

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Mukesh Saraf: Okay. So this is again only because you're kind of not taking the lower margin and the shorter lead distance business? Or is there some competitive intensity change that we are seeing in terms of pricing or services offered by others?

Sanjay Swarup: Basic reason is that we have consciously decided not to pick up low-margin business and which are low lead also. And the second thing is there is less demand in domestic. So now we are hoping to recover it. And then one more thing is that we were actually one commodity wastepaper in North India, which is coming from Mundra Port. That we were -- we had actually -- our competitors had given some competitive rates, and it was -- it has moved from us. That is the reason for decrease in market share at Mundra. So now we have done our work, and

we have offered good rates to customers, and it is likely to come back to us now.
Mukesh Saraf: Got it. Got it. And in one of the comments you had mentioned about this assured transit trains that you'll start to Nhava Sheva. Obviously, once DFC connectivity comes. But currently, are you not doing this already for, say, Mundra, Pipavav ports from NCR because a large part of that is already conne

cted on the DFC?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, of course, we are doing for Mundra Port, in my earlier conference calls, I have already told you, it is a very big hit freight express trains from our mega MMLP at Dadri, we are running trains to Mundra Port and which helps us to shift a lot of cargo from road to rail.

Mukesh Saraf: Sir, any sense you can give us, maybe just approximately what proportion of volumes we are moving on, are these assured timetable kind of trains in this route? Just to kind of help us understand how much more improvement can come once you start offering more of this service.

Sanjay Swarup: You mean shift in volume from road to rail. That is almost 12% to 15% shift is there in from road to rail.

Mukesh Saraf: Okay. But you'll also be offering the non-assured services right now, sir, on this route, the nontimetable adoption.

Sanjay Swarup: Those numbers, I don't have with me right now. Can give you later on.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Achal from Nuvama.

Achal: Sir, if you could give us some sense about the opportunity size for the bulk cement. I'm not seeking for the volume guidance on that, but just an opportunity, how large is this? And currently, it is moved by road or by Indian Railways, if you could clarify that? And what is the cost saving proposition to the customer when they are shifting to the tank containers?

Sanjay Swarup: It's a very big growth area, and I can only say that very less is moving by rail. Most of the quantity is moving by road only. And my director domestic, Mr. Azhar Shams will give all the details. I will pass on the phone to him.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Hello. I am Mohammad Azhar Shams, Director, Domestic. With respect to bulk demand, whatever you raised the question as of now, that in total, the total production of cement in India
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is around 400 million tonnes. Out of this 400 million tonne cement production, 70 million tonne is being moved by road. That is in bulk condition.

Out of this 70 million tonnes, railway is moving 7 million, only 10% of the bulk cement is being moved as of now by Indian Railways in their specialized wagon, we call it BCCW and BCFC, okay? So the remaining 63 million is moving by bulker on road. We all have been saying on road that bulk cement going on bulkers. So we want to tap this gap of 63 million tonnes, whatever is being moved by the bulkers because the containers offer very door-to-door service, for example, in 1 bulker 35 to 40-tonne cargo is going. And in one train of 90 containers, we are moving around 2,500 tonnes.

And keeping in view the infrastructure projects and development and the focus of the government on different infrastructure projects, the demand of the bulk cement has increased like anything. We had been in touch with UltraTech, Adani as our CMD sir just underlined. So this movement of bulk cement is just to multiply. So to get those business and the sky is the limit. The 63 million tonnes is a huge quantity.

And if we will start getting 1 million, 2 million or 3 million, the only constraint is availability of the tank container. As of now, we can't import the tank container from China. So as Atmanirbhar Bharat Initiative of Government of India, we have given 1,000 container orders to Indian companies, 500 to Braithwaite and then 500 to the open market that is buttoned in container manufacturer in Ahmedabad.

So out of 500 orders given to Braithwaite, that is the railway PSUs, we have got 200 containers, which we are moving in 3 circuits from Hyderabad area. And the 5 container order, whatever we gave to Vasant manufacturers, so they are likely to start giving us deliveries by mid of December.

So as soon as we get the container, the constraint only is the availability of the container. As soon as we get the container, we are having agreement in place, cargo is available. We will start

immediately moving the cargo. So the limiting factor is availability of the container on which we are focusing on just ensuring that how quickly we can get those containers.

Achal: Just to clarify, in terms of the profitability of this tank container will be similar? Or it could be better than the existing margin per TEU?

Mohammad Azhar Shams: Actually, it will be certainly -- I mean our margin will increase because as of now, we are not moving much of cement. We are moving just bag cement that is to 50 containers with whatever we are allowed. So in that, our margins are very limited. But with bulk cement, whatever 3

streams we are running from I mean as of now, our margins are certainly on the higher side and which are likely to increase. The agreement, whatever we have entered with the UltraTech, so that is the quantity is around 1 lakh tonne per month.

So -- and similar with Adani and other parties. So our margin in this bulk cement will certainly be on higher side as compared to our existing margin in domestic.

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Achal: Got it. The second question, sir, if you could help us with the port mix, please? And the port wise market share, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. Yes. It is -- JNPT, it is 35.5%. Mundra Port, 35 point...

Achal: This is for the quarter or first half? Sorry, sir, I'm interjecting. Is this for the quarter or first half, you're saying?

Sanjay Swarup: It's for the first half, actually.

Achal: First half, okay. 35.5% JNPT?

Sanjay Swarup: Mundra, 35.3%. Pipavav 8.18%, Visakhapatnam 5.3%, Chennai 4.5%, Vallarpadam 5.3%, Ennore 2.1%, Katupalli 1.6% and Tuticorin 1%.

Achal: And if you could help us with the market share as well?

Sanjay Swarup: Market share at ports?

Achal: Ports. Yes, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Market share at ports at JNPT, it has increased from 57.5% to 59.4%. Mundra Port, it has decreased from 38.8% to 36.2%. Pipavav Port, it has increased from 48% to 50%.

Achal: So 2 out of these 3 large ports have seen a market share expansion, yet you said the market share has actually come off. If you could clarify?

Sanjay Swarup: That's okay. Two have shown increase, but Mundra Port, we are down. Mundra Port is a major contributor. Almost you have seen 1/3 of our volumes are through Mundra Port. Mundra Port, our market share has come down.

And at other places also, JNPT, there was -- there is a growth in market share, but we could have managed more because of the low-margin things we are not doing. All these have contributed in less -- slight dip in market share for us in EXIM.

Achal: Got it. And just last question. With respect to JNPT, whatever, 8 million to 9 million TEU gets handled, how much is actually going to north at this stage, sir, according to you?

Sanjay Swarup: JNPT is not sending -- I don't have the numbers with me right now, but not much is coming to north. It is catering to the Maharashtra area and a lot of volume is going there. And apart from that, a lot of volume is going to Hyderabad area. And it is -- we have an ICD there in Hyderabad, and it is getting good exports from Bangalore also for mainline vessels going to Western countries. So via Bangalore, we are running 3 services in a week, which are very well patronized by train for JNPT.

So North India, of course, a lot of volumes are not coming, mostly it is catered by Mundra Port, but actually will change the scenario.

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Achal: And that would be because of the timetable, because of the cost proposition because from a time perspective, it will be a little longer distance, right?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. As I told you, transit time and costs are the 2 main factors which determine the choice of the traders, what port they will use. So both these things will be quite positive for JNPT.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Krishnendu

Saha from Quantum AMC.

Krishnendu Saha: Just quickly just on the container tanks for cement. Just to understand, 1 tank can take in how many -- like suppose they're going -- as you said, they are going by trucks. So 1 tank container takes how many trucks? Or is it like same amount of quantity or volume?

Sanjay Swarup: One tank container can have 31 tons of cargo. How much can we load on truck?

Mohammad Azhar Shams: 35.

Sanjay Swarup: Truck, can carry 35.

Krishnendu Saha: I've seen the same. Just a clarification. And just to understand on the rail freight...

Sanjay Swarup: Just 1 minute couple. Yes go on.

Mohammad Azhar Shams: No, actually, the USP of tank container that is in the limited space and these can directly go to the project site, and then RMC plant. It is not the case with the bulker, whatever the bulk cement is being moved in those kind of arrangements, okay? So that is the hit. USP, it is very handy.

You can take the tank container to whatever place you want.

Suppose 31 tonne cement is there. So you can upload 15 tonnes at 1 location, 10 tonne at other

locations. And then similarly, you can serve the industry or the project. This is not a flexibility with respect to bulkers. And 1 more point, which I would like to underline is that in containers, we are giving free time and they can -- around 20 to 30 days.

And cement manufacturer can store or remain, they will keep their cement in tank container for 20 to 30 days. So that saves the unloading and then warehousing kind of an arrangement. So this is again a very big plus.

Sanjay Swarup: It is a very big plus because it eliminates the requirement of secondary warehousing by the consumer. So he can use container as warehouse. And as Director, Domestic has explained, after a free time, we charge very nominal rate from the customer. And he can use like suppose 31-tonne cargo is there. He wants to use 15 tonne today, and he wants to use the rest of the cargo after 15 days.

He can keep the container with him and pay the nominal charges to us. So this will eliminate the -- otherwise, he will have to hire another warehouse to keep the cargo. So that way, it is very beneficial and traders and customers are very happy with this kind of arrangement.

Krishnendu Saha: I see. And in spite of getting 30 days, 20 days free time, we are still above the company margins for this business.

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Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes. That we have -- that care we have taken. It will be good margins for the company.

Krishnendu Saha: On this, the cement tankers are not fungible. They can only be used for cement. That's my understanding, right?

Sanjay Swarup: Fly ash can also be transmitted. Food can be...

Mohammad Azhar Shams: No, no. I believe with these cement tank containers, we have experimented with fly ash also, and we have experimented with alumina powder also. So our first move the cement, I can tell you we will try to get both way traffic, either alumina powder or fly ash. As you know, there is huge demand of fly ash in the cement industry.

Krishnendu Saha: Okay. So the whole value chain. Yes, right. Just on the rail freight, if I might ask for my knowledge, this is the first quarter, if I divide it by the handling volume, it's just basic mathematics. It is 8,700 roughly.

This is the lowest I've seen in the last whatever quarters and going back to the years. So with double stacking coming in and things getting better for us. How do you see the rail freight per TEU moving for us? If you can give some direction on that, it will be helpful. And the LLF, do you think this is a rate -- quarterly rate which is there, sorry, INR110 crores is the rough rate per quarter.

Will it stay out there or it can improve or increase as we expand more? So just these 2 on the cost side, please, if you can help me.

Sanjay Swarup: Now I would suggest you use the originating volumes and not

the handling volumes. It cannot

be proper indicator. So for your kind information, rail freight margin, in fact, has increased year-on-year. For the first half of last financial year, it was 26.17%. And now it has become 28 -- sorry, it has become 27.80%. So there has been a good increase in rail freight margin, on a year-on-year basis. Now what was your second question?

Krishnendu Saha: No, my first question is on the handling -- sorry, the handling rail freight with the cost, the haulage cost. So the haulage cost we saw on the lower side, so you clarified you should divide the originating volume. Yes. And the second question was the LLF, which is running at INR110 crores per month. Is that a number I can take it for the next 2, 3 years? Or we should see some increase in the LLF also?

Sanjay Swarup: See, LLF, as you know, it is increasing 7% every year, and our LLF is in the range of INR400 crores to INR420 crores every year. So in this year also, you may be seeing an increase in LLF for this particular quarter from INR66 crores to INR105 crores. But if you see on a yearly basis, every quarter, INR100 crores, INR105 crores is quite a nominal figure.

And our LLF payout is going to remain intact because every year, we have to increase it by 7%. But at the same time, we are surrendering some terminals by -- not by losing any business, but we are coming up with our terminals at those locations.

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So we are surrendering the railway land, like suppose for example in Jodhpur. Jodhpur, we have a terminal at Bhagat Ki Kothi, and we are coming up with another terminal at Salawas. We have purchased the land from state government, and we are going to start in this financial year only. Then we will be bringing double-stack trains at our present terminal, which is on railway land,

we cannot bring double-stack trains.

So in the new terminal at Salawas, we will be bringing double-stack trains also. This will bring further boost to our business. So when we -- as soon as we commission the Salawas and traffic is started, we will surrender the railway terminals. So that will be saving for us, but 7% growth is also there. So net will be in the same range, only it will remain.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Jainam Shah from Equirus Securities.

Jainam Shah: Sir, just 1 question from my side. When I look at the depreciation number for this particular quarter, it has gone down. Of course, there has been some impact of the LNG truck useful life. We have increased from 8 to 15 years. Other than that, is there any one-off or anything in this quarter? Or is this the normal run rate we can take into account because our capex is already there and why it would have reduced?

Harish Chandra: Depreciation.

Sanjay Swarup: Depreciation. My CFO, I will request him to take this question.

Harish Chandra: You have rightly said depreciation, we have changed the rate for LNG trucks, which has some impact in this quarter. And in the last quarter, there was some capitalization, which was done retrospectively for our DR site, which was commissioned. So there was some little depreciation on that account. That's why last quarter, it was higher. Now it is balanced in this quarter. So that's why you can see in the first quarter, there is a little higher depreciation, which is appearing.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Koundinya from Jefferies Group.

Koundinya: So a strategic question, a couple of bookkeeping questions. So first thing, I mean, if you were to look at it from a company strategy standpoint, I know we understand that the competitive interest obviously is rising. So would your preference be for volumes vis-a-vis margins? What will be your first priority, if I may understand your thought process on that, please?

Sanjay Swarup: As I already explained in the earlier calls also, we will increase volumes.

At the same time, we

will not sacrifice our margins. So that is the company's strategy for so many years, and it will continue. And whatever savings we receive, we get -- that we'll share with our customers. So that I demonstrated in the -- in my opening address also that we have increased our share at ports without sacrificing our margins.

In fact, our margins have also increased. So our share is also increasing, margin is also increasing. So that will be the strategy of the company, which will remain in the future.

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Koundinya: Okay. Fine, sir. Okay. Then a couple of other questions. Sir, I mean, firstly, if I look at the empty running cost, I think specific to the quarter, the domestic seems to have run ahead of the volume growth. I mean what is happening here, if you can help us understand a bit better there, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Domestic empty running has also come down. What is exactly the question? I'm not able to understand. It has come down from -- last year, it was INR67 crores. This year, it is INR66 crores, it is less.

Koundinya: Okay. Then maybe something wrong with my math. So fine.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Domestic also, it has reduced. EXIM also, it has reduced.

Koundinya: Okay. Sir, lastly, if I may ask you, what percent of your volumes come from Dadri and Tughlakabad? I mean, what would that -- what were the volumes from Dadri and Tughlakabad in FY '25 maybe?

Sanjay Swarup: Dadri and Tughlakabad combined total volume you are asking of the company?

Koundinya: Yes, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Total volume will be, I think 7% to 8%.

Koundinya: Okay. 78% of total volumes. Understood, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: No, not 78%. 7% to 8%. Either 7% or 8%.

Koundinya: 7% to 8%. You are speaking in terms of originating volumes only, right, sir? I mean.

Sanjay Swarup: No, I am speaking in terms of handling volumes.

Koundinya: In terms of handling volumes. Okay. Understood sir.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Neelotpal Sahu from JM Financials.

Neelotpal Sahu: Am I audible?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes.

Neelotpal Sahu: Congratulations on a good set of numbers. I wanted to check on the profitability levels, especially on the EXIM front have been quite good this quarter. The rail freight margin also, we have seen a significant improvement. So I wanted to understand what is driving this thing? And is it like sustainable for the year and probably if you could give an outlook for the medium term?

Sanjay Swarup: In EXIM, as I told you, the operations -- my operations team has done a very good job. And they have planned in movement in such a manner that empty running is minimized. And it is -- there is a saving of around 18% year-on-year for the first half of the financial year in EXIM itself. The 18% revenue is a huge saving, and double stack has also helped us. Our double stack has grown

by 7.4% in the first half. So I should say, better planning by our team has resulted in very good margins in EXIM.

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Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Bhoomika Nair from DAM Capital.

Bhoomika Nair: Yes, sir. Sir, just wanted to ask on this double stack. If I see our double stack numbers are broadly now kind of stabilizing around that 1,500 to 1,800 rakes on a quarterly basis. Is it that as of now, we've kind of reached the peak capabilities or abilities to kind of double stack given the market environment? And now the next improvement in double stack will only happen once the DFC is operational or better improvement in infrastructure per se?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, you are absolutely right. Next, growth in quantum jump in double stack will come when DFC is connected to JNPT. As far as Mundra is concerned, you can say that it will be -- growth would be like this only and not much growth we can expect now in double stack till the JNPT

is

connected to DFC. You're absolutely right.

Moderator: Ms. Bhoomika, do you have any further questions?

Bhoomika Nair: Yes. Sorry, I was on mute. Sir, between export and import, how is the trends in terms of the outlook? Is there -- is it more balanced? Or are you seeing imbalance continuing in terms of the outlook per se?

Sanjay Swarup: If you see on pan-India basis, I should say it is almost balanced.

Bhoomika Nair: But for our key ports like JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav, which is bulk of our volumes?

Sanjay Swarup: See Mundra is always export heavy and Pipavav, it is almost balanced, and Nhava Sheva is import heavy. It is a normal trend. So that still continues.

Bhoomika Nair: Okay. And in domestic, as we do more of these bulk containers for cement etc., will the empty running tend to see an increase out there because of that, because of the imbalance?

Sanjay Swarup: The empty running also will be there, you are right. But we are trying -- as Director Domestic already explained, we are trying to get business on empty direction also because apart from cement, we are examining other products like fly ash and alumina. And if we are able to tap that, then we will bring down the empty running. And in empty direction, railway gives us some discount also. We are availing of that facility.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Sumit Kishore from Axis Capital.

Sumit Kishore: In your opening remarks, you had mentioned medium-term growth focus areas of your shipping sector foray. You mentioned the Bhavnagar container terminal. So what exactly will be CONCOR's role there? And you mentioned good sheds that you are taking over from railways to develop these logistics sheds. So over the next 2 to 3 years, what kind of revenue potential do you see from each of these areas, if you could deliberate on this.

Sanjay Swarup: Good question. As far as shipping sector is concerned, already, we have started moving, and it is stretching us good margins because it is both sided loaded movement. And almost -- it is more than upward of 30% margin per container, we are getting in shipping. So at present, I'm not able to give any numbers to this, because I don't have with me, and they will be insignificant as far

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as the total numbers are concerned because it's a very small number. But we have made the beginning and there is good demand from trade, and we have got good fleet of containers. 40-foot containers are also arriving and 20 feet already, we have a good fleet of containers and Far East service also, we are starting. So this is a forward integration for our customers. Our customers have welcomed this initiative of the company, and they are giving us more and more business. The second initiative that we have taken in Bhavnagar Port, we have signed MOU. We have experience for port operations, and we are a minority partner at 1 of the terminals at Nhava Sheva, which is called GTI.

We are running it in partnership with APM Terminals. And second is the terminal at Vallarpadam. That we are running in partnership with DP World. At both the places, we are junior partners. But at Bhavnagar, we will be senior partners.

So we have signed an MOU with them, where we will be operating the terminal -- container terminal. We will be designing the terminal and then operating the terminal also. So we will have a consortium with a leading international port operator. We are in talks with some port operators on this subject. And very soon, we will tie up the deal with them.

But this terminal will be functional from 2030 only. So before that, we will be doing all the necessary work. We'll be placing the trains and all and rail line will be laid. So all these will be ready. And 2030, this port will start functioning.

Third is the goods shed initiative. Indian Railways has given 1 good shed in -- near Lucknow, which is called Sonik

on trial basis to CONCOR. For 2 years, extendable by another 2 years, that is a total 4 years period to develop the good shed into integrated logistics hubs, where we give warehousing facility to our customers. Then we give first mile, last mile services to them. So everything we will do for the customer.

So we are developing that also on a pilot basis. Once we send the report to railways after 1 year, what all we have done, what facilities we have developed, how much traffic we have increased, then Railway Board will decide it and analyse it and take a decision. And they are very keen to give more good shed also to CONCOR after 1 year, after seeing the result of this particular good shed.

So -- and this is also a very high-margin business in which -- and altogether a new area for us, and it's a high-margin business where we will be giving end logistics to the customers who are bringing their cargo to Indian railway rakes. So this is a diversification, I should say. And railway has taken initiative for end-to-end logistics for which they have entrusted CONCOR.

Sumit Kishore: Okay. Sir, just 1 follow-up. What is the size of the Bhavnagar container terminal that you are planning in terms of whatever TEUs? And what kind of capex would be required for the terminal and the railway line that you mentioned?

Sanjay Swarup: See, they have a berth of around -- in their Phase 1, actually, there are 2 phases. In Phase 1, I think around 700 to 800 meters berth will be there. So -- and how much land, I don't remember

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the number. And capex also, we are working out actually. We have not finalized how much capex we'll be spending there.

So rough numbers are available, but they will not be of much use to you. So once we work out the capex numbers, we will definitely share it with you. I think this should be the last question now.

Moderator: Sir, there are 2 more questions. The next question comes from the line of Achal from Nuvama Wealth Management.

Achal: Sir, first, on the contingent liability in the annual report, Page 446, the contingent liability has gone up from INR1,377 crores to INR2,120 crores. Can you help us understand what does this pertain to, sir? Is it pertaining to the LLF? Is it pertaining to something else, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: I'm very sure it will not be LLF. My CFO can attempt. Otherwise, we will get back to you.

Harish Chandra: You were talking about the last year contingent liabilities which we have disclosed.

Achal: Yes. FY '25, sir.

Harish Chandra: So these are related to various court cases and claims mainly and some custom bonds and all that. So maybe on account of that. The details, I'll have to see, but it is mainly -- our contingent liabilities are related to these elements only.

Sanjay Swarup: Exact numbers we will share with you, it's difficult to tell now.

Achal: Right. Because in the notes, it's mentioned that one of the sentences is the amount of contingent liability, including LLF demand from railways for few terminals. So that's why the question.

Harish Chandra: Sometimes for some terminal, they might have raised the demand, which we are contesting that may have been included in that, but that's not an actual liability, which is payable. That like for some terminals, they might have raised some demand, which we are contesting. So it could be on that account. But major contingent liabilities are related to claims and terms, yes.

Achal: Got it. Sure, sure. Just a clarification on the market share. If you could give us, once again, sir, 1H market share for EXIM, domestic and the total basis?

Sanjay Swarup: EXIM it is 54.1%, domestic 55.7%, total 54.6% for this year...

Achal: Yes, sir. And last year, how was their...

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Last year, EXIM 55.9%, domestic 58% total 56.5%.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Krishnendu Saha from Quantum AMC.

Krishnendu Sa

ha: Just a little clarification. How much is value -- we have a target of having value-added services, which is a high-margin business for us. So what is the portion of that, the percentage of revenue right now?

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Sanjay Swarup: At present, I don't have the numbers for that. We will get back to you.

Moderator: Sir, there is one last question. Would you like to take it?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, please, I will take it.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Amish Kanani from Knowise Co.

Amish Kanani: Sir, the same question that you had answered for the Bhavnagar. I had a question on this Vadhvan Port. It's a very, very large port that is emerging out of Maharashtra and JNPT is the operator, whatever little we understand. If you can give us some sense of both Bhavnagar and Vadhvan Port put together. Beyond 2030, it's a very long short horizon.

But both these put together, does it change the trajectory of our long term, we have double-digit growth aspiration. These 2 ports together, does it increase our long-term growth potential?

Whatever initial thoughts of yours, sir, that will be helpful. Thanks.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, definitely, it will increase our growth potential for the company and port operations is a very interesting field for the company. And Vadhvan Port, as you know, it is the port of the future, designed for around 24 million TEUs handling, and we will be bidding for terminals also. Very soon, bids will come out when they will be going for bids for the terminal operations. We are in talk with very big, reputed players, port operators, international port operators.

We are in advanced stage of talks and they are very keen to partner with CONCOR, and that is the bidding thing. As far as the common rail operator for which we have already signed MOU with Vadhvan Port, that is a common rail operator, they have given on nomination to CONCOR. They have not invited any bids for that. They thought CONCOR is a big player in rail-based logistics. So they have chosen CONCOR and given it to us.

So for that, we will be designing the railway yard for Vadhvan Port, which will be for receipt and dispatch of trains. Then we will be -- after the design and commissioning, we will be executing. We will be operating the rail yard also and -- which will be responsible for removal and placement of rakes. Various rakes for Vadhvan Port. So that will be a very big business for -- actually, it's a futuristic port, modern port and 2030 is not very far. Already 2026 is going to start.

So we are ready to take up these challenges. These are the challenges, and they are the bright spots for the company for the future. Company has got a great future, I should say. And all these initiatives will help us to propel our revenues. And we are in logistics sector, not only confined to rail-based container logistics.

This is demonstrated amply by giving good shared operations also to us by Indian Railways, port operations, we are going, shipping also, we are going. So we are not confined to 1 particular stream of business. We are expanding to various fields of logistics so that we give maximum satisfaction to our customers and increase our business.

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Amish Kanani: Very reassuring to hear. We'll wait for some capex and potential volumes, numbers emerging maybe by end of the year or whatever.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the line of participants, I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Sanjay Swarup: I just want to say that we are standing on very strong fundamentals. We have a huge infrastructure, which we are expanding. Ambitious capex plans are there. And already, I have - - for futuristic growth for long-term growth also, I have shared my vision with all of you.

So I should say that t

he company is on a great path for progress, and we will have lots to come in the near future and in distant future also, short term, long term, both company has got a very bright outlook and very bright future. We have good connect with customers, which is helping us in a very big way.

Moderator: On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No. Name Phone Company

1Host:Bhoomika Nair 9867693472 DAM Capital Advisors Ltd.

2Host:Mangement 1141673000 Container Corporation of India Ltd

3 Abhishek Poddar 6563515200 Fitedile

4 Achal Lohade 9.19137E+11 Nuvama Wealth Management

5 Aditiya Mongya 2243360884 Kotak Securities

6 Ajit Darda 9049224455 Individual Investor

7 Akhilesh Bhandari 9.1656E+11 North Rock Capital

8 Akshata Thakkar 9.17208E+11 Asian Market Sec

9 Alok 61291549 MOFS

10 Amish Kanani 9833102393 Knowise Co

11 Amit Bhinde 9.12261E+11 Morgan Stanley

12 Amit Khurana 2240969742 Dolat Capital
13 Aniket 16578375417 London Stock Exchange Group
14 Ankita Shah 9820679464 Elara Capital
15 Anuragh Katta 9998697378 Equirus Securities
16 Arul 7498846328 Bajaj Life Insurance
17 Arun Kumar 15103907767 Bloomberg Financial Data
18 Arun R 9087779152 Capital Market
19 Ashish Shah 6566025000 Milleinum capita;l
20 Ashwat 9320088900 Arihant Capital
21 Atul Kumar 9820034170 Salvation Capital
22 Ayush Abhijeet 8097436847 WhiteOak Capital
23 Ayush Agarwal 9825012075 Individual Investor
24 Ayush Shah 9.19871E+11 ICICI AMC
25 Bianca Sayon 17812306877 Aiera
26 Chandan Mistry 9476007111 Tata Mutual Fund
27 David Anderson 19376321077 Anderson Family Office
28 David Yehuda 4.47401E+11 S&P Global
29 Deepak Kumar 7838341823 Fidelity Investments
30 Deepak Vyas 9818259362 Financia
31 Disha Giria 9324791509 Ashika Instituional
32 Durgesh Shukla 7217791285 Container Corporation of India LtdTHANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US
Container Corporation of India Ltd (CONCOR)
Earnings call Q2 FY26-hosted by DAM Capital
November 12, 2025 at 11:30 Hrs India Time
Total 106 Participants including the Speakers.
Participants List
33 Ganesh Patil 4.47401E+11 Oracle Pvt Ltd
34 Gautam Vm 9043411450 Vara Futures
35 Gurpreet Singh 9755552907 Arihant Capital
36 Harshit 9007036570 Nuvama Wealth Management
37 Hed Patel 9.19909E+11 Elara Capital
38 Heet Modi 9.18209E+11 RV investment
39 James Gan 6560310815 Principal Asset Management
40 Janim Shah 9.18759E+11 Equirus Securities
41 Jay Bhatia 9.19833E+11 Joint Vision
42 Jignesh Makhwana 9930122599 Asian Market Securities
43 Jinay 9372789943 Motilal Oswal
44 Jitendra Mehta 9004358051 Tara Capital
45 Kapil Agarwal 9.71551E+11 Tara Capital
46 Karthik Kohli 8447689945 Kotak IE
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50 Kiran 8660110148 Tijori Finance
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59 Mohit Lohiya 8699633997 ICICI Bank
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70 Pulkit Patni 66169044 Goldman sachs
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73 Rajesh Gajra 9.19644E+11 Informis Media
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76 Rohan 9870041211 Axis Capital
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Rohit Birla 66550038 Individual Investor
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81 Sagar Kale 9.19137E+11 Delta Group
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91 Shubham Zope 9326311600 Sicomoro Advisors Pvt Ltd
92 Srinidhi Parlekar 9901999884 ASK Investments Managers
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102 Vivek 8013013100 Emkay Global
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Call: Feb 2026

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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

No.CON/F&CS/IRC/STOCK EX/C.No.91029/NoteNo.97 ~ Navratna CPSE of Govt. of India)

~: 05.02.2026

1. The Bombay Stock Exchange Ltd., Mumbai (Through BSE Listing Centre)

Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Dalal Street

Mumbai-400001

2. National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (Through NEAPS)

Exchange Plaza, 5th Floor, Plot No. C/1,G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E)

Mumbai-400 051

Dear Sir/Madam,

~ : Disclosure under SEBI (Listing Obligation & Disclosure Requirements)

Regulations, 2015.

Pursuant to applicable provisions of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find

enclosed transcript of Post results conference call held on 30.01.2026 .

For your information and record please.

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Regd. Office: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, New Delhi-110076

~ /Tel. 011-41673093, 495121.50,60

{~ /E-mail: rn.pro@concnrindia.com Cl:l: l .6:10 l l D L l 988GO l 030915

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Think Logistics, Think CONCOR

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"Container Corporation of India Limited Q3 FY 2026

Earnings Conference Call"

January 30, 2026

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP -- CHAIRMAN & MANAGING  
DIRECTOR - CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS AND  
SERVICES) - CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. VIJOY KUMAR SINGH – DIRECTOR  
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING AND OPERATIONS ) -  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. MOHAMMAD AZHAR SHAMS – DIRECTOR  
(DOMESTIC ) - CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. HARISH CHANDRA – PRINCIPAL EXECUTIVE  
DIRECTOR (FINANCE) & COMPANY SECRETARY AND  
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER - CONTAINER  
CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. KUNAL SHAH – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Container Corporation of India Limited Q3 FY 2026 Earnings Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital Advisors Limited.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing "\*" then "0" on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Kunal Shah from DAM Capital. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Kunal Shah: Yes, hi everyone. Welcome to the 3Q FY 2026 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the Management being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup – Chairman and Managing Director.

At this point, I would like to hand over the call to the Management for their opening remarks, post which we can take up the Q&A. Thanks, and over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Good morning to all of you. I am Sanjay Swarup – CMD of Container Corporation. I am joined by my directors, Shri. Ajit Kumar Panda, Director - Projects and Services; Mr. Vijoy Kumar Singh, Director - International Marketing and Operations; Mr. Mohammad Azhar Shams, Director - Domestic; And Mr. Harish Chandra, Principal Executive Director - Finance, Company Secretary, and CFO.

So, I like to give some opening remarks. After that, we can go for question-answer session.

At the outset, I am glad to announce that the Board of Directors have approved a dividend of Rs. 3.40 on share of Rs. 5 par value, that is 68% in its meeting concluded yesterday. So, till now, the total dividend for this FY that has been given to shareholders is Rs. 7.60, which is 152%.

Second point is the throughput:

We have achieved a throughput of 4.15 million TEUs in the period ending December 2025, which is ever highest in the company's history. Throughput growth has been around 11%, in which EXIM has increased by 10% and domestic has shown a growth of 13%. In fact, it is better than the India's international trade, Mercantile's growth also, in which exports have shown a growth of 2.4%, which is USD 330.3 billion. And imports have shown a growth of 6% at USD 578.6 billion for the first nine months of this financial year.

Domestic:

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There has been a less growth as we had projected. We had projected 20% growth, whereas we have achieved around 13%. The primary reasons for this is that we have not picked up the low-margin business in the domestic. Second is that the tank containers, which we were thinking that in Q3 we will get a good supply, but somehow it got delayed during manufacturing. And now in Q4, we are getting a supply of tank containers, and domestic loading is picking up now. And there has been less demand of gunny bales also because of the disturbances in Bangladesh. As far as market share is concerned, we increased our market share at JNPT by 186 basis points and at the Pipavav Port by 93 basis points, and Mundra, our market share went down by 232 basis points. And the good thing is that we increased the market share without sacrificing our margins. Rail freight margin increased by around 200 basis points from 25.7% to 27.7%, and operating margin also increased by around 100 basis points from 30.2% to 31.2%.

Operating income has shown a good growth of 3.3%. Profit before depreciation has shown a growth of 1.8% for the period ending, and if we see for the Q3, the profit before depreciation has increased by 7.6%. There has been a flattish performance of PAT due to the depreciation, which was high by around Rs. 68 crores in this quarter. The reason for that is because in last financial year, we had done some corrections for life of wagons; because of that, the depreci

ation

was less in last financial year. So, that has been now at par and because of that effect, we are seeing a dip in PAT, where profit before depreciation is showing a very healthy growth.

Reason for less PAT are some other reasons are also there, like there is subdued demand in domestic streams, and second is the decrease in EXIM lead by 2% due to less demand in North India. And depreciation, I have already explained to you. LLF also in this quarter, LLF is showing increase of around 23% and which is in line with the total LLF that we pay to railways around Rs. 450 crores every year. Last year, there were some reversals because of that the LLF in this quarter was Rs. 89 crores. In this financial year, it is corrected to Rs. 110.7 crores, which is the actual LLF we will be paying to railways.

Now, there has been growth in double-stack rakes also. Growth of 7% in this financial year till now from 4608 rakes to 4933 rakes, which is quite a healthy growth. And a reduction in empty running of rakes is also quite substantial. In EXIM, it is 21%, domestic it is 8.5%, total 12%. So,

both these factors, growth in double-stack, reduction in empty rakes, have made a positive contribution to the company's bottom line.

We are continuously upgrading our infrastructure, as I have been telling in previous calls also. In this financial year till now, we have commissioned 31 high-speed rakes, which is also an all-time high for the company. And now we are having a robust fleet of 413 rakes in our kitty. And we have procured around 3,800 containers in this financial year till now. So, total container fleet stands at around 57,000 containers of our own ownership.

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Seeing the robust demand in the market, which I will be just telling you a short while from now, the Board of Directors have yesterday enhanced the CAPEX budget for this financial year by 23%, from Rs. 860 crores to Rs. 1,060 crores. Till now in this financial year, we have already spent Rs. 717 crores on CAPEX. So, we are on track, and we are procuring infrastructure, building up infrastructure, seeing the robust demand in the market.

Now I would like to tell you about the two streams – EXIM and domestic:

EXIM:

EXIM is showing excellent growth in this financial year. EXIM alone is likely to cross the turnover of USD 60 billion in revenue, which will be an all-time high for EXIM stream. It is a very handsome growth. And it is likely to increase in the coming months, which I will be explaining a short while from now.

Western DFC connectivity is expected by March 2026 to JNPT. It will give a very big boost to EXIM business. Export growth, till now, we have experienced around 23% growth in aluminum ingots, 22% growth in meat, 14% growth in auto parts, and very good growth in rapeseed meal and rice. Imports, also we have experienced a growth of 4 times growth in glass items, which are used in solar panels, 69% growth in raw cotton; 29% growth in auto parts; 22% growth in furniture.

We have rolled out a liberalized policy for cabotage movement and DPD, and this is likely to make a very big contribution in volumes in the coming months. Already, we are seeing the impact in EXIM. There is a healthy growth of 7.5% on a pan India basis in imports, out of which JNPT has shown a growth of 17%, Mundra has shown a growth of 8.4% for us, Chennai has shown a growth of 14%; and Vishakhapatnam has shown a growth of 28%; and there is a healthy growth of 7% in exports also for CONCOR in this financial year.

Now we come to domestic:

In domestic, there is a bulk cement and tank containers, which is likely to drive growth in the coming months in a big way. Then talks are in an advanced stage with Petronet Limited for ethane propane loading on a long-term basis. And long-term agreement we are going to sign with this company at Dahej, loading at Dahej. And also talks are in a

dvanced stage with GAIL,

Gas Authority for their PTA business from Mangalore Port. And the end-to-end logistics train that we are running from Delhi to Kolkata (Calcutta) via Agra and Kanpur, that has been a huge success, and we are getting very good business on this end-to-end train also.

At this juncture, I will like to keep my guidance for 13%, that is 10% EXIM, 20% domestic unchanged. We are confident that by the end of the financial year, we will be able to meet this guidance.

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Now I would like to give a brief snapshot of what is the future of CONCOR in the next three years going forward:

So, the EXIM, which will be as per our calculations and predictions. By FY 2029, every year EXIM will show growth of more than 15% per annum. So, for three years, we can see back-to-back growth of 15%, and primary drivers will be Western DFC by March 2026. Second is assured transit time trains that we will be running between JNPA and NCR on our mega terminal at Dadri and Kathuwas.

And next is the double-stacks, we will be bringing, I am glad to announce you that we will be bringing Jodhpur on double-stack map very soon in this financial year only. We are going to commission a new terminal from where we will be running double-stack trains between Jodhpur and Ports. Second is Ahmedabad also, we are going to bring double-stack business very soon. At present, our terminal is not able to handle double stack because of that we are not able to get that much business. And once we develop a new terminal, we are developing near Sanand, which will be capable of handling double-stack trains, and it will be also on DFC. That will also give big boost to our traffic at Ahmedabad.

We have already commissioned a few terminals at Mandalgarh, Jajpur, Kadakola, from which

we are expecting good traffic in the coming three years. And then, next is the Nepal traffic that we are catering from our facility at Vishakhapatnam and Kolkata (Calcutta), also. So, Nepal traffic we are running at present to Birgunj, and now very soon we will be starting at Raxaul and Biratnagar also. So, this will give further boost to our EXIM business as well as domestic business till FY 2029.

We are having a tie-up, five-year contract with all major shipping lines like Maersk, MSC, CMA-CGM, Hapag-Lloyd, etc. These are also going to positively contribute. And next big thing is the shipping sector in which we have made our presence felt in Middle East. And we have finalized a contract with another agency for Far East. So, Far East also we will be starting the services. Already one container we have sent. So, Middle East plus Far East, the short voyages we will see for few years and then we will go for longer voyages. So, these will be the major contributors for more than 15% growth in EXIM.

Now let me come to domestic:

Domestic, there is a huge potential. Untapped market is there and we are expecting more than 20% growth every year for the next three years, in which bulk cement and tank containers will be a primary contributor. We have already signed agreement with UltraTech, with Adani, with My Home Cement, with JK, and with other parties and they are expected to give very good business to us in bulk cement. And we have also tied up with big corporate customers like Vedanta, Jindal, Tata, GAIL, Petronet already I have told you.

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So, all these sectors will give very good growth in domestic of more than 20% for next three years. So, by FY 2029, I am projecting a top line of Rs. 15,000 crores for the company, which is quite achievable and 10 million TEUs handling throughput 75 million tonnes of cargo, containerized cargo. These three projections I am making for FY 2029 and Board of Directors has appreciated these projections and that was the reason for enhancing the capital budget,

so

that we are having equipment with us to meet these targets. And let me assure you, CAPEX will be around the same lines for next three years also. We are in expansion mode because there is lot of demand in the market and we are going to tap all the demand and bring more and more business to our company.

So, these were my opening remarks. Now we can start the question-and-answer session.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Pulkit Patni from Goldman Sachs. Please go ahead.

Pulkit Patni: Sir, my question is you have been giving guidance on volumes and as you rightly highlighted, you are not too far from that. But on the revenue front, we are significantly lower. We barely do mid-single-digit revenue this year based on how we are tracking. So, I just wanted to understand what is really happening on realization, because it is not only domestic, but even on the EXIM side, our realizations have been fairly muted this year. And in your expectation, because you are guiding for a pretty robust number even for the next three years, what is the assumption of realization increase that you have taken?

Sanjay Swarup: See, EXIM, there is a realization not commensurate with the physical. The reason is you are seeing the throughput growth and you are correlating it with the revenue growth. Actually, you should see originating numbers for that purpose. And second thing is, tonnage is not the correct parameter for correlating the revenue. Actually, it is NTKM, net tonne kilometers. That is the basic parameter you should be focusing, because the revenue is a function of two things, tonnage and distance, lead. So, if you see tonnage increases, but lead comes down, so that has an effect on NTKM.

So, correct parameter to correlate loading with revenue will be NTKM, in my opinion. So, as I already told in my opening remarks, the lead of EXIM has gone down by 2% due to less demand in North India. That is a primary contributor for less realization, as you call. But as far as we are concerned, we got a good realization in EXIM as compared to last year. Okay, it is not commensurate with the physical volume. That reason, already I told you.

Now, for the next three years, top line of Rs. 15,000 crores that I have told is quite achievable because when DFC comes, we are quite optimistic that we will be able to run assured transit train on that, which will be bringing long lead traffic, because it is 1,500 kilometers from NCR to JNPA, and it will give a good revenue also. And light cargo, which is at present moving by road, it will come on rail because there will be transit assurance, there will be cost benefits. So,

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the growth that we will be getting will be excellent in terms of physical volumes as well as revenue.

Pulkit Patni: Sir, can I take the liberty of asking one more question?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, sure.

Pulkit Patni: Sir, if I look at the last three years, while I understand the full connection of DFC to JNPT has been completed, and the impact will come through, but few ports in Gujarat, Mundra, Pipavav have been connected to DFC for a while now, and the impact of that have not really reflected. If you could just help us sort of solve this a little bit. What is the reason that just JNPT connection would be such a big game changer for CONCOR in terms of volume?

Sanjay Swarup: Now, the thing is that Gujarat ports like Mundra and Pipavav, which have been connected, they are actually, strictly speaking, not on DFC. They are connected till Palanpur, there is a station. DFC is there. After that, there is a feeder route for Mundra and Pipavav. So feeder route actually is not a DFC, it is an Indian Railways route. So, while the connection with JNPA is different. JNPA, DFC will be going up to JNPA. So, only freight trains fast moving container train

ns will

be moving on this circuit. Whereas, on that route, goods train, passenger train, everything moves on feeder route, because it is Indian Railways route. So, that is the difference.

And the second thing is that, which is very important for you to understand, is that 25 tonne axle load wagon, that is high-capacity wagons that we are procuring, BLCS and BLSS. These are the two type of wagon, which are having a 25 tonnes axle load. That means they can carry a payload of 80 tonnes. So, that cannot move on Indian Railways route and it cannot have a payload of 80 tonnes. So, that restriction is there, whereas on DFC, 80 tonnes payload can move. So, it will improve the double-stacking.

If I can carry more load on that wagon on DFC, because JNPA is pure DFC, there is no feeder route. So, that advantage will be the second advantage. So, these two advantages will see a distinct shift of traffic from road to rail.

Pulkit Patni: Okay. Sir, lastly, which quarter should we see the impact of DFC come through for us?

Sanjay Swarup: It will be starting from the next financial year. So, I am not an astrologer, I cannot predict that which quarter you will see the impact. But definitely from Q1 of next FY, we should start seeing some difference.

Pulkit Patni: Fair point. Thank you so much for taking these questions.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Jayman Shah from Equirus Securities. Please go ahead.

Jayman Shah: Yes. Thanks for the opportunity. I also just wanted one clarification. The volume, growth guidance that we have given for the five-year timeline - four-year timeline, is it on the railing part or is it on the originating part?

Sanjay Swarup: I have given only for three-year time...

Jayman Shah: Yes, this is for the...

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, if you have listened carefully, first is 10 million TEUs which is on handling throughput. Second is 75 million tonnes, which is on cargo movement, containerized cargo. Third is Rs. 15,000 crores, which is on top line of revenue.

Jayman Shah: Got it. Sir, if you can just provide me the originating volume for this particular quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: For this particular quarter, Q3?

Jayman Shah: Yes. For EXIM and domestic.

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. Originating volume for this quarter is EXIM, it is 564,324 TEUs; domestic is 120,817 TEUs; and total is 685,141 TEUs.

Jayman Shah: Sir, just wanted to understand one thing. As you are highlighting clearly that we should be looking at the originating volume and net tonnes kilometers for revenue part and all those things. Why we are not publishing the originating kilometers in the press release after the quarter ends and why we are only focusing on the handling volumes? Because whenever we are asking the question on the realization, the first point is always that we should be looking at the originating volume. Then why we are shying away from giving the originating volume growth and of course on the originating volume growth, what could be the market share that we have witnessed over nine months and for this particular quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay, I have noted your request. We will see.

Jayman Shah: And sir, what would be the market share for this particular quarter and for the nine months at the all India level?

Sanjay Swarup: I do not have the market share with me right now for this particular quarter. For nine-month period, I can give you the market share, for EXIM, it is 53.8%; and domestic it is 55.88%. Total is 54.35%.

Jayman Shah: And what could be the comparison for last nine months?

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Sanjay Swarup: Last financial year?

Jayman Shah: Nine months of FY 2025, yes, nine months of FY 2025.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. EXIM it is 55.28%; domestic 58.03%; total is 56.05%.

Jayman Shah: Yes. Sir, my question would be on t

his that of course we are near to our target in terms of EXIM volume guidance. We are little bit away from our domestic volume guidance and there has been reasons. But why we are not taking any major steps to make sure that our market share does not fall? We were at 75% a few years and 15 years back. Now we are at 53% - 54%. So, what kind of things which has happened over last decade, which has resulted in this kind of market share dip for us? And what kind of market share we are expecting with this kind of 15,000 revenue that we are expecting? Our market share is constant in that case. We are increasing it or we are thinking that it might reduce further from here on?

Sanjay Swarup: See, fall in market share in every conference I am giving you the details, reasons are pretty obvious. We are not picking up the low margin business, because we believe in giving good service to our customers while retaining our margins. That is the primary reason. To arrest this decline in market share and to increase our market share, our company is taking lot of steps. Like we are focusing on multi modal logistic paths. We are focusing on first mile, last mile transportation. So, the projection that I have given for FY 2029, definitely it is going to increase our market share and take it between 65% to 70%.

Jayman Shah: Got it, sir. If the comment of us is that we are not taking low margin contracts in this time, but if you see a margin pre-COVID, it used to be 25% - 26% excluding you can say other income part. Whereas as of now, it is ranging in between 20% - 22%. Of course, there has been an effect of LLF. But apart from that, despite having the recent DFC getting operational to a larger extent, we are doing double-stacking on all these parts, we are doing so much of CAPEX. Our margin has really not improved, of course, our revenue growth has been slow. But on the margin part also, we are now taking no margin contract. There has to be some, you can say, compensatory impact on the margin, but which has not been reflective over the last so many quarters.

Sanjay Swarup: If you compare pre-COVID and because there was a change in LLF payment to railway that is so more like CAPEX...

Jayman Shah: Excluding LLF also, there has been a bit of a dip in the margin.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, 4 times it increased from Rs. 100 crores to Rs. 400 crores.

Jayman Shah: To Rs. 400 crores, yes.

Sanjay Swarup: And as far as the EBITDA margins are concerned, I have the numbers with me. For Q3 of this financial year, we have achieved EBITDA margin of Rs. 601 crores, if you take other income  
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also, which is 25.1%. And last Q3, last financial year, it was 24.2%. So, there has been an improvement of around 100 basis points and I do not know from where you are getting the numbers. There is an improvement of margin. Similarly, for the period ending this financial year, this December, we are having a margin of Rs. 1,785.8 crores, which is 25.2%. And last financial year, it was Rs. 1,753.7 crores, which is 25.4%. So, percent wise, it is exactly the same, whereas money wise, it has increased. So, in fact, we have improved our margins. You please correct your numbers.

Jayman Shah: Sir, from the analyst point of view, we do not take other income into the margin, but if we exclude the other income, our margin was 22.2%, whereas this time, it is 22%.

Sanjay Swarup: I will request you to discuss it separately.

Jayman Shah: Sure. Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sumit Kishore from Axis Securities. Please go ahead.

Sumit Kishore: Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, we have been talking about bulk cement in tank containers for quite some time now. So, what is the total number of tank containers that we have presently and what do you expect by the end of the financial year? And if you were to utilize those tank containers reasona

bly well, what kind of volumes would you be able to handle in a quarter? That is my first question.

Sanjay Swarup: We have as of now 300 tank containers of our own ownership. Apart from that, one of our customer has also procured 200 tank containers, for which we have signed an agreement and he is using our services. So, if we add these two numbers, 500 tank containers are already there in our circuit of bulk cement by tank containers. Now, we are getting 100 containers around one rake every month. So, we expect that by the end of the financial year, one rake in February, one rake in March. 200 more containers we will get. And after that, every month, we will be getting

100 containers.

So, it depends on the actually lead like it depends, if the lead is between 700 kilometers to 1,000 kilometers from the origin point to the destination point, and turn around, we are now improving with every movement, because it is a new product, so in de-stuffing at some places, sometimes is being taken. We are in touch with our customers, we are improving that and we hope that a very good impact will be visible in Q1 of the next financial year.

Sumit Kishore: What I am trying to if you quantify this, let us say you have four rakes also, and those rakes make, let us say for argument's sake, 10 rakes I mean, we are still talking about what, 4x10x200 - 300 containers, so that would be how much as a percentage of your existing quarterly volumes in domestic. Is it going to make a meaningful difference when you are doing already something like 350,000 in TEU in a quarter in domestic?

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Sanjay Swarup: So, at this moment of time, I do not have the numbers with me. I will provide you later on.

Sumit Kishore: Sure. Sir, my second question is, you mentioned in response to the first question that a net tonne kilometer would be the right parameter. Could you provide us some sense of what has been done in the nine-month FY 2026 period in net tonne kilometer terms in EXIM and domestic, and please provide this on a recurring basis so that we can analyze your company properly.

Sanjay Swarup: So, I have noted your request. We will definitely act on that.

Sumit Kishore: The last question is that of the 15% and you have given guidance of 20% on three years for domestic. The first nine months is 13%. What is so extraordinary that is going to happen in the fourth quarter that you will get to 20% growth, which will imply a very high growth for the fourth quarter? And finally, on volumes on the 15% guidance for EXIM and 20% for domestic over the next three years. For EXIM in particular, how much is the dividend you are expecting because of DFC commissioning? If you were to segregate the benefit of DFC in that 15% figure, we will have to understand how much is going to be just DFC commissioning up to JNPT. Thank you.

Sanjay Swarup: See, as far as the first question is concerned, in the domestic we are going to, we are getting good loading now in all the factors like cement, is there, and tiles are there, and other merchandise is there. So, based on that, we are quite optimistic of achieving the target that we gave at the start of the financial year. Now as far as the EXIM, more than 15% growth is there. We have the numbers with us of what different parameters that I told you, but at this stage we cannot disclose those numbers to you.

Sumit Kishore: Sure. Thank you and wish you all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Priyanka Biswas: Thanks, sir, for the opportunity. Sir, I would like to ask more about the long-term guidance. So, you said 10 million TEUs on handling this what we should expect in let us say FY 2029. Now, can we get a similar assessment like in that should we assume that the originating also grows at the same level or should we assume like the origi

nating goes at a lower level like what is your underlying assumption for it?

Sanjay Swarup: The originating definitely will grow, then only we will get more handling volumes, originating with...

Priyanka Biswas: No. Same levels or would it be somewhere lower or higher? Try to assess that.

Sanjay Swarup: It will be on similar lines, of course.

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Priyanka Biswas: Okay. Similarly, like the leads, because as you rightly said NTKM should be the parameter we should watch out. So, in that what you are building, is there a lead improvement, because let us say we are connecting to JNPT and consequently the leads improve or are we saying this Rs. 150 billion revenue based on a leads which is similar to today's level. So, trying to assess that as well.

Sanjay Swarup: See, definitely there will be improvement in lead. Because JNPT as I mentioned in my earlier answer is 1,500 kilometers from NCR to JNPT and EXIM, the average lead in this financial year till now has been 693 kilometers. So, if we get a lot of business of 1,500 kilometers, definitely it will have a positive impact on lead. So, lead will definitely improve.

Priyanka Biswas: So, can the lead be something like a 800 kilometers or something like based on like let us say the increase JNPT that is how let us say the mix improves. So, would it be a right assessment?

Sanjay Swarup: I will not be making any speculation at this moment. We will be present, so we can see what will be lead that we achieve. It will gradually increase.

Priyanka Biswas: And sir, if I can just squeeze one more question in. While you gave the movement of market

shares in the key ports that is there, would you kindly share the rail coefficient in each of these ports and what it was, let us say, for the nine-month period last year? That will help.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. I can tell you for three ports, JNPT, it is 15.57% in this FY; last year it was 15.7%. In Mundra port, last year it was 23.9%; this year, it is 24.5%. In Pipavav port, last year, it was 57.7%; this year, it is 57%, rail coefficient.

Priyanka Biswas: And would you be able to provide, since you give the market share movements, what it would be in absolute terms, like, let us say, JNPT, Mundra, and Pipavav? That is my last question.

Sanjay Swarup: JNPT last year it was 58%, market share of CONCOR; this year it is 60%. Mundra last year it was 38%; this year it is 36%. Pipavav last year it was 48%; this year it is 49%.

Priyanka Biswas: Thank you so much, sir. I wish you all the best.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Mukesh Saraf: Yes. Thank you for the opportunity. My first question is on the JNPT connectivity of DFC.

Currently, could you give us some sense on the opportunity size, say either in tonnage or in number of containers or the number of container equivalents, basically on the shipment that is happening by road, this light cargo that you mentioned between say the Northern Hinterland and JNPT, which eventually can shift to rail?

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Sanjay Swarup: See, that is a market intelligence information that I cannot share on this platform.

Mukesh Saraf: Just the opportunity size, I mean, the reason I am asking this question is there was an understanding that a lot of the cargo has already moved to the ports in Gujarat. And secondly, a lot of JNPT, what is catering to now is more Central India and maybe Andhra Pradesh that kind of a market. So, just trying to assess is there a large market from the Northern Hinterland into JNPT, which is moving by road? Because all these years this is what we have been understanding that that cargo has already shifted to other ports.

Sanjay Swarup: See, whatever you have mentioned is partially correct. It has shifted. It was it

has shifted, but

now, it can come back also if there is efficiency in movement. And shipping is a ever changing process. Suppose a ship calls at JNPT first and in three days it goes to Mundra. And in those three days, the cargo already comes to NCR. So, as a consignee, what will you prefer? What will be your preference?

Mukesh Saraf: All right, understood.

Sanjay Swarup: Will not you prefer that before the ship goes to Mundra, my container comes to my factory? So, if those efficiencies are available, a lot of cargo can shift back to JNPT. I am telling you a situation, which can happen.

Mukesh Saraf: Sure. Got it. And also, we have Varnama as a large trans-shipment hub, where we are taking a lot of the double-stacking cargo as close as possible to JNPT. So in some form are not we already catering to that possible demand that will come up because of the DFC connectivity?

Sanjay Swarup: See Varnama, we started giving facility to double-stack to our NCR customers. But Varnama we cannot run assured transit time train. Assured transit time train, we can run only to JNPT because double-stacking and then changing it to single-stack. Assured transit, we cannot give to our customers, that we can give only if we have direct connectivity to JNPT.

Mukesh Saraf: Got it. And just lastly, because you had kind of outlined the CAPEX plan going up, would you be able to give some break-up of how much on rolling stock and how much on land for MMLPs?

Sanjay Swarup: Why do you want that? We do not give such information.

Mukesh Saraf: Just help us understand the gestation period, sir. I mean, if there is a lot of investment on land, probably the benefits of that would be slightly back ended. So, just want to understand that.

Sanjay Swarup: See, infrastructure projects are long gestation period projects. Suppose I created MMLP today, from tomorrow, I will start getting profits. So, it takes some time.

Mukesh Saraf: Right.

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Sanjay Swarup: Normally, we share such information.

Mukesh Saraf: Got it. Thank you. Thanks a lot for this. I will get back.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sandesh Shetty from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Sandesh Shetty: Hello. Good afternoon, sir. Sir, my first question is on the growth guidance that you have given. Can you outline like the key factors driving both EXIM and domestic? That would be first question.

Sanjay Swarup: See, Mr. Shetty, already I told in detail the growth drivers when I was mentioning the guidance. But for your benefit, I will repeat it.



Sandesh Shetty: Thank you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: For EXIM, growth driving factors will be the commissioning of Western DFC up to JNPT by March 2026. And assured transit time train services between JNPA and NCR that we will be running. Third is the double-stack trains to Jodhpur. We are bringing Jodhpur on double-stack map in this financial year only. Fourth is double-stack trains to the Ahmedabad area, where we are commissioning a terminal, which will be able to handle double-stack trains. Next is the very good traffic we are hoping from our new terminals Jajpur, Kadakola and Mandalgarh, and Paradip also, which we have commissioned recently. We have got customs notification for a few of them, so we will get good EXIM business at these terminals. Then there is a very good potential for Nepal traffic that we will be getting that already we are getting a good business for Nepal from Visakhapatnam and some from Kolkata. So, we are going to start the facility at Raxaul very soon, and Biratnagar also. Customs has issued a notification, and we are going to generate good business for Nepal at all the three places. Then I told that we are having a tie-up with all major shipping lines like MSC, Maersk, CMA, Hapag-Lloyd, etc. Then shipping sector, where already we have started our sending our containers to the Middle East and Far East al

so, very soon we are going to start. We will consolidate these two sectors, which are going to give us good business, good volumes and good profit also. These are the main factors which will drive the growth in EXIM. As far as domestic is concerned, the primary will be the bulk cement and tank containers for which we have already signed an agreement with big players like UltraTech Cement, Adani Cement, My Home Cement and JK, apart from a few others. Then we have tied up with big corporate customers like Vedanta, Jindal, Tata and Gas Authority and Petronet we are going to sign agreements. So, these will be the additional growth drivers and normal business will continue.

So, all these factors will give a growth of more than 20% in domestic. I hope you are satisfied.  
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Sandesh Shetty: Yes. Thank you, sir, for the detailed answer. And sir, my second and last question is, sir even though there is improvement in EBITDA margin, if we see the segmental margins, there has been a decline both in EXIM and domestic. Is it just attributed to depreciation or is there some other factor as well? That would be my last question. Thank you.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Actually, primary reason is depreciation only and one more thing is the land license fees that I mentioned in my opening remarks. In previous years, we had done some reversals and some adjustments and whatever land license fee we have shown this year is actual. Normally, you may be observing that we pay around Rs. 450 crores to the railways. So, up to Q3 already, we have paid Rs. 327 crores, which is in line with those calculations.

Sandesh Shetty: Thank you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ankita Shah from Elara Capital. Please go ahead.

Ankita Shah: Hi. Thank you for the opportunity. Sir, this is on the guidance, so if we assume a risk of DFC getting delayed further, then in that scenario how much the growth guidance of 15% growth on the EXIM side and similarly, on growth on the domestic side, how much would that get lower in case if there is further delay in DFC that could happen? That is the contingency risk that I was looking at.

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, I have spoken to very senior officers of DFC myself now and they have assured me maybe before 31st March, maybe by February, they will be able to commission connection to JNPA. So, I have no reasons to disbelieve that it will be extended beyond 31st March. I am very, very confident and it will be a pleasant surprise to us also and to the trade also that DFC is commissioned before 31st March.

Ankita Shah: Okay. And the increase in CAPEX number that you have mentioned from Rs. 860 crores to Rs. 1,000 crores this is for FY 2026 or from FY 2027 onwards?

Sanjay Swarup: It is for FY 2026 that BOD has yesterday revised the by 23% increase they have approved. For FY 2027, I will be telling about CAPEX in my conference call at the end of Q4 results.

Ankita Shah: And what is this incremental amount for going towards?

Sanjay Swarup: This is primarily for containers and rolling stock.

Ankita Shah: Okay. And sir, we were also planning increase in terminals. I think 10 new terminals we were planning to add this year. So, are we on track for that?

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Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes, we are on track. Already we have commissioned two terminals in this financial year and more terminals we are going to commission and they are in advanced stage. So, we are quite

on track.

Ankita Shah: Okay. So this 10 will come over a period of time not in FY 2026 itself?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, yes, they will come over a period of time not all in FY 2026.

Ankita Shah: Okay. All right, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to

the management for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: So, I do not have much to tell. Already I have told you the company is standing on very strong fundamentals. And we are increasing our CAPEX spend, creating more and more infrastructure.

So, we are quite confident that we are going to be on a very high growth path from now onwards

and we can see the results in a positive manner very soon. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your line. Thank you.

Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No. Name Phone Company

1 HOST: Kunal shah 2242022578 DAM Capital Advisors Ltd.

2 HOST: Management 1141673000 Container Corporation of India Ltd.

3 Aakash Goyal 9830519144 Tara Capital

4 Aakash Kumar 9920804560 Individual Investor

5 Aarti 9166911697 ICICI Bank

6 Abhishek Kumar 6569235178 Balyasny

7 Aditya Mondal 918481025006 Individual Investor

8 Aditya Mongia 919833234463 Kotak Securities

9 Ajit Darda 9049224455 Individual Investor

10 Akshata Thaker 917208211260 Asian Market Securities

11 Akshay Sharma 917303854285 Abakkus Asset Managers

12 Ali Khan 2406135002 Alpha Capital

13 Ali Khan 9226535120 Nexa

14 Alok D 61291549 Motilal Oswal

15 Amit Khurana 2240969791 Dolat Capital

16 Anant Poddar 9727709469 Tripura Infra Developers

17 Anish Rankawat Rankawat 919820563345 UTI MF

18 Ankit Jain 912267800305 Mirae Asset

19 Ankita Shah 9820679464 Elara Capital

20 Anshul Agarwal 66121228 Emkay Global

21 Arshit S 9007036570 Axis Capital

22 Arun Kumar 15103907767 AlphaStreet

23 Aryan Mahadevan 9352609089 InVed

24 Ashish Shah 6566025000 Millennium Capital

25 Atul Kumar 9820034170 Salvation Captial

26 Bharat Parekh 912266505020 CLSA

27 Bharati C Sawant 919004192576 Dam Capital Advisors Ltd

28 Bharti Sawant 67800306 Mirae Asset

29 Bianca Sayon 17812306877 Aiera

30 Brijesh Gupta 9619309121 Tentacle Infoedge Solutions

31 David Andersson 19376321077 Andersson Family Office

32 David Yehuda 2245630325 S&P Global

33 Deepak Krishnan 917022619241 Kotak Securities

34 Deepak Kumar 7838341823 Fedelity

35 Disha 9324791509 Ashika Institutional Equities

36 Durgesh Shukla 8506882086 incred capital

37 Dushant Arrorra 69209663 Baroda bnp

38 Gorav Narayan 9820073819 Seltora

39 Guatam 9384112771 Vara Technology

40 Harish Grover 8076180580 Individual Investor

41 Harsh Dole 9967581549 Optivus Technologies Private Limited

42 Harsh Jain 918240684867 SUD Life Insurance

43 Harsh Shah 9833504037 SRE PMS

44 Harshil Shah 8779640875 Philip Capital

45 Het Patel 919909374685 Elara Capital

46 Himani Negi 8287616135 District D

47 Hritik Daman 66323075 Bank Of America

48 Jaiwant Shah 61910261 SBI LifeTHANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US

Participants ListTotal - 112 Participants including the Speakers.January 30 , 2026 at -11:30 Hrs India TimeContainer

Corporation of India Ltd Q3 FY26 Earnings Call

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Sr. No. Name Phone Company

49 Janhavi Jain 9969378247 Axia India  
50 Jay Bhatia 919833231037 Joint Vision  
51 Jayman Shah 918758759924 Equirus Securities Private Limited  
52 Jegnesh M 9930122599 Individual Investor  
53 Jehangir Master 919869444648 NSFO  
54 Jinay Bhansali 919372789943 Motilal Oswal  
55 Kapil Agarwal 9582939294 Daksh and Associates  
56 Kartika 9166911697 ICICI  
57 Kaushal Chandarama 9820385213 Individual Investor  
58 Kiran K 16465173334 Bloomberg  
59 Koundinya 912242246159 Jefferies  
60 Krupa Shankar 9884128127 Avendus Spark  
61 Laxmi Narayan 9789951580 Ksema Wealth Pvt Ltd  
62 Lekha Badlani 9820654602 MC Research  
63 Lizian Maharana 8123210284 Tijori Finance  
64 M S Arun 8655956230 Capital Market  
65 Mani Kanthalia 66121389 MK Investment Managers  
66 Manya Kakkar 919971734529 BoFA Sec  
67 Mehul Sawla 2249790915 RW Equity  
68 Mohit C 9034299517 Shubhlabh Research  
69 Mukesh Saraf 9840016171 Avendus Spark  
70 Neelotal Sahu 9355735975 JM Financial  
71 Nilesh Rai 919819502023 blue sapphire  
72 Paresh Dave 912266520067 ASK Hedge Solutions  
7

3 Pranali Patil 912261047504 Iden Investment  
74 Prithvi Ranga 8525020335 Avendus Spark  
75 Priyanka Biswas 9731956565 JM Financial  
76 Pulkit Patni 66169044 Goldman Sachs  
77 Rachel Smith 17812306877 Aiera  
78 Rahil Bohra 917738370836 SBI Pension Fund  
79 Rahul Agarwal 2243422807 Bandan AMC  
80 Rajashi Mehta 9820637133 InCred  
81 Ratnakar 12032048517 Factset  
82 Rishab Gathan 17856293739 Alphasense  
83 Rohan Jain 9896593945 Nuvama Wealth  
84 Rohit Mishra 18085949726 Max Solution  
85 Rohit Ohri 9870448599 Progressive Share Brokers Pvt. Ltd.  
86 Sandesh Shetty 8983386423 HSBC  
87 Saunak Mayani 9833448425 Individual Investor  
88 Saurabh Kachhawa 918655707761 Indusind General Insurance  
89 Sheena 85291631120 TRow Pribe  
90 Sheena Barbosa 911205052490 Individual Investor  
91 Shivaji Mehta 9892729143 Individual Investor  
92 Shivam Agarwal 8877441119 Motilal Oswal  
93 Shrey Mehta 8369749502 Goldman Sachs  
94 Shriram Rajaram 9699085560 Sampada Capital  
95 Shruti Vasani 9820527639 Individual Investor  
96 Subroto Sarkar 8697983934 Mount Infra Global Private Limited  
97 Sumit Kishore 8169836189 Axis Securities  
98 Sunil Ragu 69854003 Informist Media  
99 Suriya Kiran 8618598567 EQ India Advisors  
100 Tvisha 919820722403 Karma capital  
101 Udit Dhekale 919766645997 bank of america  
102 Urmil Dhiraj Shah 919819916595 Ageas Federal Life Insurance  
103 Urmil Shah 912269317829 Anvil Research  
104 Vaibhav Grag 9868164488 Vikas Portfolio Pvt Ltd  
105 Vibhav 7738959037 J.P. Morgan  
106 Vikram Suryavanshi 9867327414 Philip Capital  
107 Vishnu Selvam 912266786760 UTI AMC  
108 Vivek 66121306 MK Global  
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Sr. No. Name Phone Company  
109 Vyom Chedda 9167333110 BT Group

110 Yash Jain 918291040927 Dam Capital Advisors Ltd  
111 Yash Tanna 9920046969 iThought PMS  
112 Yogesh Patil 66016073 LIC MF  
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Container Corporation of India Ltd.

A Multi-modal Logistics Company

(A N avratna CPSE of Govt. of India)

No.CON /F&CS / IRC/STOCK EX/ C.N o. 91029 / N oteN o.112/ ~: 03.06.2026

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Mumbai-400 051

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Pursuant to applicable provision s of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, please find enclosed transcript of Post Results Conference Call held on 26.05.2026.

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Regd. Ofli;e: CONCOR Bhawa.n, C-3, Ma.thura Road, New Delhi-110076

~ /Tel. Oll-41673093, 49512150,60

{-t:.T / Ermail: co.pro@concorindia.com CIK:L630IIDL1988G010a0915

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"Container Corporation of India Limited

Q4 FY26 Earnings Conference Call"

May 26, 2026

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY SWARUP – CHAIRMAN & MANAGING  
DIRECTOR – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. AJIT KUMAR PANDA – DIRECTOR (PROJECTS &  
SERVICES)– CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA  
LIMITED

M R. VIJOY KUMAR SINGH – DIRECTOR  
(INTERNATIONAL MARKETING & OPERATIONS ) –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

M R. VIVEK GUPTA – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) AND CHIEF  
FINANCIAL OFFICER – CONTAINER CORPORATION OF  
INDIA LIMITED

M R. HARISH CHANDRA – PRINCIPAL EXECUTIVE  
DIRECTOR (FINANCE) AND COMPANY SECRETARY –  
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

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MODERATOR : MR. KUNAL SHAH – DAM CAPITAL ADVISORS  
LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Container Corporation of India Limited Q4  
FY26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by DAM Capital Advisors. As a reminder, all participant  
lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions

after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Kunal Shah from DAM Capital Advisors. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Kunal Shah: Yes. Good afternoon. Welcome to the 4Q FY26 Earnings Call of Container Corporation of India. We have the management being represented by Mr. Sanjay Swarup, Chairman and Managing Director. I would like to hand over the call to Sanjay sir for his opening remarks, post which we can take up the Q&A. Over to you, sir. Thank you.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Good morning to all. I am accompanied by Mr. Ajit Kumar Panda, Director, Projects and Services; Mr. Vijoy Kumar Singh, Director, International Marketing and Operations; Mr. Vivek Gupta, Director, Finance and CFO; and Mr. Harish Chandra, Principal Executive Director, Finance, and Company Secretary of our company.

I will just make the opening remarks, and then I will open for a question-and-answer session.

I'm glad to announce that Board of Directors have approved the dividend of INR1 per share of par value INR5 for -- that is interim dividend for quarter 4. This made the total dividend of INR8.6 per share, which is 172% of the par value of share. This is the -- in yesterday's Board of Directors meeting, it was approved.

I would like to outline the challenges being faced by international trade in FY25-26. Most of you are quite well aware of that. There are a lot of geopolitical uncertainties which is due to the international conflicts and trade tensions. And this has severely disrupted the global supply chains and increased the trade risks. There are trade restrictions and tariffs by United States up to 50% were imposed during the year.

And this has severely affected the volumes, especially in textiles and marine products. And then there was a global economic slowdown in U.S., Europe and parts of Asia. There are currency fluctuations also, exchange rate instability is there. All these factors are impacting the EXIM trade.

India's international trade that is merchandise trade for -- was as under for the FY. Exports were total USD441.8 billion, which was a growth of 0.9% over the previous financial year. Imports were USD774.9 billion, which was a growth of 7.45% over the previous year. Despite these challenges, our company, Container Corporation achieved ever highest throughput of 5.58 million TEUs in FY26, which was a growth of 9.6% in which EXIM growth was 8% and domestic growth was 14.6%.

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Our rail freight margin increased from 25.65% to 27.16%, which is quite a healthy rail freight margin. It's a growth of 1.51%. Our overall operating margin increased from 29.99% to 30.89%. It's a growth of almost 1%. Our operating income increased by 2.2%.

Our PAT suffered a decrease of 4.5%. The main reasons are the less demand in domestic streams, primarily the Gunny Bales traffic and tiles traffic due to the geopolitical conflicts. Second reason is the shortage of tank containers because the ecosystem of tank container, it's a new product. In our country that the ecosystem was not there. Due to that, in last FY, we could not get a good supply of tank containers.

But now the ecosystem is quite well developed. We have 2, 3 good vendors, and we have a fleet of 500 tank containers with us right now. And every month, we are adding

200 tank containers

to this fleet.

Yesterday, I'm glad to inform you, Board of Directors further approved the procurement of 2,000 more tank containers, apart from 1,000 tank containers approved earlier. So in this FY, we will have a very good availability of tank containers, which will give us good loading of bulk cement in domestic. Apart from that, the reason for decline in PAT was the challenges faced by international trade, as I already highlighted.

The growth in double stack rakes was 1.5% from 6,302 double stack to 6,396 double stack rakes in this financial year. And there is a very big development taking place that already most of you may be knowing, DFC connected to -- connectivity to JNPT will be commissioned by 1st June 2026, so we are quite ready.

And last week, I had a meeting with top management of DFC Corporation, and they are quite optimistic that this -- from 1st June, they will be able to run double stack trains to JNPT. So we will be getting a very good business from first June. We will be running double stack train from NCR to JNPT and EXIM volumes will get a very big boost as a result of this connectivity.

Then during the financial year, CONCOR signed MOU for Bharat Container Shipping Line, in which we have a 30% stake. We are one of the majority partners of Bharat Container Shipping Line. And as per the Amrit Kaal Vision of Honorable Prime Minister, this shipping line will be

among the top 10 shipping lines of the world by 2047. CONCOR containers are now going to Middle East. Of course, because of the conflict, this movement has stopped. Otherwise, our containers, almost 700 containers have gone to Middle East under our own document that we have issued the bill of lading for these containers. We have -- we are quite bullish on infrastructure additions. We have commissioned 43 high-speed rakes in this financial year, taking total to 423. And we have procured 4,729 new containers, taking our total fleet size to 57,746 containers of our own. And due to the excellent operation planning, we reduced the empty running of rakes also and by -- in EXIM by 27% and in domestic around 4%, overall, 10.5% reduction in empty running of rakes. This has positively contributed to our bottom line.

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So the company is quite conscious about the ESG norms. We have taken a lot of green logistics initiatives. We have 230 LNG trucks of our own. We have 5 electric RSTs and 2 electric vehicles, which we are using for trial basis and once -- and we are quite -- seeing good results, we will be procuring more of them.

Capex achieved in last financial year was one of the highest, which is INR1,085.20 crores. And in this financial year, yesterday, Board of Directors have approved a capex budget of INR945 crores. We may be increasing the budget during the midyear review and -- because we need a lot of capex for infrastructure additions.

Now I will briefly summarize the business current scenario. In EXIM, we crossed INR6,000 crores, that is INR60 billion for the first time, that is the revenue. For the first time in the company's history, which is all-time high. EXIM has performed exceedingly well. We achieved 4.21 million TEUs handling only through EXIM, which is again ever highest in the company's history.

WDFC connectivity will give a very big boost to volumes in this financial year and now from the coming years. And we have signed MOU with PSA that is Port of Singapore Authority for dedicated services between JNPA and CONCOR ICDs. This will be a big driver for growth for EXIM in the coming years.

In the last financial year, we achieved an export growth in -- of total 3%, in which auto parts achieved a growth of 17%, buffalo meat 19%, aluminum ingots 22% besides other commodities. Imports, we achieved a growth of 5.8%, in which auto parts contributed 38%; solar panel parts, 92%, and polymer products, 23%.

We also

unveiled a liberalized DPD and cabotage policy, which was very well received by trade, and we saw a 38% increase in our DPD volumes, which is now further going to grow in this financial year also.

In collaboration with the leading shipping line Maersk, we launched the Aushadhi Express from our Hyderabad ICD Sanathnagar to JNPT, and it is also very well received. All these drugs are normally -- usually, they go to Western countries, U.S.A. and Europe, primarily U.S.A. So this is also a very good product that has been launched by us from Hyderabad, and we are getting good patronization from trade.

Our reefer exports also saw a very good growth of 17%. It's a healthy growth. And in this financial year also, there is a good demand in reefer volumes. At almost all the ports, we recorded growth in imports. Like in JNPT, there was 12% growth, Mundra, 8.8%, Chennai, 14%; and Vizag, 28% growth in our exports.

Now I will come to domestic. Domestic, our product that we launched, bulk cement transportation in tank containers is very well received by trade. We are getting a lot of demand and now the supply of tank containers is also coming. So we are quite well positioned in this financial year to capitalize on this new stream, which we are going to -- and normally, in domestic, we are doing 14 million to 15 million tons of loading.

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And I'm quite positive that in this financial year itself, we will be able to do at least 1 million tons of bulk cement in tank containers in domestic. Besides that, our trials for bulk loading of food grains in containers, along with liners, has been successful. And very soon, we are going to start that also.

We are running a short transit time train from Tughlakabad, Delhi to Shalimar, Calcutta, which has also contributed to increase in our volumes and several new services, assured transit will be very soon announced by Indian Railways.

Indian Railways, in fact, is working on various reforms for container sector, and we are expecting various -- so many reforms from Indian Railways, which will be unveiled in the coming weeks, which we will be informing all of you in due course of time.

We have -- we are also in talks with Gas Authority, GAIL and Petronet, and we are expecting very good volumes from them. That also we'll inform you once we receive the orders. Apart from that, gunny bales traffic, which suffered quite badly in last financial year is likely to be revived in this financial year. There are quite firm indications for that, which will positively contribute to our domestic volume.

Now going forward, as I told you, the factors which will contribute to our business, I would like to summarize them. First is WDFC commissioning and assured transit trains. Second is double stacks at our locations in Salawas and Chharodi. Salawas is near Jodhpur. Chharodi is near Ahmedabad. Chharodi will be on DFC.

So these new terminals will contribute to double stacks. We will bring to Jodhpur. Ahmedabad already, of course, double stack is there, but we don't have a facility of double stack, so we hope to ramp up good volumes at Chharodi also. And besides that, we have commissioned new terminals like Mandalgarh, Kadakola, near Mysuru, Jajpur and Paradip, which will also bring new traffic to our company.

Then Nepal traffic that is going at present to Birgunj. We have opened another point at Raxaul, where we are handling the containers. Crane handling is allowed by Indian Railways. So Birgunj and Raxaul, 2 points. Apart from that, Biratnagar, very soon, we will be starting. So Nepal traffic also, there will be good growth in this financial year.

And lastly, we are quite positive for shipping business. We are already moving -- we were already moving to Middle East before the conflict. And now Far East also, we have started moving. And apart from that, we are a major component of Bharat Container Shipping

Line, as

I already informed. This will be also a big driver in the coming years.

I would like to now give the guidance for this financial year '27. EXIM, I would like to give a guidance of 8%. Domestic, I would like to give guidance of 15%. Overall, will be 9.5%. Of course, I'm a bit conservative because of the various geopolitical factors, which are right now present, and in the midyear, we will review the -- our performance and various environment around us, and we will go for a revision if required for this guidance. But right now, it is EXIM, 8%, domestic, 15%, overall, 9.5%.

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In the present market scenario, I feel it is better not to make any long-term guidance forecast. So I will adhere to only this financial year guidance. For subsequent years, we will tell when the situation stabilizes around us. Thank you very much. This is my opening remarks.

Now you can start with your questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much, sir. First question is from the line of Mukesh Saraf from Avendus Spark.

Mukesh Saraf: My first question is regarding the DFC connectivity from JNPT starting next week itself. If you could give some sense on the size of the opportunity here, say, either road moving to rail or the shipping lines calling at JNPT and not, say, at Mundra because of this rail connectivity now.

This will kind of give us some sense on what kind of volumes we can kind of ship across JNPT to NCR?

Sanjay Swarup: See, at present, the rail coefficient at JNPT is, for the last financial year, it was 15.12%. And with this connectivity, overnight, it will not increase. But in this FY, I'm sure from 15%, at least, it will go to 18% to 19%. So there are quite good indications that -- and we will be actually running time table assured transit train from NCR to JNPT.

And secondly, we will be tinkering with our tariff also because our company believes that without sacrificing margins, if we incur some savings, we will share those savings with our customers, part of the savings. So because in double stack, we have to pay less haulage charges to railways.

So we'll be having some savings on 40-foot containers. So we will be coming out with a very competitive tariff that will be light cargo, which is at present moving by road. So transit time will reduce and our tariff will also at par or very competitive with road.

So we are quite positive that a lot of traffic will shift from road to rail. Right now, numbers I cannot give you. But I'm very sure that this shift will be there in another 3 years' time, rail coefficient will increase from 15% to at least 30% or 35% at JNPT.

And as far as the movement of cargo from Mundra to JNPT and all is concerned, at the moment, I would like to -- not like to comment on that. Let us see how the trade takes it and shipping lines and trade, they will see the service levels and what advantage they will get, what other dynamics they have. And they will take a decision.

At present, we have the service at Mundra also. We have the service at JNPT also. So -- and we



have signed, in fact, an agreement with PSA at JNPT. So from our side, we are able to give service to customers from both the ports. They have to decide that where do they want to bring the cargo.

Mukesh Saraf: Got it. Got it. That's quite clear, sir. Thank you. And secondly, on the tariffs you had mentioned, aren't we -- I mean, what we are reading is that road tariff is going up, with diesel, etc, kind of moving up.

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Are you starting to already see some kind of a shift from road to rail because road freight rates are going up, while I guess, Indian Railways is being quite aggressive on the rail side of it. If you could talk a little more on the economics between road and railways?

Sanjay Swarup: See rail is a green mode of transport, and it is an environment-friendly

mode of transport. So I

am a great advocate for rail transportation. We should have long-distance transportation by rail. So definitely, efforts should be to move more and more cargo by rail. So where -- whatever sectors are contributing to it and -- but the rail transportation at the end of the day should increase.

And for your information, at JNPT, there was a very big congestion some few days back due to various reasons, you may be reading. And because -- and CONCOR came forward. I also spoke to Chairman and the top management of JNPT. So we evacuated a lot of containers from JNPT to our facility at Dronagiri, and all this evacuation was done through rail only.

We deployed the special rakes and transportation was done between JNPT and our terminal. So rail definitely helped us a lot in easing the congestion. And now JNPT is having a huge imports now. So, it's dealing with a lot of volumes. So definitely, rail is a preferred mode of transport for our country as a whole.

Mukesh Saraf: Sure, sir. Sure. And just one last question from my side. You have mentioned about assured transit time services. Say in F '26, could you give us some sense on what percentage of your services are running on assured transit time. And what could this go up to say, in the next year?

Sanjay Swarup: See, percentage-wise, if you compare from our overall volume, it is a negligible percentage. But I should say that it's a welcome beginning by Indian Railways, which is welcomed by the trade.

So if I go for percentage, it is a very meager percentage.

But more and more reforms in the form of various other things and assured transit, more services are being announced by Indian Railways because they are seeing the benefits of that. So these are small steps being taken, and we should welcome these steps because ultimately, eventually, it will again divert traffic to rail.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Sumit Kishor from Axis Capital.

Sumit Kishor: Sir, if you can elaborate on your thoughts around the West Asia crisis, which is still ongoing. And we are almost 2 months into the June quarter, what has been the disruption in terms of volumes for EXIM and domestic?

If you could give us a flavor. And very difficult to give an outlook here. But given you have left us with the 8% growth guidance on EXIM and 15% for domestic, what kind of a slow start do you expect in the first half of the fiscal? That is my first question.

Sanjay Swarup: See, as far as the West Asia crisis is concerned, our volumes were impacted in the month of March due to which last FY also, our results were -- we were expecting more, at least we could not perform that much. And April was also not very good. But from the month of May, we are again seeing an upsurge in our volumes, which is a good indication.

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So probably the other markets like U.S. and Europe and Far East, they are now contributing a lot. And Government of India has signed various FTAs with various countries. That is also positively impacting the business. We are getting good import volumes at all the gateway ports and FTAs have a very important role to play in that.

And I'm quite sure that whatever guidance I have given, taking all these factors into consideration, we have worked out, and now we are giving this guidance. So we are quite positive to achieve this guidance.

Sumit Kishor: Sure. My second question is on the domestic segment revenue growth, a decline of 4% in the March quarter, and the domestic EBIT margin -- segment EBIT margin was just 0.2%. So if you could help us quantify the impact that the West Asia crisis in March, particularly had for the domestic business? And what really led to such a steep sort of impact in the domestic segment that will be useful?

Sanjay Swarup: See, domestic actually affected very adversely because of the disturbance in our neighboring country because of

that, we could not get the supply of jute. And this Gunny Bales were the major domestic loading commodity in Eastern India, and because of the -- no supply of jute or less supply of jute, the Gunny Bales traffic was very severely affected.

This affected our top line in domestic as well as bottom line because traditionally, cargo goes to Eastern India and in return direction, Gunny Bales were stuffed in the containers. But because of there were no Gunny Bales, so these containers were coming empty. So bottom line was very badly affected.

The second reason was the tiles industry. In Morbi, you must be reading in newspaper, not -- almost all the tile factories are closed because of there's no supply of gas. So these 2 commodities are big commodities contributing in domestic, and these were the reasons. Now slowly, both the commodities are getting revived.

So we are quite positive. Apart from that, now this bulk cement will also gain traction. So that is why I am giving a guidance of 15% domestic, which we are quite optimistic that we will be able to achieve.

Sumit Kishor: So the gunny bag issue and the Morbi volumes, are they back to 50% of normal or even below that right now?

Sanjay Swarup: Right now, they are below that, but there are indications that very quickly, they will be increasing.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditya Mongia: I had a couple of questions from my side. First one being on JNPT. Sir, you talked about an 18% to 19% year-end number and eventually 30% modal coefficient number. Could you give us a sense of what are low-hanging fruits over here, which can make 18% to 19% happen? Are you -- and then what needs to happen for 30% modal coefficient to happen?

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And why I'm also asking this question is my sense was that the entire movement that goes from road from JNPT to northern part of the country was 10%-odd. So just trying to get a sense, which are the other routes that you're exploring when you're thinking to 30% modal coefficient?

Sanjay Swarup: See, Aditya, actually, this changeover from road to rail will not happen overnight. Once these services start, it would take some time to stabilize. Like right now, I told the rail coefficient in last financial year at JNPT was 15%, 1-5. So I am expecting that in FY27, this will reach around 19%, 1-9. Maybe it may reach 20%, 21% also.

And in 3 years' time, it will stabilize at 30% or 35%, because JNPT is not serving only North India. A lot of traffic is going to Hyderabad area, to Nagpur, that is Central area, Central India and then to Bangalore also, South India. So all these places are also served by JNPT. So -- and all these places are not connected on Western DFC.

So Western DFC is connecting North India, there is NCR, it is passing through Gujarat. So Nagpur, Hyderabad and Bangalore, they continue to be non-DFC locations for JNPT. So in that all locations also, we are getting a good business. They will continue to move non-DFC.

But the benefits of DFC, and from all these locations, Nagpur, Hyderabad, Bangalore, we cannot run double stack trains to JNPT because it is not on DFC. But for NCR area and Gujarat, we will be able to run double stack. So they will reap the benefits of Western DFC. So that is why I'm saying that in 3 years, rail coefficient will increase to 30%, 35%.

Aditya Mongia: So just to clarify, what you're saying is that -- or maybe just a clarification here. When you say on the non-DFC routes, Hyderabad, Nagpur, so on and so forth, will there be any which ways impacted by the commissioning of Western DFC? What are the reasons why they would start coming on double stack to JNPT versus them not doing it today?

Sanjay Swarup: So these locations like Nagpur, Hyderabad, Bangalore will not be impacted with commissioning of Western DFC because double stack trains cannot be run from the

se locations.

Aditya Mongia: Yes, so why push it on rail from roads over time?

Sanjay Swarup: So for these locations also, we are running services and the shift from road to rail is there, but it is gradual shift. And it's not that quantum shift, I should say, that will happen when DFC is commissioned for NCR and -- between NCR and JNPT. But these locations also, there's a gradual shift from road to rail, but not that quick.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. Just a second question from my side. I was intrigued by you suggesting that Indian Railways are on the anvil of talking about or announcing more reforms. Could you give us a sense of which direction are these reforms focused on? I mean, one part is obviously assured traffic and assured rates, but what beyond that could be the focus areas for Indian Railways?

Sanjay Swarup: I cannot disclose the details of reforms to you. But in logistics, there are -- I can give you a hint

because in logistics, there are only 2 things that a customer wants. First is the transit time. And second thing is economically, costs should be reasonable. So railways is working on both these issues. That much only I can tell you right now.

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Moderator: Next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama.

Achal Lohade: Am I audible?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, please.

Achal Lohade: Sir, first question, you've talked about container, the shipping, the Bharat container investment. So if you could talk a little bit more on that in terms of what are the plans? What kind of capital allocation or capital investment would be -- would that entail from our end?

Sanjay Swarup: See, what capital we have to invest in that, it's a confidential information right now, and it's going to the Cabinet. So I cannot disclose that information to you. I can only tell you that we have a 30% stake in that. And it will be a very big shipping line for our country. And our country, it's a pride for us that we will have a container shipping line. Until now, we don't have a container shipping line at all.

With Make in India getting traction in our country and a lot of exports being generated, so it's high time that we should have a container shipping line where we should have our own ships, we should have our own containers and ports have also been made stakeholders. So we should be a very active part of global supply chains.

So this is a welcome move by government of India and Container Corporation with its strength in the hinterland and inland logistics and Shipping Corporation of India. They are also having 30% stake. They have a good experience in the shipping sector. So both these big companies have joined hands. Apart from there, they are 3 ports JNPT, Chennai Port and Tuticorin Port. They're also part and Sagarmala Development Fund. They are also part of this BCSL. So all these relevant players, Government of India have decided that they will be part of our container shipping line. And as I told you already, as per the Amrit Kaal Vision of Honorable Prime Minister, by 2047, this shipping line will be among the top 10 shipping lines of the world. Only this much I can tell you right now.

Achal Lohade: No problem, sir. The second question I had, with respect to the margins. So while you have talked about the volume growth guidance, and I presume you're talking about the handling volume or originating volume, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: I'm talking about handling volumes.

Achal Lohade: Okay. So given that volume guidance, what kind of -- how do we look at the margins, especially -- I mean if you could talk a little bit on that margin front overall? Or if possible, even on segment level?

Sanjay Swarup: See, you people are very good in number crunching. We cannot match you. So you can very easily do that. All I can tell you is we will maintain the EBITDA level between 24% to 25% as we have been doing till now. In fact, last financi

al year also, we had an EBITDA of 24.33% in

FY26. FY25, it was 24.9%. So there was hardly any drop in EBITDA percent despite all these

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setbacks. So in the coming years also, we will maintain EBITDA between 24% to 25%. We are quite clear on that.

Achal Lohade: Got it. Sir, just a quick clarification I wanted to check with is in terms of the drop in the segment margin for domestic, if I look at the Q-o-Q drop in terms of the segment EBIT, that is very, very sharp. Is there any one-off, anything you want to call out? I also see, at the same time, there is a significant jump in the other expenses. So if you could call out if there are any one-offs here or any expenses which have gone up materially?

Sanjay Swarup: See, as I told earlier also that in domestic, actually, if you have to have good bottom line, then you should have minimum empty running of containers. You should have both sides loaded movement. Logistics is sustainable only if we have loaded movement from both the sides.

But because of the setback of not getting the Gunny Bales traffic, we were forced to move empty containers from Eastern India to North India and Western India because we have a lot of business traffic moving from Western India and North India to Eastern India.

Return direction, we were getting Gunny Bales, which was loaded from Eastern India to these locations and Central India also. But now because Gunny Bales traffic stopped, so we were forced to run empty containers out from Eastern India back to these places for getting the loading.

So because of that empty running, it severely affected our profitability in domestic, and we were not able to build any circuits. Of course, we tried some triangular movements, but most of the cases, we had to take out empties from Eastern India, either to North India or to West India, sometimes to Central and South India also. So this affected the profitability of domestic in a very big way in Q4.

Achal Lohade: Got it. If you could help us with the originating volume, sir, for fourth quarter or full year, sir?

Sanjay Swarup: You want for fourth quarter or full year?

Achal Lohade: Ideally both, but if you could give any of that, that would be very helpful, sir.

Sanjay Swarup: Because up to Q3, you may be having. So fourth quarter originating volume was -- EXIM was 5,49,273 TEUs and domestic 1,29,065 TEUs, total is 6,78,338 TEUs.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Jainam Shah from Equirus Capital.

Jainam Shah: Sir, just one thing over here. If we see our handling volume growth for this year was at around 9.6% total, whereas our originating growth was at around 4.5%. And if we see our revenue growth, it was near 2%. So of course, our double stacking has been increasing, which is leading to a lower realization.

Our first mile and last mile is also increasing, which is, you can say, having a difference between originating and this -- what you can say handling volumes. And now we are guiding, let's say, around 9.5% growth for the handling volume for next year.

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How do you think it will convert into the originating growth? And probably to the revenue growth? How do we see that two numbers panning out from the handling volume growth for the FY27?

Sanjay Swarup: See, it is difficult to tell you the exact percentage. But if you are tracking Container Corporation, you may be knowing that broadly, originating is almost 65% or 70% of handling. That is a thumb rule. And as far as earning is concerned, it's a function of 2 things. NTKM, in railways, we call net ton kilometers, it's a function of weight and distance.

So originating that is only -- it tells the 1 million tons, which are -- 1 million TEUs or 1 million tons, which are moved. So you have to multiply it with the distance, which is the lead. So if originating is increa

sing by 4.47%, whereas earning is increasing by 2.2%, that means our lead has come down. So if we move for less distance, then we get less revenue. So it's a function of weight and distance. So that is the thumb rule for that, yes.

Jainam Shah: Got it, sir. Sir, on the empty running part that you will be highlighting on the domestic part, what I see over here is that for a domestic full year, I guess empty running has been down by around some 4% or 5%. For the quarter, the calculation that I've been doing, empty running has increased from INR66 crores last year, 4Q FY25 to around INR73 crores in 4Q FY26.

That is increase of around let's say, INR7 crores, INR8 crores on the top line of around INR760 crores that we have booked for the domestic segment. That is near 1% of the impact that has eventually been there in the empty running cost for the domestic part. Our margin used to be between, let's say, 5% to 8% on the EBIT margin for the domestic segment.

Now we have reported 0.2%. Even if we add back 1% of this empty running cost, which has increased over last year, then the margin would have been, let's say, 1.2%, 1.5%. So -- where is the gap between, let's say, 5%, 7% that we used to report versus, let's say, 1.5%, even after removing the empty running cost of INR73 crores that we would have reported in 4Q FY26.

Sanjay Swarup: Now the empty Q4 to Q4 has increased by 11% in domestic for your information from INR68.9 crores...

Jainam Shah: INR63 crores to INR73 crores. Yes. Yes. It was around 11%...

Sanjay Swarup: No, it is not INR63 crores. It is INR68.9 crores to INR76.7 crores. So that is 11.3% increase.

And second thing is the lead in domestic has also gone down, from INR1,321 crores to INR1,309 crores. So both these things have contributed to top line as well as bottom line. So as far as the year figure for full financial year, domestic empty running has come down from INR291.4 crores to INR280.35 crores. That is a drop of 3.8%.

Jainam Shah: Got it, sir, got it. And of course, we have not given any long-term guidance, but we used to say that our handling would be reaching to, let's say, 10 million TEUs by maybe '29, '30. How this recent crisis would have been impacted that time line of maybe the volumes? Or let's say, does this have any impact on our capex for future years? Or we'll be building on the capacities for the future growth?

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Sanjay Swarup: See, we are incurring expenditure on capex because we want to be ready. And of course, there is a lot of demand. At present, sometimes we feel when EXIM and domestic are firing on all cylinders, and a lot of demand is there, we are not able to meet the demand of our customers. And customer will not wait for us. So we should be future ready with our infrastructure, and we don't know when these things will turn, when the demand will increase.

And of course, we have some forecasts. But procurement of rakes, procurement of containers, it cannot be done overnight. It will take some time. So we have to be future ready to meet the demand of our customers because we believe in giving them excellent service without sacrificing our margins. That has been the motto of our country.

We work on that principle. That is why we go for capex of INR1,000 crores every year. This year also INR945 crores has been approved by BoD. Definitely, midyear review will be there.

And we -- I think we will be touching that figure only that we did in last financial year. So all these infrastructure additions are going to further bring in more volumes to us only.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Priyankar from JM Financial.

Priyankar: So my first question is, sir, we have recently seen like significant increases in diesel prices, I mean, in the past 1 month. So in that context, I guess, truck freight rates should have also increased meaningfully.

So in that case, are we seeing an

y movement back from road to rail, at least on the volumes that

you may have seen in the March of -- at least in the months of, let's say, month of May? So that's

the first question. And if you can elaborate like how do you see the rail modal share going ahead?

Sanjay Swarup: See, we are already in the month of May. All I can say is that definitely, we are seeing good volumes in the month of May. March and April were not good for us. So I cannot give you any numbers right now because I don't have with me at present. So definitely, it would have contributed to increase in rail share. But numbers, I don't have with me right now.

Priyankar: So ideally, the rail modal share should have increased. I mean, with this diesel price increases leading to truck freight rates. Would that be a right understanding?

Sanjay Swarup: See, it is very premature to say that. But definitely, whatever you are pointing out is correct. Definitely, it will be -- more movement will be done by -- with rail only. I fully agree with you.

Priyankar: Sir, just adding on to that. So you said despite you meeting up with your EXIM volume guidance for the full year, what I observed is despite that, the top line growth is something like 2.5%. So where is exactly the disconnect?

I mean, ideally, one should expect that if you are growing somewhere, let's say, double digits, so ideally the revenue growth should also be coming close to double digits. So what exactly is the issue that we are facing on the revenue front?

Sanjay Swarup: See, incidentally, in EXIM, we have not grown with double digit. Handling growth was 8%, originating growth was 5%, and there was a drop in lead also. As I explained earlier, the earnings

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is a function of weight as well as lead. So EXIM, there was a drop of lead of 3 kilometers overall in the financial year. That is a big drop.

So it contributed to that much -- not commensurate growth. But definitely, in EXIM, we have done very well. INR6,000 crores, we have crossed for the first time in our history. So this is a good growth, and we are expecting more growth in this financial year.

Priyankar: And sir, just squeezing one more question in. One more question. So you used to provide your market share at JNPT, Mundra and Pipavav and also the rail co-efficient. If you can do that for the quarter?

Sanjay Swarup: I can give you for the year. I don't have for the quarter.

Priyankar: Yes, yes. That's also fine. For the year would also work.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. JNPT rail coefficient was 15.12%, and our share was 60%. Mundra, rail coefficient 24.6%. Our share is 35.4%. Pipavav, rail coefficient is 57.5%. Our share is 48.3%.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Vivek Sethia from HDFC Securities.

Vivek Sethia: Am I audible?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes, please.

Vivek Sethia: Just at the cost of sounding repetitive, I missed the initial part of the call. Could you please provide us with the -- provide me with the handling volume and originating volume? And if you could repeat the market share and coefficient, which you've just repeated for the previous caller?

Sanjay Swarup: The handling we achieved for the financial year. You want full financial year?

Vivek Sethia: Quarter financials, breakdown in terms of EXIM and domestic book.

Sanjay Swarup: Because Q3, you may be having already. So I would tell you about Q4. Q4 handling volumes for EXIM was 10,68,283. Domestic, 3,59,819. Total 14,28,102.

Vivek Sethia: Yes. Also if you could provide the originating?

Sanjay Swarup: Originating?

Vivek Sethia: Yes.

Sanjay Swarup: Originating EXIM is 5,49,273. Domestic 1,29,065, total 6,78,338.

Vivek Sethia: And if you could repeat the market share point, which you just discussed?

Sanjay Swarup: Market share is JNPT rail coefficient is 15.12%, market share is 60%. Mundra, this rail coefficient 24.6%, market share is 35.4%. Pipavav, rail coefficient

is 57.5%, market share is

48.3%.

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Vivek Sethia: 48.3%. Okay.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditya Mongia: Sir, I just want to kind of gauge from you as -- from a costing perspective, the dependencies on Indian Railways, where do you think there is scope for any kind of rationalization from a CONCOR perspective for railways to do better, yes?

Sanjay Swarup: Can you please repeat the question? I have not heard you properly.

Aditya Mongia: I'm just saying as in from the perspective of costing and that's decided by Indian Railways, there are a few dependencies over here. Where do you think that if the cost is rationalized, that the demand for the rail product can go up?

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. See, right now, if you see the point-to-point cost, rail cost is less than road cost. And the increase in total logistics cost is because road is door-to-door and rail, we have to go for first mile, last mile. Normally, first mile, last mile is the component, which increases the transportation if we do through rail. But rail point-to-point is still it is cheaper than road.

So we have to minimize first mile, last mile. So we have to have more and more facilities, more and more terminals, which should be near the cargo center. So that first mile last mile comes down and transportation is done through rail.

And at present, the challenge being faced by trade is not the high cost that we have to incur on rail transportation. It is the transit time. Transit time is the challenge that trade is facing. So cost wise, I don't think there is not much issue.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Koundinaya from Jefferies.

Koundinaya: Sir, 2, 3 questions from my end. So firstly, on the market share on the EXIM side, last year, you were about 55%-odd. Where would you be currently? And how would that number correspond?

I mean, at different ports, have you lost or gained share anywhere? If you can speak a little bit about that?

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. I would tell you the entire year. Last year, in EXIM, it was 55.2%. This year, it is 53.9%.

Domestic last year was 57.6%. This year, it is 55.9%. Overall, last year, it was 55.9%. This year, it is 54.5%. There is a marginal drop in market share. And basic reasons are we purposely avoided picking up the low-margin businesses on some segments and some market share we lost in domestic due to various reasons. As far as port market share is concerned, already I have told for all the 3 ports.

Koundinaya: Sure, sir. Sir, my second question is, I mean, with respect to the empty running, for the quarter gone by that is the March '26 quarter, your domestic empty running costs went up by about 6% Y-o-Y, if I understood it correctly, which is similar to the Y-o-Y growth in your domestic originating volumes.

So therefore, I mean, why there is a sharp drop in margins? I understand you spoke about the empty running and all that due to gunny bags, but then the empty running cost on a Y-o-Y basis

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is pretty similar to your cargo volume growth. Therefore, on a per TEU basis, I mean, are there any other elements which we are missing? I mean, or at least, is there a gap in our understanding?

If you can help us there, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Now the -- if you see the Q4 Y-o-Y, the domestic empty running has increased by 11.3%, not by 5% or 6%. It is 11.3%. Last year, it was INR68.94 crores. This year, it is INR76.76 crores.

So that is a growth, an increase of 11.3% in domestic.

The reason that I was telling you because of the Eastern side, we have to move empty containers.

And originating volumes in domestic have increased by 1.9%. So -- and then lead has also come down from 1,321 kilometers to 1,309 kilometers. So all these factors have contributed to the numbers in domestic.

Koundi

naya: Sir, if I may ask one last question. How is the current quarter shaping up? Because with the West Asia crisis and everything, are you seeing higher empty running or lower double stacking? I mean how are the operations impacted? Because we understand Middle East is a key export destination. So how is it impacting the operations now, not just in terms of volumes, but also in terms of managing the empty running movement, etcetera?

Sanjay Swarup: See now the -- as I told earlier also, April month was not very good for us from a business point of view. But from May, business has really picked up quite well. We are seeing good tendencies at ports also, and exports are also picking up. Domestic is also now gradually increasing. So from May onwards, we are seeing some upsurge. So we hope to end the quarter on a positive note.

Koundinaya: Sir, my question is more specific to the operations rather than just the business because Middle East being a key export destination, are you seeing a potentially higher empty running or lower double stacking in the current quarter is what I was trying to understand because there were some media articles quoting that. Just trying to confirm it from you.

Sanjay Swarup: I don't have the numbers with me right now. So a specific question -- I cannot answer that question. Right now, I don't have the numbers with me for this current quarter.

Moderator: Next question is from the line of Krishnendu Saha from Quantum AMC.

Krishnendu Saha: So just a clarification Atmanirbhar Container Drive with BCSL, it talks about an outlay of investment of INR59,000 crores. This is reading from the GIGW release so because in the parliament. So is it that you are still making investment of 40% of this INR59,000 crores? If I understood it right or wrong? Can you just help me with that, please?

Sanjay Swarup: Sorry, your voice is not clear. I'm not able to understand your question. Can you move a little away from mic and then tell, because I'm not able to understand.

Krishnendu Saha: Hello. Can you hear me? Hello?

Sanjay Swarup: What is the question? What do...

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Krishnendu Saha: Yes. When I look at the press release from PIB, Atmanirbhar Container Drive taking shape with the BCSL, it talks about an outlay of investment of INR59,000 crores. So is that understanding that we have to forgo 30% of that? Or just trying to understand because this press release talks about a large number of INR59,000 crores. So I just wanted your thoughts on that. And the second question is on the -- sorry, the second question is on Bharat Mumbai. Hello -- sorry..

Sanjay Swarup: At the moment, I cannot comment on what is there on press release, and it's a confidential information. How much we have to spend in that JV, it's not possible. I will not use this forum to comment on that.

Krishnendu Saha: Okay. Fair enough. Just on the Bharat Mumbai container of the PSA, what is the reason, sir, we have to get into an agreement with PSA? Isn't that the containers offload automatically and we get it? Or is that like we get the first right of first refusal or something like that?

Is there anything more benefits for us in that manner? Just trying to understand that business. And just last one, the other expenses have increased drastically as a percentage of revenue. So if you just throw some light on that, it will be helpful.

Sanjay Swarup: See, actually, the PSA, that agreement we have signed, that's a unique agreement because for the first time, the -- we will be bringing domestic containers as well as the cabotage containers also on that train. So that we have got a special permission from customs. That permission is for everybody. Anybody can use that. So we will be bringing domestic plus EXIM containers from their terminal.

And why PSA? Reason is that they have a fully compliant DFC yard in JNPT. Huge yard they have constructed from

which double stack trains can be directly run. So this will be domestic plus EXIM. Now the other terminals at JNPT are also approaching CONCOR to sign a similar agreement with them. We are evaluating that. And very soon, we may be signing with other players also.

Krishnendu Saha: So is it like they have to give you a certain amount of volume or you have to be on time? Is the agreement -- as what agreement says that there has to be some agreement. So what is -- is there anything -- what is the underlying thing which holds up the agreement? If you can shed some light on that?

Sanjay Swarup: See, it's a confidential agreement. I can't share. It's not in public domain, but all I can say is it will bring more business to CONCOR.

Krishnendu Saha: I understand, sir. And the other expenses, which has increased drastically, could you just say? And do you think after DFC comes in full force, we will have expenses increasing on the haulage charges because now fuel prices have increased, everything. We become more competitive with DFC operating come June. So what do you think the haulage charges could be at this level, hovering at whatever the number is right now?

Sanjay Swarup: I will answer your second part first. And then the first part, I will request my Principal Executive

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Railways. There is no difference at all. So if I run train on Indian Railways or I run train on DFC, I have to pay the same money. There's no difference at all.

But in the double stack, you may be aware that containers, which are moving on upper deck, we have to pay 50% haulage charges. So I will have some savings on that. So I will share a part of that saving with my customers by tinkering on tariffs with -- for containers, which are moving on upper deck. So then my tariff for upper deck will become competitive with road tariff. So I will be able to attract business on upper deck. As far as the question for other charges...

Krishnendu Saha: No, I get that. I was just trying to understand whether you see an increase in haulage charges. I get the economics of upper and lower deck and so on and so forth. But is there -- do you see in the light in the recent happening of all this war and etc, etc, we don't get any details, but do you see any increase in haulage charges as a whole for the Indian Railways, from the Indian Railways to us? That's what I was trying to drive at.

Sanjay Swarup: Okay. Okay. See, that is actually -- that I can't comment. That is a decision taken by Indian Railways. But at present, I can tell you there is no such move that Indian Railways is going to increase the haulage charges.

Krishnendu Saha: Sure thing. And the other expenses...

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. Other charges, Mr. Harish Chandra, our Principal Executive Director, I will request him to answer your question.

Krishnendu Saha: Yes, sir. Yes.

Harish Chandra: In fact, the element of rail freight and other operating expenses, we have shown separately and the other expenses normally include the expenses related to maintenance, the legal expenses and the expenses related to security at our terminals. So there has been some increase in our maintenance expenses and the AMCs which are payable for our contracts because we have also set up a DR site last year. So the maintenance cost of that has also gone up. So because of these elements, like CSR expenses and maintenance expenses, there is some increase in the other expenses during the year.

Krishnendu Saha: So is this INR120 crores, is this the run rate we look at for every year? Or is it like this is just a 1 quarter phenomenon?

Harish Chandra: No, this is not a one-off. This will be basically -- this will be a recurring expense. Maintenance is a recurring expense.

Krishnendu Saha: No, no. What might drive that? So the expenses we

re around 3.53 so on an average, for this

quarter, it shot up to 5.3%, 5.4%, practically 2 percentage more. So just trying to drive that, whether this expenditure will normalize at 3.54, or it is going to be at 5.4%, 5.5%. So that takes out 1.5 percentage of my EBITDA margin so that helps you later. So just trying to drive that...

Harish Chandra: No, the expense for the year, if you see in the other expenses, it is INR358 crores.

Krishnendu Saha: Yes, yes. That's for the whole year. I'm just trying to drive for the quarter.

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Harish Chandra: Yes. So on an average, you can see the expenses would be around INR70 crores to INR80 crores per quarter. INR80 crores, you can say.

Krishnendu Saha: Yes. It's in between INR80 crores, INR90 crores. But this year, it is INR120 crores.

Harish Chandra: Yes.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, we will take this as the last question for the day. I now hand the conference over to the management for the closing comments.

Sanjay Swarup: Yes. All I can assure my shareholders is that the company has, over the years, earned a very good name in -- among all its stakeholders, and we are able to give best service to the customers, and without sacrificing our margins. We have a world-class infrastructure. We are standing on very strong fundamentals, and all ethical working is there in our company.

And we have got good contacts, good relationships and with all stakeholders, including various government departments, various customers and other business associates, so they value our company very much. And this confidence has been reposed every year, we are getting more and more business.

Government is also decided -- government decided to make our company an important stakeholder when they decided to constitute Bharat Container Shipping Line. That goes a very strong testimonial from the government for the good governance that is prevalent in your company.



So all I can say is that we will continue to do that, serve the EXIM and domestic trade to the best of our capabilities. And we hope that the coming -- this financial year will bring much, much, much better results. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you so much, sir. On behalf of DAM Capital Advisors, that concludes this conference.

Thank you all for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Conference Name:

Time:

Sr. No. Name Phone Company

1 Host: Kunal Shah 2242022578 DAM Capital  
2 Host: Management 1141673000 Container Corporation of India  
3 Abhijit Kaale 8085949726 Citi Group  
4Abhishek Kumar 6569235178 Bam Asset Management  
5Abhishek P 9831477912 Informist  
6Abhishek Poddar 6563515200 Citadel  
7Abhishek Rathii 6568122156 Polymer Capital  
8Achal Lohade 9136727590 Nuvama  
9Aditya Mongia 9833234463 Kotak Securities  
10Akash Goel 9830519144 Tara Capital  
11Akash Kumar 9920804560 Bandhan AMC  
12Akash Mehta 9892138178 Canara HSBC Life  
13Akshata Thakur 7208211260 Asian Market Securities  
14Akshay Sharma 7303854285 Abakkus  
15Alok Deora 9820513792 MOSL  
16Amish Kanani 9833102393 Knowise Investments Mgmt  
17Amit Khurana 2265479735 Dolat Capital  
18Amit Kumar 8898708990 Determind Investment  
19Anadi Agarwal 2242246101 Jefferies  
20Anant Poddar 6355117027 P poddar Infra developers  
21Anish Rankawat Rankawat 9820563345 UTI MF  
22Ankit Jain 67800305 Mirae Asset  
23Ankita Shah 9820679464 Elara Capital  
24Anurag Katta 9998697378 Equirus Securities  
25Anurag Khandelwal 9650806954 Individual Investor  
26Arun Kumar 5103907767 Alpha Street  
27Ashish Shah 66316387 HDFC AMC  
28Ashish Shah 6566025000 Millennium Capital  
29Atul Kumar 9820034170 Salvation Capital  
30Ayush Abhijeet 8097436847 Whiteoak Capital  
31Balakrishna 4041970210 S&P Global  
32Bharat Parekh 2266505020 CLSA  
33Bharti Sawant 2267800306 Mirae Asset  
34Darshan Bavdane 7303020567 Electrum Portfolio Managers Pvt Ltd  
35Darshan Kumar 9619996886 CNBC  
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42Gaurav 9819427740 Jain Financial  
43Gaurav Narayan 9820073819 Valletoro  
44Girish 9819101512 Morgan Stanley  
45Hardik Chedda 8830714698 Lark  
46Harsh Dome 9967581549 Optimum Capital  
47Harshal Shah 8779640875 Container Corporation of India  
48Heet Patel 9909374685 Elara Capital  
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56Jignesh Makhwana 9930122599 Asian Market Securities  
57Jonas Bhutta 2243568068 Birla MF

58Kartik 8657949304 Kotak Securities  
 59Kaushal Chadarana 9820385213 individual investor  
 60Kenil Mehta 7666428772 Boring AMC  
 61Kevin 6578375417 London Stock Exchange  
 62Koundinaya 2242246159 Jefferies  
 63Krishnendu Saha 9892702832 Quantum AMC  
 64Krishti 61447845 Quantum AMC  
 65Krupa Shankar 9884128127 Avendus Spark  
 66Kushant Aror 69209663 Baroda BNP  
 67Lakshmi Narayan 9789951580 Ksema Wealth  
 68Lekha 9820654602 MC ResearchTHANK YOU FOR BEING WITH US  
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 Sr. No. Name Phone Company  
 69Mandar Pawar 8657989125 Kotak Mutual Funds  
 70Manish Chanda 9022535651 New Age Capital  
 71Manya Thakkar 9971734529 Bank Of America Securities  
 72Mitesh Shah 9820995883 OHM Portfolio  
 73Mohit Chugh 9034299517 Shubh Labh Research  
 74Mohit Jain 7400195462 Tara Capital  
 75Mukesh Saraf 9840016171 Avendus Spark  
 76Mukul Deshpande 9594906606 Insightful Investment Managers  
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 78Neil Ostwal 2261593165 PGIM India Asset Management  
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 83Priyanka 9820810432 Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance  
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 85Rachel Smith 7812306877 Aiera  
 86Raja Shekhar 4023391987 Vishal Portfolio Management  
 87Rajarshi Maitra 9820637133 Incred Equities  
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 89Remant Shah 61910261 SBI Life  
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 91Rithik Dhiman 66323075 Bank Of America  
 92Rohit Ohri 9870448599 Progressive Shares  
 93Ruchira Kagita 69854002 Individual Investor  
 94Sagar Gupta 2245630321 UBS Group  
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 97Sandesh Shetty 6463626880 HSBC  
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 103Shiva Hari 9620767145 Pinpoint Asset Management  
 104Shivam Agarwal 8877441119 Motilal Oswal  
 105Shivam Ghag 61291574 MOSL  
 106Shreyans 2266016079 LIC MF  
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 108Shriram Rajaram 9699085560 Sampada Capital  
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 114Sumit Kishor 2243251144 Axis Capital  
 115Tanmay 6569803834 Optimus Capital  
 116Tirth Khandelwal 8153035734 UTI AMC  
 117Udit Dhale 66328520 BOA  
 118Vaibhav Punjabi 9424852295 Phillip Capital

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120Vasant Joshi 69544414 CP invest  
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